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Managing Suppliers and Supplier Lifecycles

SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance

SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture)

SAP Ariba Supplier Risk

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Managing Suppliers and Supplier Lifecycles

This guide is for SAP Ariba buyer users seeking information on how to manage their suppliers, including common supplier information, supplier creation and onboarding, and supplier lifecycle processes.

Buyers manage common supplier information, on boarding, and supplier lifecycle processes to add new suppliers, collect and maintain supplier profile information, and decide which suppliers are qualified or preferred in specific domains.

This guide applies to:

- SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance
- SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture)
- SAP Ariba Supplier Risk

Related guides

[Quick reference to SAP Ariba Supplier Management solutions features](#)

[Supplier Management Setup and Administration Guide](#)

[Running Supplier Performance Management Reviews](#)

[Managing Projects, Teams, Documents, and Tasks](#)

[Strategic Sourcing and Supplier Management Group Descriptions](#)

[Monitoring Supplier Risk](#)

Features and Functions for Managing Suppliers and Supplier Lifecycles

Features and functions for managing suppliers and supplier lifecycles include tools for managing common supplier information, creating and onboarding suppliers, and managing qualification and other lifecycle processes. Their availability depends on your SAP Ariba solution package.

Table 1: Availability of Features and Functions for Managing Suppliers and Supplier Lifecycles by SAP Ariba solution

Feature or Function	SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture)	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance	SAP Ariba Supplier Risk	For More Information
Features and Functions for Managing Common Supplier Information				
Supplier profile summary (applicable panels and data)		✓	✓	About the Supplier Profile Summary [page 14]
Classic supplier 360° profile (applicable areas)	✓	✓	✓	About the Classic Supplier 360° Profile [page 26]
My Activities area on the Supplier Management dashboard	✓	✓		My Activities on the Supplier Management Dashboard [page 11]
My Suppliers area on the Supplier Management dashboard		✓		My Suppliers on the Supplier Management Dashboard [page 13]
Supplier search on the Supplier Management dashboard	✓	✓		Supplier and Supplier Management Project Search [page 59]
Manual supplier contact management	✓	✓	✓	Supplier Contact Management [page 46]
Supplier data snapshots	✓	✓		Creating a Supplier Data Snapshot [page 71]
Analytical reporting on supplier management projects, questionnaires, and tasks: facts and prepackaged lifecycle reports	✓	✓		Analytical Reporting on Suppliers and Supplier Management Projects [page 76]
Supplier Creation and Registration				

Feature or Function	SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture)	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance	SAP Ariba Supplier Risk	For More Information
Supplier request projects	✓	✓		Supplier Request Creation and Management [page 93]
Supplier registration projects	✓	✓		Supplier Registration Management [page 107]
Fulfillment and sourcing relationship establishment	✓	✓		Sourcing and Fulfillment (Trading) Relationships with Suppliers [page 149]
Manual ERP synchronization	✓	✓		Manually Synchronizing a Supplier to Your ERP System [page 155]
Supplier Lifecycle Management				
Supplier qualifications and disqualifications and miscellaneous supplier lifecycle processes		✓		Supplier Qualifications and Lifecycle Processes [page 158]
Preferred supplier management		✓		Preferred Supplier Management [page 222]
Classic Supplier performance management (SPM) projects	✓	✓		Running Supplier Performance Management Reviews
Modular Questionnaires and Certificate Management				
Modular questionnaire projects	✓	✓	✓	Modular Questionnaire and Supplier Certificate Management [page 231]
Certificate management	✓	✓	✓	Supplier Certificate Management [page 234]
Common Supplier Management Project Activities				
Questionnaire export to Microsoft Excel	✓	✓	✓ (modular questionnaires only)	Exporting a Supplier Management Questionnaire to Microsoft Excel [page 256]
Questionnaire version comparison	✓	✓	✓	Comparing Different Versions of a Supplier Management Questionnaire [page 258]

Feature or Function	SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture)	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance	SAP Ariba Supplier Risk	For More Information
Missing approver management	✓	✓	✓ (modular questionnaires only)	Adding a Missing Approver to a Supplier Management Project [page 261]

Common Supplier Information

About the Supplier Management Dashboard

The **Supplier Management** dashboard shows all of the activities and suppliers that you manage directly. You also search for suppliers there.

Use the **Supplier Management** dashboard to:

- Search for suppliers.
- Monitor your supplier management activities, such as the supplier requests you've created or the registrations you've started.
- Monitor the suppliers to which you've been assigned through buyer category assignments (the user matrix), including their qualifications and preferred status levels (SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance only).

On the **Supplier Management** dashboard, choose any supplier's name to see their profile. A supplier's profile includes all of the information your organization has gathered about them and all of their activities, supplier management projects, and lifecycle processes.

The **Supplier Management** dashboard is available in sites that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance or SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture).

Related Information

[My Activities on the Supplier Management Dashboard \[page 11\]](#)

[My Suppliers on the Supplier Management Dashboard \[page 13\]](#)

[Searching for Suppliers \[page 60\]](#)

My Activities on the Supplier Management Dashboard

The **My Activities** area of the **Supplier Management** dashboard shows information about the supplier management projects you've created so that you can monitor their progress and navigate to them easily.

You only see this area if you have permission to create a supplier management project (such as requesting a new supplier or inviting a supplier to register) and have created at least one project. In sites where the process project feature (SM-16798) is enabled, you also see this area if you're a decision-maker for at least one qualification process project.

The area shows a tile for each supplier lifecycle stage with the number of projects you've created or are a decision-maker for. Choose a tile to see a list of projects with the following information:

- The supplier name, which you can choose to open their profile.

- The projects that you created. Lifecycle tiles in the **My Activities** area are locale-specific, meaning that they only show the projects that you created in the current locale setting in your user preferences, and don't show projects that you created in any other locales. For example, if you create a supplier request with your locale set to **English-United States**, and then change your default locale to **Spanish-Mexico** and create another request, you only see the one request you created in the **Spanish-Mexico** locale.
- The current status of the project. If the project is still in approval, the **Status** column shows the number of days it has been in approval and the names of the outstanding approvers. You can use this information to monitor the approval's progress and send reminders as needed. Choose the filter icon (▼) to filter the activity list by status.
- For qualification, disqualification, and preferred supplier management projects (SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance only), the commodities and regions associated with the project.
- A **View** button, which you can choose to open the relevant area of the supplier's profile and review questionnaires, issue reinvestigations, or complete tasks.

The **My Activities** area only shows the supplier projects that you created manually and that require approval:

- If a supplier request you created is automatically approved, it doesn't show on the **Requests** tile.
- Supplier registrations created through automatic invitation or mass invitation don't show on the **Registration** tile.

📌 Note

In sites where the process project feature (SM-16798) is enabled:

- The **Qualifications** tile shows qualifications regardless of project type. It shows any legacy qualification projects you've created. It also shows any process qualification projects that you've created or are a decision-maker for.
- In addition to legacy disqualification projects, the **Disqualification** tile also shows discontinuation process projects created for qualification processes.

Related Information

[About the Supplier Management Dashboard \[page 11\]](#)

[Internal Supplier Requests \[page 93\]](#)

[New Supplier Registrations \[page 108\]](#)

[Supplier Qualification and Requalification Using Supplier Qualification Projects \[page 170\]](#)

[Supplier Disqualifications Using Supplier Disqualification Projects \[page 171\]](#)

[Qualification and Miscellaneous Supplier Management Process Projects \[page 188\]](#)

[Discontinuation Processes \[page 193\]](#)

[Preferred Category Statuses Management Projects \[page 223\]](#)

My Suppliers on the Supplier Management Dashboard

The **My Suppliers** area of the **Supplier Management** dashboard shows you the most recent activities for the suppliers to whom you've been assigned and who have at least one qualification, disqualification, or preferred supplier project.

The **My Suppliers** area is only available in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance solutions.

To see the **My Suppliers** area, you must be assigned to at least one supplier qualification, disqualification, or preferred supplier project or process based on a commodity and region combination using buyer category assignments (the user matrix).

The area shows the following information for each supplier you manage:

- Supplier name and ID. Choose a supplier's name to open their profile.
- Registration status.

→ Tip

An administrator can designate suppliers as qualified or preferred by importing data into your site. In this case, it's possible for suppliers to be qualified or preferred without having registered first, and their profile information can be incomplete as a result. You can use this registration status information to identify those suppliers and invite them to register and complete their profiles.

- The most recent activity, for example, if the supplier was recently qualified or disqualified, or achieved a preferred status level.
- The supplier's preferred category status levels, if any, which show as color-coded labels by status level. The preferred status labels include the number of categories for which the supplier has that status level. Choose the **Details** link to see the list of categories and regions for which the supplier has that preferred category status level.

The **My Suppliers** area includes a number of filters that you can use to show only the suppliers that meet specific criteria:

- **Preferred status filters**, which are links at the top of the area. There's an **All Status** link, and a link for each preferred level your organization uses. To apply one of these filters, choose the status level link. Each link shows the number of suppliers in the current list who have achieved that level for at least one commodity category and region. These numbers can change as you apply or clear other filters to change the current supplier list. To clear the filters, choose the **All Status** link.
- **Category and region filters**, which are dropdown menus. These filters apply to both preferred and qualified categories and regions. To apply them, select categories or regions on the dropdown menu, then choose **Done**. If you've applied one of these filters, the dropdown menu shows the number of filtered values present in the current supplier list. For example, if you selected five commodity categories, but the current list only includes suppliers who are preferred or qualified for two of those categories, the dropdown menu shows a (2). This number can change as you apply or clear other filters to change the current supplier list. To clear this filter, choose the dropdown menu, then choose **Clear**.
- **Registration and qualification status filters**, which are dropdown menus. To apply these filters, select statuses on the dropdown menu, then choose **Done**. If you've applied one of these filters, the dropdown menu shows the number of filter values present in the current supplier list. This number can change as you apply or clear other filters to change the current supplier list. To clear this filter, choose the dropdown menu, then choose **Clear**.
- A **primary supplier manager filter**. The supplier list shows the suppliers to which you've been assigned based on commodity and region combinations using buyer category assignments (the user matrix). The primary

supplier manager filter allows you to narrow the list to suppliers for which you've also been specified as primary supplier manager either in the supplier's profile or in a supplier data import. Select this filter to apply it, and clear it to remove it.

These filters are additive. Applying the first filter narrows the list to those suppliers who meet those initial criteria, and applying the second filter narrows the list down further to the list of suppliers that meet both criteria. In addition, the filter options that are available depend on the characteristics of the suppliers in the current list. Therefore, the filters you apply affect the options in the other filters. For example, if you filter by commodity category, the region filter only shows the regions that match the previously filtered categories; the registration status filter only shows the statuses for suppliers with the matching commodity categories; and so on.

Related Information

[About the Supplier Management Dashboard \[page 11\]](#)

[My Activities on the Supplier Management Dashboard \[page 11\]](#)

[About the Classic Supplier 360° Profile \[page 26\]](#)

[Assigning, Reassigning, or Removing a Primary Supplier Manager \[page 58\]](#)

[Inviting a Supplier to Register \[page 116\]](#)

[Supplier Qualification and Requalification Using Supplier Qualification Projects \[page 170\]](#)

[Qualification and Miscellaneous Supplier Management Process Projects \[page 188\]](#)

[Preferred Category Statuses Management Projects \[page 223\]](#)

Supplier Profiles

A supplier's profile provides a central view of their information and their activity with your organization. Depending on how your site is set up, your use either the supplier profile summary or the classic supplier 360° profile to view and manage suppliers.

[About the Supplier Profile Summary \[page 14\]](#)

[About the Classic Supplier 360° Profile \[page 26\]](#)

[Supplier IDs in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance \[page 40\]](#)

[About the Activity log Detail Area of the Supplier Profile \[page 45\]](#)

About the Supplier Profile Summary

The supplier profile summary shows all the information that your organization has collected about a supplier. Depending on your role, you can also manage common supplier information and activities from their profile summary.

You can view a supplier's profile summary by choosing their name on the **Supplier Management** dashboard, including in supplier search results.

The profile summary includes different panels for specific activities and types of information. The panels you see can vary depending on your organization's solution package and feature configuration.

Table 2: Supplier Profile Summary Panels and Applicable Solutions

	Panel or Area	Contents	Availability
1	Banner	Contact Information: Shows the supplier's main address and primary contact, if available. Choose the primary contact's name to see more details, and choose Manage Contacts to view or manage the supplier's contacts. The address information shown here can be from a supplier data import, replication from an integrated ERP system, or from mapped questions in the supplier request or another questionnaire.	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance SAP Ariba Supplier Risk Basic profile
1	Banner	Risk Exposure: The supplier's overall risk exposure. Choose the supplier risk level to see risk exposure and level by category. You can click View More Details to view all the supplier's risk information. If your organization uses more than four custom risk categories, the Risk Exposure popup shows the top four categories that have data, determined by weight or, in cases where weights are equal, by alphabetical order of names. It only shows categories that have data. For more information, see Monitoring Supplier Risk.	SAP Ariba Supplier Risk

	Panel or Area	Contents	Availability
1	Banner	Operational Score: The supplier's operational score from the Operational Supplier Evaluation app in SAP S/4HANA, cloud edition, based on your organization's purchasing history with them. This score is the current calculation based on the weighted average of the quantity variance, price variance, and time variance over the past 180 days. Choose the score to view scores for specific key indicators, and click View More Details to see more information in the Operational Supplier Evaluation app. Operational Score is available in sites integrated with the SAP S/4HANA, cloud edition Operational Supplier Evaluation app.	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance
1	Banner	Lifecycle Status: a color-coded indicator of the supplier's progress through lifecycle stages such as registration, qualification, and preferred category status. Choose an icon to see the status, and choose a status link to open the related profile detail page. For supplier registration, qualification, and preferred category statuses managed through projects, SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance is required.	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance SAP Ariba Supplier Risk

	Panel or Area	Contents	Availability
1	Banner	Activity Status: an indicator that the supplier is inactive or has a common block. This area doesn't show in the profiles of active, unblocked suppliers. It only shows if a supplier has at least one of these statuses: Inactive, meaning that the supplier has been inactivated by an administrator in your organization or the integrated ERP system. Your organization can inactivate suppliers they no longer want to work with. Inactivation preserves a supplier's information and previous transactions, but they're read only. It's not possible to edit the supplier's information, start new supplier management activities for them, or create transactions such as sourcing events with them. Blocked, meaning that the supplier is flagged for a common block. Blocking is typically a less drastic measure than inactivation, and indicates that a supplier isn't suitable to work with at the moment, but can become available again. The supplier is still editable.	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance SAP Ariba Supplier Risk

Note

A common block means that the vendor . vendor I

	Panel or Area	Contents	Availability
		infoExt.commonBlockedIndicator field in the supplier record is set to true. The Activity Status area doesn't show a Blocked status for payment, purchasing, company code-specific, or purchasing organization-specific blocks.	
2	Quick Links	Quick links to common supplier management activities, including: - Basic quick links: Contacts Preferred ERP Data - Additional SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance quick links: Processes Certificates Activity Log Risk Supplier Request Registration Qualifications Questionnaires Use these quick links to view or manage the related activity.	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance SAP Ariba Supplier Risk

	Panel or Area	Contents	Availability
3	Supplier Status	An overview of the supplier's statuses for various lifecycle activities. The panel shows the following information for the supplier: • ERP Integration Status: Whether the supplier has been synchronized to an integrated ERP system. • Registration Status: The supplier's progress towards registration. Click the status to view registration details, if available. For more information, refer to About the Registration Detail Area in the Supplier Profile [page 114]. • Qualification Status: The number of the supplier's qualified categories, if the supplier has any qualifications. Click the number to view qualification details. For more information, refer to About the Qualifications Detail Area in the Supplier Profile [page 158]. • Preferred Status: The number of preferred categories, if the supplier is preferred for specific categories. Click the number to view preferred category status details. For more information, refer to About the Preferred Detail Area in the Supplier Profile [page 224]. For supplier registration, qualification, and preferred category statuses managed through projects, SAP Ariba	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance SAP Ariba Supplier Risk

	Panel or Area	Contents	Availability
		Supplier Lifecycle and Performance is required. Otherwise, qualified and preferred category statuses can be set through data import. Statuses that aren't available in your solution package, or for which there's no data, show a '-'.	
4	Supplier IDs	The IDs associated with the supplier, including SM Vendor ID, ERP ID, AN ID, and ACM ID. Choose copy () to copy an ID to your computer clipboard. For more information on these supplier IDs, see Supplier IDs in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance [page 40]. IDs that aren't available in your solution package, or for which there's no data, show a '-'.	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance SAP Ariba Supplier Risk
5	Supplier Contacts	The primary supplier contact, if available. Choose the panel to view or manage all contacts. For details, see to About the Contacts Detail Area of the Supplier Profile [page 47].	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance SAP Ariba Supplier Risk

	Panel or Area	Contents	Availability
6	Certificates	Supplier certificates from up to two different sources: Supplier Management: The number of certificates the supplier has in Valid, Expiring Soon, or Expired status that were collected by your organization in approved questionnaires. Choose one of these numbers to open the Certificates detail area of the supplier's profile and view details for these certificates. Managers or owners of the modular questionnaires where the certificates are collected can in some cases request updates from the supplier. For details, refer to Supplier Certificate Management [page 234]. SAP Business Network: The number of certificates the supplier maintains in their SAP Business Network profile in Valid or Expired status, as well as Total number of certificates. This certificate information is only available if a supplier has a linked SAP Business Network account and has added at least one certificate to their profile there. Choose one of these numbers to open the Certifications area of the supplier's SAP Business Network account in a new tab and view details for these certificates. If you	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance SAP Ariba Supplier Risk

Panel or Area	Contents	Availability
	have a user account in your organization's SAP Business Network buyer account, you can use it to ask the supplier to add or update the certificates they maintain in their SAP Business Network account. SAP Business Network certificates are self-reported by the supplier. Supplier Management certificates, on the other hand, are collected by your organization in approved supplier management questionnaires. The information in these two lists can be different: • The supplier can add a certificate to their SAP Business Network profile that they haven't reported to your organization when answering a questionnaire, or conversely. • The supplier can update an expired certificate with a new, future expiration date in their SAP Business Network profile without updating the questionnaire where you collected the information, or conversely. • The supplier can add or update a certificate in both places, but the questionnaire update can still be pending approval. • The Supplier Management list distinguishes between Expiring and Valid certificates.	

	Panel or Area	Contents	Availability
		In the SAP Business Network list, both show as Valid .	
7	SAP Business Network Profile	The supplier's public profile on SAP Business Network, which is information they maintain about themselves and can include number of employees, year founded, business type, revenue, Dun & Bradstreet number, and other details. The panel shows the supplier's name on SAP Business Network and their rating. Click the panel to open their complete profile on SAP Business Network in a new tab. This information panel is only available if a supplier has a linked SAP Business Network account.	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance SAP Ariba Supplier Risk
8	Questionnaires	A summary of up to five of the supplier's modular questionnaires with the most recent updates. Click the panel to view all the supplier's modular questionnaires, see questionnaire details, or manage questionnaires and their tasks. For more information, refer to About the Questionnaires Detail Area in the Supplier Profile [page 232]. This panel lists questionnaire name, type, and status, but currently doesn't include questionnaire scores.	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance SAP Ariba Supplier Risk

	Panel or Area	Contents	Availability
9	Qualifications	The number of qualifications in different statuses, if available. Click the panel to view all qualification details and to create or manage qualifications. For more information, refer to About the Qualifications Detail Area in the Supplier Profile [page 158] .	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance

Related Information

[Supplier Profile Summary Navigation \[page 24\]](#)

Supplier Profile Summary Navigation

You can use breadcrumbs and useful links to navigate between the supplier profile summary and profile detail pages, where you view and manage supplier information and lifecycle activities.

Navigation to and from the Profile Summary

You can use breadcrumbs to navigate between the supplier profile summary, the profile detail pages you open from the summary, and your previous location.

Choosing a supplier's name on the **Supplier Management** dashboard opens their profile summary. From there, you can use breadcrumbs to navigate back to a previous page. For example, you can search for **Supplier ABC** and open their profile summary from search results. The resulting breadcrumbs in the banner of the profile summary show the navigation path, which you can use to return to search results:

[Search](#) / [Supplier ABC](#)

In the supplier profile summary, you can choose links or cards to navigate to profile detail pages. You can then use breadcrumbs on profile detail pages to navigate back to the profile summary or to your previous location. For example, once you've searched for **Supplier ABC** and opened their profile summary, you can choose the **Contacts** panel to view their contact details. The resulting breadcrumb in the **Contacts** detail area shows the complete navigation path from search:

[Search](#) / [Supplier ABC](#) / [Contacts](#)

The **Search** breadcrumb represents the supplier search page on the **Supplier Management** dashboard.

In sites that include SAP Ariba Supplier Risk, a **Risk Information** breadcrumb represents navigation steps for risk-related pages, including supplier search and other areas of the **Supplier Risk** dashboard as well as engagement detail pages. Choose the **Risk Information** breadcrumb to return to the original risk-related page in the navigation path.

→ Tip

For reliable navigation, always use breadcrumbs rather than your browser's back button or the back arrow (**Go to Dashboard**) in the site banner.

Navigation to and from Guided Sourcing Pages

Choosing a supplier name in the following areas opens the supplier's profile summary:

- The **Invite suppliers** page in the creation workflow for guided sourcing events
- On the **For You** dashboard:
 - Draft events with invited suppliers
 - Events awaiting publication approval with invited suppliers
 - Pending selection and awarded events with participating suppliers
 - Event lists opened from the **RFx** link in the **Quick Links** panel

When navigating from a guided sourcing page to a supplier's profile summary, a **Sourcing** breadcrumb returns you to your original location in guided sourcing.

Navigation Between Profile Detail Pages

On profile detail pages, **Useful Links** to the most commonly used profile detail areas allow you to navigate directly between those areas without returning to the supplier profile summary. Depending on your organization's solution package and your site's configuration, the **Useful Links** list can include the following links:

Table 3: Useful Links

Link	Availability
Contacts	Always.
Certificates	Always.
Registration	In sites that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance or SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture).
Qualifications	In sites that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance. Depending on your site's configuration, it can show at all times or only after the supplier has a registration status of Registered .

Link	Availability
Preferred	In sites that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance, after the supplier has at least one approved qualification.
Questionnaires	Always.
Processes	In sites that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance where the process feature (SM-16798) is enabled.

Choose a link to navigate directly to that profile detail area.

If you want to navigate to a profile detail area that isn't included in **Useful Links**, such as the **Activity log**, choose the supplier's name in the breadcrumbs to return to their profile summary. From the profile summary, you can navigate to any profile detail area.

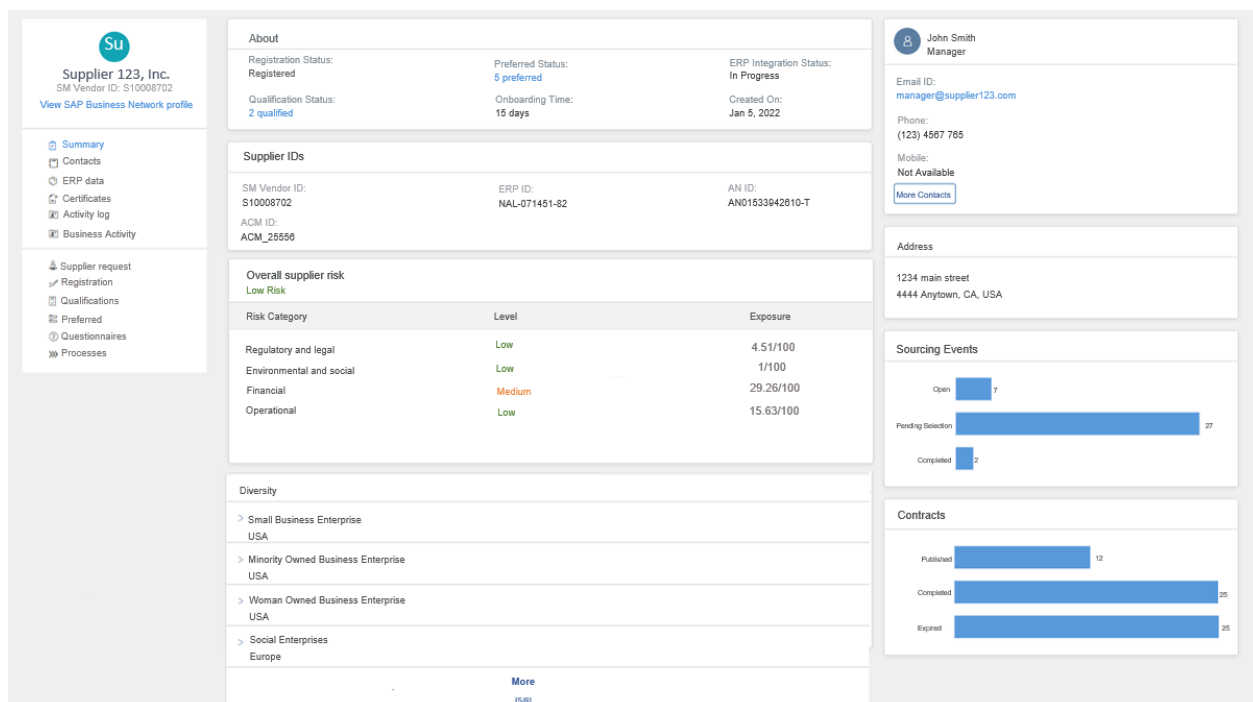
Related Information

[About the Supplier Profile Summary \[page 14\]](#)

About the Classic Supplier 360° Profile

The classic supplier 360° profile shows all the information that your organization has collected about a supplier in separate areas, and provides tools for managing common supplier information, onboarding, and lifecycle activities.

Depending on how your site is set up, you use either the supplier profile summary or the classic supplier 360° profile to view and manage suppliers. The classic supplier 360° profile opens on a **Summary** area by default and includes a navigation panel with the supplier's name. If your site uses the profile summary instead, most of the same information is available there in a different layout. For more information, see [About the Supplier Profile Summary \[page 14\]](#).



You can open a supplier's profile by choosing the supplier's name on dashboards, in search results, and in associated projects and events. The classic supplier 360° profile includes different areas for specific activities and types of information. The areas you see vary depending on your site's solution package and feature enablement. In the navigation bar, choose the link for an area to view it.

Table 4: Classic Supplier 360° Profile Areas and Applicable Solutions

This profile area...	Shows...	...and is available in...
Summary	Basic information for the supplier in the About, Diversity, Address, contacts and Supplier IDs panels. In sites that include SAP Ariba Supplier Risk, the Overall supplier risk panel also shows a summary of the supplier's risk exposure information. For details, refer to About the Summary Area of the Classic Supplier 360° Profile [page 34].	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture) SAP Ariba Supplier Risk

This profile area...	Shows...	...and is available in...
Contacts	All the external contacts associated with the supplier, including the primary supplier contact, and the internal primary supplier manager assigned to the supplier, if any. You can manage both supplier contacts and primary supplier manager in this area. For details, refer to About the Contacts Detail Area of the Supplier Profile [page 47].	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture) SAP Ariba Supplier Risk
ERP data	All questionnaire answers that are mapped to ERP-related fields, any information from an integrated ERP system, and the current integration status of the supplier. Manually synchronization and resynchronization of the supplier to an integrated ERP system is available in this area. For details, refer to Manually Synchronizing a Supplier to Your ERP System [page 155].	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture) SAP Ariba Supplier Risk
Risk	Information about the supplier's risk exposure. For details, refer to Monitoring Supplier Risk.	SAP Ariba Supplier Risk
View SAP Business Network profile	Link to access the supplier's SAP Business Network profile. The link is available when the supplier is registered in the SAP Business Network and has an AN ID. You can view the supplier's business profile in a new browser tab allowing you to work concurrently on supplier management and the SAP Business Network. Note If the browser locale is different from the user locale in supplier management, the SAP Business Network profile opens with the browser locale.	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture) SAP Ariba Supplier Risk

This profile area...	Shows...	...and is available in...
Certificates	All the certificates associated with the supplier. Each certificate has a summary card that shows its name; whether it's valid, expiring, or expired; and its expiration date. Choose a certificate card to see all certificate details, including the certificate attachment and the questionnaire where it was collected. For details, refer to Supplier Certificate Management [page 234].	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture) SAP Ariba Supplier Risk
Activity log	A record of project activities, including automated activities. This activity log is separate from the History tab in the project advanced view. For details, refer to About the Activity log Detail Area of the Supplier Profile [page 45].	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture) SAP Ariba Supplier Risk
Business activity	Lists the supplier's activities in other SAP Ariba applications. You can filter the business activities based on type and status. You can find specific activities by using the search bar. Clicking the activity name takes you to the respective application giving details about the supplier's activity. For sourcing events and contracts, the area shows up to 200 of the most recent activities that you're authorized to view for each status. The Business activity area is only available if an administrator has enabled the following parameters in ► SM Administration ► Configuration Parameters ►: • Application.SM.UI.SourcingSummary • Application.SM.UI.ContractsSummary For details, refer to About the Business Activity Area of the Classic Supplier 360° Profile [page 38]	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture) SAP Ariba Supplier Risk

This profile area...	Shows...	...and is available in...
Supplier request	The supplier request, for suppliers created from an approved supplier request. This area always includes the original information from the supplier request at the time of its approval. The Requested by field shows the person in your organization who created the request. Request approval flows can include multiple approvers. The Approved by field always shows the final approver in the request's approval flow.	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture)
Registration	Current information about the supplier's registration. If registration hasn't started for the supplier, registration managers invite the supplier to register here. Otherwise, this area shows questionnaires, tasks, and a process flow diagram for the in-progress or completed supplier registration or the current registration update. Registration managers, internal questionnaire editors, and To Do task owners fill out internal registration questionnaires, and approvers approve registration questionnaires in this area. For details, refer to About the Registration Detail Area in the Supplier Profile [page 114].	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture)

This profile area...	Shows...	...and is available in...
Qualifications	Qualifications and disqualifications for a supplier. In this area, if your organization uses supplier qualification and disqualification projects to manage qualifications: • Qualification managers start new qualifications, disqualifications, or requalifications. • Internal questionnaire editors or To Do task owners fill out internal qualification questionnaires. • Approvers approve qualifications, disqualifications, and requalifications. In this area, if your organization uses process projects to manage supplier qualifications: • Process initiators start, renew, cancel, or discontinue qualification processes. • Internal modular questionnaire recipients submit their assigned questionnaires. • Decision-makers set or change qualification process statuses. For details, refer to About the Qualifications Detail Area in the Supplier Profile [page 158]. This area only shows in the profiles of suppliers that have achieved Registered registration status. If your organization uses process qualifications, you can view and manage them either in the Qualifications area (for registered suppliers only) or the Processes area (for all suppliers regardless of registration status). In SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture), this area only shows if there's imported qualification data for the supplier. Associated lifecycle projects aren't available.	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture)

This profile area...	Shows...	...and is available in...
Preferred	Preferred category statuses for a supplier. Category or supplier managers request or remove preferred category statuses in this area. This area only shows in the profiles of suppliers with at least one approved qualification. In SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture), this area only shows if there's imported preferred data for the supplier. Associated lifecycle projects aren't available.	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture)
Questionnaires	Modular questionnaire projects associated with the supplier. These modular questionnaire projects can be standalone questionnaires, questionnaires included in process projects, or risk assessments included in engagement risk assessment projects. In this area: - To Do task owners and internal form editors perform assigned tasks and edit internal forms in questionnaire projects. - Internal questionnaire recipients edit assigned questionnaires. - Approvers approve forms or questionnaires. Questionnaire managers request updates or reassign questionnaires to different recipients. For details, refer to About the Questionnaires Detail Area in the Supplier Profile [page 232].	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture) SAP Ariba Supplier Risk

This profile area...	Shows...	...and is available in...
Processes	All types of processes for a supplier, including qualification and miscellaneous processes. This area is available in sites where the modular process framework feature (SM-16798) is enabled. In this area: • Process initiators start, renew, cancel, or discontinue qualification or miscellaneous processes. • Internal modular questionnaire recipients submit their assigned questionnaires. • Decision-makers set or change process statuses. For details, refer to About the Processes Detail Area in the Supplier Profile [page 162].	SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance

📘 Note

- If the supplier is public (has an SAP Business Network account that is linked to your site), the name they maintain in their SAP Business Network supplier account shows as their **Public** name in their supplier 360° profile and their ANID also shows.
- A supplier's classic 360° profile shows the **ERP Vendor ID** if the vendorErpId field in the supplier's database record has a value and either:
 - the supplier is **Integrated**.
 - the supplier's source system is **SAP**.

Members of the **SM Ops Administrator** group can export supplier data in **SM Administration** to view supplier source system information.

Related Information

[Risk Exposure Information in a Supplier's Profile](#)

[About the Summary Area of the Classic Supplier 360° Profile \[page 34\]](#)

[About the Contacts Detail Area of the Supplier Profile \[page 47\]](#)

[About the Activity log Detail Area of the Supplier Profile \[page 45\]](#)

[Supplier Certificate Management \[page 234\]](#)

[About the Registration Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 114\]](#)

[About the Qualifications Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 158\]](#)

[About the Preferred Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 224\]](#)

[About the Questionnaires Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 232\]](#)

[About the Processes Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 162\]](#)

About the Summary Area of the Classic Supplier 360° Profile

The **Summary** area provides basic information about the supplier.

If your site uses the classic supplier 360° profile, it includes a **Summary** area with basic information about the supplier. If your site uses the supplier profile summary, see [About the Supplier Profile Summary \[page 14\]](#).

The screenshot displays the 'Summary' area of a supplier profile for 'Supplier 123, Inc.' (SM Vendor ID: S10008702). The interface includes a left-hand navigation menu with options like Summary, Contacts, ERP data, Certificates, Activity log, Business Activity, Supplier request, Registration, Qualifications, Preferred, Questionnaires, and Processes. The main content area is divided into several sections: 'About' (Registration Status: Registered, Preferred Status: 5 preferred, ERP Integration Status: In Progress, Qualification Status: 2 qualified, Onboarding Time: 15 days, Created On: Jan 5, 2022), 'Supplier IDs' (SM Vendor ID: S10008702, ERP ID: NAL-071451-82, AN ID: AN01533942610-T, ACM ID: ACM_25556), 'Overall supplier risk' (Low Risk), a risk table, 'Diversity' (listing Small Business Enterprise, Minority Owned Business Enterprise, Woman Owned Business Enterprise, and Social Enterprises), and a 'More' link. The right-hand sidebar shows contact information for John Smith (Manager), including email (manager@supplier123.com), phone ((123) 4567 765), and mobile (Not Available), along with a 'More Contacts' button. Below this is the 'Address' (1234 main street, 4444 Anytown, CA, USA) and two bar charts: 'Sourcing Events' (Open: 7, Pending Selection: 27, Completed: 2) and 'Contracts' (Published: 12, Completed: 25, Expired: 25).

Risk Category	Level	Exposure
Regulatory and legal	Low	4.51/100
Environmental and social	Low	1/100
Financial	Medium	29.26/100
Operational	Low	15.63/100

Event Type	Count
Open	7
Pending Selection	27
Completed	2

Contract Type	Count
Published	12
Completed	25
Expired	25

This Profile Area...	Shows...
About	An overview of the supplier's registration, preferred, ERP synchronization, and qualification statuses along with the onboarding time and the date. You can click the Preferred Status and Qualification Status to view the preferred and qualification details for the supplier 360° profile. The About panel shows the following information for the supplier: • Registration Status: the registration status of the supplier. • Preferred Status: the number of preferred categories, if the supplier is preferred for specific categories. Choose the status to view the preferred details. • ERP Integration Status: whether the ERP synchronization is in progress or is completed. In sites integrated with an SAP ERP system, it shows the integration status for the supplier. • Qualification Status: the total number of supplier's qualified categories including legacy qualification and process qualification projects. Choose the status to view the qualification details. • Onboarding Time: the time from when the supplier's registration is started and when they're registered. It's available when all the tasks related to an internal or external registration are approved and the supplier's registration status is Registered. It's not available if the supplier is in Not invited status, hasn't yet been registered, or has achieved Registered status from a data import. • Created On: the date when the supplier request is approved.
Contacts	The primary supplier contact name, title, e-mail address, and phone in the Contact panel. To manage and view all the external and internal contacts, choose More Contacts. For more information, see About the Contacts Detail Area of the Supplier Profile [page 47].
Overall Supplier Risk	The supplier's risk category, level, and exposure. You can see the date and time when the risk exposure was last updated. Choose Overall supplier risk or the risk level to view details about the supplier's risk exposure. This area is only available in sites that include SAP Ariba Supplier Risk. For more information, see Monitoring Supplier Risk.

This Profile Area...	Shows...
Diversity	Diversity information about the supplier, if available. This diversity information can include: • Diversity type, which is a category defined by your organization, and the region where it's applicable. • Background information about the supplier providing information about their diversity categorization. An administrator in your organization imports diversity data for suppliers.
Address	The supplier address, if available. This address comes from vendor . address or vendor . extendedAddress fields in the supplier database, meaning that it can show an address from a supplier data import, an integrated ERP system, or mapped questions in the supplier request or another supplier management questionnaire.
Supplier IDs	The IDs associated with the supplier, including SM Vendor ID, ERP ID, AN ID, and ACM ID. For more information, see Supplier IDs in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance [page 40].

This Profile Area...

Sourcing Events

Shows...

The sourcing events that the supplier has participated in, including the number of **Open**, **Pending**, and **Completed** events. This panel shows events created in both guided sourcing and legacy sourcing. The panel shows the latest 200 sourcing events for each status when there are large number of events.

If you're not a member of the **Category Buyer** group but are authorized to view sourcing events created in guided sourcing, the events open in classic sourcing.

If you're a member of the **Category Buyer** group, you can view events created in guided sourcing in guided sourcing and classic sourcing events in classic sourcing.

Event data isn't available when:

- You have access, but there are no events created or the only existing events are test projects, which don't show here.
- You don't have access to the available events. This panel only shows events you're authorized to see.

Note

This panel isn't available by default. An administrator in your organization must enable the **Application.SM.UI.SourcingSummary** parameter in

► **SM Administration** ► **Configuration Parameters** ► to show the **Sourcing Events** panel in the **Summary** area and the **Business activity** area of the classic supplier 360° profile.

This Profile Area...	Shows...
Contracts	The contracts the supplier has participated in, including the number of Published, Draft Amendment, and Expired contracts. The panel shows the latest 200 contracts for each status when there are large number of contracts. Contracts data isn't available when: - You have access, but there are no contract workspaces created or the only existing contracts are test projects, which don't show here. - You don't have access to available contracts. This panel only shows the contracts that you're authorized to see. Note This panel isn't available by default. An administrator in your organization must enable the Application.SM.UI.ContractsSummary parameter in SM Administration > Configuration Parameters to show the Contracts panel in the Summary area and the Business activity area of the classic supplier 360° profile.

Related Information

[About the Preferred Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 224\]](#)
[About the Qualifications Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 158\]](#)
[About the Registration Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 114\]](#)
[Risk Exposure Information in a Supplier's Profile](#)
[Vendor Diversity Data File Format](#)

About the Business Activity Area of the Classic Supplier 360° Profile

The **Business Activity** area gives an overview list of the supplier's activities in other SAP Ariba applications.

The **Business Activity** area is only available in the classic supplier 360° profile. If your site uses the supplier profile summary, see [About the Supplier Profile Summary \[page 14\]](#).

The **Business Activity** area in the supplier 360° profile gives an overview of the supplier's activities in other SAP Ariba applications. You can filter sourcing events and contracts based on their statuses. For specific sourcing events or contracts, you can search based on the **Name** and **ID** using the search bar.



Supplier 123, Inc.

SM Vendor ID: S10023456
ERP Vendor ID: VDR123456

- Summary
- Contacts
- ERP data
- Certificates
- Activity log
- Risk
- Business activity

- Supplier request
- Registration
- Qualifications
- Preferred
- Questionnaires
- Processes

Contracts

All

Search for ID or Name

NAME	ID	STATUS	EFFECTIVE DATE	EXPIRATION DATE
Event 1	SE01234	Published	09/04/2022	10/11/2022
TestEvent 1	SE00134	Draft Amendment	06/01/2022	-
Sourcing Event 1	SE001234	Draft Amendment	08/19/2022	12/19/2022
Sourcing Event 2	SE199234	Expired		-
Event 2	SE177234	Expired	08/29/2022	-

This area doesn't show any information for test projects.

This Business Activity...

Sourcing

Shows...

The sourcing events that the supplier has participated in. The table shows **Name**, **ID**, **Event Type**, **Status** of the event, and **Participation Status** of the supplier. Choose an event name to open it. You can only see the sourcing events to which you have access.

If you're not a member of the **Category Buyer** group but are authorized to view sourcing events created in guided sourcing, the events open in classic sourcing.

If you're a member of the **Category Buyer** group, you can view events created in guided sourcing in the guided sourcing application and the classic sourcing events in the classic sourcing application.

Note

Sourcing event information isn't available by default. An administrator in your organization must enable the **Application.SM.UI.SourcingSummary** parameter in **SM Administration > Configuration Parameters** to show the **Sourcing Events** panel in the **Summary** area and the **Business activity** area in the supplier 360° profile.

This Business Activity...	Shows...
Contracts	The supplier's contracts along with the Name, ID, Status, Effective Date, and Expiration Date. Choose a contract's name to open it. You can only see the contracts to which you have access.  Note Contract information isn't available by default. An administrator in your organization must enable the Application.SM.UI.ContractsSummary parameter in SM Administration > Configuration Parameters to show the Contracts panel in the Summary area and the Business activity area in the supplier 360° profile.

Related Information

[About the Classic Supplier 360° Profile \[page 26\]](#)

[About the Summary Area of the Classic Supplier 360° Profile \[page 34\]](#)

[Reference of Configuration Parameters in Supplier Administration \[page 318\]](#)

[Managing Configuration Parameters in Supplier Administration \[page 353\]](#)

Supplier IDs in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance

Supplier data can flow through a number of different interconnected systems, including SAP Ariba applications, SAP Business Network, and integrated ERP systems. A supplier in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance or SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture) has several different IDs that identify them in these different systems.

A supplier in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance or SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture) can have the following IDs:

ID	Description	Field Names
ERP vendor ID	A mandatory ID for the supplier, which must be unique in combination with the supplier's source system. A supplier's ERP vendor ID can come from one of the following sources: • Automatic assignment by SAP Ariba: SAP Ariba automatically assigns an ERP vendor ID that starts with VDR and a source system of SM to all new suppliers created manually in SAP Ariba through an approved supplier request. In sites that are integrated with SAP ERP or SAP S/4HANA, this VDR ERP vendor ID serves as a placeholder until the supplier is synchronized to the integrated system and obtains the "real" ERP vendor ID. • Data import: Customer administrators can create suppliers in SAP Ariba by importing supplier data, which includes a required erpVendorId field. They can also use data import to update the erpVendorId in some circumstances. • Migration: When you migrate supplier organizations to the unified vendor model, a specific supplier or organization domain ID is migrated to the ERP vendor ID. Which organization ID is migrated depends on organization ID domains and migration options. Refer to Migrating Suppliers to the Unified Vendor Model for details about organization ID migration to ERP vendor IDs. • Synchronization from an integrated ERP system: Suppliers created by synchronization from an integrated SAP ERP or SAP S/4HANA system are created with the ERP vendor ID from that system. If a supplier is originally created in SAP	• ERP Vendor ID in supplier profiles • erpVendorId in data imports and exports in Manage > SM Administration • ERP Vendor ID in JSON responses for Supplier Data API with Pagination client applications • smsupplierid in the SupplierIDs.csv file used by supplier organization data import tasks for operational procurement in Manage > Core Administration > Site Manager > Data Import/Export, in sites that include SAP Ariba Procurement solutions such as SAP Ariba Buying or SAP Ariba Buying and Invoicing

ID	Description	Field Names
	Ariba with a VDR ERP vendor ID and then synchronized to an integrated ERP system, the VDR ERP vendor ID isn't sent to the integrated system. The integrated system creates a new vendor record and sends its ERP vendor ID back to SAP Ariba, where it replaces the supplier's placeholder VDR ID as ERP vendor ID.	
SM vendor ID	A unique ID that SAP Ariba assigns automatically to suppliers in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance or SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture). Supplier Data API with Pagination client applications use SM vendor IDs to retrieve or update data for specific suppliers.	• SM Vendor ID in supplier profiles • smVendorId in data imports and exports in SM Administration • SM Vendor ID in JSON responses for Supplier Data API with Pagination client applications
ACM ID	A unique ID assigned by SAP Ariba that identifies suppliers internally within SAP Ariba applications. It's also sometimes called the "S4 Org System ID" (the "S4" here isn't related to SAP S/4HANA). Suppliers created in SAP Ariba Strategic Sourcing and Supplier Management solutions typically have ACM IDs that start with ACM_. In suite-integrated sites, suppliers created in SAP Ariba Procurement solutions such as SAP Ariba Buying or SAP Ariba Buying and Invoicing start with buyer_. Migrated suppliers always have ACM IDs. In suite-integrated sites, common suppliers in SAP Ariba Procurement solutions are linked with corresponding suppliers in SAP Ariba Strategic Sourcing and Supplier Management solutions by having the same value for ACM ID (or organization ID in the buyersystemid domain in SAP Ariba Strategic Sourcing and Supplier Management solutions) and buyersystemid in SAP Ariba Procurement solutions.	• s4orgSystemId in data imports and exports in SM Administration • ACM ID in JSON responses for Supplier Data API with Pagination client applications

ID	Description	Field Names
DUNS ID	A unique identifier assigned to suppliers by Dun & Bradstreet, a company that maintains detailed information about companies, and also known as a D-U-N-S Number. Supplier DUNS IDs can come from a number of sources, including: • Data import in SM Administration • Mapped questions in supplier management questionnaires • SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance integration with Dun & Bradstreet • A public supplier's SAP Business Network profile • An integrated ERP system	• dunsId in data imports and exports in SM Administration • Duns Id in JSON responses for Supplier Data API with Pagination client applications

ID	Description	Field Names
ANID	An ID that SAP Business Network automatically assigns to suppliers when they create accounts there. A private supplier is a supplier that exists in your site but doesn't have a linked SAP Business Network account. (The supplier can have an SAP Business Network account, but if they do, it's not yet linked to your site.) A public supplier has a linked SAP Business Network account and an ANID in your site. The supplier's ANID in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance, including in the supplier profile, is their sourcing ANID and is associated with sourcing and supplier management activities. If your solution includes SAP Ariba Procurement solutions and you've established a fulfillment or trading relationship with them, they also have a transaction ANID for procurement activities such as orders and invoicing. In some cases, the supplier's sourcing and transaction ANIDs are different, and the ANID in the supplier's profile is therefore different from their ANID in Core Administration. It's possible in some cases for a supplier to have an ANID in their profile but not in their organization IDs.	• Ariba Network ID or ANID in supplier profiles • An Id in JSON responses for Supplier Data API with Pagination client applications Both of these fields hold the supplier's sourcing ANID.

ID	Description	Field Names
Business partner ID	An ID assigned to the supplier in an integrated SAP ERP, SAP S/4HANA, or SAP MDG system. If your solution includes both SAP Ariba Procurement solutions and SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance and you add suppliers from the integrated system using data import tasks in SAP Ariba Procurement solutions, it's important to include a business partner ID for every ERP supplier so that when they synchronize back from SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance to the ERP system, the ERP system recognizes it as an existing supplier.	• smbpid in the SupplierIDs.csv file used by supplier organization data import tasks for operational procurement in ► Manage ► Core Administration ► Site Manager ► Data Import/Export ►, in sites that include SAP Ariba Procurement solutions such as SAP Ariba Buying or SAP Ariba Buying and Invoicing

Related Information

[Sourcing and Fulfillment \(Trading\) Relationships with Suppliers \[page 149\]](#)

About the Activity log Detail Area of the Supplier Profile

The **Activity log** detail area in supplier profiles shows a record of project activities, including project activities that are automated.

Use the **Activity log** to view the **Date**, **User**, **Process Type**, **Activity Type**, **Title**, and **Details** of activities in supplier management projects.

The **Activity log** differs from the advanced view **History** tab in multiple ways. The **Activity log** aggregates and displays activity from multiple project types, whereas the **History** tab displays an audit trail of changes and activity in a specific project. You can't export data from the **Activity log**, but you can from the **History** tab. Also, the **Activity log** displays only dates, while the **History** tab displays timestamps.

You can search the **Activity log** for keyword data from the **Title** and **Details** columns. You can also filter the log by project type or activity type.

- Project types:
 - **Supplier Request**
 - **Supplier Registration**
 - **Supplier Qualification** (SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance only)
 - **Supplier Disqualification** (SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance only)
 - **Preferred Supplier** (SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance only)
 - **Modular Questionnaire**

- **SM Process Project** (SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance only, if your site uses process projects)
- Activity types:
 - **Document**
 - **Folder**
 - **Phase**
 - **Task**
 - **Team**
 - **Workspace**

Note

If you're authorized to view the advanced view of a project, you can also see its **History** tab, which includes detailed logs of project activities not included in the **Activity log**.

Related Information

[Viewing a Project's Activity History \[page 274\]](#)

Supplier Contact Management

Supplier contacts are people in the external supplier organization who can respond to questionnaires and perform other activities on behalf of the supplier. Managing these contacts makes the appropriate supplier organization representatives available for questionnaire invitations. Suppliers can also have an internal primary supplier manager, who is a person in your organization who either interacts with or can answer questions about the supplier.

[About the Contacts Detail Area of the Supplier Profile \[page 47\]](#)

[Supplier Contact Synchronization with SAP Business Network \[page 49\]](#)

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About the Contacts Detail Area of the Supplier Profile

Supplier contacts are the external people that you interact with while doing business with a supplier. A primary supplier manager is a person at your company who is familiar with the supplier. You view and manage these external and internal contacts in the **Contacts** detail area of the supplier profile.

Contacts

Supplier Manager

NAME		EMAIL	
A	Alice Jones	ajones@buyer123.com	⋮

Contacts of Supplier 123, Inc. (2)

NAME	TYPE	AN STATUS	REGION	CATEGORY	
★ Bob Smith bsmith@supplier123.com	N/A	Private	California	Office Equipment and Accessories and Supplies	⋮
Jane Chen	N/A	Private	USA	Paper Materials and Products	⋮
jchen@supplier123.com					

Contacts

Supplier contacts are external to your organization, but they can sign in to SAP Business Network to fill out questionnaires, participate in events, negotiate contracts, and perform other tasks in your site.

Approved supplier contacts are added to a supplier when:

- An administrator imports supplier contact data in your site.
- An approver approves a supplier request, which always includes an initial contact for the supplier.
- Someone in your organization who has appropriate permissions manually adds a contact to the supplier.
- Someone in the supplier organization creates a user in the supplier's SAP Business Network account and your site is configured to automatically synchronize them to the supplier's contacts in your site. Your site can be configured to auto-approve these contacts.

The **Contacts** detail area of the supplier profile shows the following information for all the contacts that have been added to the supplier in your site:

Column	Description
Name	The contact's first and last name.

Column	Description
Contact	The contact's email address, which is also their unique user name.
Type	The type of the contact, if any (for example, technical, accounts receivable, or legal).
AN Status	An indicator of whether or not the supplier contact is a known user who can sign in to the supplier's SAP Business Network account. A contact is a known user in the supplier's SAP Business Network account when they've responded to a questionnaire invitation or been synchronized from SAP Business Network. You can add contacts that don't have SAP Business Network users yet, but those contacts must create them to answer questionnaires. The links in notification emails to supplier contacts prompt them to either sign in or create an account on SAP Business Network.
Category	The commodity categories associated with the contact, if any.
Region	The regions associated with the contact, if any.
Department	The departments associated with the contact, if any. This column only shows in sites where departments are enabled.
Status	The contact status, which can be Approved , Pending Approval , or Denied .

You can click any of these column headings to sort the supplier contact list by the information in the column.

The current primary supplier contact is starred.

Depending on your permissions, in the **Contacts** area, you can:

- View details for any contact.
- Add or edit a contact.
- Delete any contact other than the primary contact.
- Approve or deny a contact from SAP Business Network.

Once a supplier contact is synchronized with SAP Business Network, the contact maintains their own first name, last name, email address, and phone number data. Any edits you make to that information are overwritten by the information from SAP Business Network. Any updates the supplier contact makes to those fields automatically show in their contact information in your site.

Supplier Manager

A primary supplier manager is internal to your organization, and is typically a person who is familiar with or interacts with the supplier. Each supplier can have one primary supplier manager. A primary supplier manager is added to a supplier when:

- An administrator imports primary supplier manager data in your site.
- Someone in your organization who has the required permissions manually adds a primary supplier manager to the supplier.

The **Contacts** detail area of the supplier profile shows the following information for the supplier's assigned supplier manager:

Column	Description
Name	The unique user name of the primary supplier manager in your site.
Email	The email address of the primary supplier manager.

Depending on your permissions, you can assign, reassign, or remove the primary supplier manager from here.

Related Information

[Adding or Editing a Supplier Contact \[page 50\]](#)

[Deleting a Supplier Contact \[page 55\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a New Supplier Contact from SAP Business Network \[page 57\]](#)

[Assigning, Reassigning, or Removing a Primary Supplier Manager \[page 58\]](#)

[About the Classic Supplier 360° Profile \[page 26\]](#)

Supplier Contact Synchronization with SAP Business Network

Depending on your site's configuration, new users in the supplier's SAP Business Network account can be automatically added as contacts in your site and can either be automatically approved or require manual approval.

Suppliers fill out and submit external questionnaires in their SAP Business Network accounts. If a supplier hasn't responded to any questionnaire or event invitations from you before, your site doesn't have a link to their SAP Business Network account and they're private. Once they respond to an invitation, your site is linked to their SAP Business Network account and they're public.

Supplier contacts created in your site are private at first. They're not synchronized to the supplier's SAP Business Network account and exist only in your site until you invite them to a sourcing event or an external questionnaire. If you do invite a private supplier contact to an event and that contact doesn't exist in the supplier's SAP Business Network account, the supplier account administrator must approve the contact before they can participate in the event. The supplier contact then maintains their own profile information on SAP Business Network, including name and contact information.

Once a supplier contact is public, their first name, last name, email address, and phone number are no longer editable in your site. The information in those fields is synchronized from SAP Business Network, where the supplier contact maintains it. Any updates the supplier contact makes to those fields in SAP Business Network show in your site. You continue to maintain the other information associated with the supplier contact, such as type, whether they're the primary contact, and associated commodities, regions, and departments.

Information you maintain about supplier contacts in your site, including question answers mapped to contact fields, is never synchronized to the supplier's SAP Business Network account. Suppliers and supplier contacts always maintain their own information about themselves on SAP Business Network.

On SAP Business Network, a supplier user can request the removal of their personal information from the supplier's SAP Business Network account. An administrator in the supplier SAP Business Network account approves the request. At that point, if the supplier user is a public supplier contact in your site, the contact is removed from the supplier's profile. They no longer have access to any of your supplier management questionnaires to which they were previously assigned.

Related Information

[About the Contacts Detail Area of the Supplier Profile \[page 47\]](#)

[Adding or Editing a Supplier Contact \[page 50\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a New Supplier Contact from SAP Business Network \[page 57\]](#)

Adding or Editing a Supplier Contact

Use these steps to add or edit a supplier contact in the supplier's profile so that they're available for event or questionnaire invitations and have the most current information. Supplier contacts are the people in the supplier organization who interact with your organization to register, fill out questionnaires, bid on events, and so forth.

Prerequisites

To add, edit, or delete a supplier contact in a supplier's profile or when inviting a supplier to a questionnaire, you must be a member of one of the following groups:

- **Supplier Registration Manager**
- **SM Ops Administrator**
- **Customer Administrator**
- **Category Manager**
- **Commodity Manager**
- **Event Administrator**
- **Limited Event Administrator**
- **Sourcing Project Administrator**
- **Supplier Project Administrator**
- **Supplier/Customer Manager**
- **Supplier/Customer Agent**

Members of the **Supplier Qualification Manager** group can add, but not edit or delete, supplier contacts in the supplier's profile and when inviting a supplier to a questionnaire.

Context

If you're adding the first contact to a supplier's profile, that contact automatically becomes the primary supplier contact.

→ Tip

Since a supplier must always have a primary contact, you can't toggle **Primary Contact** off when editing the current primary contact for the supplier. Instead, create or edit another supplier contact and toggle **Primary Contact** on for them. Doing so transfers primary status from the previous primary contact to the new or edited contact.

You can't edit an unapproved supplier contact.

Once a supplier contact is linked to an SAP Business Network account, the contact maintains their own first name, last name, email address, and phone number data, and those fields are no longer editable in your site. Any updates the supplier contact makes to those fields in their SAP Business Network profile automatically show in their contact information in your site.

You can create two different supplier contacts with the same email address for a supplier because the email addresses aren't case-sensitive. For example: you can create **emailaddress@company.com** and **Emailaddress@company.com**.

ⓘ Note

Although there's no limit to the number of contacts you can add to a supplier, a maximum of 1000 active contacts per supplier is made available for searching, in no particular order or priority and with no guarantee that one of those 1000 contacts is the primary contact. Only contacts that are made available for searching show in lists of available contacts during questionnaire or sourcing event invitations and other workflows that involve contact selection or can be used in supplier searches.

Procedure

1. Perform one of the following actions:

- In the supplier's profile summary, choose the **Supplier Contacts** panel.
- In the classic supplier 360° profile, choose **Contacts** in the left-hand navigation bar

The **Contacts** detail area of the supplier's profile opens.

2. Perform one of the following actions:

- To add a new contact, in the upper right corner of the contacts table, choose **Add** (+).
- To edit an existing contact, choose ... (options) > **Edit** (✎).

3. Enter or edit information for the supplier contact, including the required first and last name and email address.

Edit Supplier Contact

Primary Contact ☒

First Name *	Bob
Middle Name	
Last Name *	Smith
Title	
Email Address *	bsmith@supplier123.com
Mobile Phone	Country Code Phone number (with area cod
Office Phone	Country Code Phone number (with area cod
	Q
Category	Office Equipment and ... X
	Q
Region	California X
	Q
Department	Q
Contact Type	Select ✓
Language	Select ✓
Time Zone	Select ✓

→ Tip

The default time zone for supplier contacts is Pacific Standard Time. If you know the supplier contact's time zone, you can set it here. Differences between the default time zone and the actual time zone of the new contact can prevent them from accessing an event or activity with an impending closing date.

4. **Optional:** Toggle **Primary Contact** on to make the contact the primary contact for the supplier.

A message indicates the name of the supplier contact that you're replacing with the new contact as primary contact for the supplier. The primary contact is the default recipient of all new external questionnaire invitations.

They show in the header and **Supplier Contacts** panel of the supplier profile summary or the **Summary** area of the classic supplier 360° profile.

5. **Optional:** Choose the commodities, regions, and departments for which the supplier contact is responsible.
6. **Optional:** Choose a type for the contact from the **Contact Type** dropdown menu.

7. Choose **Save**.

Results

If you created a new supplier contact, it's automatically approved and is added to the supplier. The new contact shows in the **Contact** detail area of the supplier profile and on the list of available recipients for external questionnaires. Both areas show the contact type and the commodities, regions, and departments associated with the contact, if any.

Supplier contacts receive an email notification when they're added. However, the system doesn't verify if the communication was successfully delivered. Supplier contacts also receive an email notification when they're added:

- in a supplier request
- using the **Contacts** data import in **SM Administration**
- while creating a sourcing event

Note

Supplier contacts added through ► **Manage** ► **Administration** ► **Supplier and Customer Manager** ► **Users** ► don't receive email notifications when they're added.

If you edited an existing supplier contact, the **Contacts** detail area of the supplier profile shows your updates.

Related Information

[About the Contacts Detail Area of the Supplier Profile \[page 47\]](#)

[About the Classic Supplier 360° Profile \[page 26\]](#)

[About the Supplier Profile Summary \[page 14\]](#)

[Deleting a Supplier Contact \[page 55\]](#)

[Supplier Contact Synchronization with SAP Business Network \[page 49\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a New Supplier Contact from SAP Business Network \[page 57\]](#)

[Adding a Supplier Contact as a Questionnaire Recipient \[page 54\]](#)

Adding a Supplier Contact as a Questionnaire Recipient

Use these steps to add a supplier contact if you're inviting or reinviting a supplier to fill out questionnaires and you don't see the person that you want to invite listed as an available supplier contact.

Prerequisites

To add, edit, or delete a supplier contact in a supplier's profile or when inviting a supplier to a questionnaire, you must be a member of one of the following groups:

- **Supplier Registration Manager**
- **SM Ops Administrator**
- **Customer Administrator**
- **Category Manager**
- **Commodity Manager**
- **Event Administrator**
- **Limited Event Administrator**
- **Sourcing Project Administrator**
- **Supplier Project Administrator**
- **Supplier/Customer Manager**
- **Supplier/Customer Agent**

Members of the **Supplier Qualification Manager** group can add, but not edit or delete, supplier contacts in the supplier's profile and when inviting a supplier to a questionnaire.

You must also have permission to send the external questionnaire:

- For registration questionnaires, you must be a member of the **Supplier Registration Manager** group.
- For standalone modular questionnaires, you must be a member of the **SM Modular Questionnaire Manager** group.
- For qualification questionnaires in qualification projects, you must be a member of the **Supplier Qualification Manager** group (SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance only).
- For modular questionnaires included in qualification or other process projects, you must be a member of the **SM Modular Questionnaire Manager** global user group and a project group with the **Process Initiator** role (SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance only, in sites where the process project feature (SM-16798) is enabled).

Procedure

1. Perform one of the following actions in the list of available recipients on the send questionnaires page:
 - To add a new supplier contact, in the upper right corner of the recipients table, choose the add icon (+).
 - To edit an existing supplier contact, choose ... (more options) >  **Edit**.

Choose recipient

	NAME	TYPE	AN STATUS	REGION	CATEGORY	
☒	 Bob Smith bsmith@supplier123.com	N/A	Private	California	Office Equipment and Accessories and Supplies	...
☐	Jane Chen jchen@supplier123.com	N/A	Private	USA	Paper Materials and Products	View Edit

2. Enter or edit information for the supplier contact, including the required first and last name and email address.
3. **Optional:** Choose the **Primary Contact** toggle switch on to make the contact the primary contact for the supplier.

A message indicates the name of the supplier contact that you're replacing with the new contact as primary contact for the supplier. The primary supplier contact shows in the **Summary** area of the supplier 360° profile and is the default recipient for all external questionnaires.

4. **Optional:** Choose the commodities, regions, and departments for which the supplier contact is responsible.
5. **Optional:** Choose a type for the contact from the **Contact Type** dropdown menu.
6. Click **Save**.

Results

The new contact is automatically approved and shows in the list of available recipients for the questionnaires. It also shows in the **Contacts** detail area of the supplier's profile, where you can edit it as needed.

Related Information

[Adding or Editing a Supplier Contact \[page 50\]](#)

[About the Contacts Detail Area of the Supplier Profile \[page 47\]](#)

[Deleting a Supplier Contact \[page 55\]](#)

Deleting a Supplier Contact

Use these steps to permanently remove a supplier contact from a supplier. Deleted supplier contacts can no longer be invited to questionnaires or events.

Prerequisites

To add, edit, or delete a supplier contact in a supplier's profile or when inviting a supplier to a questionnaire, you must be a member of one of the following groups:

- **Supplier Registration Manager**
- **SM Ops Administrator**
- **Customer Administrator**
- **Category Manager**
- **Commodity Manager**
- **Event Administrator**
- **Limited Event Administrator**
- **Sourcing Project Administrator**
- **Supplier Project Administrator**
- **Supplier/Customer Manager**
- **Supplier/Customer Agent**

Members of the **Supplier Qualification Manager** group can add, but not edit or delete, supplier contacts in the supplier's profile and when inviting a supplier to a questionnaire.

Context

You can't delete unapproved contacts or the primary supplier contact. If you want to delete the supplier's current primary contact, add or edit another contact to make them the primary contact instead. Once you've removed the primary designation from a contact, you can delete it.

Procedure

1. Perform one of the following actions:
 - In the supplier's profile summary, choose the **Supplier Contacts** panel.
 - In the classic supplier 360° profile, choose **Contacts** in the left-hand navigation bar

The **Contacts** detail area of the supplier's profile opens.

2. Choose **...** (options) > **Delete**  for the contact that you want to delete.
3. Choose **Delete**.

Related Information

[About the Contacts Detail Area of the Supplier Profile \[page 47\]](#)

[About the Supplier Profile Summary \[page 14\]](#)

[About the Classic Supplier 360° Profile \[page 26\]](#)

[Adding or Editing a Supplier Contact \[page 50\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a New Supplier Contact from SAP Business Network \[page 57\]](#)

Approving or Denying a New Supplier Contact from SAP Business Network

If your site is set up to add new, unapproved supplier contacts automatically from the supplier's SAP Business Network account, use these steps to approve or deny them. Unapproved contacts can't be invited to participate in sourcing events or fill out some types of supplier management questionnaires.

Prerequisites

You must be a member of the **Supplier Registration Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** to approve or deny supplier contacts from SAP Business Network in supplier profiles.

Context

Unapproved supplier contacts show in the **Contacts** details area of supplier profiles with the status **Pending Approval**. You can approve contacts that were previously either unapproved or denied. Once you approve a contact, that approval is final.

Unapproved supplier contacts can't be invited to participate in sourcing events or to fill out external registration and qualification questionnaires. However, they can be added to process projects and invited to external modular questionnaires.

Procedure

1. Perform one of the following actions:
 - In the supplier's profile summary, choose the **Supplier Contacts** panel.
 - In the classic supplier 360° profile, choose **Contacts** in the left-hand navigation barThe **Contacts** detail area of the supplier's profile opens.
2. Perform one of the following actions:
 - Choose  (options) > **Approve**  to approve the contact.
 - Choose  (options) > **Deny**  to deny the contact.

Results

The supplier contact now shows a status of either **Approved** or **Denied**.

Next Steps

Once the supplier contact is approved, you can edit it to add more information such as commodities, regions, departments, contact type, and so forth. You can also make the approved contact the recipient of supplier management questionnaires.

Once the supplier contact is either approved or denied, you can delete it. You can't delete unapproved supplier contacts from the supplier's contacts list.

Related Information

[About the Contacts Detail Area of the Supplier Profile \[page 47\]](#)

[Adding or Editing a Supplier Contact \[page 50\]](#)

[Deleting a Supplier Contact \[page 55\]](#)

[Supplier Contact Synchronization with SAP Business Network \[page 49\]](#)

Assigning, Reassigning, or Removing a Primary Supplier Manager

Use these steps to assign, reassign, or remove a primary supplier manager in the supplier's profile. A primary supplier manager is a person at your company who either interacts with or can answer questions about the supplier.

Prerequisites

You must be a member of the **Supplier Registration Manager**, **Supplier Qualification Manager**, **Preferred Supplier Manager**, **SM ERP Administrator**, or **SM Ops Administrator** group to add or edit contacts in the supplier profile.

Context

Each supplier can have one assigned primary supplier manager. In sites that use modular supplier management questionnaires, the primary supplier manager can receive notifications of expiring or expired questionnaires.

You can assign any person in your organization who has a user account in your site as the primary supplier manager. Customer administrators in your organization can also manage primary supplier manager assignments by importing them into your site in a CSV data file. The most recent assignment, whether made manually in the supplier profile or through data import, is always the current assignment. People who are added or removed as primary supplier manager through data import don't receive email notifications of the assignment or removal.

In sites that include the **Supplier Management** dashboard, you can filter both supplier searches and the information in the **My Suppliers** dashboard area by primary supplier manager. The **My Suppliers** area is only available in solutions that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance.

Procedure

1. Perform one of the following actions:

- In the supplier's profile summary, choose the **Supplier Contacts** panel.
- In the classic supplier 360° profile, choose **Contacts** in the left-hand navigation bar

The **Contacts** detail area of the supplier's profile opens.

2. Perform one of the following actions in the **Supplier Manager** area:

- Choose **Assign supplier manager** if the supplier doesn't currently have a primary supplier manager and you want to assign one. Search for or navigate to the name of the person you want to assign and select them.
- Choose **...** (options) > **Edit** (✎) to change the currently assigned primary supplier manager. Search for or navigate to the name of the person you want to assign and select them.
- Choose **...** (options) > **Delete** (🗑) to remove the primary supplier manager without replacing them.

Results

People who are assigned to or removed from suppliers as primary supplier manager in supplier profiles receive notifications informing them of the change.

Related Information

[About the Contacts Detail Area of the Supplier Profile \[page 47\]](#)

[Supplier Certificate Management \[page 234\]](#)

Supplier and Supplier Management Project Search

You can search for suppliers on the **Supplier Management** dashboard and for supplier management projects on the **Home** dashboard.

Supplier search includes filters to help you locate suppliers by registration or qualification status, commodities, integration status, and other useful characteristics.

Project search includes filters to help you locate supplier management projects by status, created date, owner, and other useful characteristics. It's useful for locating unapproved or denied supplier requests, since they're not included in supplier search.

The **Supplier Management** dashboard and its supplier search are available in sites that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance or SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture).

If your site includes SAP Ariba Supplier Risk, the **Supplier Risk** dashboard includes a separate supplier search. For details, refer to [Supplier Risk Dashboard](#).

[Searching for Suppliers \[page 60\]](#)

[Saving a Supplier Search and Running It Later \[page 65\]](#)

[Modifying or Deleting a Saved Supplier Search \[page 66\]](#)

[Exporting Supplier Search Results for Reporting and Other Uses \[page 67\]](#)

[Searching for Unapproved or External Supplier Requests and Other Supplier Management Projects \[page 69\]](#)

Searching for Suppliers

Use these steps to view detailed information about your organization's suppliers by searching for them on the **Supplier Management** dashboard.

Prerequisites

The **Category** search filter is only available if there's at least one question of type **Commodity** in an external (supplier-facing) registration questionnaire, a qualification questionnaire, a preferred level questionnaire, or a modular questionnaire. The same is true of the **Region** filter and a question of type **Region**, and the **Department** filter and a question of type **Department**.

Qualification status and **Category status** filters are only available in sites that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance.

Context

📘 Note

- Combining different types search terms such as name and country code in a single supplier search can produce unexpected results.
- If an administrator in your site updates master data such as commodities, regions, and departments, there can be a short delay before those updates are reflected in the filters in the **Refine results** panel.
- When you choose multiple registration statuses and either commodities, department, or region, the search doesn't show any results.
- If your site uses internal registrations, when filtering on registration status, there's no way to distinguish between internal and external registrations.

The supplier search page includes filters for commodity categories, regions, ERP integration status, primary supplier manager, certificates, and, if your organization uses them, departments. It also includes filters for the supplier's status in various supplier management processes such as registration.

If you run a search based on search terms, the list of available search filters narrows to the options that apply to the suppliers in the current search results. For example, if you search for **plastics** and none of the suppliers that match that term are registered, the registration status filter doesn't include the **Registered** status. To update the list of available search filters, clear the current filters and run either a new search based on different search terms or an empty search.

If your questionnaires use search terms, you can search for suppliers based on answers to questions that have been enabled for search. The options for these filters vary depending on how the questions were set up, and can involve selecting one or more values from a list; entering a range of dates or numbers; entering one or more words to search for text answers that include them; or choosing between yes and no answers. There can be a short delay between when an answer is updated in a questionnaire and when it shows up in search.

You can apply filters to search results in any order.

→ Tip

You can't use supplier search to find these types of information:

- Suppliers with requests that have been submitted but haven't been approved yet.
- The type of supplier request used to create a supplier (internal or external).
- Suppliers invited to register through mass registration invitations (legacy suppliers) versus suppliers invited through other means (nonlegacy suppliers).

However, you can search for these things using project search on the **Home** dashboard. You can also use project search quickly find specific supplier registration, qualification, disqualification, preferred supplier management, and process projects.

Procedure

1. On the dashboard, click the **Supplier Management** tab.
2. Perform one of the following actions:
 - To perform a targeted search, enter a search term in the search bar on the dashboard and press **Enter** or click the search icon (🔍).
 - To filter the entire supplier search list using search filters, leave the search bar on the dashboard empty and press **Enter** or click the search icon (🔍).

The search results display a list of suppliers on the right and a set of permanent search filters to the left.

3. (Optional) Refine the search results using any of the following filters:

Filter	Usage
Supplier process status (SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance only, in sites where the process project feature (SM-16798) is enabled)	Choose one or more statuses from the list, which show all qualification, discontinuation, or miscellaneous process statuses associated with at least one supplier.

Filter	Usage
	→ Tip If your organization has transitioned from supplier qualification and disqualification projects to qualification process projects for managing supplier qualifications, the Qualification status filters return results for legacy qualifications, while the Supplier process status filters return results for process qualifications. To return complete results for both types of qualifications, use both filters.
Qualification status (SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance only)	Choose one or more statuses from the list, which shows all qualification statuses associated with at least one supplier.
Categories, Regions, and Departments	To filter by a single commodity, region, or department, start entering its name or ID in the search field, then choose from the suggestions. To browse through a complete list of commodities, regions, or departments and select multiple values, choose Manage filters. The search results show the suppliers that have answers that match selected commodities, regions, and departments in certain questionnaires. The Department filter is only available if your organization uses departments for supplier managements.
Category status (SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance only)	Choose one or more statuses from the list, which shows all preferred statuses associated with at least one supplier.
Registration status	Choose one or more statuses from the list. Registration status indicates a supplier's progress in the new registration process and is based on the entire registration project. Once a new registration is approved, the supplier remains in registered status but their Registration update status can change depending on subsequent update activity.
Registration update status	Choose one or more statuses from the list. Registration update status is the status of the latest update to a registration questionnaire for an already registered supplier, and it can change over time as periodic updates to questionnaires are submitted move through the approval process.
Integrated with ERP	Choose Yes to see suppliers that have been synchronized to an integrated ERP system, or No to see suppliers that aren't integrated yet. Note that the Yes filter shows suppliers that have completed the initial synchronization even if an update has failed.

Filter	Usage
Primary Supplier Manager	You can search for suppliers managed by specific people in your organization. To add a filter, enter the primary supplier manager's user name (user ID), not their name.
Certificate	- The list of available Certificate Type filters includes the types for the suppliers in the current search results up to a maximum of 30. That list doesn't necessarily include all available certificate types. To filter by Certificate Type, choose one or more types from the list up to a maximum of 20. Search results show suppliers with any of the selected certificate types rather than only the suppliers that have all of the selected certificate types. - To filter by Certificate Status, choose one or more of these statuses: Valid, for certificates that have an effective date before the current date and an expiration date after the current date and that aren't expiring. Expiring for certificates that haven't reached their expiration date yet but have generated notifications of upcoming expiration. Expired for certificates with an expiration date before the current date. - To filter by Expiry Date Range, choose start and end dates. Search results show suppliers with certificates that have expiration dates within that date range. Note You must choose at least one certificate type before you can filter by date range. For certificates collected in modular questionnaire projects that include internal forms, certificate search only shows filters and results for certificates collected in the key questionnaire. Certificates collected in internal forms aren't included in certificate filters or search results.
Risk level	Choose one or more risk levels from the list. This filter indicates the level of risk associated with each supplier. The risk level for each supplier is shown in the search results, saved searches, and exported search results.
Manage filters (🔗)	Choose Manage filters to select multiple values for a single filter or to manage all supplier search filters in one place. You can use this tool to navigate between different search filters and choose values for each of them all in one place. For data

Filter	Usage
	that has a multilevel structure, like commodities, you can browse through all levels and choose multiple values. You can remove currently selected values individually or choose Clear all to clear all selections. Choose Apply to apply currently settings to search results.

4. To add one or more filters based on questionnaire answers, perform the following steps:
 - a. Choose **+ Add Filters**.
The **Add Filters** popup displays a list of all available question-based search filters.
 - b. Check the filters that you want to add and click **Apply**.
 - c. On the search results page, enter values or choose options for the question-based filters you just added.

Results

The search results update as you apply filters.

Next Steps

Choose a supplier's name in the search results to open its profile.

Choose X in the search bar to clear your current search terms.

The filters list shows all of the filters applied to the current search results. You can delete them individually or click **Clear all** to remove all currently applied filters at once.

Choose **Save Search** to save your current search filters to use again later.

If you have permission, choose **Export** to export your current search results to a CSV file.

Related Information

[Saving a Supplier Search and Running It Later \[page 65\]](#)

[Modifying or Deleting a Saved Supplier Search \[page 66\]](#)

[Exporting Supplier Search Results for Reporting and Other Uses \[page 67\]](#)

[Searching for Unapproved or External Supplier Requests and Other Supplier Management Projects \[page 69\]](#)

Saving a Supplier Search and Running It Later

Use these steps to save any set of search filters you use frequently so that you can and run the search again quickly instead of having to manually apply the same filters each time.

Context

Saving a search saves a specific set of filters so that you can apply them again in one step.

Saved searches are always based on permanent filters such as registration status, commodity, and region. They can't include search terms such as supplier name or country/region code, or any custom search filters based on answers to questionnaires.

You can maintain up to 10 saved searches at a time.

Procedure

1. On the search results page, apply the default filters you want to save in the search.
2. In the area above the search results, choose **Save Search**.
3. Enter a name for the search and choose **Save**.

Results

The filters you applied are now saved under the name you specified and the saved search is applied to the current search results. The search fields on both the **Supplier Management** dashboard and the search results page show a **Saved Searches** link that indicates the current number of searches you've saved in parentheses.

Next Steps

To clear a saved search, remove its filters from the filter list. Once you've removed the last filter, you've cleared the saved search.

To run a saved search, choose **Saved Search**, then choose the name of your saved search. If you already had a search open, your previous search results are automatically cleared and replaced by the results of the saved search.

Related Information

[Modifying or Deleting a Saved Supplier Search \[page 66\]](#)

[Searching for Suppliers \[page 60\]](#)

[Exporting Supplier Search Results for Reporting and Other Uses \[page 67\]](#)

Modifying or Deleting a Saved Supplier Search

Use these steps to update a current search, save changes to filters as a new saved search, or delete a saved search you no longer need.

Context

Saved searches are always based only on default filters such as registration status, commodity, and region (the permanent filters on the left side of the search page). Saved searches can't include search terms (such as supplier name or contact information), or any custom search filters based on answers to supplier management forms and questionnaires.

You can only maintain 10 saved searches at a time.

Procedure

- To modify a current saved search, perform the following actions:
 - a. On the **Supplier Management** dashboard or the search results page, run the saved search by choosing **Saved Searches**, then choosing the name of the saved search in the dropdown menu.
 - b. Modify the search by adding or removing filters.
 - c. Save your changes by performing one of the following actions:
 - To update the current saved search with your changes, choose the name of the saved search, then choose **Update Search**.
 - To save your changes as a new saved search, choose **Save new Search**, enter a name for the new search, and choose **Save**.

Your new or updated search is applied to the current search results. You can rerun it at any time.

- To delete a current saved search, perform one of the following actions:
 - On the **Supplier Management** dashboard or on the search results page, to the right of the search field, choose **Saved Searches**, then choose the delete icon (). Choose **OK** to confirm that you want to delete the search.
 - To delete the currently applied saved search on the search results page, click the name of the saved search and choose **Delete Search**. Choose **OK** to confirm that you want to delete the search.

If you deleted the currently applied saved search, its filters are applied to the current search results, but the saved search itself is now deleted. You can remove the filters from the filter list.

Related Information

[Saving a Supplier Search and Running It Later \[page 65\]](#)

[Searching for Suppliers \[page 60\]](#)

[Exporting Supplier Search Results for Reporting and Other Uses \[page 67\]](#)

Exporting Supplier Search Results for Reporting and Other Uses

Use these steps to export supplier search results to a comma-separated value (CSV) file allows. You can use the exported file as a snapshot of specific supplier data to your computer to work with offline in a spreadsheet program such as Microsoft Excel or import it into a third-party reporting tool.

Prerequisites

You can export any supplier search results as long as you've applied at least one search filter to them. You can't export an empty supplier search, which includes all of the suppliers in your site.

To export search results, you must be a member of one of the following groups:

- **SM Ops Administrator**
- **Customer Administrator**
- **Supplier Request Manager**
- **Supplier Registration Manager**
- **Supplier Qualification Manager**
- **Preferred Supplier Manager**
- **Mobile Supplier Manager**

Context

When you export supplier search results, you can choose the character that separates values in the export file and the export file encoding. By default, exported files use a comma separator (,) and UTF-8 encoding. Regardless of the separator you choose, the export generates a file with a CSV (comma-separated value) extension. You can change the extension when you save the file to your computer.

The exported file includes data for the suppliers in the current search results based on both the search terms and filters you've used (including custom filters based on questionnaire answers) and contains the following columns:

- **Supplier Name**
- **ERP Vendor ID**
- **SM Vendor ID**

- **An Id**
- **Registration Status**
- **Integrated to ERP**
- **Primary contact first name**
- **Primary contact middle name**
- **Primary contact last name**
- **Primary contact email**
- **Address - Line1**
- **Address - Line2**
- **Address - Line3**
- **Address - City**
- **Address - Country Code**
- **Address - Region Code**
- **Address - PO Box**
- **Address - Postal Code**
- **Qualification Status**
- **Preferred Status**
- **Category**
- **Region**
- **Business Unit**

A single supplier can have multiple rows of data in the exported file. If the supplier's preferred or qualified or multiple combinations of category, region, and department, the exported file contains a separate row for each unique status and combination. .

Note

While there's no explicit limit on the amount of supplier data you can export in search results, the larger the data set, the longer the export takes.

Procedure

1. Perform a supplier search, using search terms and applying filters to return the results you want to capture in the exported file.
2. At the top of the search results list, click **Export**.
3. (Optional) Expand **Export settings** and perform any of the following actions:
 - To use a separator other than a comma (,), choose a separator from the **Delimiter** dropdown menu.
 - To use an encoding method other than UTF-8, choose an encoding method from the **Encoding format** dropdown menu.
4. Click **Export**.
5. Save the exported file to the location of your choice.

Related Information

[Searching for Suppliers \[page 60\]](#)

Searching for Unapproved or External Supplier Requests and Other Supplier Management Projects

Use these steps to search for supplier management projects, including supplier requests that are in approval or denied (and therefore not visible in supplier searches) or requests by external or internal request type.

Context

You can use project search on the **Home** dashboard to search for supplier management projects. Project search allows you to create search filters using certain project fields that aren't available as filters in supplier search on the **Supplier Management** dashboard. Since project search returns results for all projects, it also includes supplier requests that are in approval or denied, and that therefore haven't resulted in the creation of a supplier.

For complete details on using project search, refer to [Searching for Projects or Documents using the Search Page](#).

→ Tip

- The names of supplier management projects always include the supplier's name. You can use supplier names as project search terms if you want to look for the projects associated with a specific supplier.
- To search for external supplier requests, use the **Supplier Request Project** content type and filter the search by the **Is Self Registration** field.

Supplier registration project search includes a filter for the **Is Legacy** field, but searching using that filter currently isn't supported.

Procedure

1. Choose the **Home** dashboard.
2. On the dashboard search bar, choose the content type menu to the left of the search field and select the type of content you want to search for, such as **Supplier Request Project**.
3. Enter a search term, such as the name of the supplier.
4. Press or choose the search icon (🔍) to start the search.
5. To search for matching text in text-based project fields (such as the **Title**), enter text in the unlabeled text box.
6. To search by project status or another project field that doesn't currently show in the **Search Filter** area, perform the following steps:
 - a. Choose ► **Options** ► **Fields** ► **Others** ►.

- b. Select the project field or fields that you want to add to the search filters. The fields that are available as filters depend on the type of supplier management project you're searching for.
 - c. Choose **OK**.
7. In the **Search Filter** area, specify values for the search filters you added.
8. Choose **Search**.

Results

Search results show the projects that meet your search criteria.

Next Steps

To view a supplier management project, choose its name in search results and choose **Open**.

Related Information

[Searching for Suppliers \[page 60\]](#)

Reports on Supplier Management Projects and Activities

You can use either supplier data snapshots or analytical reports to analyze and download data on various aspects of your organization's suppliers and supplier management activities.

There are two methods for reporting on supplier management projects and activities:

- **Supplier data snapshots**, which allow you to export preconfigured sets of data in specific areas such as onboarding progress or certificates in CSV files.
- **Analytical reports**, which allow you to aggregate, drill down, and filter on supplier, project, and task data along different dimensions, including:
 - Commodities, regions, and departments
 - Project type and owner
 - Key dates such as project start and questionnaire submission dates
 - Task owner and status

With analytical reports, you can create custom reports or use prepackaged reports designed for the most common types of queries.

[Creating a Supplier Data Snapshot \[page 71\]](#)

[Analytical Reporting on Suppliers and Supplier Management Projects \[page 76\]](#)

Creating a Supplier Data Snapshot

Use these steps to export a snapshot of supplier onboarding activity or certificates in a CSV file.

Prerequisites

To create a supplier data snapshot, you must be a member of one of the following groups:

- **Supplier Registration Manager**
- **Supplier Qualification Manager**
- **Preferred Supplier Manager**
- **SM Modular Questionnaire Manager**
- **SM Process Manager**
- **SM ERP Administrator**
- **SM Ops Administrator**

Supplier data snapshots are only available in sites that include either SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance or SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture).

Context

You can create the following supplier data snapshots:

Snapshot Report	Description
Supplier Onboarding Progress [page 73]	This snapshot includes data about supplier onboarding progress, from the time the supplier request was submitted to the time the registration was approved to the time the supplier was successfully integrated. This report is useful for tracking how long various supplier onboarding milestones have been pending so that you can identify and address issues and bottlenecks.
Supplier Certificate Data [page 74]	This snapshot report includes the supplier's certificates, which can be collected across multiple questionnaires. The report shows the certificate data that is either created or updated within the time range selected.

Note

- Supplier data snapshot CSV files opened in Microsoft Excel only show Latin characters. To see non-Latin characters in a supplier data snapshot, open the CSV file in a text editor.
- Data about inactive suppliers isn't available in supplier data snapshots.
- The snapshot report headers are not localized and are always exported in English regardless of the user's locale.

Procedure

1. On the dashboard, choose ► **Manage** ► **Supplier data snapshots** ►.
2. Enter a **Report name** for your current snapshot export.
3. On the **Report type** dropdown menu, choose the report type.
4. **Optional:** Choose a delimiter for the exported file from the **CSV Delimiter** dropdown menu.
5. On the **Time period** dropdown menu, choose a time period for the snapshot by performing one of the following actions:
 - To create a snapshot for the last one, three, or six months, select a predefined time period.
 - To create a snapshot for a custom time period, choose **Custom length** and select start and end dates. To include the data created on the current day in the report, set the **Report end date** to tomorrow's date.

→ Tip

The **Time period** setting filters the snapshot based on certain dates for activity related to the snapshot. For example, the **Supplier Onboarding Progress** snapshot filters suppliers based on request creation and registration invitation or creation dates. The reference information about the type of data snapshot you're creating has details about how its **Time period** filter works.

6. Choose **Submit**.

Results

Your data snapshot appears in the report table at the bottom of the page. The table includes all snapshot reports run in the past 6 months.

Next Steps

Download the snapshot by choosing [↓](#) (download) in the report table.

Supplier Onboarding Progress Data Snapshot Reference

The **Supplier Onboarding Progress** data snapshot is a CSV file that includes data about supplier onboarding progress, from submission of a supplier request to registration to successful integration. It shows how long various supplier onboarding milestones have been pending so that you can identify and address issues and bottlenecks.

Time period Filters

A supplier is included in a **Supplier Onboarding Progress** data snapshot if any one of the following dates falls within the date range specified in the **Time period** filter:

- The submission date of the supplier request that created the supplier.
- The supplier's registration invitation date
- The date when the registration was created, if the supplier has a registration status other than **Not Invited** but there's no registration invitation date.

Snapshot Data Fields

Report column header	Description
Supplier Name	The name of the supplier.
SM Vendor ID	The SM ID of the supplier.
ERP Vendor ID	The ERP ID of the supplier.
Common Supplier ID	The system ID of the buyer's system.
AN ID	The ID assigned when supplier registers on SAP Business Network.
Supplier Request Type	If the supplier was created from an approved request, a type that indicates whether the request is internal or external.
Requestor	The requester who submitted the supplier request.
Request Submitted Date	When the supplier request was submitted.

Note

This column only includes data for suppliers invited to register after March 2020.

Report column header	Description
Request Approved Date	When the supplier request status changed to Approved .
 Note This column only includes data for suppliers invited to register after March 2020.	
Request Status	The current supplier request status.
Invited to Register Date	When the supplier was invited to register.
Initial Supplier Response Submitted Date	When the supplier submitted their initial response to an external registration questionnaire. If there are multiple questionnaires, this field shows the initial submission date for the first submitted questionnaire.
Registration Approved Date	When the supplier registration status changed to Registered .
Registration Status	The current supplier registration status.
Most Recent Registration Reinvite Date	When the supplier was reinvited to register. If the supplier has been reinvited more than once, this field shows the most recent reinvitation date.
Number of Reinvitations Sent	The number of times the supplier was reinvited to register.
ERP Sync Triggered Date	When synchronization to an integrated ERP system was triggered either automatically or manually.
Supplier Integration Successful Date	When the supplier's integration status changed to Integrated .
Supplier Integration Status	The supplier's current integration status.
Days Elapsed Between Supplier Creation And Registration Completion	The total number of days between when the supplier was created and when their registration status changed to Registered .
Days Elapsed Between Registration Invitation And Registration Completion	The total number of days between when the supplier was invited to register and when their registration status changed to Registered .

Supplier Certificate Data Snapshot Reference

The **Supplier Certificate Data** data snapshot is a CSV file that includes data about supplier certificates.

The **Supplier Certificate Data** snapshot includes data about a supplier's certificates that can be collected across multiple questionnaires. The report shows the certificate data that's either created or updated within the time range selected.

Note

The customized fields in certificate section aren't available in the **Supplier Certificate Data** report.

Table 5: Contents of the **Supplier Certificate Data** Snapshot

Report Column Header	Description
Supplier Name	The name of the supplier.
SM Vendor ID	The SM ID of the supplier.
ERP Vendor ID	The ERP ID of the supplier.
Certificate Type	The type of the certificate.
Certificate Status	The status of the certificate. The available certificate statuses are: • Not Applicable: Indicates that the status wasn't provided by the supplier. • Pending: Indicates when the certificate was initially created. It can also be in pending status when the effective date isn't provided or the effective date is in the future. • Valid: Indicates that the certificate has reached the effective date. • Expiring: Indicates that the certificate has reached the expiration reminder date. • Expired: Indicates that the certificate has passed the expiration date.
Certificate Number	The certificate number.
Certificate Issuer	The name of the authority that issued the certificate to the supplier.
Certificate Location	The location the certificate is applicable for.
Publication Year	The year the certificate was issued.
Effective Date	The date the certificate validity starts.
Expiration Date	The certificate expiration date.
Expiring Date	The expiration reminder date for the certificate. This field is available only if it was configured in the questionnaire.
Description	The description provided for the certificate.
Attachment File Name	The file name of the attached document.
Last Updated Date	The date the certificate was last updated.
Questionnaire Source	The questionnaire from which the certificate data is collected.
Questionnaire Project Type	The type of the questionnaire project from which the certificate data was collected.

Analytical Reporting on Suppliers and Supplier Management Projects

You can use SAP Ariba analytical reports to analyze your organization's suppliers and supplier management project activities.

If you have permission to run analytical reports, you can use the following prepackaged reports for supplier management projects:

Report	Description
Modular Questionnaire Response Report	Responses to questionnaires in modular supplier management questionnaire projects by supplier, project, project owner, respondent, and section.
Open Supplier Registrations Report	Supplier registration projects that haven't been finally approved or denied yet by registration status and supplier, including the number of days open, project owners, how many times the supplier has been reinvited to register and reinvitation dates, and dates when external questionnaires were submitted. You can use this report to identify registrations that require follow-up with the supplier to complete questionnaires or that the supplier has completed but are stuck in approval.
Open Supplier Requests Report	Supplier request projects that haven't been finally approved or denied yet by request status and requester, including the number of days open and whether the request is an internal or external request. You can use this report to identify requests that are stalled either because the requester hasn't provided additional information requested by an approver or because they're stuck in approval.
Project Approval Activity Report	Approval tasks in supplier management projects, including approvers, approval comments, and the number of days the approval tasks have been open.
Supplier ID Report	SM vendor IDs, ERP vendor IDs, ANIDs, and ACM IDs for suppliers.
Supplier Management Questionnaire Response Report	Responses to questionnaires in all supplier management projects by supplier, project, project owner, respondent, and section.
Supplier Registration Project Report	Supplier registration projects by supplier, including project owners, project creation states, dates when external questionnaires were submitted, dates when both new registrations and the latest registration updates were approved or denied, and how many times the supplier has been reinvited to register.
Supplier Registration Response Report	Responses to supplier registration questionnaires by supplier, registration project, project owner, respondent, and section.

Report	Description
Supplier Request Project Report	Supplier request projects by supplier, including project owners, project creation dates, dates when the requests were submitted, request status, and approved and denied dates.

To run these reports, on the dashboard, choose ► **Manage** ► **Prepackaged Reports** ► **Supplier Lifecycle Reports** ►.

If you have permission to create analytical reports, you can create reports based on the following reporting facts to see data on supplier management projects:

Fact	Data.
SM Project	All types of supplier management projects: • Supplier request projects (internal and external) • Supplier registration projects • Supplier qualification and disqualification projects • Preferred supplier management projects • Modular questionnaire projects • Process projects, including process qualifications You can analyze overall project activity across all supplier management project types by supplier, project owner (typically the person who created the project), questionnaire submission dates, project commodities, regions, and departments, reinvitation count, and other metrics. Note SM Project reports can include both process projects and modular questionnaire projects, but analytical reports can't show relationships between them.
Supplier Request Project	Supplier request projects. You can analyze supplier request project activity by project owner (typically the person who created the project), questionnaire submission and project approved and denied dates, whether the supplier request is internal or external (self-registration), request status, and other metrics.
Supplier Registration Project	Supplier registration projects. You can analyze supplier registration project activity by project owner (typically the person who created the project), questionnaire submission dates, new registration and update approved and denied dates, whether the registration is for a legacy supplier (created through a mass registration invitation) or not, registration status and registration update status, reinvitation count, and other metrics.

Fact	Data.
SM Project Questionnaire Response	Responses to questionnaires in supplier management projects. You can analyze questionnaire responses by supplier, project, project owner (typically the person who created the project), project type, questionnaire, respondent, section, question, and other metrics.

You must have the appropriate permissions to run, edit, or create analytical reports. The following table provides a quick reference for where to find information about SAP Ariba analytical reporting:

Topic	Resources
Running a report that you or another person in your organization has created	Running Analytical Reports → Tip To see the reports that other people in your organization have created and made publicly available, choose ► Manage ► Public Reports ►
Creating analytical reports	Creating Analytical Reports
Understanding the data that is available in different reporting facts and how multi-fact reports on combinations of data that include SM Project , Supplier Registration Project , and Supplier Request Project data work	Reporting Fact Reference
Understanding the contents of the prepackaged Supplier Lifecycle Reports	Prepackaged Report Reference
Which user groups grant reporting permissions	Strategic Sourcing and Supplier Management Group Descriptions

Keep in mind the following tips when running or creating analytical reports on supplier management projects:

- Every analytical report must include at least one measure (data field), which you add in the first step of the reporting wizard.
- The supplier management project facts include pre-defined measures (data fields). You can also create custom measures (user-defined fields) that contain the results of calculations based on data in other fields in the fact. For example, you can identify bottlenecks in your organization's approval process based on the amount of time between questionnaire submission and final project approval by adding a user-defined field with a formula of `IF(sum(ApprovedDate.Day-QuestionnaireSubmissionDate.Day)>0, (sum(ApprovedDate.Day-QuestionnaireSubmissionDate.Day)), 0)`. You can also identify aging requests or registrations based on the amount of time between when the project was created and the current date by adding a user-defined field with a formula such as `sum(CURRDATE-BeginDate.Day)` and then using filters on status fields; for example, you can filter registration projects by **Invited** status to identify aging registrations to which the supplier hasn't responded.
- If you want a report that simply lists all of the data in rows, add fields to the **Detail Fields** area of the pivot layout and check **Show detail fields in report**. On the report pivot table, you can also switch between detail and aggregate views by clicking the data menu.

- The **Status** field in the **Project** hierarchy shows a generic project status rather than supplier management project statuses. Use the **Registration Status**, **Registration Update Status**, and **Request Status** to see statuses for those specific types of projects.
- The **Process** and **Process Status** fields show generic project values and aren't related to process projects.

Note

Some data fields may appear in analytical reports but are not available for use in reporting. For example, the **Process Status** field might be displayed, but cannot be included in reports.

- In supplier management projects, **Start Date** typically shows when the project is created. However, in registration and modular questionnaire project, **Start Date** is reset every time the project is upgraded to the latest template version. This behavior can result in reports where project **Start Date** is after the dates of other activities.
- You can use the **Project Type** field to filter **SM Project** reports based on project type.
- The second step of the report wizard shows available hierarchy fields by default. To see all available fields, including flat (nonhierarchical) fields, click **Available Hierarchies** and choose **Available Fields**. Some fields that are important for reports on supplier management projects, such as **Is Legacy**, **Is Self Registration**, **Registration Status**, **Registration Update Status**, **Request Status**, and various supplier IDs only show on the **Available Fields** list.
- If you're not sure which fields you want to add to a report, add them as page fields. Once you've run the report, you can move page fields into the report from the **Field Browser**, as well as moving fields between rows, columns, and the **Field Browser**.
- The **Supplier/Customer** fact includes data on the suppliers in your site. However, many of its hierarchies and fields pull data from legacy supplier workspace projects and the supplier profile questionnaire, which aren't applicable in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance and SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture) solutions. To see **Supplier/Customer** data alongside supplier management project data in an analytical report, create a multi-fact report that includes both the **Supplier/Customer** fact and one or more of the supplier management project facts.
- Every analytical report includes at least one date filter. Typically, the larger the date range you choose, the larger the report.
- Dates related to project activity are calendar dates that are relative to the server time zone. Dates related to task activity use a fixed timestamp based on Greenwich Mean Time (GMT). This difference can cause some discrepancies between project and task duration calculations in analytical reports.
- To add the supplier name to supplier management project reports, use the **Common Supplier** field.
- The following ID fields are useful for supplier management project reports:

Field Name	Description
ERP Vendor Id	The ERP vendor ID for the supplier, which is its organization ID in the sap domain. Always use this field rather than ERP Supplier ID in supplier management project reports. ERP Vendor Id is always the ERP vendor ID associated with a supplier in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance and SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture). ERP Supplier ID shows IDs for suppliers loaded in SAP Ariba Spend Analysis.

Field Name	Description
SM Vendor Id	A unique identifier for suppliers. Depending on whether or not a supplier is integrated, this ID can be automatically generated by SAP Ariba or an ERP vendor ID.
Supplier AN Number	The ANID or SAP Business Network ID for the supplier.
Common Supplier ID	The ACM ID for the supplier, which is its ID in the buyersystemid domain.
DUNS Number	The D-U-N-S number for the supplier, which is its ID in the duns domain.

- The following fields are useful for reports on supplier management projects and are included in prepackaged supplier lifecycle reports:

Field Name	Description
Questionnaire Submission Date	For projects that only support one type of questionnaire (internal or external), the date when the respondent submitted that questionnaire. For example, the date when a requester submitted a supplier request. For projects that support both external and external questionnaires, the date when the supplier submitted the first external questionnaire.
Approved Date	The date when the project was finally approved. For projects that support both new and update phases, this date is the date when the new phase is finally approved.
Update Approved Date	The date when the latest update phase is finally approved.
Denied Date	The date when the project was finally denied. For projects that support both new and update phases, this date is the date when the new questionnaire phase is denied.
Update Denied Date	The date when the latest update phase is denied.
Reinvite Count	The number of times the supplier was reinvited to fill out questionnaires for the project in the new phase.
Reinvite Date	The date when the supplier was most recently reinvited to fill out questionnaires for the project in the new phase.
Is Self-Registration	Whether the supplier request is internal (No) or external (Yes).
Is Legacy	Whether or not a supplier registration was created through a mass registration invitation.

Related Information

[Strategic Sourcing and Supplier Management Group Descriptions](#)
[Running Analytical Reports](#)
[Creating Analytical Reports](#)
[Reporting Fact Reference](#)

Joule Capabilities in Supplier Management

SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance is integrated with Joule, SAP's generative AI copilot.

Users in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance can ask Joule questions about your organization's suppliers and receive immediate and accurate answers through generative AI.

⚠ Caution

Joule must not be used in shared desktop environments where different users share the same Web browser (so-called “kiosk mode”). To prevent unauthorized access to conversations, for example, if a session is not terminated properly, each user must use a separate session at the operating system level. We strongly recommend not relying on browser sign-out only.

Prerequisites

- Joule must be integrated with SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance. For details, see [Integrating Joule with SAP Ariba Solutions](#).
- An administrator must enable the configurable field **Last Status Change Date** in vendor data export. For more information about enabling this field, refer to [Use of the Supplier Data API with Pagination vendorDataRequests Endpoint](#).
- To navigate to supplier profiles from Joule, including **Open in App** navigation, users in your SAP Ariba site must be members of the **Joule Supplier Profile User** group.
- Users must have the appropriate permissions and project team roles for the specific scenarios.
- For navigation to supplier management project pages, the features and projects associated with the specific scenarios must be enabled and configured.

Capabilities

To access the Joule panel, users click the Joule icon (🗨) at the top of the window.

The following capabilities are available in Joule for supplier management:

Capability Type	Scenario	Description	Example
Transactional	Supplier contact information	Displays a list of the supplier's contacts when you provide any of the following information:	Show me contact details for supplier S12434567

Capability Type	Scenario	Description	Example
		- SM vendor ID - ERP vendor ID (excluding "placeholder" ERP vendor IDs assigned by SAP Ariba to non-integrated suppliers, which begin with VDR and aren't supported in this scenario) - Full or partial supplier name	Show me contact details for Supplier A
Transactional	Suppliers in Invited registration status for a number of days	Displays a list of suppliers that have been invited to register but haven't responded to the invitation in the specified number of days.	Show me the list of suppliers in "invited" status for more than 100 days
Transactional	Suppliers in In Registration status for a number of days	Displays a list of suppliers that have started the registration process but haven't submitted questionnaires in the specified number of days.	Show me the list of suppliers in "In Registration" status for more than 100 days
Transactional	Tasks still pending approval	Displays a list of tasks pending approval by the current user, with options for approving or denying the tasks in Joule. Results include matching tasks in all project types. There's currently no way to filter the list by project type. Tasks in some supplier management projects also support a Request Additional Info option. You must navigate to the task details page if you want to use this option rather than approving or denying the task.	Show me tasks pending approval
Transactional	Check approval status	Displays the approval status and currently active approvers of the specified task. You must include the task's ID in the question	Check approval status for task TSK1234567

Capability Type	Scenario	Description	Example
Transactional	Qualified suppliers (legacy qualifications and disqualifications)	Displays a list of suppliers with the specified standard, overall qualification status. This scenario returns qualifications using legacy qualification projects or data import only. You must include the standard qualification status. Using the same capitalization as the user interface label is recommended. For statuses with multiple words such as "Qualification Started," enclosing the status in quotation marks is also recommended. Choose Open in App to view a supplier's profile and see qualification details.	Show me "Qualification Started" suppliers
Transactional	Qualified suppliers (process qualifications)	Displays a list of suppliers with the specified process status. This scenario returns qualifications using process qualification projects or data import only. You must include: - The words "SM process status" preceding the status. - The process status used by your organization. Using the same capitalization as the user interface label is recommended. For process statuses with multiple words, enclosing the status in quotation marks is also recommended.	Show me suppliers with SM process status "Qualification In Progress".

Capability Type	Scenario	Description	Example
		Choose Open in App to view a supplier's profile and see qualification details.	
Transactional	Preferred suppliers by level	Displays a list of suppliers with the specified level of preferred category status. You must use the preferred category status label defined by your organization, not the level number. Using the same capitalization as the user interface label is recommended. For preferred category statuses with multiple words, enclosing the status in quotation marks is also recommended. Choose Open in App to view a supplier's profile and see preferred category status details.	Show me preferred suppliers for Strategic.
Transactional	Pending approvers for my supplier management projects	Displays a list of projects created by the current user that are in approval, with the list of approvers. You must specify the project type. Modular questionnaires aren't currently included. Choose Open in App to view project details.	Show me pending supplier requests created by me.
		Displays a list of projects created by the current user. Modular questionnaires aren't currently included. If you don't specify a project type in the prompt, choose a project type to see only projects of that type. Choose Open in App to view project details.	Show me supplier registrations created by me.

Capability Type	Scenario	Description	Example
Navigational	View a supplier's profile	Displays the matching supplier or suppliers. Choose Open in App to view the supplier's profile. To find suppliers by ID, you must include the supplier's SM vendor ID in the question.	Show me the profile for supplier 12345678 Show me the profile for supplier ABC
Navigational	Create a supplier request	Displays a Create supplier request in app quick link that opens the supplier request form or questionnaire configured for your site, if you have permission to create supplier requests. The link opens either the standard supplier request or the Dun & Bradstreet-integrated supplier request, depending on which one your organization uses.	Take me to the page for creating a supplier request
Navigational	Send modular questionnaires to suppliers	Displays a Send modular questionnaires in app quick link that opens the first page in the workflow for inviting suppliers to standalone modular questionnaires, if you have permission to create modular questionnaire projects.	Take me to the page for creating a modular questionnaire

In Joule answers, users can choose **Open in App** to open a supplier's profile and view details. For the contact use case, users can choose **Open List in App** to directly view contact details in the supplier's profile.

WalkMe in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance

WalkMe Digital Adoption Platform is available in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance.

WalkMe is an AI-powered digital adoption solution that enables teams to create guidance and automation in the flow of work, while giving business and technology leaders insights into how people are using the software and where users can be more self-sufficient. This enables organizations to accelerate user adoption of technology, boost productivity, and maximize the value of enterprise software investments.

Note

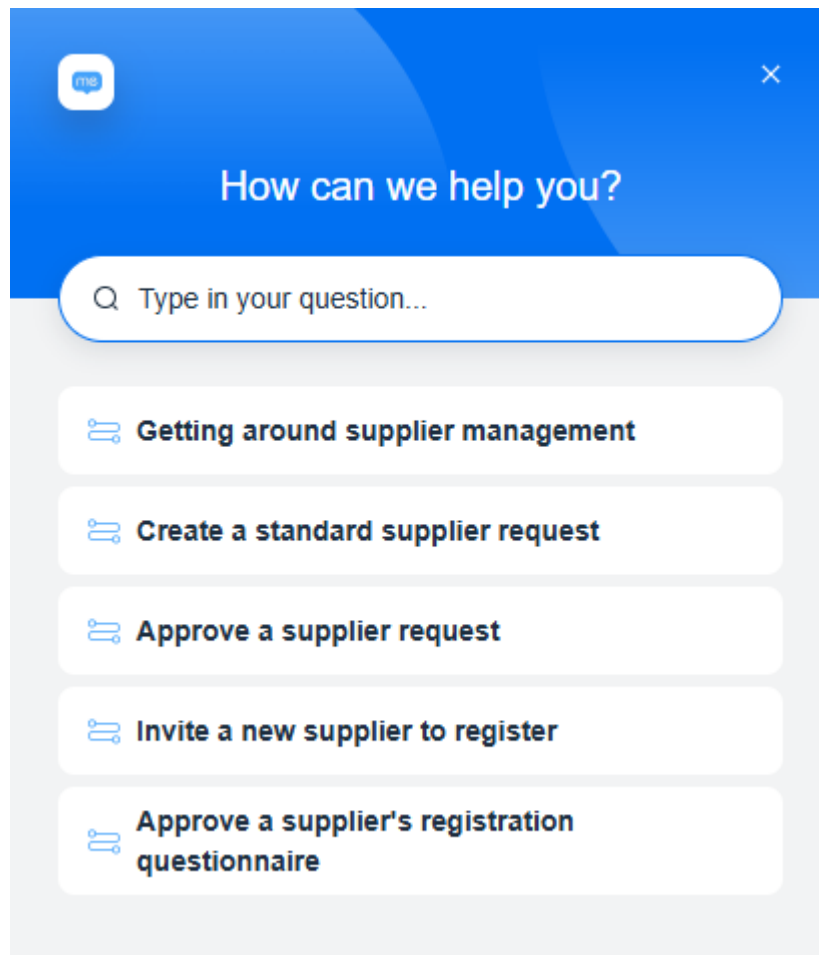
The following features and functionalities provided by SAP as part of SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance including automation and transaction processing may be continuously improved on behalf of the customer. SAP may use Customer Data in order to achieve such improvement.

WalkMe is enabled by default in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance. An administrator can manage WalkMe using the following self-service configuration parameters in **Intelligent Configuration Manager**:

- [Enable the SAP WalkMe feature](#)
- [Specify URL for WalkMe custom content](#)
- [Enable WalkMe analytics](#)

These parameters are general settings that control WalkMe in all available applications in your solution package.

Users click the WalkMe icon () in the banner of each page to launch the WalkMe panel.



If you have an SAP Companion help system enabled, its help content is available alongside WalkMe. In the WalkMe panel, choose **Switch to Help Topics** to switch to SAP Companion help. In the SAP Companion panel, choose **Switch to Guided Help** to switch back to the WalkMe panel. SAP Companion guided tours aren't compatible with WalkMe and aren't available when WalkMe is enabled.

WalkMe includes the following standard smart walk-throughs from SAP Ariba:

- An introductory walkthrough that introduces the **Supplier Management** dashboard and shows users how to launch the WalkMe panel.
- Walk-throughs for following the following supplier management processes:
 - Creating a standard supplier request
 - Creating a Dun & Bradstreet supplier request

- Approving a supplier request
- Starting a supplier registration
- Approving a supplier registration questionnaire

Users can only see the walk-through steps for the workflows and workflow pages they have permission to access.

Users can start any of the available smart walk-throughs for the process for which they need help. Each walk-through provides short descriptions of the main steps and guides them through the procedure for completing a process. They can choose to close a walk-through at any point.

Customers can also choose to develop their own content by first purchasing WalkMe Premium for SAP Ariba solutions. For more information about WalkMe Premium for SAP Ariba solutions, see <https://walkme.com> .

Note

If SAP Companion enabled for supplier management in your site, it and WalkMe are both help systems with similar functions. SAP Ariba recommends choosing which system you want to use and disabling the other one.

Supplier Management Activities Using the SAP Ariba Procurement Mobile App

The SAP Ariba Procurement mobile app gives you mobile access to your company's SAP Ariba strategic sourcing solutions. You can use your mobile device to use many of the features that are available from a web browser, such as the ability to perform supplier management activities and manage various tasks for SAP Ariba strategic sourcing solutions.

You can use the mobile device to perform certain supplier management tasks such as searching for suppliers, viewing their profiles, requesting new suppliers, and viewing supplier registrations. You must belong to the **Mobile Supplier Manager** and **Supplier Request Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** groups to create supplier requests.

SAP Ariba Procurement mobile app includes the following supplier management features:

- **Search for suppliers:** You can search for suppliers by name, contact details, or location from the **Supplier Management** page, and view detailed information about them.
- **View supplier 360° profile:** You can tap a supplier's name to see their 360° profile. The supplier 360° profile shows all of the information your organization has about a supplier.
Only the **Summary** and the **Registration** sections are displayed in the mobile app.
- **Request new suppliers:** If you want to request to work with new suppliers, you can create and submit internal supplier request forms. When a supplier request is approved, the supplier is created in your site.
Depending on your site's configuration, the supplier can be automatically invited to register at this point, or a category or supplier manager manually issues a registration invitation.
- **View supplier registrations:** You can view a list of the available supplier registrations in various statuses.

For more information about the SAP Ariba Procurement mobile app, see [SAP Ariba Procurement Mobile App](#).

Restrictions

- Push notification related to supplier requests aren't supported.
- The following supplier request form fields aren't displayed in the SAP Ariba Procurement mobile app:
 - Bank
 - Extended Address
 - Certificate
 - Tax
 - BusinessPartner
- Registration invitations to suppliers can't be issued manually using the SAP Ariba Procurement mobile app.
- Supplier qualification activities such as starting qualification projects and sending qualification questionnaires aren't supported in the mobile app.
- Repeatable sections in supplier request forms aren't supported.
- This feature isn't supported in sites that are configured for the approved supplier requests to be validated in SAP Master Data Governance for suppliers (MDG-S) module before the new supplier database records are created in the SAP Ariba strategic sourcing solutions.
- If your site is integrated with Dun & Bradstreet (D&B), the supplier request workflow that includes a step that looks up the supplier in the Dun & Bradstreet database isn't supported in the mobile app.

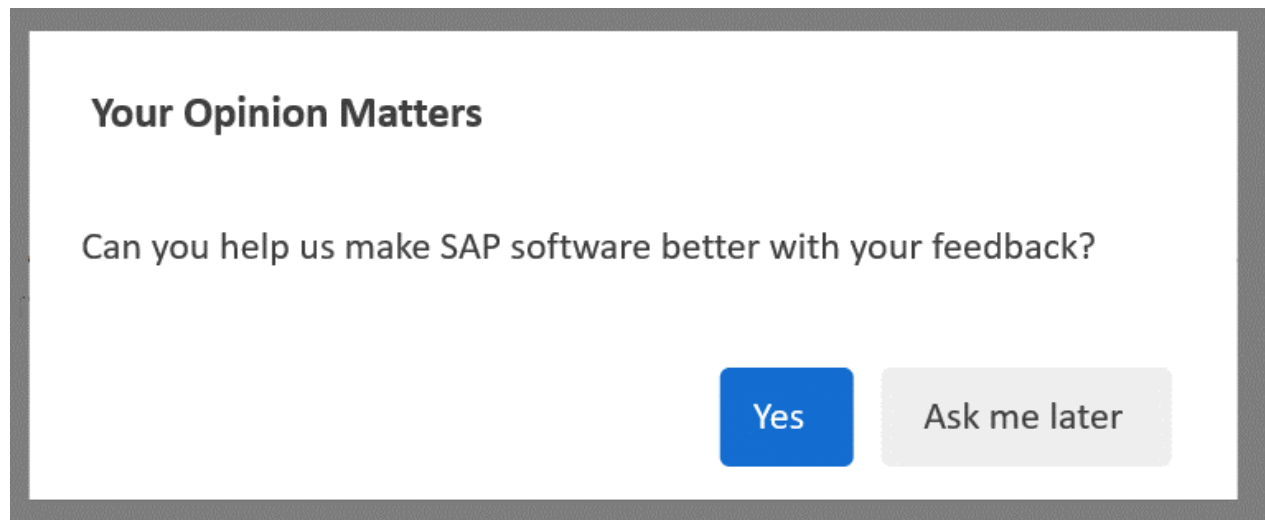
Related Information

[SAP Ariba Procurement Mobile App](#)

User Experience Feedback Surveys for Supplier Management

A feedback survey about user experience is available on the **Supplier Management** dashboard, the supplier search page, and profile detail pages such as the **Contact** page. You can use it to provide feedback about your experience of supplier management functionality to SAP Ariba.

When you navigate to an applicable supplier management page, a popup asks you to help make SAP software better with your feedback:



Your Opinion Matters

Can you help us make SAP software better with your feedback?

Yes Ask me later

Clicking **Yes** opens one of two variations of the **Overall Product Satisfaction Survey** randomly. One variation asks you to select agreement with two statements about the software's usability from **Strongly disagree** to **Strongly**

agree. The other variation asks you to select their overall satisfaction with the software from **Very dissatisfied** to **Very satisfied**:

Your Opinion Matters ✕

Overall, how satisfied are you with this software?

Very dissatisfied Dissatisfied Neither satisfied nor dissatisfied Satisfied Very satisfied

Please tell us about your experience with this software.

Please do not enter personal data into this field.

By providing responses, the user permits SAP to use the responses to improve its products.

Submit

Powered by Qualtrics

Both variations also ask you to provide written feedback regarding their experience with the software.

If you submit a response, you don't see the survey prompt again for 90 days. If you close the survey without submitting a response, you're prompted again after 48 hours. If you click **Ask me later**, the survey closes and you're prompted again in 25 hours.

These surveys are run by [Qualtrics](#) . All responses are transmitted directly to Qualtrics, which is hosted in the European Union, and are governed by the Qualtrics [terms of service](#) . SAP Ariba has access to those responses for internal use only.

Note

Feedback surveys don't collect personal data in predefined questions and answers, only data about SAP Ariba applications. Don't enter any personal data in the comments.

If the supplier profile summary (NGSM-2959) is enabled in your site, the feedback surveys aren't available there.

If your organization doesn't want to participate in the feedback collection process, create a case with SAP Ariba Support to opt out of user feedback surveys, using one of the following components:

- CA-PX-CC
- CA-FLP-EXT-FX

Accessibility in Supplier Management

The supplier management application is enhanced to provide accessibility to people with special needs.

SAP Ariba has enhanced the accessibility of supplier management with the goal of eventually reaching adherence with the Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG). The supplier management user interface supports screen readers to guide people with special needs through the application.

These accessibility enhancements, include the following changes:

- User interface elements are accurately labeled to ensure the users know what information can be entered in the fields.
- User interface pages have titles that describe the purpose of the page/topic, helping the users to navigate through the application.
- Tooltips are available for the user interface elements such as icons and graphics.
- You can use keyboard navigation to access some of the user interface elements. You can see a visible outline around the user interface element that has the current keyboard focus. For more information see, *Keyboard Navigation*.

Screen Readers

You can use screens readers to read the user interface elements. SAP Ariba supports the following screen reader programs.

- JAWS, from Freedom Scientific Inc.
- VoiceOver from Apple Inc.

Note

Other screen reader programs can work but aren't officially tested by SAP Ariba.

Pages

SAP Ariba continues to enhance the accessibility in supplier management with the goal of reaching adherence with the Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG). Accessibility enhancements are available in **Request**, **Registration** workflows, supplier search page, supplier 360 profile, and **SM Administration**.

Keyboard Navigation

You can use the following keyboard options to navigate the user interface:

Keyboard Navigation	Purpose
Tab	To navigate between user interface elements.
Tab or Spacebar	- To activate the button on the page. - To select the values from the lists.
Shift + Tab	To navigate to the previous user interface elements.
Navigation for drop-down fields	
Down arrow	To open a dropdown list and move within the list.
Up arrow	To collapse a dropdown list and move up the list of options.
Enter or Return	To select an option in the dropdown list.

Supplier Creation and Onboarding

Supplier Request Creation and Management

Approved supplier requests create new suppliers in your site. Depending on your role, you can request a new supplier or approve a supplier request created by someone else in your organization.

There are two types of supplier requests:

- Internal supplier requests, where someone in your organization requests a new supplier. Depending on your site's configuration, this internal request can be the default request, or it can use a Dun & Bradstreet lookup to add certain information about the supplier to the request automatically.
- External supplier requests, where a supplier requests to be added to your site. External supplier requests are an optional feature and their availability depends on your site's configuration.

[Internal Supplier Requests \[page 93\]](#)

[External Supplier Requests \[page 94\]](#)

[Requesting a New Supplier \[page 96\]](#)

[Requesting a New Supplier Using Dun & Bradstreet Lookup \[page 97\]](#)

[Your Supplier Requests \[page 99\]](#)

[Resubmitting a Supplier Request When an Approver Asks for Additional Information \[page 101\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a Supplier Request \[page 102\]](#)

[How Duplicate Checks Work in Submitted Supplier Requests \[page 105\]](#)

[Supplier Request Status Flow \[page 107\]](#)

Internal Supplier Requests

Internal supplier request projects allow internal users to request to work with new suppliers. When a supplier request is approved, the supplier is created in your site.

Procurement agents, functional buyers, people running sourcing events, and others in your company who want to work with new suppliers can request a new supplier by filling out and submitting an internal supplier request form. Note that there's a separate project for [suppliers to create an external supplier request \[page 94\]](#).

The internal supplier request project template determines:

- What information users need to provide when submitting the request.
- Whether the request is automatically approved on submission or must be manually approved.
- If the request requires manual approval, which category or supplier managers approve the request, and whether other stakeholders at your company must also approve the request.

Requesters create internal supplier requests from the **Create** menu on the dashboard and monitor their progress in the **My Activities** area of the **Supplier Management** dashboard. As the requester enters information in an internal

supplier request, an automatic duplicate check presents them with possible matches to suppliers that already exist in the database. The requester then has the option of canceling the request if they see a valid match or of submitting the request if they don't believe any of the potential matches are duplicates.

If your site is integrated with Dun & Bradstreet (D&B), the supplier request workflow also includes a step that looks up the supplier in the Dun & Bradstreet database. If the supplier isn't found, this workflow can also include an exception process for requesting a non-D&B supplier.

Notifications inform approvers that the request requires approval. They can also see outstanding requests by choosing ► **Manage** ► **My Tasks** ► on the dashboard. Notifications also inform the requester when the request has been approved or denied, and show the final approver so that the requester can have further discussions about denied requests. Approvers also see a list of potential duplicate suppliers so that they can deny duplicate requests and approve only requests for genuinely new suppliers.

When a supplier request is approved, either automatically or manually, the supplier is created in your site's supplier database. The information in the approved external supplier request shows in the **Supplier request** detail area of the supplier's profile. If your site is integrated with Dun & Bradstreet, the new supplier profile includes data from D&B.

If your site is integrated with SAP Master Data Governance for Suppliers (MDG-S), the supplier request workflow can also include a final step for validating approved supplier requests in SAP MDG-S before creating suppliers in the database. If MDG-S identifies the supplier as a duplicate, SAP Ariba marks the approved request as a duplicate, hides it, and redirects the requester to the existing, matched supplier instead. This option is only supported if your supplier requests don't use Dun & Bradstreet integration.

Newly created suppliers are eligible for registration, which gathers detailed profile information about them. Your site's configuration determines whether the supplier is automatically invited to register or a registration manager can manually start an internal or external registration. If your site is integrated with SAP ERP, SAP S/4HANA, or SAP MDG-S, your site's integration settings determine whether the new supplier is automatically or manually synchronized with the integrated system's vendor master list either at this point or during supplier registration.

Related Information

[External Supplier Requests \[page 94\]](#)

[New Supplier Registrations \[page 108\]](#)

[Supplier Qualification and Requalification Using Supplier Qualification Projects \[page 170\]](#)

[Preferred Category Statuses Management Projects \[page 223\]](#)

[Supplier Disqualifications Using Supplier Disqualification Projects \[page 171\]](#)

[Supplier Performance Evaluations Using SPM Projects](#)

External Supplier Requests

External supplier request projects allow suppliers who want to do business with your organization to introduce themselves. When an external request is approved, the supplier is created in your site.

External supplier request projects aren't available by default and are only available in sites where the feature is enabled. As part of external supplier request enablement, SAP Ariba Support provides your organization with

an external supplier request URL that's specific to your site. Your organization can provide this URL to potential new suppliers through specific outreach programs, by publishing it on a corporate website, or through other means. Suppliers can introduce themselves to your organization by clicking the URL, completing a ReCAPTCHA verification, and filling out and submitting the external supplier request form. Note that there's a separate type of request project for [internal users at your company to request a new supplier \[page 93\]](#). External supplier requests are sometimes called self-registration, but the form submitted is a **request**, the first step in working with a supplier. [Supplier registration \[page 108\]](#), the next step, is a separate type of project.

The external supplier request project template determines:

- What information suppliers need to provide when submitting the request.
- Which category or supplier managers approve the request and whether other stakeholders at your company must also approve the request.

Notifications let the approver know that the external supplier request requires approval; they can also see outstanding external requests using **Manage > My Tasks** on the dashboard. Approvers see a list of existing suppliers in the database that match information in the external request so that they can deny duplicate requests and approve only requests for genuinely new suppliers.

When an external supplier request is approved, the supplier is created in your site's supplier database. The information in the approved external supplier request shows in the **Supplier request** detail area of the supplier's profile.

Depending on your site's configuration, the supplier can be automatically invited to register at this point, or a category or supplier manager can manually issue a registration invitation. If your site is integrated with SAP ERP, SAP S/4HANA, or SAP MDG-S, your site's integration settings determine whether the new supplier is automatically or manually synchronized with the integrated system's vendor master list either at this point or during supplier registration.

Related Information

[Internal Supplier Requests \[page 93\]](#)

[New Supplier Registrations \[page 108\]](#)

[Supplier Qualification and Requalification Using Supplier Qualification Projects \[page 170\]](#)

[Preferred Category Statuses Management Projects \[page 223\]](#)

[Supplier Disqualifications Using Supplier Disqualification Projects \[page 171\]](#)

[Supplier Performance Evaluations Using SPM Projects](#)

Requesting a New Supplier

Use these steps to create a supplier request when you want to work with a supplier that is not already in your organization's vendor database.

Prerequisites

You must also be a member of the **Supplier Request Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** group to create supplier requests.

Context

Creating a supplier request starts your organization's process for registering and managing the supplier.

While you're creating a supplier request, SAP Ariba searches the database to see if there are any existing suppliers or previously denied requests with the same information and identifies potential duplicates. If the supplier you're requesting already exists in your site, or was previously denied by approvers, you can cancel the request.

You can save a supplier requests as a draft so that you can exit the form without losing your current answers. You can complete and submit a draft supplier request later, or you can discard it. The draft supplier request isn't validated until you submit it.

Once you have submitted a supplier request, you cannot delete it.

If your site is integrated with Dun & Bradstreet, refer to [Requesting a New Supplier Using Dun & Bradstreet Lookup \[page 97\]](#).

Note

- For supplier request questionnaires that include **Extended Address** questions, an answer in the **Region** field is required.
- Attachments in supplier management questionnaires can't include embedded documents.

Procedure

1. On the dashboard, choose **Create > Supplier Request**.
2. Enter information in the supplier request form.
3. If SAP Ariba identifies any existing suppliers or previously denied requests that match the information in your request, perform the following actions:
 - a. Choose **See duplicates**.
 - b. Review potential duplicate suppliers. If you agree with a suggested match, choose **Cancel Request**. If you don't think any of the potential matches is the same supplier, choose **Close**.

4. Perform one of the following actions:

- To submit the request for approval, choose **Submit**.
- To save the request as a draft to finalize and submit later, choose **Save**.

Results

If you submitted the supplier request form, it's sent for approval. You receive a notification when the request is approved or denied. If your request is approved, the new supplier is added to the supplier database. If the request is denied, it's not.

If you saved a draft of the supplier request, it's available on the **Supplier Request** tile of the **Supplier Management** dashboard. You can also view the draft supplier requests you created in the **My Documents** content item on the **Home** dashboard.

Related Information

[Internal Supplier Requests \[page 93\]](#)

[Your Supplier Requests \[page 99\]](#)

[Resubmitting a Supplier Request When an Approver Asks for Additional Information \[page 101\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a Supplier Request \[page 102\]](#)

[Adding a Missing Approver to a Supplier Management Project \[page 261\]](#)

Requesting a New Supplier Using Dun & Bradstreet Lookup

When you want to work with a supplier that isn't already in your site's vendor database, use these steps to create an internal supplier request. Your organization requires that you try to match potential new suppliers to the Dun & Bradstreet (D&B) supplier database before creating the request.

Prerequisites

The supplier request with Dun & Bradstreet lookup is only available in sites with the D&B integration feature enabled.

To create a supplier request, you must be a member of the **Supplier Request Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** group.

If you request a D&B supplier, answers that are automatically filled in by D&B data aren't editable by default, even if there's no D&B data available for the supplier you selected. If the self-service configuration parameter **Enable Extended Address editing in supplier requests using Dun & Bradstreet lookup** is enabled in your site, you can edit supplier address answers before submitting the request.

Context

Creating a supplier request starts your organization's process for registering and managing the supplier.

To create a supplier request using Dun & Bradstreet lookup, you search for the supplier you want to request in the D&B database. If the supplier is in the D&B database, you select it, then fill out the request form. D&B information for supplier name, address, and Dun & Bradstreet ID (D-U-N-S number) are automatically added to the request form.

If you don't see the supplier you want to request in the D&B database, you can perform one of the following actions:

- Ask the supplier to register with D&B. Once they've done so, you can create the request by selecting the supplier in the D&B search.
- Fill out the request even though you can't find the supplier in the D&B database. In this case, the supplier probably isn't registered with D&B, and the supplier request includes questions about why you need an exception to your organization's general requirement that all suppliers have D-U-N-S numbers. Provide the supplier name and address information that would otherwise automatically be added to the request by D&B. Depending on your organization's processes, approval of requests for suppliers that aren't registered with D&B can be different.

While you're creating a supplier request, SAP Ariba searches the database to see if there are any existing suppliers or previously denied requests with the same information and identifies potential duplicates. If the supplier you're requesting already exists in your site, or was previously denied by approvers, you can cancel the request.

You can save a supplier requests as a draft so that you can exit the form without losing your current answers. You can complete and submit a draft supplier request later, or you can discard it. The draft supplier request isn't validated until you submit it.

Note

- Lookups through the Dun & Bradstreet Data Integration Toolkit are in principle free of charge unless there's a misuse of the current customer agreement.
- Attachments in supplier management questionnaires can't include embedded documents.

Procedure

1. On the dashboard, choose **Create > Supplier Request with D&B Lookup**.
2. On the **Search Supplier** by dropdown menu, choose one of the following options:
 - D-U-N-S Number
 - Phone number
 - Name
 - Business ID (Tax ID, VAT ID, other ID)
 - Email or website
3. Enter search criteria and choose **Search**. Some options require you to specify the supplier's country or region. Required fields for each option are indicated by an asterisk (*).
4. Review the list of suppliers in the D&B database that match your search criteria and perform one of the following actions:

- If you see the supplier you want to request in the list, select them and choose **Next**.
 - If you don't see the supplier you want to request in the list, and you don't want to ask the supplier to register with D&B before you create a request for them, choose **Can't find supplier**.
5. Enter information in the supplier request form.
 6. If SAP Ariba identifies any existing suppliers or previously denied requests that match the information in your request, perform the following actions:
 - a. Choose **See duplicates**.
 - b. Review potential duplicate suppliers. If you agree with a suggested match, choose **Cancel Request**. If you don't think any of the potential matches is the same supplier, choose **Close**.
 7. Perform one of the following actions:
 - To submit the request for approval, choose **Submit**.
 - To save the request as a draft to finalize and submit later, choose **Save**.

Results

If you submitted the supplier request form, it's sent for approval. You receive a notification when the request is approved or denied. If your request is approved, the new supplier is added to the supplier database. If the request is denied, it's not.

If you saved a draft of the supplier request, it's available on the **Supplier Request** tile of the **Supplier Management** dashboard. You can also view the draft supplier requests you created in the **My Documents** content item on the **Home** dashboard.

Related Information

[Supplier Request Status Flow \[page 107\]](#)

[How Duplicate Checks Work in Submitted Supplier Requests \[page 105\]](#)

Your Supplier Requests

You can view and, in some cases, edit the supplier requests you've created. You can also discard your draft requests if necessary.

To see the supplier requests that you've created, choose the **Supplier Request** tile in the **My Activities** area of the **Supplier Management** dashboard. You only see this area if you've created at least one supplier request.

On the **Supplier Request** tile, you can do the following things:

Table 6: Options on the **Supplier Request** Tile

Request Status	Options	Availability
Draft	Edit your draft to make any necessary changes and submit the request for approval, or Discard your draft if you no longer need it.	Draft requests are available on the Supplier Request tile regardless of the approval process for your organization's supplier requests.
Submitted	View the request and edit it if necessary, since approval hasn't started yet.	These options are only available if your organization uses a manual approval process for supplier requests. If your organization uses automatic approval, the Supplier Request tile only shows requests in Draft status.
In Approval	View the request. The request details page shows approval progress. You can also edit it at this point if your organization allows unrestricted editing. By default, only approvers can edit requests when they're in approval.	
Pending Resubmission	View the request and edit it to address approvers' questions or concerns.	Even if your organization uses a manual approval process, the Supplier Request tile doesn't show denied requests.
Approved	View the completed request, including its completed approval process, and view the supplier's 360° profile.	You can use project search on the Home dashboard to find denied or automatically approved supplier requests that you've created.

You can also filter supplier requests based on status.

The screenshot shows the 'SUPPLIER MANAGEMENT' section of a dashboard. At the top, there's a navigation bar with 'HOME', 'SOURCING', 'SUPPLIERS', 'SUPPLIER MANAGEMENT' (active), and 'MORE...'. On the right, there are buttons for 'Recent', 'Manage', and 'Create'. Below the navigation bar is a search bar labeled 'Enter Supplier name or ID' and a link to 'Export supplier data'. Under 'My Activities', there are three cards: '131 Supplier Request' (highlighted), '161 Registration', and '18 Qualification'. Below these is a table with columns 'Supplier name', 'Status', and 'Action'.

Supplier name	Status	Action
Supplier 1	Draft	Edit Discard
Supplier 2	Draft	Edit Discard

Note

- The **Supplier Request** tile shows requests created by users with your name. If your organization has multiple users with the same **Name** value, it shows all requests created by users with the same name to those users. All users in your organization must have a unique **User ID**, but multiple users can have the same **Name**.
- Once you've submitted a request, you can't discard or delete it. However, an approver can deny it to prevent creation of the requested supplier.

Related Information

[Searching for Unapproved or External Supplier Requests and Other Supplier Management Projects \[page 69\]](#)

[Requesting a New Supplier \[page 96\]](#)

[Requesting a New Supplier Using Dun & Bradstreet Lookup \[page 97\]](#)

[Resubmitting a Supplier Request When an Approver Asks for Additional Information \[page 101\]](#)

Resubmitting a Supplier Request When an Approver Asks for Additional Information

If an approver asks for additional information about a supplier request you created, use these steps to edit the request, make the necessary changes, and resubmit them for approval.

Context

If an approver asks for additional information about a supplier request that you created, it moves from **In Approval** status to **Pending Resubmit** status. Edit the request to provide the requested information and resubmit it so that it can be approved.

The email notification you receive includes comments from the approver detailing the additional information they're asking for.

Procedure

1. Perform one of the following actions:
 - Choose the link in the notification email to reopen the request.
 - In the **My Activities** area of the **Supplier Management** dashboard tab, choose the **Supplier Requests** tile, locate the request you need to resubmit, and choose **View**.
2. Choose **Edit**.
3. Make the requested changes.
4. Choose **Save**.

Results

The supplier request moves back from **Pending Resubmit** status to **In Approval** status and the approval flow restarts.

Related Information

[Your Supplier Requests \[page 99\]](#)

[Supplier Request Status Flow \[page 107\]](#)

Approving or Denying a Supplier Request

If you're in the approval flow for a supplier request, use these steps to approve or deny it. Approving a supplier request creates the supplier in your site.

Prerequisites

To edit a supplier request while it's in approval:

- If the self-service configuration parameter **Application.SM.SupplierRequest.RestrictRequestEdit** is enabled in **SM Administration**, you must be a member of the **Supplier Request Manager** group who is also either the project owner (the person who created the supplier request project) or a currently active approver.
- If the parameter is disabled, you must be a member of the **Supplier Request Manager** group.

If your organization uses the supplier request with Dun & Bradstreet lookup and the requester has selected a D&B supplier, certain questions are automatically filled in with D&B data where it's available, including address answers. These answers aren't editable by default, even if there's no data from D&B. If the self-service configuration parameter **Enable Extended Address editing in supplier requests using Dun & Bradstreet lookup** is enabled in **Intelligent Configuration Manager** and you otherwise have permission to edit the request during approval, you can also edit address answers.

Context

People in your organization submit internal supplier requests to add suppliers they want to work with to your site. If the external supplier request feature (SM-2861) is enabled in your site, suppliers outside of your organization can also submit supplier requests on their own behalf to introduce themselves.

Approvers can edit supplier requests to add missing information, correct mistakes, or supply information that can only be added by approvers, before approving the request and creating the supplier.

When a requester submits a supplier request, SAP Ariba searches the database to see if there are any existing suppliers or previously denied requests with the same information and identifies potential duplicates. If you believe that the requested supplier already exists in your site, you can prevent duplicate supplier records by denying the request.

Procedure

1. Perform one of the following actions:
 - Choose the link in the notification email to open the request.
 - On the dashboard, choose ► **Manage** ► **My Tasks** ►. Locate the supplier request that you want to work with, click the associated approval task, and choose **Approve** or **Deny**.

The approval task details page for the supplier request opens.

2. Review the information in the supplier request.
3. **Optional:** If the option is available, choose **Edit** to edit the supplier request, then choose **Save** to save your changes.

Note

In external supplier requests, some fields in bank and tax questions depend on data from your site that's not shown to suppliers but is shown to internal requesters and approvers. Suppliers can't enter information in those fields. In this situation, you can edit the request to add that information.

4. If the information in the request matches any existing suppliers or previously denied requests, choose **See duplicates** to view details about potential duplicate matches.
5. Perform one of the following actions:
 - Choose **Approve** to approve the request.
 - Choose **Deny** to deny the request, enter explanatory comments to tell the requester the reason for the denial, and click **Confirm denial**.
 - To request additional information, choose **Request additional info**, enter a comment for requester explaining what information you want, and choose **Confirm request additional info**. This option is only available in internal supplier requests.

Results

The following table describes the results of an approver's action on the supplier request:

Table 7: Results of Approver Actions on Supplier Requests

Approver action	SAP Master Data Governance validation	Result
Approved	No validation in an integrated SAP Master Data Governance - Suppliers (MDG-S) system	The supplier is created in your site with the registration status Not Invited , and the supplier contact specified in the request is added as the primary contact. The supplier now has a profile, and the Supplier request detail area shows information from the supplier request.

Approver action	SAP Master Data Governance validation	Result
	Validation in an integrated SAP MDG-S system	The process flow diagram for the supplier request shows a new automatic step, MDGS Validation , and the supplier is in In External Approval status. If SAP MDG-S matches the request to an existing supplier, the request is automatically denied and you're redirected to the existing supplier's profile. If SAP MDG-S doesn't match the request to an existing supplier, the supplier is created in your site with the registration status Not Invited , and the supplier contact specified in the request is added as the primary contact. The supplier now has a profile, and the Supplier request detail area shows information from the supplier request.
Denied	N/A	The supplier isn't created. A notification to the requester includes your comments explaining your denial. If a requester creates a request for the same supplier later and the duplicate check identifies a match, the requester can see that someone already tried to add the supplier to the database and that the request was denied.
Requested additional information	N/A	The supplier isn't created. The internal requester must edit and resubmit the supplier request, at which point it re-enters the approval flow. Your site's configuration determines whether the current node in the approval flow restarts or the entire approval flow restarts from the beginning.
Edited the request	N/A	The supplier isn't created. The request re-enters the approval flow.

Any comments that you or other approvers added during approval show on the supplier request details page, which you can see by searching for the supplier request project.

If your site is integrated with Dun & Bradstreet (D&B), when you approve a supplier request based on a D&B supplier, a data pull adds D&B data to the supplier profile. Depending on the D&B products used in your D&B integration and your licensing agreement with D&B, this data pull can incur D&B fees.

Next Steps

After the supplier request is approved, you can invite the supplier to register or start an internal registration.

Related Information

[How Duplicate Checks Work in Submitted Supplier Requests \[page 105\]](#)

[Inviting a Supplier to Register \[page 116\]](#)

[Starting an Internal Supplier Registration on Behalf of a Supplier \[page 122\]](#)

[Supplier Request Status Flow \[page 107\]](#)

[Searching for Unapproved or External Supplier Requests and Other Supplier Management Projects \[page 69\]](#)

How Duplicate Checks Work in Submitted Supplier Requests

Duplicate checks help prevent the creation of duplicate records for the same supplier in the database. After a requester submits an internal supplier request, or a supplier submits an external supplier request, a duplicate check matches its information to existing suppliers to identify potential duplicates.

The information in the request that contributes to the duplicate check depends on your site's configuration and the setup of your organization's supplier requests. External supplier requests and duplicate check based on custom questions are both optional features.

The supplier request duplicate check searches for existing suppliers in your site's vendor database, by a combination of:

- Exact match to Dun & Bradstreet ID (D-U-N-S Number).
- Exact match to country/region-specific tax IDs in internal supplier requests only, if your organization uses default duplicate check based on tax IDs.
- Strict match to the full supplier name, based on the following conditions:
 - Company extensions such as LLC, INC, Incorporated, are truncated when performing a duplicate check. For example, if your site has an existing supplier with the value "First Light Diagnostics LLC", the duplicate check removes "LLC" from the supplier name and performs a search only for "First Light Diagnostics". Note that the supplier full names support the following company extensions but truncate them during duplicate checks: "co", "company", "corp", "corporation", "incorporated", "inc", "llc", "llp", "sa", "sl", "srl", "ag", "ltd", "gmbh".
 - When searching, if the supplier name matches any of these vendor database fields in your site: name1, name2, name3, or name4. For example, a supplier in your site has "First", "Light", "Medical", and "Diagnostics" as values for name1, name2, name3, and name4 respectively. Consequently, a search for "Medical" returns every supplier with the value "Medical" in name1, name2, name3, or name4. Therefore, "SMR Medical", "Medical Diagnostics", "Health and Medical" and so on are all potential matches for the search.
 - In a supplier search, the exact full match is shown regardless of the supplier's status, whether approved, registered, draft, and so on.
- At least a partial match to supplier name followed by a partial or full address match. At least a partial name match must occur before address matching is attempted.
- If your site uses custom duplicate check, partial matches to answers are also used for custom duplication check. For custom duplicate check, the answer must match starting with the first character. If the answer contains any spaces, each space-separated word or group of characters is matched separately, and each must either fully or partially match starting with the first character.

For example, if your site has an existing supplier with the value "Green Energy Corporation" in a field used for a custom duplicate check, "Green," "Energy," and "Corporation" are all indexed for matching separately. Any corresponding supplier request answer that starts with "G," "E," or "C" is considered for matching, and answers such as "Gre," "Energ," and "Corp" are matched. Answers such as "Greed," "Reen," and "Gre Energion" aren't matched.

Matching is case insensitive. The duplicate check scores different matches based on predefined logic. The score is expressed as a percentage between 0 and 100, with scores of 70% and above considered strong matches and scores of less than 70% considered weak matches.

In match scoring, a D-U-N-S Number match scores either 100% for an exact match or 0% for no match. Strict name matches score 100%, while partial name matches can vary between 0% and 100%. For matches on country/region, the duplicate check assigns maximum scores to exact matches but also accepts synonyms, ignoring case, and scores synonym matches based on degree of similarity to the request answer, with an exact string match scoring 100%. The duplicate check assigns a total matching score to existing, potentially matching suppliers based on all matching fields.

When the requester submits the supplier request (for internal requests only) and during supplier request approval (for both internal and external supplier requests), the duplicate check displays the top 20 matching suppliers, based on match score, in the following order:

- Exact matches (score of 100%) first.
- Partial matches next, in descending order based on score.

The duplicate check popup includes information on which answers in the current supplier request match to existing suppliers.

Suppliers that might match your request

Suppliers matched for: Supplier Company Name: Supplier ABC, France: VAT Registration Number:FRAA123456789, France: SIRET Number:FRAA123456789, France: SIREN Number:FRAA123456789,etc....

NAME	ADDRESS	TAX NAME	TAX ID	VENDOR ID	ANID	MATCH SCORE
Supplier ABC, Inc		France: VAT Registration Number France: SIRET Number France: SIREN Number	FRAA123456789 FRAA123456789 FRAA123456789	S10238706		100.00 (STRONG)

[Cancel request](#)

[Close](#)

⚠ Restriction

- For default duplicate check on supplier D-U-N-S Number, name, and address, the duplicate check cleanses the values in those fields and replaces newlines, white spaces, and ASCII punctuation with a single space before matching values to existing suppliers. Because of this cleansing, a new supplier request with a supplier name of "Supplier A, Ltd." matches an existing supplier name "Supplier A Ltd" but not an existing supplier named "Supplier A, Ltd.".
- Default duplicate checks match against existing suppliers in the database regardless of how the matching supplier information was added. Default duplicate check against tax IDs in supplier registration questionnaires with the required configuration is only supported for answers added by questionnaire recipients. It's not supported for answers added by registration questionnaire imports. Custom duplicate checks match answers in internal or external supplier requests against mapped answers from existing submitted supplier requests. They don't match against mapped data that originates

from sources outside of supplier requests, such as data import, ERP integration, or other types of questionnaires.

- Duplicate checks don't match against denied supplier requests or inactivated suppliers.

Supplier Request Status Flow

As suppliers move through the request process, their **Request** status moves from **Not Invited** to **Completed**.

Action	Request status
The supplier request isn't created.	Not Started
A user creates a supplier request.	Not Started > Initiated (not shown in the user interface)
A user creates a supplier request with minimum supplier information and saves the draft rather than submitting it.	Initiated (not shown in the user interface) > Draft
A requester discards a draft supplier request.	Draft > Canceled
The requester submits a previously-saved draft request.	Draft > Submitted
The approval flow for a submitted request starts.	Submitted > In Approval
An approver asks the requester for more information during approval	In Approval > Pending Resubmission
The requester provides more information and resubmits the request.	Pending Resubmission > In Approval
The supplier request is denied.	In Approval > Rejected
The supplier request is approved.	In Approval > Approved
The supplier request is canceled.	Canceled > Rejected

Supplier Registration Management

Supplier registrations collect and maintain detailed profile information about your organization's suppliers. Depending on your role, you can start a supplier registration, fill out registration questionnaires, approve or deny registration questionnaires, or cancel an in-progress registration.

Supplier registrations typically collect detailed profile information about the supplier, often information that's required before your organization can start transacting with them. For example, registration questionnaires can collect essential bank and tax information. Because this profile information can change over time, supplier registrations have two stages:

- **New registration**, where a registration manager starts a registration, questionnaire recipients provide initial profile information, and approvers vet this information and approve or deny the registration.
- **Registration updates**, where questionnaire recipients update previous answers where necessary after the supplier is registered.

[New Supplier Registrations \[page 108\]](#)

[Supplier Registration Updates \[page 113\]](#)

[About the Registration Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 114\]](#)

[Inviting a Supplier to Register \[page 116\]](#)

[Reinviting a Supplier to Register \[page 120\]](#)

[Starting an Internal Supplier Registration on Behalf of a Supplier \[page 122\]](#)

[Setting a Supplier as Registered Using the Set Registered Option \[page 125\]](#)

[Reinviting Internal Recipients to an Internal Supplier Registration \[page 126\]](#)

[Filling Out an Internal Registration Questionnaire \[page 128\]](#)

[Filling Out an External Registration Questionnaire on Behalf of a Supplier in an Internal Registration \[page 130\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a Supplier Registration Questionnaire \[page 131\]](#)

[Starting a New Approval Round for a Denied Supplier Registration Questionnaire \[page 135\]](#)

[Restarting a Denied Supplier Registration \[page 136\]](#)

[Inviting a Supplier to Participate in an Internal Registration \[page 138\]](#)

[Reassigning External Questionnaires in a Completed Registration to a Different Recipient \[page 142\]](#)

[Viewing Supplier Registration Projects Based on Previous Template Versions After Template Upgrade \[page 143\]](#)

[Canceling an In-Progress Supplier Registration \[page 145\]](#)

[Supplier Registration Status Flow \[page 148\]](#)

New Supplier Registrations

Starting a new supplier registration creates a registration project with questionnaires to gather detailed profile information about a supplier.

After a new supplier is created, a registration manager starts a supplier registration by sending one or more external registration questionnaires to recipients. Registration projects can also include internal questionnaires, and starting the registration makes them available for editing. Approvers review the submitted questionnaires and approve or deny them. If the new registration is approved, the registration project then supports ongoing updates to both external and internal questionnaires.

There are two types of supplier registrations:

Table 8: Types of Supplier Registrations

Registration Type	Description
External	Invites a supplier contact to create an account or sign into an existing account on SAP Business Network to fill out and submit external registration questionnaires. Suppliers participate in external registrations, and you collect registration information directly from them. After a supplier completes an external registration, you can establish a fulfillment relationship with them.
Internal	Invites people in your organization to fill out and submit external registration questionnaires on behalf of the supplier. Suppliers don't participate in internal registrations, and you collect registration information about them from people in your organization. A registration manager can invite the supplier to participate in an internal registration later, converting it to an external registration. After an internal registration is completed for a supplier, you can only establish a fulfillment relationship with them if they have a linked SAP Business Network through another means, such as participation in a sourcing event or response to an external qualification questionnaire.

Both registration types use the same registration project and have the same registration statuses.

Depending on your site's configuration and the particular supplier, there are several different methods for starting a registration:

Table 9: Methods for Starting a Supplier Registration

Registration Method	Registration Type
Automatically whenever a supplier request is approved.	External
Manually by a registration manager.	External or Internal
Manually by choosing the Set Registered option in the Registration detail area of the supplier's profile	Internal
Through a mass invitation wave, which an administrator can create to onboard a specific set of suppliers at one time.	External
(In sites that include SAP Ariba Sourcing) Automatically whenever an uninvited supplier is invited to a sourcing event that requires that a registration status of at least Invited , if not higher, to participate in the event.	External
(In sites that include SAP Ariba Sourcing) Automatically when a previously uninvited supplier attempts to participate in a sourcing event if your site requires a minimum status of Registered to participate in sourcing events.	External

The registration process typically asks for detailed profile information about the supplier, such as the commodities they supply, the regions in which they operate, what standards they adhere to or agree with, financial details, and so forth. Depending on the way registration is set up in your site, it can include one or more external registration questionnaires to gather this information.

Supplier registration projects can also include internal questionnaires that allow internal stakeholders to answer questions about the supplier based on your organization's internal processes and to add internally important information to the supplier's profile.

It's possible to cancel a registration while it's in progress. Canceling is the only way to convert an external registration to an internal one after the supplier has been invited, and is useful if an external registration is stalled and you want to complete it internally instead.

The supplier registration project template determines:

- The number of external registration questionnaires and the number of internal questionnaires (if any), and their content.
- Registration approvers, and whether or not there are different approval flows and other tasks for new registrations versus questionnaire updates.
- Whether other tasks are part of the registration workflow.
- Whether or not denial of an internal questionnaire affects the supplier's registration status in a new registration.
- How long external questionnaires remain open so that suppliers can submit their answers.

Users with the appropriate permissions start the registration, send one or more external questionnaires to recipients, fill out any internal questionnaires, review the questionnaire responses, request more information, complete To Do tasks, approve or deny the registration, and view its progress and status in the **Registration** detail area of the supplier's profile.

In external registrations, the supplier submits external registration questionnaires in their SAP Business Network profile. To do so, they must create an SAP Business Network account if they don't already have one. The supplier's profile is automatically shared between SAP Business Network and SAP Ariba Supplier Management solutions. Once registration is complete, the supplier is public, meaning that they have a linked SAP Business Network account in your site.

In internal registrations, internal recipients in your organization submit external registration questionnaires in your site and the supplier doesn't participate at all. Internal registrations don't establish communications with the supplier through SAP Business Network. Unless you've interacted with the supplier through SAP Business Network for another activity, such as a sourcing event or an external modular questionnaire, they remain private, meaning that they don't have a linked SAP Business Network account in your site.

In registrations that are done using the **Set Registered** option, registration managers choose this option in the supplier's profile and the supplier doesn't participate at all. The **Set Registered** option is available only after the supplier request is approved. When registration managers choose this option, the system immediately sets the status of the supplier to **Registered**. In addition, the system synchronizes supplier data with your ERP systems automatically or with manual intervention depending on how your site is configured. This data then becomes available for supplier qualifications or for use in other SAP Ariba procurement applications. After setting a supplier as **Registered**, you can still start an internal or external registration project. However, if you do so, the registration process starts and the **Set Registered** option is only available again if you cancel the newly started registration.

Notifications inform:

- Questionnaire recipients that they've been invited to register, including a link to the external questionnaires.
- The requester for the supplier that the registration has started.

- Approvers that they need to approve a new or updated registration questionnaire.
- Internal stakeholders that they need to complete other tasks.
- The supplier that the registration has been approved, denied, or requires more information (in external registrations only).

If a registration invitation includes multiple external questionnaires, questionnaire recipients receive a separate notification for each questionnaire. If the registration has been canceled, notifications inform registration managers of the cancellation.

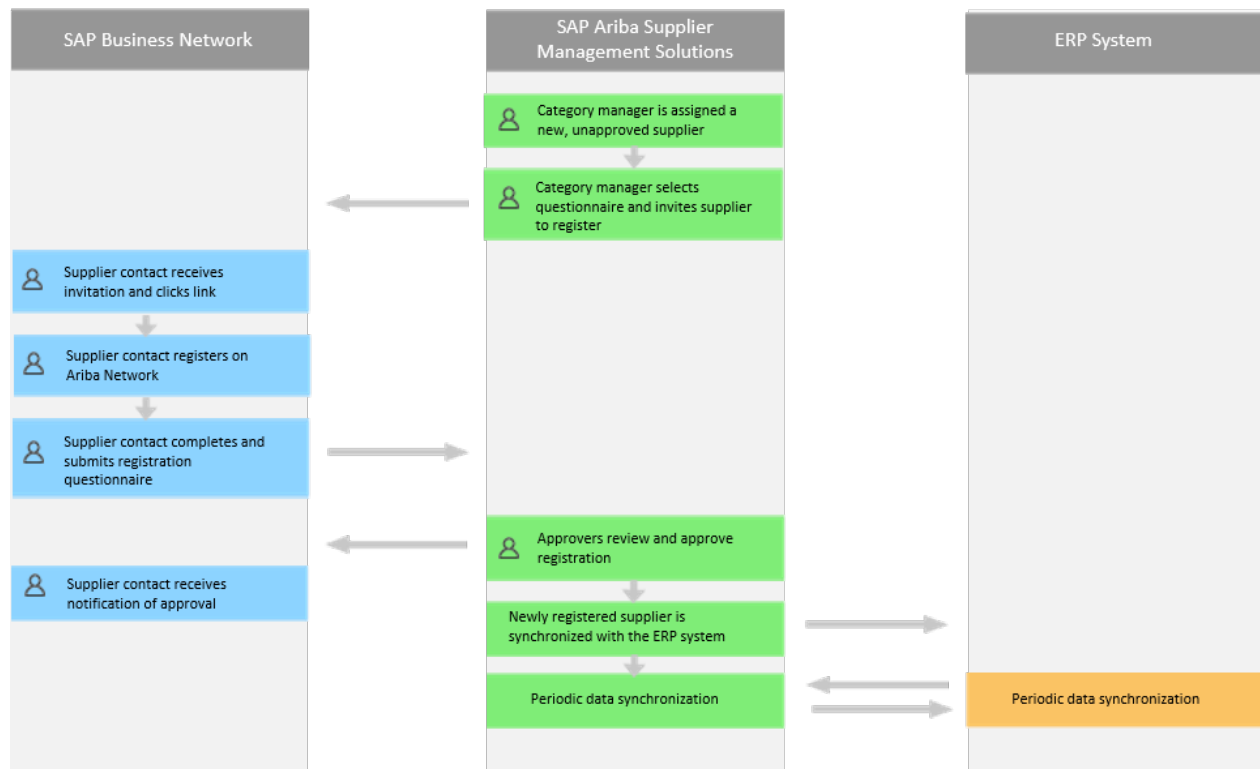
As your organization's registration process evolves over time, an administrator can upgrade existing registration projects to the latest version of the template. An upgrade can include changes to internal or external questionnaires, tasks, and approval flows. The administrator can opt to send notifications about the upgrade to supplier contacts so that they can update affected questionnaires. Internal users don't receive upgrade notifications.

If your site is integrated with an SAP ERP system, your site's integration settings determine whether a new supplier is automatically or manually synchronized with your ERP vendor master list. Many organizations require registration before synchronizing a new supplier to the ERP system.

For suppliers with external registrations, additional settings allow registration managers to establish a fulfillment relationship with the supplier as they register, at the same time as the sourcing relationship is established.

In solutions that include SAP Ariba Sourcing, event templates can specify that suppliers must be registered to either participate in or be awarded events. There's also a configuration option for requiring a minimum registration status for participation in sourcing events.

The following diagram shows the workflow for a new external registration where integration is set to synchronize the supplier automatically with the ERP vendor master after registration is approved:



Related Information

[Internal Supplier Requests \[page 93\]](#)

[External Supplier Requests \[page 94\]](#)

[Setting a Supplier as Registered Using the Set Registered Option \[page 125\]](#)

[Supplier Qualification and Requalification Using Supplier Qualification Projects \[page 170\]](#)

[Preferred Category Statuses Management Projects \[page 223\]](#)

[Supplier Disqualifications Using Supplier Disqualification Projects \[page 171\]](#)

[Supplier Performance Evaluations Using SPM Projects](#)

[Supplier Registration Updates \[page 113\]](#)

[About the Registration Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 114\]](#)

[Supplier Registration Status Flow \[page 148\]](#)

[Inviting a Supplier to Register \[page 116\]](#)

[Starting an Internal Supplier Registration on Behalf of a Supplier \[page 122\]](#)

[Canceling an In-Progress Supplier Registration \[page 145\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a Supplier Registration Questionnaire \[page 131\]](#)

Supplier Registration Updates

After a supplier is registered, external questionnaire recipients and people in your organization can update questionnaires to keep profile information for the supplier current.

Supplier registration projects can be set up to support different approval flows for new registrations and for updates to individual questionnaires.

When a new registration starts, external registration questionnaires are open for the amount of time defined in the template questionnaire's timing rules. Once the recipient submits the questionnaire the first time, it closes automatically. After all of the tasks in a new registration are completed and the supplier has **Registered** status, previously closed external questionnaires automatically reopen for an amount of time defined by your site's configuration and configurations in individual questionnaires. The default amount of time a questionnaire remains open is 365 days from the approval. The recipient assigned to the external questionnaires in a registration can navigate to them and submit updates at any time when they're not in approval. External questionnaires can be set up to generate periodic reminders asking suppliers for updates.

Internal registration questionnaires are also always open for update when they're not in approval.

In a new registration, once the recipient invited to the registration opens at least one questionnaire, only they can access the external questionnaires in the registration. In internal registrations, the registration project owner can also access external questionnaires. After the new registration is approved, you can reassign external questionnaires to a different recipient at any time when no external questionnaire updates are in approval. Only the assigned recipient or, in internal registrations, the registration project owner, can update the external questionnaires.

If a registration starts as an internal registration, meaning that people in your organization submit questionnaires on behalf of the supplier, internal recipients can continue to update those questionnaires. A registration manager can invite the supplier to an internal registration, transferring ownership of external questionnaires to a supplier contact. When a supplier contact submits external questionnaires from a registration that was previously internal for the first time, that initial submission is also treated as an updated.

As your organization's registration process evolves over time, an administrator in your organization can upgrade existing registration projects to the latest version of the template. An upgrade can include changes to internal or external questionnaires, tasks, and approval flows. The administrator can opt to send notifications about the upgrade to supplier contacts so that they can update affected questionnaires. Internal users don't receive upgrade notifications. Suppliers or internal recipients can also choose to update registrations for other reasons.

When a recipient submits an update to an external registration questionnaire, the supplier remains in **Registered** registration status, but has a separate **Pending Approval** registration update status.

The new registration workflow includes all of the tasks associated with all of the questionnaires in a new registration. If your registration projects include one or more registration update phases to define tasks for registration updates, each questionnaire update is handled individually. When a respondent submits an update to an external or internal registration questionnaire, only the tasks associated with that questionnaire start, and task owners or approvers can complete the tasks related to the questionnaire being updated. When there are no remaining tasks in progress for the questionnaire that is being approved and no tasks in progress for the other questionnaires in the update phase, the update status is **Approved**.

If the registration update isn't set to auto-approve, approvers approve or request more information for registration updates. If the updates are approved, they're added to the supplier's profile. The supplier remains in **Registered** registration status, but has **Approved** registration update status. The registration update status is always based on the entire workflow defined by all of the tasks in registration update phases.

The registration status reflects the supplier's progress through the full initial registration process where your organization collects important profile information from them. Registration update status is useful mainly for tracking individual updates, which typically involve small changes to that profile information, and can be used to create conditions in the registration project. Registration update status doesn't show in the supplier's profile. However, you can search for registration projects using the search bar on the **Home** dashboard and filter the results by registration update status. If you have permission to access the advanced view of a registration project, you can see also its registration update status on the **Overview** tab. To see the advanced of a registration project, the **Advanced View** link for that project type must be enabled in your site and you must have the appropriate permissions.

Related Information

[New Supplier Registrations \[page 108\]](#)

[Supplier Registration Status Flow \[page 148\]](#)

[Project Advanced View \[page 265\]](#)

About the Registration Detail Area in the Supplier Profile

You invite a supplier to register and view and manage their registration, including internal profile questionnaires, in the **Registration** detail area of a supplier's profile.

Every supplier profile includes a **Registration** detail area, whether or not the supplier is registered.

Registration

Invited by

Alice Jones

Invited on

September 24, 2019

Registration status

Pending Approval

Supplier recipient

Bob Smith

Email

bsmith@supplier123.com

Office phone

Process Flow

Questionnaires

NAME	TYPE	
Supplier registration questionnaire	External	
Supplier Internal questionnaire	Internal	
Supplier registration questionnaire2	External	

Tasks

NAME	ACTION BY	STATUS	
Approval for Supplier registration questionnaire	Project Owner	In Approval	
Approval for Supplier Internal questionnaire	Alice Jones	Approved	

Once a supplier is invited to register, the **Registration** area includes the following information:

- A summary of the registration, including who invited the supplier to register and on what date, the invited supplier contact, and their email address.
- A process flow, which shows the steps of the registration project workflow. The currently active step is highlighted in blue, while completed steps are highlighted in green. Once registration tasks have started, they show in the process flow, with the names of the people or groups responsible for completing them enclosed by brackets ([]). You can choose a task node to see a complete list of approvers or task owners, including a list of group members when the approver or task is a project group.
For new registrations, the process flow shows all tasks associated with the registration. For registration updates, if your site uses tasks in one or more registration update phases, the process flow shows only the steps associated with the most recently updated questionnaire.
- All internal and external questionnaires that are included in the registration.
- All To Do and approval tasks associated with the registration.
- In sites that include approval tasks for registration updates, an alert message that includes the name of any updated questionnaires that have pending approvals.

If you have permission, you can do the following things in the **Registration** detail area:

- [Invite \[page 116\]](#) or [reinvite \[page 120\]](#) a new supplier to register.
- [Start an internal registration \[page 122\]](#) on behalf of a supplier.

- If the status tracker for email notifications feature (SM-5116) is enabled in your site, see whether registration invitations were sent or were undeliverable. The status tracker only tracks email notifications to supplier contacts in external registrations. It doesn't track notifications to internal recipients of external questionnaires in internal registrations.

Note

If this feature is enabled, the date of reinvitation doesn't update once the supplier is public.

- Track the progress of the registration in the process flow graph.
- View the answers to both internal and external registration questionnaires in the **Questionnaires** table.
- [Fill out and submit internal registration questionnaires \[page 128\]](#) in the **Questionnaires** table if you have the appropriate permissions.
- View all tasks associated with the registration in the **Tasks** table and view the details of completed tasks.
- [Complete any standalone To Do tasks \[page 259\]](#) to which you've been assigned.
- [Cancel \[page 145\]](#) the registration if it's in progress and meets prerequisites for cancellation.
- [Approve or deny the registration \[page 131\]](#) if you're in the approval flow.
- [Restart \[page 136\]](#) a denied registration.
- [Reassign external questionnaires in a completed registration \[page 142\]](#) so that a different recipient can update them.
- For registrations that have been upgraded to the latest version of the project template at least once, [view registrations based on previous template versions \[page 143\]](#), including the questionnaires, tasks, and process flows for those previous versions.
- [Invite the supplier to participate \[page 138\]](#) in an internal registration.

Related Information

[Approving or Denying a Supplier Registration Questionnaire \[page 131\]](#)

[Inviting a Supplier to Register \[page 116\]](#)

[Reinviting a Supplier to Register \[page 120\]](#)

[Filling Out an Internal Registration Questionnaire \[page 128\]](#)

[Starting an Internal Supplier Registration on Behalf of a Supplier \[page 122\]](#)

[Restarting a Denied Supplier Registration \[page 136\]](#)

[Inviting a Supplier to Participate in an Internal Registration \[page 138\]](#)

Inviting a Supplier to Register

Use these steps to invite a supplier to register. Supplier registration gathers detailed profile information about a supplier so that your organization can assess them. Inviting a supplier to register creates a supplier registration project for them, invites them to fill out external registration questionnaires, and makes internal registration questionnaires available for editing.

Prerequisites

To invite a supplier to register, you must be a member of the **Supplier Registration Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** group.

To specify a requester for the registration during invitation, the requester selection feature (SM-20904) must be enabled in your site.

Context

Inviting a supplier to register asks them to participate in their registration from the beginning by filling out external questionnaires. If you want to register a supplier without asking them to fill out external questionnaires, you can start an internal registration instead. In an internal registration, recipients in your organization submit questionnaires on the supplier's behalf instead.

Your organization's registration projects can have one or more external (supplier-facing) registration questionnaires. If there are multiple external questionnaires, some of them can be optional. You can choose which optional external questionnaires to send with the registration invitation. Each external registration questionnaire generates a separate email invitation to the supplier contact.

If the requester selection during registration invitation feature is enabled in your site, you can also choose the requester for invitations to fill out registration questionnaires. Choosing the requester allows you to identify someone in your organization with whom the supplier is familiar as the sender of those invitations. The name of the requester you choose shows in the "From" field in registration invitations to the supplier. Depending on how your organization has set up registration invitations, the requester's name can also show in other places in those emails as well. For suppliers created from approved supplier requests, the default registration requester is the owner of the supplier request project, which can be a person with whom the supplier already has a relationship. If you don't choose a registration requester, registration invitations use whatever default sender is set up for them, which can be a generic system alias, a custom alias, or you as the registration project owner.

Procedure

1. Locate the supplier on the **Supplier Management** dashboard.

→ Tip

In supplier search results, you can filter by the registration status **Not Invited** to show new suppliers that haven't yet been invited to register.

2. Choose the supplier's name to open their profile.
3. Perform one of the following actions:
 - In the supplier's profile summary, choose the registration status link in the **Supplier Status** panel.
 - In the classic supplier 360° profile, choose **Registration** in the left-hand navigation bar.

The **Registration** detail area of the supplier's profile opens.

4. Choose **Invite**.

5. Select the optional questionnaires that you want to send to the supplier if the registration project includes optional questionnaires. If there's only one questionnaire, or if a questionnaire is required, it automatically selected and you can't deselect it.
To preview a questionnaire, choose  (view).
6. Choose the contact to whom you want to send the registration invitation. If the supplier has only one contact, it's automatically selected. If the contact you want to invite isn't in the list of available contacts and you have the appropriate permissions, you can add them now.

Invite to register

Confirm questionnaires to send

QUESTIONNAIRE ID	QUESTIONNAIRE NAME	
☒	Doc13905930	Supplier registration questionnaire 

Choose recipient

NAME	TYPE	AN STATUS	REGION	CATEGORY	DEPARTMENT	
 ★ John Smith jsmith@supplierabc1.com John Smith	N/A	Private	N/A	N/A	N/A	

Choose requester

 Alice Jones
 Change requester

Send

Cancel

7. **Optional:** If the select requester feature is available in your site, perform one of the following actions:
 - If there's no requester set for the registration and you want to make an individual person in your organization the requester, choose **Select requester**, select that person, and choose **Confirm**.
 - If there's already a requester for the registration and you want to select a different requester, choose **Change requester**, select a different person in your organization, and choose **Confirm**.
8. Choose **Send invite**.

Results

The supplier now has the status **Invited**. The supplier contact that you selected receives an invitation for each external questionnaire you sent. The supplier contact can use the links in the invitation emails to sign into an existing account or create a new account on SAP Business Network and fill out and submit the questionnaires.

The **Registration** detail area of the supplier's profile now shows the external questionnaires that you sent and the supplier contact you sent them to. It also shows any internal questionnaires that your organization uses for registration and all tasks for the registration. To view a questionnaire or the details for a completed task, choose **View** .

If the status tracker for supplier management email notifications feature is enabled in your site, the **Registration** area also shows **Email Status** and **Email Status Date**. The **Email Status** lets you know if the registration invitation email has been **Delivered**, **Opened**, or **Bounced**.

Technical changes have been made to the email status tracker for supplier registration invitations. As a result, data from June 2023 onwards is accessible. This transition keeps all customer data intact.

If you chose a registration requester, the invitation email notifications to the supplier show the requester's name in the "From" field. Otherwise, the name and email address in those fields is determined by how your organization has set up each registration questionnaire.

Note

On SAP Business Network, suppliers see an option to decline to participate in a supplier management questionnaire in the same way they can decline to participate in a sourcing event. If the supplier contact you invited to register declined to participate in a registration questionnaire, they can no longer access the registration questionnaire, but the supplier remains in **Invited** status.

Next Steps

While the supplier is in **Invited** status but before the invited contact has responded to your invitation, you can cancel the registration if necessary. For example, if the supplier contact hasn't responded and you need the supplier to achieve **Registered** status for business continuity or other reasons, you can cancel the external registration and start an internal one. After the supplier contact has responded to the invitation, you can only cancel the registration under certain limited circumstances.

External registration questionnaires close after an amount of time defined in your site's questionnaire setup. After a questionnaire has closed, the supplier contact can no longer edit it to fill it out. If a supplier hasn't responded, or if the invitation has bounced, reinviting the supplier to register reopens any closed questionnaires and allows you to choose a different recipient if necessary. By default, questionnaires close 30 days after the invitation is sent, but your organization can specify a different amount of time in its questionnaire setup.

You can track registration progress using the **Supplier Onboarding Progress** data snapshot or analytical reports.

Related Information

[About the Registration Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 114\]](#)

[Reinviting a Supplier to Register \[page 120\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a Supplier Registration Questionnaire \[page 131\]](#)

[Supplier Registration Status Flow \[page 148\]](#)

[Starting an Internal Supplier Registration on Behalf of a Supplier \[page 122\]](#)

[Supplier Onboarding Progress Data Snapshot Reference \[page 73\]](#)

[Analytical Reporting on Suppliers and Supplier Management Projects \[page 76\]](#)

[Canceling an In-Progress Supplier Registration \[page 145\]](#)

[Supplier Registration Status Flow \[page 148\]](#)

Reinviting a Supplier to Register

Use these steps to remind a supplier to respond to an initial registration invitation or to change the invited supplier contact.

Prerequisites

To reinvite a supplier to register, you must be a member of the **Supplier Registration Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** group.

To add or edit a supplier contact on the send questionnaires page, you must be a member of the **Supplier Registration Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** group.

You can only reinvite a supplier to register if their registration is in **Invited** status. Once the supplier has opened and viewed an external questionnaire and the registration has moved to **In Registration** status, you can no longer reinvite them. If the supplier doesn't submit the questionnaire, you must use another method to remind them.

To specify a requester for the registration during invitation, the requester selection feature (SM-20904) must be enabled in your site.

Context

Reinviting a supplier is useful if:

- **The previously invited contact is the right person to complete the registration but they need a reminder.** Reinviting the same contact sends them another invitation as a reminder.
- **The previously invited contact isn't the right person to complete the registration.** You can choose a different contact when reinviting the supplier.
- **External questionnaires have closed before the invited contact responded.** External questionnaires close after an amount of time defined in your site's questionnaire setup. By default, that amount is 30 days, but your organization can specify a different amount of time in its questionnaire setup. After a questionnaire has closed, the supplier contact can no longer edit it to fill it out. Reinviting the supplier reopens the external questionnaires.
- **The initial invitation didn't specify a requester or a different person in your organization is a more suitable requester:** The requester you choose shows in the "From" field in registration invitations to the supplier, and depending on how your organization has set up registration invitations, can also show in other places in those emails as well. Reinviting the supplier and resends questionnaire invitation emails with the requester you choose.

You can't change which external questionnaires are included when you reinvite a supplier to register. The registration always includes the external questionnaires selected during the original invitation.

Procedure

1. Locate the supplier you want to reinvite on the **Supplier Management** dashboard.

→ Tip

In supplier search results, you can filter by the registration status **Invited** to show new suppliers who have been invited to register but haven't responded yet.

2. Choose the supplier's name to open their profile.
3. Navigate to the **Registrations** detail area of the profile.
4. In the **Questionnaires** table, for any external registration questionnaire, choose **...** (more options) > **Reinvite** .
5. **Optional:** To change the questionnaire recipient, choose a different contact. If the supplier only has one contact, that contact is automatically selected and you can't uncheck it. If you have the appropriate permissions, you can [add or edit a contact now \[page 54\]](#) to make sure you're sending the invitation to the recipient you want at the correct email address.
6. **Optional:** If the select requester feature is available in your site, perform one of the following actions:
 - If there'sn't a requester set for the registration and you want to make an individual person in your organization the requester, choose **Select requester**, select that person, and choose **Confirm**.
 - If there's already a requester for the registration and you want to select a different requester, choose **Change requester**, select a different person in your organization, and chose **Confirm**.
7. Choose **Send**.

Results

The supplier contact you selected receives a new invitation for each external questionnaire in the registration with the requester you selected. The supplier contact can use the links in the emails to create an account and fill out and submit the questionnaires.

If you added or edited a supplier contact while reinviting the supplier, those changes show in the **Contacts** detail area of the supplier's profile.

Related Information

[About the Registration Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 114\]](#)

[Inviting a Supplier to Register \[page 116\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a Supplier Registration Questionnaire \[page 131\]](#)

Starting an Internal Supplier Registration on Behalf of a Supplier

Use these steps to start an internal registration and invite other people in your organization to fill out external questionnaires on behalf of a supplier. An internal registration doesn't require the supplier to sign into SAP Business Network to fill out and submit the questionnaires. Supplier registration gathers detailed profile information about a supplier.

Prerequisites

You must be a member of the **Supplier Registration Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** group to start an internal registration on behalf of a supplier.

Context

In an internal registration, people in your organization submit external registration questionnaires on behalf of a supplier. The supplier doesn't participate in the registration. Your organization's supplier registration projects can have one or more external registration questionnaires, some of which can be optional. You can choose which optional questionnaires to send to recipients. You choose one internal recipient for each external questionnaire, and you can choose different recipients for different questionnaires. A recipient can be any internal user in your site. Each external registration questionnaire generates a separate email notification to the recipient.

You can start an internal registration for a supplier if they have a registration status of:

- **Not Invited** because no one has started a registration for them before.
- **Registered** because of an internal supplier registration data import. In this case, the data import sets the supplier's registration status but doesn't create a registration project with tasks and questionnaires. Starting an internal registration creates the registration project so that recipients in your organization can fill out questionnaires and approvers and task owners can complete tasks in the registration workflow.

Note

After the internal registration is completed, registration managers have the option of inviting the supplier to participate in the registration and fill out the external questionnaires. There's currently no way to change which external questionnaires are included in a registration after it's first started. Therefore, when you start an internal registration and choose the questionnaires to include in it, keep in mind that the supplier can eventually participate in the registration.

Procedure

1. Locate the supplier that you want to register on the **Supplier Management** dashboard.

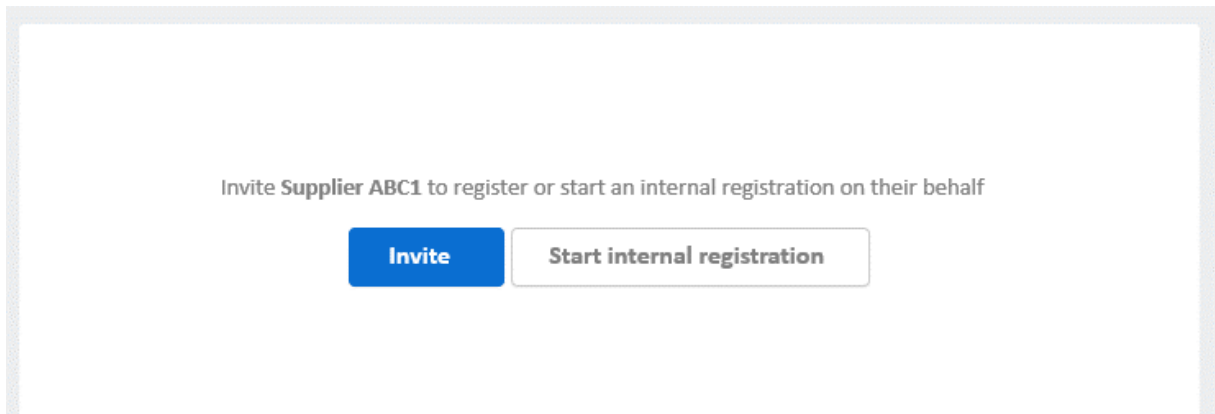
→ Tip

In supplier search results, you can filter by the registration status **Not Invited** to show new suppliers who haven't yet been invited to register. However, there's no way to distinguish suppliers who have a status of **Registered** through an internal registration data import, and for whom you can start an internal registration manually, in supplier searches.

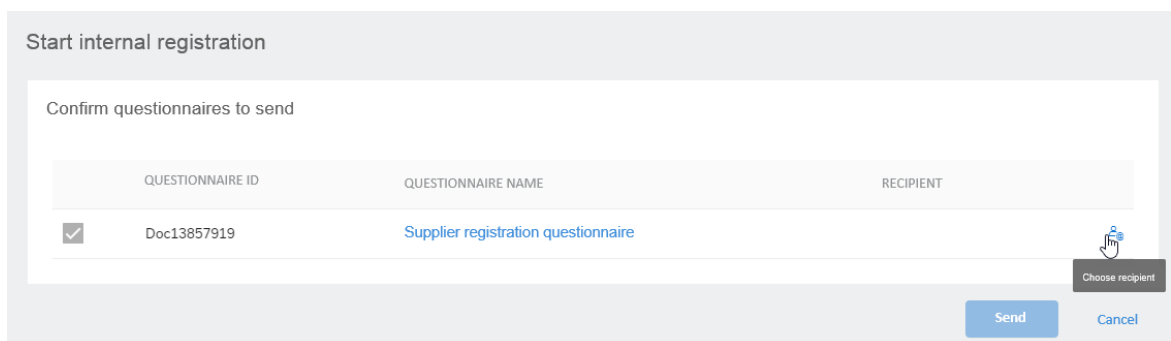
2. Choose the supplier's name to open their profile.
3. Perform one of the following actions:
 - In the supplier's profile summary, choose the registration status link in the **Supplier Status** panel.
 - In the classic supplier 360° profile, choose **Registration** in the left-hand navigation bar.

The **Registration** detail area of the supplier's profile opens.

4. Choose **Start internal registration**.



5. On the confirmation popup, choose **Start registration** to confirm that you want to start the internal registration.
6. Select any optional questionnaires that you want to include in the registration. If there's only one questionnaire, or if a questionnaire is required, it's automatically selected and you can't uncheck it.
7. For each questionnaire included in the registration, perform the following steps:
 - a. Choose **Choose recipient** (👤).



- b. Search for and select the person in your organization who you want to make the recipient of the questionnaire.
 - c. Choose **Confirm**.
8. Choose **Send**.

Results

The supplier now has the status **Invited**. The recipients you selected receive notifications for each external questionnaire you included in the registration. They can use links in the notifications or navigate to the supplier's 360° profile to edit and submit the external questionnaires to which they're assigned.

The **Registration** detail area of the supplier's profile now shows the external questionnaires that you included in the registration, any internal questionnaires your organization uses for registration, and all registration tasks. To view questionnaire or task details, choose **View** (). The **Supplier recipient** field shows the name and email address of the internal recipient for the first listed questionnaire. The questionnaire details page for each external registration questionnaire shows the name of its individual internal recipient.

Next Steps

In internal registrations, external questionnaires remain open regardless of due date settings in the questionnaire setup. However, if a recipient hasn't responded, reinviting the recipient sends a new email invitation or allows you to choose a different recipient if necessary.

After the internal registration is approved, if you later decide you want to establish communications with the supplier and have them provide registration information, you can invite them to participate and convert the internal registration to an external registration.

Related Information

[Filling Out an External Registration Questionnaire on Behalf of a Supplier in an Internal Registration \[page 130\]](#)

[Reinviting Internal Recipients to an Internal Supplier Registration \[page 126\]](#)

[Inviting a Supplier to Participate in an Internal Registration \[page 138\]](#)

[Setting a Supplier as Registered Using the Set Registered Option \[page 125\]](#)

[Canceling an In-Progress Supplier Registration \[page 145\]](#)

[Supplier Registration Status Flow \[page 148\]](#)

[New Supplier Registrations \[page 108\]](#)

Setting a Supplier as Registered Using the Set Registered Option

Use these steps to set a supplier as **Registered** without having to go through an internal or external registration process.

Prerequisites

You must be a member of the **Supplier Registration Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** group to set a supplier's status as **Registered**.

Context

In registrations that are done using the **Set Registered** option, internal users in your organization choose this option in the supplier's profile and the supplier doesn't participate at all. The **Set Registered** option is available only after the supplier request is approved and the supplier is in **Not Invited** status.

Procedure

1. Locate the supplier you want to register on the **Supplier Management** dashboard.

→ Tip

In supplier search results, you can filter by the registration status **Not Invited** to show new suppliers who haven't yet been invited to register.

2. Choose the supplier's name to open their profile.
3. Perform one of the following actions:
 - In the supplier's profile summary, choose the registration status link in the **Supplier Status** panel.
 - In the classic supplier 360° profile, choose **Registration** in the left-hand navigation bar.

The **Registration** detail area of the supplier's profile opens.

4. Choose **Set Registered**.

Results

When you choose this option, the system immediately sets the status of the supplier to **Registered**. In addition, the system synchronizes supplier data with your ERP systems automatically or with manual intervention depending on how your site is configured. This data then becomes available for supplier qualifications or for use in other SAP Ariba procurement applications.

Next Steps

After setting a supplier as **Registered**, you can still start an internal or external registration. However, if you do so, the registration process starts and the **Set Registered** option won't be available again unless you cancel the newly started registration.

Related Information

[Inviting a Supplier to Register \[page 116\]](#)

[Inviting a Supplier to Participate in an Internal Registration \[page 138\]](#)

[New Supplier Registrations \[page 108\]](#)

Reinviting Internal Recipients to an Internal Supplier Registration

Use these steps to reinvite internal recipients to an internal registration if they haven't responded to a previous invitation and you want to prompt them to do so, or if you want to change a questionnaire's recipient.

Prerequisites

To reinvite internal recipients to an internal registration, you must be a member of the **Supplier Registration Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** group.

You can only reinvite recipients to an internal registration, or change the internal recipients of external registration questionnaires, if the registration is in **Invited** or **Registration Denied** status. For registrations in **Invited** status, once an internal recipient has opened and viewed an external questionnaire and the registration has moved to **In Registration** status, you can no longer reinvite them.

Context

In an internal registration, people in your organization submit external registration questionnaires on behalf of a supplier. You can choose different recipients for different questionnaires. A recipient can be any internal user in your site. Each external registration questionnaire generates a separate email notification to the recipient.

Reinviting internal recipients to an internal registration is useful if the previously invited recipient:

- Is the right person to complete the external registration questionnaire but hasn't responded to the earlier invitation. Reinviting the same recipient sends them another invitation as a reminder.
- Isn't the right person to complete the registration questionnaire. You can choose a different recipient when reinviting them.

You can't change which external questionnaires are included in the registration when you reinvite recipients to an internal registration. The registration always includes the external questionnaires selected during the original invitation. You can change the recipients of any of the external questionnaires included in the registration, and you can choose different recipients for different questionnaires.

Procedure

1. On the **Supplier Management** dashboard, locate the supplier with the internal registration for whom you want to reinvite internal recipients.

→ Tip

In supplier search, you can filter by the registration status **Invited** to show suppliers for whom a registration has been started where no recipients have submitted external questionnaires. However, there's no way to distinguish suppliers who have a status of **Invited** through an internal registration in supplier searches.

2. Choose the supplier's name to open their 360° profile.
3. Perform one of the following actions:
 - In the supplier's profile summary, choose the registration status link in the **Supplier Status** panel.
 - In the classic supplier 360° profile, choose **Registration** in the left-hand navigation bar.The **Registration** detail area of the supplier's profile opens.
4. In the **Questionnaires** table, for any external registration questionnaire, choose  (more options) > **Reinvite** ().
5. (Optional) To change the recipients for a questionnaire, perform the following steps:
 - a. Choose **Choose recipient** ().
 - b. Search for and select the user in your organization who you want to make the recipient of the questionnaire.
 - c. Choose **Confirm**.
6. Choose **Send**.

Results

The selected recipients receive new invitations for each external questionnaire in the registration. They can use the links in the invitation emails to sign into your site and fill out and submit their assigned questionnaires.

Next Steps

After a new internal registration is approved, you can also reassign the internal recipients of its external questionnaires. When you reassign a recipient, the previous recipient can only continue to edit the questionnaire if they're also the registration project owner.

Related Information

[Starting an Internal Supplier Registration on Behalf of a Supplier \[page 122\]](#)

[Filling Out an External Registration Questionnaire on Behalf of a Supplier in an Internal Registration \[page 130\]](#)

[Inviting a Supplier to Participate in an Internal Registration \[page 138\]](#)

[New Supplier Registrations \[page 108\]](#)

[Supplier Registration Updates \[page 113\]](#)

[About the Registration Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 114\]](#)

Filling Out an Internal Registration Questionnaire

Use these steps if your organization's registration projects include one or more internal questionnaires and you're a questionnaire editor. Filling out internal questionnaires can be a required or optional step in supplier registration.

Prerequisites

To edit an internal registration questionnaire, you must be a member of the **Supplier Registration Manager**, **Supplier Internal Questionnaire Editor**, **SM Ops Administrator**, or **SM ERP Administrator** group.

If the questionnaire is associated with a To Do task, you must also be a task owner to edit the questionnaire while completing the To Do task.

Context

Internal supplier registration questionnaires typically collect detailed profile information about the supplier that only people in your organization can provide, such as internal supplier categorizations.

Internal questionnaires can be associated with To Do tasks. If there's no To Do task associated with an internal questionnaire, or if it's associated with an optional To Do task, filling out the questionnaire is optional. If there's a required To Do task associated with an internal questionnaire and you're a task owner, you must submit the internal questionnaire to complete the task.

Internal registration questionnaires are always editable unless they're in approval. You can update them at any time, even after registering the suppliers.

If the owner of a To Do task on an internal questionnaire is a project group, all members of that project group who have the appropriate permissions can edit the internal questionnaire. The first member to submit the questionnaire becomes the owner of the completed task. In registration projects, if the To Do task has restarted because of a registration update, task ownership reverts to the entire project group so that all members who have the appropriate permission can again edit the internal questionnaire.

Note

Attachments in supplier management questionnaires can't include embedded documents.

Procedure

1. Perform one of the following actions:
 - On the **Supplier Management** dashboard, locate the supplier, choose their name to open their profile, and navigate to the **Registration** detail area.
 - If the questionnaire is associated with an active To Do task and you're a task owner, choose the link in the email notification.
2. Perform one of the following actions:
 - Locate the questionnaire in the **Questionnaires** table and choose **View** () to open the questionnaire details page. On the questionnaire details page, choose **Edit**.
 - If the questionnaire is associated with an active To Do task and you're a task owner, locate the task in the **Tasks** table and choose  (take action) to open the task details page, where the questionnaire is automatically editable.
3. Fill out the questionnaire as needed.
4. **Optional:** To save your draft edits of the questionnaire, choose **Save**.
You can continue editing the questionnaire later by opening it and choosing **Edit** again.
5. Perform one of the following actions:
 - On the questionnaire details page, click **Submit**.
 - On the task details page, click **Mark Complete**.

If the questionnaire is associated with a To Do task, either of these actions completes the task.

Results

If the questionnaire has an approval task, that task starts and approvers approve or deny your answers. For internal registration questionnaires, depending on your site's configuration, your answers can be added to mapped database fields and synchronized to an integrated ERP system immediately after you submit the questionnaire or only after approval.

If you're the first user to submit the questionnaire, your name is added to the **Owner** field and is always displayed even if other users edit the questionnaire subsequently. If you have access to the **Advanced View**, you can choose **Advanced View** () in the top right corner of the questionnaire and view the questionnaire's activity history in the **History** tab. To view a project's activity history, see [Viewing a Project's Activity History \[page 274\]](#).

Next Steps

As long as it's not in approval, you can edit an internal registration questionnaire again by choosing  (view).

Related Information

[About the Registration Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 114\]](#)

[Inviting a Supplier to Register \[page 116\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a Supplier Registration Questionnaire \[page 131\]](#)

Filling Out an External Registration Questionnaire on Behalf of a Supplier in an Internal Registration

Use these steps if a registration manager has made you the recipient of one or more external registration questionnaires in an internal supplier registration so that you can fill them out on behalf of the supplier. Suppliers don't participate in internal registrations.

Prerequisites

To edit and submit an external registration questionnaire on behalf of a supplier in an internal registration, you must be the registration project owner or the questionnaire recipient.

If you're not a member of the **Sensitive Data Access** group, to see and edit otherwise masked answers, the self-service configuration parameter **Enable questionnaire recipients in internal registrations to see and edit otherwise masked answers** must be enabled in your site.

Context

Attachments in supplier management questionnaires can't include embedded documents.

Procedure

1. Perform one of the following actions:
 - Choose the link in the notification email and sign into your site.
 - Navigate to the **Registration** detail area of the supplier's profile, and choose **...** (more options) > **View**  for the questionnaire.
2. On the questionnaire details page, choose **Edit**.

→ Tip

In some cases, external registration questionnaires can include questions that already have existing answers. These answers can come from an approved supplier request, a data import, or an integrated ERP system. When you first open the questionnaire, it takes a few moments for the system to load these

answers, and during that time the **Edit** button is temporarily disabled. If this situation occurs, refresh the page or navigate away and back again to see the updated questionnaire and active **Edit** button.

3. Fill out the questionnaire as needed. If the questionnaire includes existing answers, you can edit them or leave them as is.
4. Choose **Submit**.

Results

If the questionnaire has an approval task, that task starts and approvers approve or deny your answers. Your answers aren't added to mapped database fields or synchronized to an integrated ERP system until the registration is finally approved.

Next Steps

If the internal supplier registration is approved and the supplier has **Registered** status, you can update the questionnaires to which you've been assigned as needed.

If a registration manager invites the supplier to participate in the registration, access to the external questionnaires to which you've been assigned transfers to the invited supplier contact and you can no longer edit them after that point.

Related Information

[Starting an Internal Supplier Registration on Behalf of a Supplier \[page 122\]](#)

[Reinviting Internal Recipients to an Internal Supplier Registration \[page 126\]](#)

[Inviting a Supplier to Participate in an Internal Registration \[page 138\]](#)

[Enable questionnaire recipients in internal registrations to see and edit otherwise masked answers \[page 298\]](#)

Approving or Denying a Supplier Registration Questionnaire

Use these steps to approve or deny a supplier registration questionnaire if you're in its approval flow. Questionnaire approval is part of the overall approval process for both new supplier registrations and registration updates.

Context

Supplier registration questionnaires can be internal, meaning that they're designed to collect information from people in your organization, or external, meaning that they're designed to collect information from suppliers. The

type and number of questionnaires included in a supplier registration depend on the setup of your organization's registration projects. In external registrations, the supplier fills out and submits external questionnaires. In internal registrations, people in your organization fill out and submit external questionnaires on behalf of the supplier, without the supplier's direct participation.

For a new registration, external questionnaire recipients fill out and submit registration questionnaires once. Approvals for external registration questionnaires directly affect supplier registration status. When a recipient submits the first external questionnaire for a new registration, the supplier moves to **Pending Approval** registration status. They can't move to **Registered** status until all external registration questionnaires are finally approved and any other tasks in the new registration workflow are completed. If one approver denies one external registration questionnaire, the supplier's registration status moves to **Registration Denied**.

The role of internal questionnaires in the registration workflow varies depending on their setup. Internal registration questionnaires are typically editable anytime they aren't in approval. Depending on the setup, approval of an internal questionnaire can be a required or optional part of a new registration or registration update workflow. If the internal questionnaire is set up as a profile questionnaire, its approval or denial has no impact on the supplier's registration or registration update status. Approval of nonprofile internal questionnaires directly affects the supplier's registration or registration update status.

Internal and external questionnaires can have different approval flows depending on whether they're in a new registration or are being updated after the new registration is completed. After a recipient has submitted an update to a registration questionnaire, the supplier remains in **Registered** status. If the updated questionnaire is either an external questionnaire or an internal questionnaire that affects registration status, and the update requires an approval, the supplier has a separate **Pending Approval** registration update status. When there are no remaining tasks in progress for the questionnaire that is in approval, the update status is **Approved**. Submitting an update only starts the tasks that are associated with the updated questionnaire, and the process flow graph in the **Registration** detail area of the supplier's profile now shows the tasks associated with the current update:



For either internal or external questionnaire updates, or if you've requested more information from the recipient during an approval, the approval task details page shows the answers in both the latest, unapproved update and the previous versions. You can view and compare different questionnaire versions.

Procedure

1. Perform one of the following actions:
 - Navigate to the **Registration** detail area of the supplier's profile. Choose [🔗](#) (take action) in the **Tasks** table.
 - Choose the link in the approval notification email.

The approval task details page opens.

2. Review the answers to the questionnaire.
3. **Optional:** Perform any of the following actions if you're reviewing a questionnaire update:
 - To display only the questions with updated answers, choose **Updated**.

- To display all questions regardless of whether or not they've updated answers, choose **All**.
- To compare the current answers with versions of the questionnaire that the respondent submitted before the previous version, choose the version number in the **Previous Version** column and select a version. The **Latest Version** column always shows answers from the current update.

4. Perform one of the following actions:

- To approve the questionnaire, choose **Approve**, enter an optional comment, and choose **Approve**.
- To deny the questionnaire, choose **Deny**, enter an explanatory comment, and choose **Deny**. This option is only available for new registrations. It's not available for updates.
- To request additional information from the respondent, choose **Request Additional Info**, enter a comment explaining what information you want, and choose **Request Additional Info**.

Results

For new registrations:

If you've approved the questionnaire and you're the final approver in the registration, the supplier is now in **Registered** status. After approval, answers in both internal and external registration questionnaires are added to mapped database fields and initially synchronized to an integrated system using either manual or automatic synchronization, depending on your site's integration setup. External questionnaires and internal questionnaires that affect registration status automatically reopen for further updates.

If you approved or denied an internal profile questionnaire that doesn't affect registration status, the registration status remains unchanged and the questionnaire automatically reopens for further updates.

If you denied the questionnaire and it is either an external questionnaire or an internal questionnaire that affects registration status, the registration is now in **Registration Denied** status. Answers in denied external questionnaires and denied internal questionnaires that are a required part of registration are saved and show on questionnaire detail pages, but aren't added to mapped database fields. Suppliers with denied registrations aren't synchronized to an integrated system. Both external and internal questionnaires automatically close to further updates.

For registration updates:

If you're the final approver for an external or internal questionnaire update and you approved it, the approved update shows as the latest version and the questionnaire reopens for further updates.

Depending on your site's configuration, updates to approved internal registration questionnaires can be added to mapped database fields and synchronized to an integrated system immediately after the questionnaire is submitted or only after approval.

Approved updates to an external registration questionnaire are always added to mapped database fields and synchronized to an integrated system after approval. If your registration project includes tasks in one or more update phases, updates to an external registration questionnaire are added to mapped database fields and synchronized to an integrated ERP system after all tasks associated with the questionnaire are completed, regardless of the status of the overall update phase or of other questionnaire tasks in it.

If you requested additional information rather than approving or denying the questionnaire, the questionnaire reopens so that the recipient can provide the requested information. By default, the current approval flow for the questionnaire resets and the process flow graph for the registration reverts to the previously completed new registration workflow. After the recipient resubmits the questionnaire, the approval task becomes active again,

the approval flow restarts from the beginning, and the process flow graph now shows the questionnaire update workflow again. If the enhancements to the workflow for requesting additional information feature (SM-3492) is enabled in your site, requesting additional information restarts the current node of the approval flow rather than resetting the entire approval flow.

The supplier remains in **Registered** status. After all tasks associated with the current update are completed, the supplier also has a registration update status of **Approved** or **Denied**.

For both new registrations and registration updates:

Any comments that you or other approvers added during questionnaire approval show on both the questionnaire and approval task details pages, which you can see by viewing the questionnaire or task. Questionnaire details pages show all comments for all tasks in the project, and you can filter them to just show the comments for the current questionnaire. Task details pages show only the comments associated with the current task. Depending on how your site's notifications are set up, approval comments can also be included in approval or denial notifications to suppliers.

If your organization uses different phases to manage tasks for new questionnaires and questionnaire updates, the questionnaire details page only shows comments for tasks in the current phase. When the questionnaire is new, comments for tasks in the new questionnaire phase show. After a recipient submits the first questionnaire update, only comments for tasks in the update phase show, and the comment history shows comments for all updates. If the advanced view for the project is enabled and you have permission to view it, you can see comments for tasks in the new phase by viewing task details on the **Tasks** tab of the advanced project view.

If you requested additional information during approval of an external questionnaire and entered a comment, the supplier sees the most recent approval comment when they revise their response to the questionnaire.

Next Steps

If you or another approver denied a questionnaire in a new registration, you can start a new round of the approval task to reapprove it. A member of the **Supplier Registration Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** groups can also restart the entire registration project.

If you or another approver finally approved a new registration and your site includes qualification projects, a qualification manager can now qualify the supplier for specific commodities, regions, and departments.

Related Information

[About the Registration Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 114\]](#)

[Supplier Registration Status Flow \[page 148\]](#)

[Completing a Standalone To Do Task in a Supplier Management Project \[page 259\]](#)

[Starting an Internal Supplier Registration on Behalf of a Supplier \[page 122\]](#)

[Comparing Different Versions of a Supplier Management Questionnaire \[page 258\]](#)

[Starting a New Approval Round for a Denied Supplier Registration Questionnaire \[page 135\]](#)

[Restarting a Denied Supplier Registration \[page 136\]](#)

Starting a New Approval Round for a Denied Supplier Registration Questionnaire

Use these steps to start a new round of the approval task if an approver has denied a supplier registration questionnaire in error. Starting a new round of the approval task removes the denial and restarts the approval task so that approvers can reapprove the questionnaire.

Prerequisites

To start a new approval round for a denied supplier registration questionnaire, you must be a member of the **Supplier Registration Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** group.

You can only start new rounds for denied approval tasks on external registration questionnaires and internal registration questionnaires that affect the supplier's registration status. If an internal questionnaire is a profile questionnaire, its approval or denial doesn't affect supplier registration status. Instead of starting a new approval round for a profile questionnaire, you can edit it to start a new approval for it.

Context

The option to start a new approval round is only available in new registrations. Once an approver denies an external questionnaire, or an internal questionnaire that's not a profile questionnaire, in a new registration, the entire registration is denied. Starting a new round of a denied approval task allows the approvers for that task to re-evaluate the currently submitted questionnaire answers and reapprove them so that the supplier can complete registration. For registration updates, respondents can always submit updates to denied questionnaires for reapproval.

Starting a new approval round is useful when not much time has elapsed since the questionnaire denial or when you're otherwise confident that the currently submitted answers are the appropriate basis for new approval decisions. Starting a new approval round doesn't require any further action by the questionnaire recipients and only restarts the approval tasks on the denied questionnaire. If time has elapsed since the original denial or you otherwise want the recipient to submit updates before approving the registration, you can restart the registration instead.

Procedure

1. In the **Registration** detail area of the supplier's profile, locate the denied approval task and choose **View** .
2. In the upper right corner of the approval task details page, choose **New Round**.
3. Choose **Confirm**.

Results

The supplier moves from **Denied** registration status back to **Pending Approval** registration status. Approvers in the approval flow for the task receive email notifications letting them know that they need to reapprove the questionnaire.

The approval task details page shows comments for all rounds of the approval task.

If an approver denies the questionnaire again, the registration moves back to **Denied** registration status and for external registrations, the supplier receives a second email notification for the registration denial.

If approvers approve the questionnaire, any subsequent tasks in the registration workflow start.

Related Information

[Restarting a Denied Supplier Registration \[page 136\]](#)

[New Supplier Registrations \[page 108\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a Supplier Registration Questionnaire \[page 131\]](#)

[Supplier Registration Status Flow \[page 148\]](#)

Restarting a Denied Supplier Registration

Use these steps to reinvite questionnaire recipients to a denied supplier registration and restarts the entire registration workflow so that they can update questionnaires and approvers can reapprove the registration based on those updates.

Prerequisites

To restart a denied registration, you must be the project owner or a member of the **Supplier Registration Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** group.

Context

Once an approver denies an external questionnaire, or internal registration questionnaire that's not a profile questionnaire, in a new registration, the entire registration is denied. Reinviting a supplier (for external registrations) or internal recipients (for internal registrations) to a denied registration allows you to restart the registration workflow so that the registration can be completed.

Restarting denied registration is useful when time has elapsed since the original denial or when you otherwise want to completely restart the registration process from the beginning. When you restart the registration, recipients

must resubmit all external questionnaires and task owners must recomplete all tasks related to those external questionnaires in the registration workflow.

You can't change which external questionnaires are included when restarting a denied registration. The registration always includes the external questionnaires selected during the original registration invitation.

Note

Currently, once a supplier contact opens an external questionnaire, no other supplier contact can access it. Although it's technically possible to change the contact when reinviting a supplier to a denied registration, always make sure that you reinvite the contact who originally completed the denied registration so that they can update the questionnaires.

If you want to complete the registration by reapproving existing questionnaire answers rather than requiring recipients to resubmit all external questionnaires and task owners to recomplete all required tasks, you can start a new round of approvals for the denied questionnaire instead.

Restarting a denied registration doesn't affect approvals for internal questionnaires.

Procedure

1. Locate the supplier that you want to reinvite on the **Supplier Management** dashboard.

→ Tip

In supplier search, you can filter by the registration status **Denied** to show suppliers with denied registrations.

2. Choose the supplier's name to open their profile.
3. Perform one of the following actions:
 - In the supplier's profile summary, choose the registration status link in the **Supplier Status** panel.
 - In the classic supplier 360° profile, choose **Registration** in the left-hand navigation bar.

The **Registration** detail area of the supplier's profile opens.

4. For any external registration questionnaire, choose  (more options) > **Reinvite** .
5. Choose **Send**.

Results

The supplier moves from **Denied** registration status back to **Invited** registration status. Recipients receive a new invitation for each external questionnaire in the registration. Recipients can use the links in the emails to update the questionnaires. Recipients must resubmit every external questionnaire in the registration, even if they don't change their answers, to move the registration back to **Pending Approval** status.

After recipients have resubmitted all external questionnaires, task owners recomplete any previously completed tasks and approvers reapprove previously approved or denied questionnaires. If an approver denies a registration questionnaire in an external registration, the supplier receives a second email notification of the denial. If approvers

finally approve an external registration, the supplier receives an email notification letting them know that they've registered successfully.

Questionnaires resubmitted during the restarted registration show as the latest version in the questionnaire version history. Task details pages show comments from all actions on the task during both the initial and restarted registrations.

Related Information

[Starting a New Approval Round for a Denied Supplier Registration Questionnaire \[page 135\]](#)

[New Supplier Registrations \[page 108\]](#)

[About the Registration Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 114\]](#)

[Inviting a Supplier to Register \[page 116\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a Supplier Registration Questionnaire \[page 131\]](#)

[Starting an Internal Supplier Registration on Behalf of a Supplier \[page 122\]](#)

Inviting a Supplier to Participate in an Internal Registration

Use these steps to invite a supplier to participate in an internal registration for the first time by signing into SAP Business Network and updating external questionnaires, making the registration external. In internal registrations, people in your organization complete a registration on behalf of the supplier.

Prerequisites

To invite a supplier to participate in an internal registration, you must be a member of the **Supplier Registration Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** group.

The supplier must have one of the following registration statuses:

- **Registered**, through either an internal supplier registration data import or an approved internal registration project.
- **Registration Denied**, through a denied internal registration project.

You can't invite a supplier to participate in an internal registration if they have an internal registration project that is in progress or a questionnaire update submitted by an internal recipient is in progress.

The supplier must have at least one contact. To add or edit a supplier contact on the send questionnaires page, you must be a member of the **Supplier Registration Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** group.

To specify a requester for the registration during invitation, the requester selection feature (SM-20904) must be enabled.

Context

Inviting a supplier to an internal registration transfers access to external questionnaires from assigned internal recipients to the invited supplier contact. The supplier must now create an account or sign into an existing account on SAP Business Network to fill out the external questionnaires and submit them. When you first invite a supplier to an internal registration, you send them the external questionnaires for the first time, and those questionnaires close after the amount of time defined for new questionnaires in your site's questionnaire setup.

If the supplier was originally registered through an approved internal registration project, you can't change which external questionnaires are included in the registration when you invite the supplier to it. In this case, registration always includes the external questionnaires selected for the original internal registration. If the supplier was internally registered through a data import, you select the external questionnaires to include in the registration when inviting them to participate in it.

If the requester selection during registration invitation feature is enabled in your site, you can also choose the requester for invitations to fill out registration questionnaires. Choosing the requester allows you to identify someone in your organization with whom the supplier is familiar as the sender of those invitations. The name of the requester you choose shows in the "From" field in registration invitations to the supplier. Depending on how your organization has set up registration invitations, the requester's name can also show in other places in those emails as well. For suppliers created from approved supplier requests, the default registration requester is the owner of the supplier request project, which can be a person with whom the supplier already has a relationship. If you don't choose a registration requester, registration invitations use whatever default sender is set up for them, which can be a generic system alias, a custom alias, or you as the registration project owner.

Procedure

1. On the **Supplier Management** dashboard, locate the internally registered supplier you want to invite.
2. Choose the supplier's name to open their profile.
3. Perform one of the following actions:
 - In the supplier's profile summary, choose the registration status link in the **Supplier Status** panel.
 - In the classic supplier 360° profile, choose **Registration** in the left-hand navigation bar.

The **Registration** detail area of the supplier's profile opens.

4. Perform one of the following actions:
 - a. If the supplier was internally registered through a data import, choose **Invite**.
 - b. If the supplier has an approved or denied internal registration project, choose **Invite supplier**, then choose **Send Invite** to confirm that you want to invite the supplier to the registration.

Registration		Internally Registered Supplier	Invite supplier	Current template version (V30)	
Invited by	Bob Smith				
Invited on	May 28, 2020				
Registration status	Registered				
Supplier recipient	Alice Jones				
Email	ajones@buyer123.com				

5. Select the contact to whom you want to send the registration invitation. If the supplier has only one contact, it's automatically selected. If the contact you want to invite isn't in the list of available contacts, you can add them now.

Invite to register

Confirm questionnaires to send

QUESTIONNAIRE ID	QUESTIONNAIRE NAME
☒ Doc13905930	Supplier registration questionnaire

Choose recipient

NAME	TYPE	AN STATUS	REGION	CATEGORY	DEPARTMENT	
☒ ★ John Smith jsmith@supplierabc1.com John Smith	N/A	Private	N/A	N/A	N/A	...

Choose requester

A

Alice Jones

Change requester

Send

Cancel

6. **Optional:** If the select requester feature is available in your site, perform one of the following actions:
 - If there's no requester set for the registration and you want to make an individual person in your organization the requester, choose **Select requester**, select that person, and choose **Confirm**.
 - If there's already a requester for the registration and you want to select a different person, choose **Change requester**, select a different person in your organization, and choose **Confirm**.
7. Choose **Send**.

Results

The supplier contact that you selected receives an invitation for each external questionnaire in the registration asking them to create an account or sign into an existing account on SAP Business Network and fill out and submit the questionnaires.

The **Registration** detail area of the supplier's profile now shows the supplier contact that you invited in the **Supplier recipient** and **Email** fields. The internal recipients previously assigned to external registration questionnaires can no longer edit them.

If the status tracker for supplier management email notifications feature is enabled in your site, the **Registration** area also shows **Email Status** and **Email Status Date**. The **Email Status** lets you know if the registration invitation email has been **Delivered**, **Opened**, or **Bounced**.

If you selected a registration requester, the invitation email notifications to the supplier show the requester's name in the "From" field. Otherwise, the name in that field is determined by how your organization has set up each registration questionnaire.

If the supplier had a registration status of **Registered** from an internal registration data import, inviting them to participate in the registration creates a registration project for the first time and resets their registration status to

Invited. Their registration proceeds through the workflow your organization has defined for new registrations. They can only achieve **Registered** status again through the final approval of the external registration.

If the supplier had a registration status of **Registration Denied** from an internal registration project, inviting them to participate in the registration restarts it. They now have a registration status of **Invited** and the workflow that your organization has defined for a new registration restarts. In this case, the supplier doesn't see any previous answers from internal recipients in external questionnaires, since the internal registration was denied.

If the supplier had a registration status of **Registered** from an internal registration project, they remain in **Registered** status after you've invited them to participate in the registration, and the system treats all subsequent activity in the registration as updates. In this case, the supplier contact sees the last approved internal answers in external questionnaires and can update them as needed. The questionnaire version history retains all approved versions previously submitted by internal recipients as well as approved updates from the supplier going forward.

Next Steps

For suppliers invited to a previously internal registration, if the supplier doesn't respond, external registration questionnaires close after an amount of time defined by the circumstances of the previous internal registration and your site's questionnaire setup.

Table 10: When an External Registration Questionnaires Close

Supplier Registration State	External Questionnaire Closing Interval
Registered or Registration denied through an internal registration project	The amount of time specified for reopened questionnaires in your site's configuration or the questionnaire setup, which can be a set number of days or can be indefinite. If it's a set number of days, the default number is 365, but your organization can specify a different amount of time.
Registered through an internal supplier registration data import	The amount of time specified for new questionnaires in the questionnaire's due date settings. By default, questionnaires close 30 days after the invitation is sent, but your organization can specify a different amount of time in the questionnaire setup.

After a questionnaire has closed, the supplier contact can no longer edit it to fill it out. If a supplier hasn't responded, or if the invitation has bounced, reinviting the supplier to register reopens any closed questionnaires and allows you to choose a different supplier contact if necessary.

Reassigning External Questionnaires in a Completed Registration to a Different Recipient

Use these steps to reassign an external registration questionnaire to a different recipient if the current recipient isn't the most appropriate person to update it. In external registrations, only the supplier contact who is currently assigned to external registration questionnaires can open and update them.

Prerequisites

To reassign a different recipient to external questionnaires in a completed registration:

- You must be a member of the **Supplier Registration Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** group.
- The registration must be in **Registered** status.
- No external registration questionnaire updates must be pending approval (registration update status must be **Approved** or **Denied**).

To add or edit a supplier contact on the send questionnaires page, you must be a member of the **Supplier Registration Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** group.

Context

In new, external registrations, once the invited supplier contact opens at least one external questionnaire, no other contact for the supplier can access the external questionnaires until the registration is complete. In new, internal registrations, once an invited recipient opens at least one external questionnaire, only the assigned recipients and the registration project owner can access the external questionnaires until the registration is complete.

After the registration is complete, however, you can reassign the external questionnaires in the registration to different recipients for updates. Reassigning external questionnaires for updates allows you to make sure that the most appropriate recipient has a current invitation to update the questionnaires. Only the currently assigned recipient or, in internal registrations, the project owner can update the questionnaires.

In external registrations, you can't reassign individual external questionnaires to different supplier contacts. Reassignments apply to all external registration questionnaires in the registration project for the supplier. In internal registrations, you can reassign individual external questionnaires to different recipients.

You can't change which external questionnaires are included in the registration when you reassign a recipient. The reassignment always includes the external questionnaires selected during the original registration invitation.

Procedure

1. Locate the supplier for whom you want to reassign questionnaires on the **Supplier Management** dashboard.
2. Choose the supplier's name to open their profile.
3. Perform one of the following actions:

- In the supplier's profile summary, choose the registration status link in the **Supplier Status** panel.
- In the classic supplier 360° profile, choose **Registration** in the left-hand navigation bar.

The **Registration** detail area of the supplier's profile opens.

4. In the **Questionnaires** table, for any external registration questionnaire, choose  (more options) > **Reinvite** .
5. Select the recipients to which you want to reassign the questionnaires. If you have the appropriate permissions, you can add or edit the contact now.
6. Choose **Send**.

Results

The new recipients receive an email notification for each external questionnaire in the registration, letting them know of the reassignment.

Both the **Supplier recipient** field in the **Registration** area of the supplier's 360 profile and the **Recipient** field in the individual external registration questionnaire details pages now to show the newly reassigned recipient.

As long as the newly assigned recipient hasn't submitted an update to any of the external questionnaires after assignment, you can reassign them to a different recipient. However, if the newly reassigned recipient has submitted an update for at least one of the external questionnaires that are included in the registration project, it remains in **Registered** status but now has a registration update status of **Pending Approval**. You can't reassign the questionnaires to a different recipient until the current update is finally approved or denied and the registration update status is **Approved** or **Denied**.

Related Information

[Supplier Registration Updates \[page 113\]](#)

[About the Registration Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 114\]](#)

Viewing Supplier Registration Projects Based on Previous Template Versions After Template Upgrade

Use these steps to view registration information across template upgrades if an administrator in your organization has upgraded a supplier registration to a newer version of the registration project template. Differences across template versions can include changes to questionnaires, tasks, and project and message history.

Prerequisites

To access the advanced view of a project, you must be either a member of the **SM Advanced View Access** group or the project owner or a member of the **SM Ops Administrator** group, depending on your site's configuration.

Context

When template creators in your site change your organization's registration process by updating the registration project template, an administrator can upgrade existing supplier registrations to the newer template version. Each template upgrade creates a new registration project with the current registration information and automatically archives the previous registration project based on the previous template version. The template version menu in the upper right corner of the **Registration** detail area of a supplier's profile shows all template versions that have been applied to the registration, including the version number:

Registration

Current template version (V30) ▼ ⚙

Invited by	Bob Smith
Invited on	May 28, 2020
Registration status	Registered
Supplier recipient	Alice Jones
Email	ajones@supplierabc1.com

When you select a previous template version, the **Registration** area updates to show you the previous, archived registration project based on that version. Differences in template version can include:

- **Different registration questionnaires:** Template upgrades can add or remove either external or internal questionnaires in a registration. The **Questionnaires** table shows the questionnaires in the registration for the template version that you select.
- **Different registration tasks:** Template upgrades can add or remove tasks in a registration, or can change approvers and task owners. The **Tasks** table shows the tasks in the registration for the template version that you selected and who completed the completed tasks as of that template upgrade.
- **Different process flow diagrams:** The process flow diagram shows the process flow for the registration based on the template version that you select, including tasks and task owners or approvers in that version.
- **Registration status:** An administrator in your organization can upgrade a registration to the latest template version when a supplier has a registration status of **Invited**, **In Registration**, or **Registration Denied**, or when they have **Registered** registration status and an update isn't in approval. The registration summary reflects the supplier's registration status at the time of upgrade to the selected template version. For example, a currently registered supplier can have a status of **Registered** for the current template version 3, but a status of **In Registration** for template version 2 and **Invited** for template version 1.
- **Questionnaire contents:** If a supplier hasn't submitted an external questionnaire yet, viewing it shows the questionnaire contents for the selected template version. Otherwise, questionnaire version history reflects changes to questionnaire content across template upgrades as well as changes to recipient answers.

If you have permission to access the advanced view of a registration project, you can use the template version dropdown menu to access the advanced view of the selected template version. The advanced view includes the following information for the selected template version:

- Questionnaire-specific notifications sent to recipients on the **Event Messages** tab.
- Questionnaire response activity history in the bid history for individual questionnaires.
- Project history.

- Project documents and tasks, which are always read-only in previous projects.

Procedure

1. In the upper right corner of the **Registration** detail area of the supplier's profile, choose a template version from the template version dropdown menu.

The **Registration** area updates to show you the previous, archived registration project based on that version.

2. **Optional:** To access the advanced view of the previous project associated with the selected template version, choose **Advanced View** (⚙️).

Next Steps

If you're in the advanced view of a project that has a previous, archived project from a previous template upgrade, the **Previous Project** field on the **Overview** tab shows its ID, and you can choose the ID to see that previous project.

Related Information

[New Supplier Registrations \[page 108\]](#)

[Supplier Registration Updates \[page 113\]](#)

[About the Registration Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 114\]](#)

[Comparing Different Versions of a Supplier Management Questionnaire \[page 258\]](#)

Canceling an In-Progress Supplier Registration

Use these steps to cancel an in-progress supplier registration. Canceling a registration removes the current registration project and returns the supplier to **Invited** registration status so that you can start a new registration. It also allows you to convert an external registration to an internal one or vice versa.

Prerequisites

To cancel a supplier registration, you must be a member of the **Supplier Registration Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** group.

The supplier must be private (not linked to an SAP Business Network account) and have a registration status of:

Table 11: Registration Statuses Eligible for Cancellation

Registration Type	Registration Status
Internal	Invited, In Registration, Pending Resubmission, or Pending Approval
External, and the supplier has never been public	Invited
External, and the supplier was previously public but a customer administrator in your organization has unlinked the supplier from their SAP Business Network account	Invited, In Registration, Pending Resubmission, or Pending Approval

Regardless of the registration type or status, you can't cancel a supplier registration if the supplier has:

- One or more imported qualifications
- One or more imported qualification processes or qualification process projects

Context

Note

Canceling an in-progress registration removes the current registration project from the supplier, including any data collected in questionnaires and any activity history.

Procedure

1. On the **Supplier Management** dashboard, locate the supplier whose registration you want to cancel.
2. Choose the supplier's name to open their profile.
3. Perform one of the following actions:
 - In the supplier's profile summary, choose the registration status link in the **Supplier Status** panel.
 - In the classic supplier 360° profile, choose **Registration** in the left-hand navigation bar.

The **Registration** detail area of the supplier's profile opens.

4. Choose **Cancel**.

Registration

Cancel

Invited by	Mark White
Invited on	May 27, 2021
Registration status	Invited
Supplier recipient	Jane Smith
Email	jsmith@supplierabcinc.com
Office phone	

Process Flow



5. Enter a message explaining the cancellation.
6. Choose **Confirm** to confirm that you want to cancel the registration.

Results

The current registration project is permanently removed, with the following results:

- The supplier returns to **Not Invited** registration status and a supplier registration manager can start a new internal or external registration for them.
- Any active tasks are withdrawn.
- The canceled registration project is removed from your site, including in the **Activity log** detail area of the supplier's profile, the **Registration** tile on the **Supplier Management** dashboard of the registration owner, and project search on the **Home** dashboard.
- Data in internal questionnaires that have already been submitted is removed.
- Data from the canceled registration is no longer included in analytical reports or supplier data snapshots.

Next Steps

Start a new external or internal registration for the supplier.

Related Information

[Unlinking a Supplier's SAP Business Network Account and ANID from Your Site](#)

Supplier Registration Status Flow

As suppliers move through registration in a registration project, their **Registration** status moves from **Not Invited** to **Registered** or **Registration Denied**.

Action	Registration status
A user submits a supplier request.	In Creation (not shown in the user interface)
The supplier request has been denied.	Not Created (not shown in the user interface)
The supplier request has been approved, but the supplier hasn't yet been invited to register.	In Creation (not shown in the user interface) > Not Invited
A registration manager started a registration but the operation failed.	Not Invited > Failed - Not Invited (temporary status) > Not Invited
The supplier has been invited to register or an internal registration has started and recipients have been sent links to external registration questionnaires.	Not Invited > Invite in Progress (temporary status) > Invited
The registration has been canceled.	Invited > Not Invited
Recipients have started but not submitted at least one external registration questionnaire.	Invited > In Registration
Recipients have submitted responses to at least one registration questionnaire and they're in the approval process.	In Registration > Pending Approval
An approver has asked a questionnaire recipient for more information as a condition of approving the registration.	Pending Approval
The recipient has resubmitted more information for the registration questionnaire and it's back in the approval process.	Pending Approval
Approvers have finally approved all external questionnaires and any nonprofile internal questionnaires in the registration and all tasks in the registration workflow have been completed.	Pending Approval > Registered
A registration manager has invited a supplier who was previously registered internally to participate in the registration.	Registered
At least one external questionnaire or nonprofile internal questionnaire has been denied.	Pending Approval > Registration Denied

Action	Registration status
An approver has started a new round of the approval task on a denied registration questionnaire.	Registration Denied > Pending Approval
A registration manager has reinvited a supplier to a denied registration or has invited a supplier to participate in a denied internal registration.	Registration Denied > Invited
A questionnaire recipient has submitted an update to a registration questionnaire and it's in the approval process, including a supplier submitting an external registration questionnaire for the first time after being invited to participate in an internal registration.	Registered (registration update status is Pending Approval)
An approver has asked the questionnaire recipient for more information as a condition of approving the registration update.	Registered (registration update status is Pending Approval > Pending Resubmit)
The recipient has resubmitted more information for the registration questionnaire update and it's back in the approval process.	Registered (registration update status is Pending Resubmit > Pending Approval)
An approver has denied the questionnaire update.	Registered (registration update status is Pending Approval > Denied)
Approvers have finally approved the questionnaire update.	Registered (registration update status is Pending Approval > Approved)

A supplier can also move from **Invited**, **In Registration**, **Pending Resubmission**, or **Pending Approval** registration status to **Not Invited** registration status in either of the following circumstances:

- The registration is internal and has been canceled
- The registration is external, and a customer administrator in your organization has unlinked the supplier's SAP Business Network account

Sourcing and Fulfillment (Trading) Relationships with Suppliers

A sourcing relationship with a supplier on SAP Business Network allows them to fill out SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance questionnaires and participate in sourcing events. A fulfillment or trading relationship allows you to send them purchase orders and begin transacting with them. You can establish both relationships at the same time.

In your SAP Business Network buyer account, a supplier can have two different SAP Business Network IDs (ANIDs): a sourcing ANID that's assigned when you first establish a sourcing relationship with the supplier and a transaction ANID that's assigned when you first establish a fulfillment relationship with them.

By default, you establish these relationships separately. You establish the sourcing relationship when the supplier responds to your first invitation to participate in a sourcing event or fill out a supplier management questionnaire.

You establish the fulfillment relationship when the supplier accepts a request to establish either a full or a quick-enabled trading relationship that you've sent them in your SAP Business Network buyer account as part of supplier onboarding for procurement. The supplier's acceptance can be automatic or manual, depending on their settings. In cases where you don't have an existing sourcing or fulfillment relationship with the supplier yet, both types of invitation prompt the supplier to create a new SAP Business Network account. In some cases, an invited supplier contact who isn't aware that the supplier has an existing SAP Business Network account can create a new, duplicate account for the supplier instead of signing into the existing account. In this case, in your SAP Business Network buyer account, the supplier's vendor ID is associated with different transaction and sourcing ANIDs pointing to the separate, duplicate supplier accounts. The only remedy for this situation is unlinking the supplier's sourcing ANID, which results in the supplier losing access to any content they responded to using the account with the unlinked ANID.

An optional feature, SM-5144, allows you to flag suppliers for which you want to establish simultaneous sourcing and fulfillment relationships. Once you establish one type of relationship with the supplier, the other relationship is established automatically and uses the same supplier ANID.

There are several options for flagging suppliers to establish simultaneous sourcing and fulfillment relationships:

- **Flagging all suppliers:** when you ask SAP Ariba Support to enable SM-5144, you have the additional option of universally flagging every supplier in your SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance site.
- **Flagging specific suppliers:** If you don't use the option for flagging all suppliers universally, you can flag specific suppliers using either of the following methods:
 - Setting the flag in registration mass invitations using the optional **Fulfillment** column in the CSV data files that define mass registration waves.
 - Setting the flag manually for individual suppliers in their profiles.

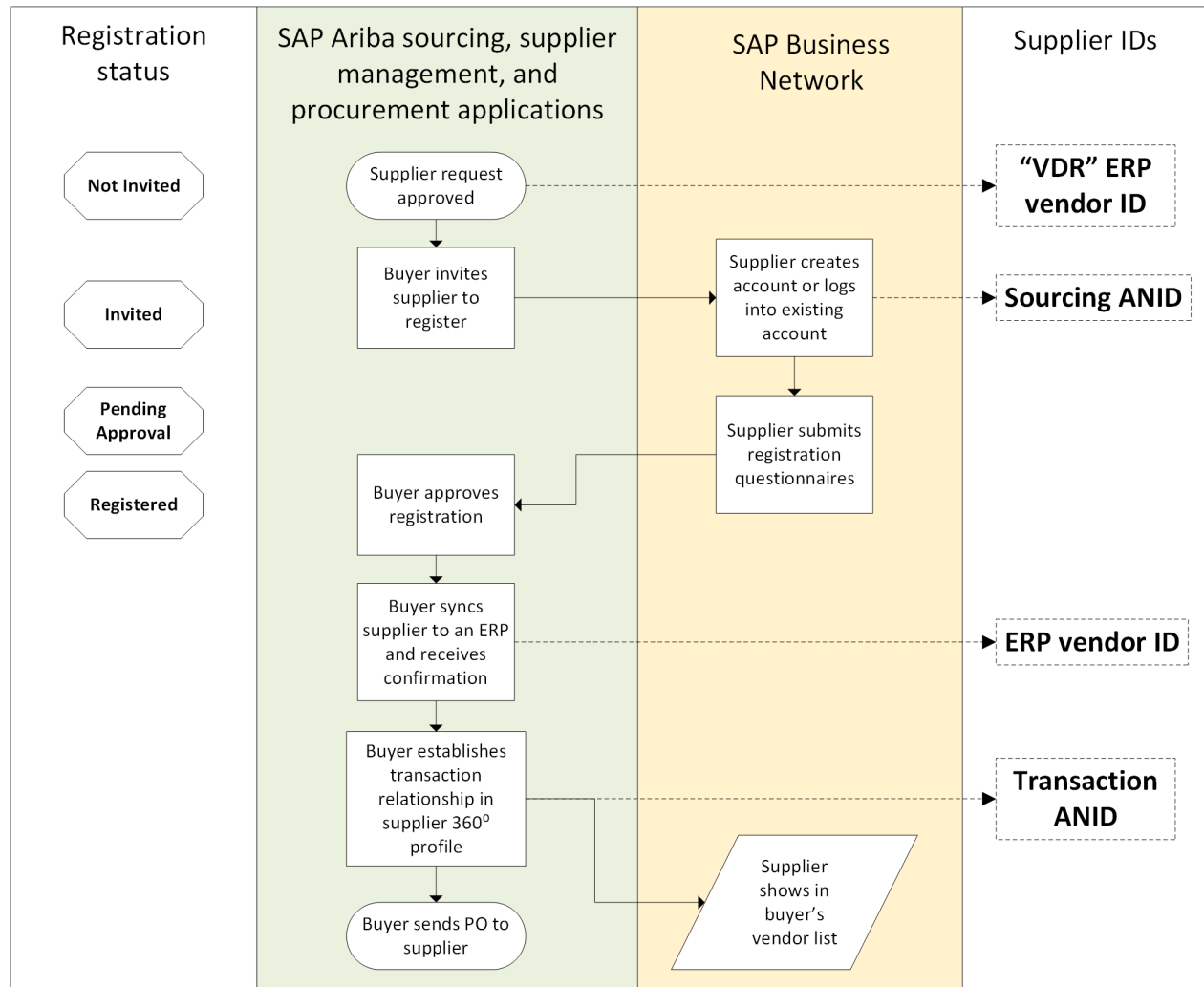
When a supplier is flagged and has an ERP vendor ID that doesn't start with VDR in the SM source system, establishing a sourcing relationship with them also automatically establishes the transaction relationship and vice versa. For suppliers with ERP vendor IDs that start with VDR in the SM source system, the flag is ignored. SAP Ariba automatically assigns an ERP vendor ID that starts with VDR and a source system of supplier account, depending on the supplier's transaction volumes, whether their transactions involve SM to every supplier created from an approved supplier request, but these IDs are often placeholders and are replaced by a "real" ERP vendor ID from an integrated ERP system after a new supplier is synchronized to it, with an updated source system such as SAP. In this case, once the ERP vendor ID is updated or the source system is updated to a non-SM value, or both, the flag becomes active and the second relationship is established. A registration manager can also manually set the flag after the ERP vendor ID or source system, or both, are updated.

Note

There are several different levels of SAP Business NetworkSAP Business Network for Supply Chain supplier account, depending on the supplier's transaction volumes, whether their, and other factors. Some suppliers deliberately maintain different SAP Business Network accounts at different levels for different buyers. If the supplier has a "real" ERP vendor ID (either a non-VDR ID or a VDR ID in a non-SM source system), automatic flagging can establish simultaneous fulfillment and sourcing relationships using an ANID for an SAP Business Network account that the supplier doesn't want to use for transactions with you. Setting flags manually for individual suppliers gives them more control over the account through which you establish these relationships with them.

In solutions that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance orSAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture) , it's common to establish a sourcing relationship with a supplier through a supplier registration. The following diagram illustrates this process with a supplier created from an approved supplier request, where SAP Ariba synchronizes the supplier to an integrated ERP system after they

achieve **Registered** status and a registration manager manually establishes the fulfillment relationship in the supplier's profile:



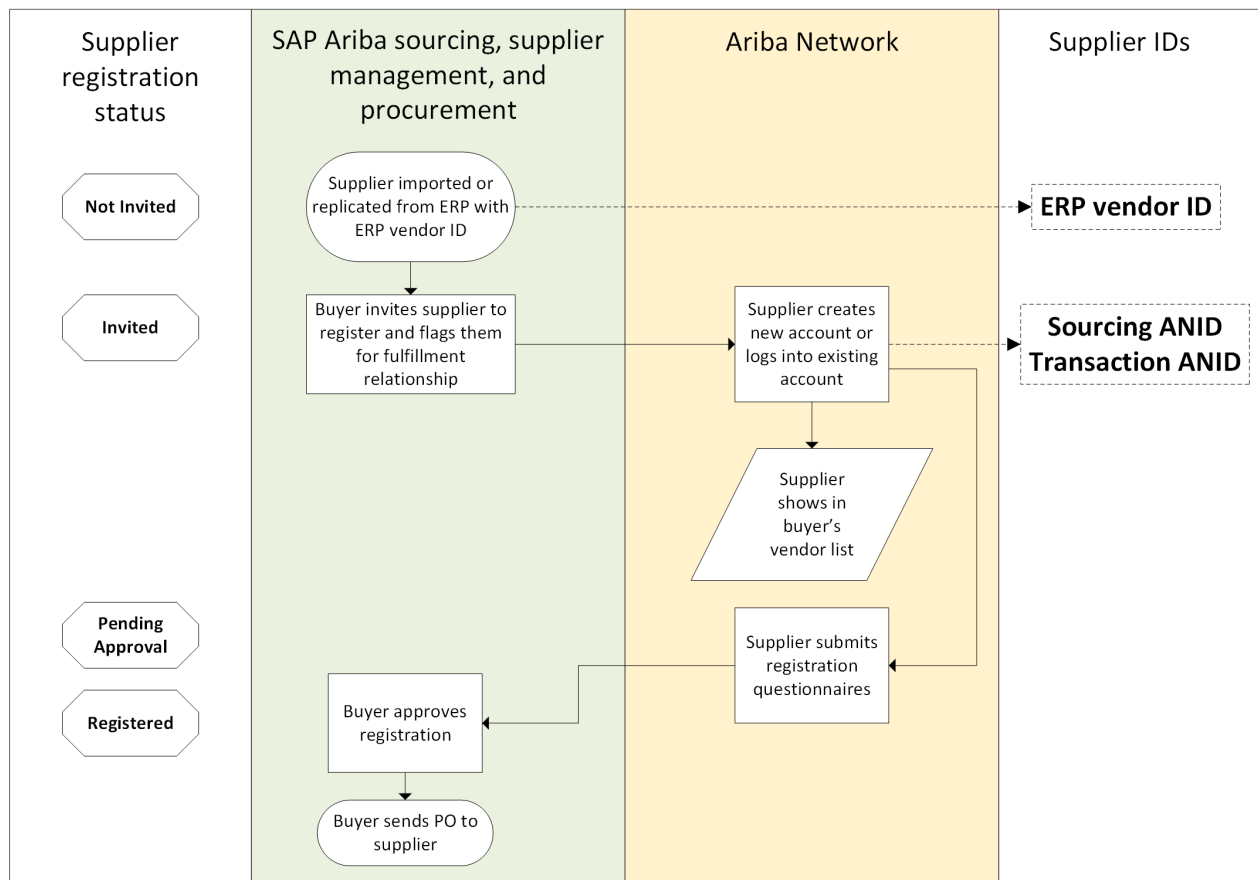
In this process:

1. A requester creates a supplier request from the dashboard.
2. When approvers finally approve the supplier request, SAP Ariba automatically assigns the new supplier a placeholder ERP vendor ID starting with VDR in the SM source system.
3. A registration manager invites the supplier to register.
4. The supplier either creates a new SAP Business Network account or, if they have an existing account, logs into it, where they fill out and submit the registration questionnaires.
5. Questionnaire submission establishes the sourcing relationship and assigns the supplier account's ANID as the supplier's sourcing ANID.
6. Approvers finally approve the supplier registration.
7. SAP Ariba synchronizes the supplier to an integrated ERP system. Depending on your site's integration settings, synchronization can be automatic based on the supplier's registration status or manual in the supplier's profile.

8. The integrated ERP system creates the new vendor record, generates an ID for it, and sends the ERP vendor ID back to SAP Ariba, where it replaces the placeholder VDR ID and updates the source system to a non-SM value such as SAP.
9. A registration manager enables the fulfillment relationship in the supplier's profile.
10. SAP Ariba establishes the fulfillment relationship and assigns the same ANID to the supplier as the transaction ANID.
11. The supplier shows in the vendor list in the buyer's SAP Business Network account and is enabled for transactions.
12. The buyer sends the supplier a purchase order through SAP Business Network using the transaction ANID.

In solutions that also include SAP Ariba Sourcing, if you don't require a minimum registration status of **Pending Approval** for inviting suppliers to participate in sourcing events, it's possible to establish a sourcing relationship when the invited supplier bids on the sourcing event, before supplier registration, instead.

If a supplier already has a non-VDR ERP vendor ID, or a VDR ERP vendor ID in a non-SM source system, and is already flagged for simultaneous establishment of sourcing and fulfillment relationships when the sourcing relationship is established, the transaction relationship is established at the same time. The following diagram illustrates the process with a supplier created with a "real" ERP vendor ID:



In this process:

1. The supplier is created through either replication from an integrated ERP system, migration from a supplier organization, or data import in **SM Administration**. With all of these methods, the supplier is created with "real" ERP vendor ID, which can be a non-VDR ERP vendor ID or a VDR ERP vendor ID in a non-SM source system such as SAP.

2. A registration manager invites the supplier to register. The supplier is automatically flagged for simultaneous establishment of sourcing and fulfillment relationships either universally at creation, in a mass registration invitation wave, or manually before or just after being invited to register.
3. The supplier either creates a new SAP Business Network account or, if they have an existing account, logs into it, where they fill out and submit the registration questionnaires.
4. Questionnaire submission establishes the sourcing and fulfillment relationships at the same time and assigns the supplier account's ANID as both sourcing ANID and transaction ANID for the supplier.
5. The supplier shows in the vendor list in the buyer's SAP Business Network account and is enabled for transactions.
6. The buyer sends the supplier a purchase order through SAP Business Network using the transaction ANID.

If your first interaction with the supplier involves onboarding in SAP Business Network rather than a sourcing or supplier management activity, once the supplier has accepted the fulfillment (trading) relationship and been flagged for simultaneous fulfillment and sourcing relationships, the supplier account's ANID is assigned as both their sourcing and transaction ANID. If you've enabled the supplier through a trading relationship request (full enablement) or a quick enablement invitation (quick or light enablement), that enablement assigns the supplier's transaction ANID to their vendor key automatically. If you've requested the relationship after a search, the supplier's vendor key must be added manually.

Related Information

[Manually Enabling a Fulfillment Relationship with an Invited or Registered Sourcing Supplier \[page 153\]](#)

Manually Enabling a Fulfillment Relationship with an Invited or Registered Sourcing Supplier

Use these steps to establish a fulfillment relationship with a supplier simultaneously when you establish a sourcing relationship with them. Establishing these relationships simultaneously ensures that the same supplier SAP Business Network ID (ANID) is associated with the supplier for both procurement and sourcing activities and can prevent duplicate supplier SAP Business Network accounts.

Prerequisites

You must be a member of the **Supplier Registration Manager** group to manually enable a fulfillment relationship with invited or registered suppliers.

Context

In your SAP Business Network buyer account, a supplier can have two different SAP Business Network IDs (ANIDs): a sourcing ANID that is assigned when you first establish a sourcing relationship with the supplier and a transaction ANID that is assigned when you first establish a fulfillment relationship with them.

Enabling a supplier for a transaction (fulfillment relationship) sets a flag. Once the supplier has established one type of relationship with your organization and has a "real" ERP vendor ID from your ERP system, the other one is established automatically. A supplier's first response to your invitation to a sourcing event, or to register or fill out another type of external supplier management questionnaire, establishes the sourcing relationship.

A supplier has a "real" ERP vendor ID if either their ERP vendor ID doesn't start in **VDR** or if it does start in **VDR** but the source system isn't **SM**. Typically, these conditions indicate that the supplier's ERP vendor ID comes from an ERP system.

Procedure

1. On the **Supplier Management** dashboard, locate the supplier with which you want to establish a fulfillment relationship.
2. Choose the supplier's name to open their profile.
3. Perform one of the following actions:
 - In the supplier's profile summary, choose **ERP Data** in the **Supplier Details** panel.
 - In the classic supplier 360° profile, choose **ERP data** in the left-hand navigation bar.

The **ERP data** detail area of the supplier's profile opens.

4. Choose **Enable Vendor for Transaction Relationship**, then choose **Confirm**.

Results

The supplier now has the **Relationship Type Trading** and the flag for simultaneous sourcing and fulfillment relationships is set.

Depending on the supplier's ERP vendor ID and source system, setting the flag produces one of the following two results:

Table 12: Results of Enabling a Transaction Relationship

ERP Vendor ID	Result
"Real" ERP vendor ID that meets one of the following two conditions: - Doesn't start with VDR - Starts with VDR but has a source system other than SM	Once you've established a sourcing relationship with them, the fulfillment relationship is automatically established as well. For example, if they're already registered or have already participated in a sourcing event, the fulfillment relationship is automatically established when you enable them for the transaction relationship. In your SAP Business Network buyer account, the supplier shows in your vendor list and is enabled for transactions. Or, if you establish a fulfillment relationship with the supplier first, a sourcing relationship is automatically established at the same time. In your SAP Business Network buyer account, transaction and sourcing ANIDs for the supplier are the same.
"Placeholder" ERP vendor ID that starts with VDR in the SM source system	The flag is ignored until the supplier is updated with a "real" ERP vendor ID either through data import or synchronization with an integrated ERP system.

Related Information

[Sourcing and Fulfillment \(Trading\) Relationships with Suppliers \[page 149\]](#)

[Supplier IDs in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance \[page 40\]](#)

Manually Synchronizing a Supplier to Your ERP System

Use these steps to manually synchronize or resynchronize a supplier to an integrated SAP ERP system. Synchronizing a new supplier adds a them to the ERP vendor master. Manually resynchronizing a supplier reestablishes automatic synchronization after an error has occurred.

Prerequisites

To manually synchronize a new supplier with the ERP system, you must be a member of the **SM Manual ERP Sync**, **SM Ops Administrator**, or **SM ERP Administrator** group.

To manually resynchronize a supplier with the ERP system, you must be a member of the **SM ERP Administrator** group.

The supplier must meet either of the following conditions:

- For synchronization, the supplier is new, your site is configured to require initial manual synchronization for new suppliers, and the supplier has the minimum registration or qualification status where initial synchronization is allowed.
- For resynchronization, there has been an error in the automatic synchronization of the supplier.

Context

Your organization's ERP vendor master is the official record of your company's suppliers.

Initial ERP synchronization adds suppliers that have been created in your site to the ERP vendor master. Your organization's ERP integration setup determines whether you always manually synchronize new suppliers to the ERP system, or whether that initial synchronization is automatic once the new supplier achieves a specific registration or qualification status.

If your organization uses manual initial synchronization, you must manually synchronize the supplier to the ERP system to establish the initial connection, after which updates are automatically synchronized.

If a synchronization error occurs, you must manually resynchronize the supplier with the ERP system to re-establish the connection and resume automatic synchronization of updates.

Note

If current supplier data includes validation errors, the supplier can't successfully synchronize to the ERP system until those errors are corrected. Users with the appropriate permissions can correct any validation errors introduced by answers to internal registration questionnaires. Members of the **SM Ops Administrator** group can view error details and manage validation errors in **SM Administration**.

Procedure

1. Perform one of the following actions:

- In the supplier's profile summary, choose **ERP Data** in the **Supplier Details** panel.
- In the classic supplier 360° profile, choose **ERP data** in the left-hand navigation bar.

The **ERP data** detail area of the supplier's profile opens.

2. Perform one of the following actions:

- To synchronize a new supplier to the ERP system, choose  **Sync Now**.
- To resynchronize a supplier to the ERP system after a synchronization error, choose  **Resync Now**.

Results

A message lets you know that the synchronization has started. Once it's finished, any updates to the supplier in either system are automatically synchronized between the two. Both the **ERP data** detail area and these areas of the supplier profile show the current integration status of the supplier:

- In the supplier profile summary, the **Supplier Status** panel.
- In the classic supplier 360° profile, the **Summary** area.

Related Information

[About the Classic Supplier 360° Profile \[page 26\]](#)

Supplier Qualifications, Preferred Category Status, and Other Lifecycle Processes

Supplier Qualifications and Lifecycle Processes

Qualifications vet supplier's suitability to provide specific commodities for specific regions and (if your organization uses them) departments. They assign qualification statuses for those combinations. Depending on your site's setup, your organization can use similar workflows for other processes.

If your organization qualifies suppliers, you use one of two available qualification methods:

- Supplier qualification and disqualification projects. In this case, there are no process status filters in supplier search, and you view and manage qualifications only in the **Qualifications** area of suppliers' 360° profiles.
- Process qualification and discontinuation (disqualification) projects. If your organization uses process qualifications, it can also use process projects to manage custom or miscellaneous lifecycle processes. In this case, there are process status filters in supplier search, and you can view or manage qualifications in either the **Qualifications** or **Processes** area of suppliers' 360° profiles.

[About the Qualifications Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 158\]](#)

[About the Processes Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 162\]](#)

[Supplier Qualification and Disqualification Status Flow \[page 163\]](#)

[Transition from Legacy Supplier Qualification Projects to Qualification Process Projects \[page 167\]](#)

[Qualification Management Using Supplier Qualification and Disqualification Projects \[page 169\]](#)

[Supplier Qualification and Lifecycle Management Using Process Projects \[page 187\]](#)

About the Qualifications Detail Area in the Supplier Profile

You can view and manage supplier qualifications in the **Qualifications** detail area of the supplier profile.

Supplier qualifications are only available in solutions that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance.

By default, the **Qualifications** detail area is only available after the supplier is registered. If your organization uses process projects to manage supplier qualifications:

- Qualification processes for unregistered suppliers are also available in the **Processes** area.
- The **Qualifications** area is available for suppliers who aren't registered if an administrator has enabled the self-service configuration parameter

Application.SM.Process.AllowStartOfProcessQualificationForUnRegisteredSuppliers in ► **SM Administration** ► **Configuration Parameters** ► in your site.

About the Qualifications Area in Sites That Manage Qualifications Using Supplier Qualification and Disqualification Projects

The following image shows an example of the **Qualifications** detail area with qualifications and disqualifications for a supplier:

Qualifications				
CATEGORY	REGION	STATUS	OWNER	
Office supplies	California	Disqualified	Alice Jones	
Paper Materials and Products	USA	Disqualified	Alice Jones	
Mailing supplies	Los Angeles Metro	Qualified	Alice Jones	...
Industrial use papers	USA	Qualified	Alice Jones	...
Tools and General Machinery	Australia	Qualified	Alice Jones	...
Tools and General Machinery	USA	Disqualified	Alice Jones	
Pneumatic machinery and equipment	USA	Restricted	Alice Jones	
Automotive specialty tools	USA	Disqualified	Alice Jones	...
				 View  Requalify

You can do the following things in the **Qualifications** detail area:

- Start a [qualification \[page 173\]](#), [disqualification \[page 179\]](#), or [requalification \[page 182\]](#) using qualification and disqualification projects.
- View a summary list of all the supplier's qualifications and disqualifications. Disqualifications are nested under their associated qualification. The summary list includes end dates for the current statuses, such as the date a qualification expires or the date when a disqualification becomes eligible for requalification.
- View qualification or disqualification details by choosing  (view). On the qualification or disqualification details page, you can:
 - See expiration dates for qualifications if your organization uses them.
 - See all tasks associated with a qualification, disqualification, or requalification in the **Tasks** table.
 - See details for external or internal qualification questionnaires in the **Questionnaires** table, including questions and answers.
- Fill out and submit an [internal questionnaire \[page 177\]](#) in a qualification project.
- [Complete any stand-alone To Do tasks \[page 259\]](#) to which you've been assigned.
- [Approve or deny \[page 184\]](#) a qualification, disqualification, or requalification if you're in the approval flow.
- [Reinviting \[page 176\]](#) the supplier to fill out the qualification questionnaire if you've started a qualification or requalification and they haven't responded yet.

The **Qualifications** detail area only shows summary information for supplier qualifications and disqualifications that are based on a data import rather than a project, since project details such as questionnaires and tasks aren't available.

A customer administrator in your organization can cancel an imported qualification or disqualification or an in-progress qualification project. Canceled qualifications and disqualifications no longer show in the **Qualifications** detail area. If the supplier has an imported qualification for which one or more disqualification projects have been created and a customer administrator cancels the imported qualification, the canceled qualification no longer shows in the **Qualifications** detail area, but the disqualifications continue to show.

About the Qualifications Area in Sites That Manage Qualifications Using Process Projects

The following image shows an example of a **Qualifications** area with process qualifications for a supplier:

The screenshot displays the 'Qualifications' detail area. At the top, there are two tabs: 'Process qualifications' (selected) and 'Legacy qualifications'. Below the tabs is a search bar with a magnifying glass icon and a 'Filter' button with a funnel icon. The main content area is titled 'Prequalification' and contains a table with the following data:

CATEGORY	REGION	BUSINESS UNIT	STATUS	OWNER	EFFECTIVE DATE	
Alloys Category ID: 1117	Brazil Region ID: 405	All Business Unit ID: 0	Prequalified	John Smith	.6/2021	...
Alloys Category ID: 1117	Mexico Region ID: 419	All Business Unit ID: 0	Prequalification in Progress	Jane Wu		...

If your site previously used supplier qualification and disqualification projects and has transitioned to using process qualification and discontinuation projects, the **Qualifications** detail area includes tabs for both types of qualifications. Any supplier qualification and disqualification projects show on the **Legacy qualifications** tab. Process qualifications and disqualifications show on the **Process qualifications** tab. If your organization has only managed supplier qualifications in SAP Ariba using process projects, the **Qualifications** detail area doesn't have any tabs.

You can do the following things in the **Qualifications** detail area:

- [Start \[page 197\]](#) or [renew \[page 216\]](#) a qualification process.
- View a summary list of all the supplier's qualification processes.
If the supplier has more than one qualification process of a specific type, the summary list for that type shows the processes in alphabetical order by category name. The summary list includes an effective date for the current qualification status. You can also search in this list or filter it by process status, owner, decision-maker, expiration date, and other characteristics.
- [Disqualify \[page 205\]](#) a qualification process that is in the approved or partially approved status.
- View qualification process details. On the process details page you can:
 - See all modular questionnaires included in the process qualification and, if you're a recipient for an internal questionnaire, [fill it out and submit it \[page 207\]](#).
 - [Approve or deny \[page 209\]](#) modular questionnaires included in the qualification process.
 - [Request an update or change the recipient \[page 240\]](#) of a modular questionnaire included in the qualification process.
- [Set or change the status \[page 220\]](#) of a qualification process, if you're a decision-maker for it.
- [Cancel \[page 212\]](#) a qualification process.

If your site previously used qualification and disqualification projects, you can also do the following things on the **Legacy qualifications** tab:

- View a summary list and details of the supplier's legacy qualifications and disqualifications.
- [Disqualify \[page 179\]](#) a legacy qualification, which starts a legacy disqualification project.
- Requalify a legacy qualification, which starts a [new qualification process project \[page 197\]](#).
Enabling the process project feature disabled creation of new legacy qualification projects in your site. All new project-based qualifications and requalifications use process projects.

The **Qualifications** detail area shows both qualification processes that are based on process projects and qualification processes created from a data import. You can only view details for qualification processes based on projects, since imported processes don't include questionnaires and tasks. You can renew or cancel qualification processes created from either projects or a data import.

An administrator in your organization can also use a data import to cancel a process. Canceled qualification processes no longer show in the **Qualifications** detail area.

Your organization can also use process projects for custom or miscellaneous lifecycle processes. The **Qualifications** detail area only shows qualification processes. The **Processes area [page 162]** shows both qualification and miscellaneous processes.

Related Information

[About the Registration Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 114\]](#)

[About the Questionnaires Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 232\]](#)

[About the Preferred Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 224\]](#)

About the Processes Detail Area in the Supplier Profile

The **Processes** detail area of a supplier's profile is where you can create, manage, and view miscellaneous or qualification process projects and their questionnaires.

The **Processes** detail area is only available if the process project feature (SM-16798) is enabled in your site.

If your site uses the supplier profile summary (NGSM-2959), you can open the **Processes** detail area from it by choosing **Processes** in the **Quick Links** panel.

Processes

Filter

Prequalification

CATEGORY	REGION	BUSINESS UNIT	STATUS	OWNER	EFFECTIVE DATE	
Alloys  Category ID: 1117	Brazil Region ID: 405	All Business Unit ID: 0	Prequalified	John Smith	5/2021	...
Alloys Category ID: 1117	Mexico Region ID: 419	All Business Unit ID: 0	Prequalification in Progress	Jane Wu		...

Due Diligence

CATEGORY	REGION	BUSINESS UNIT	STATUS	OWNER	EFFECTIVE DATE	
Raw Materials Category ID: 11	Latin America Region ID: 4	All Business Unit ID: 0	Due Diligence Completed	Al Garcia	6/2021	...
Raw Materials Category ID: 11	North America Region ID: 3	All Business Unit ID: 0	Due Diligence In Progress	Al Garcia		...

In the **Processes** detail area, you can do the following things:

- [Create any type of new miscellaneous or qualification process \[page 197\]](#) for which you're a process initiator.
- Search for any of the supplier's existing processes using the search bar.
- Filter the supplier's existing processes by status, owner, type, commodity, process initiator, or process decision-maker by choosing **Filter**.
- View the details for any miscellaneous or qualification process, including modular questionnaires used in the process.

- [Cancel a process or process renewal \[page 212\]](#) that is in progress.
- [Renew a process \[page 216\]](#) to gather updated information.
- [Set a status \[page 220\]](#) for a process if you're a decision-maker for it.
- [Disqualify a qualification process \[page 205\]](#) that is in the approved or partially approved status.

You can [fill out internal questionnaires \[page 207\]](#) that have been assigned to you and complete tasks for both internal and external questionnaires from the process details page or in the **Questionnaires detail area** [\[page 232\]](#) of the supplier profile.

If the supplier has more than one process for a process type, those processes are listed alphabetically by category name.

Related Information

[Qualification and Miscellaneous Supplier Management Process Projects \[page 188\]](#)

[About the Registration Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 114\]](#)

[About the Qualifications Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 158\]](#)

[About the Questionnaires Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 232\]](#)

[Creating a Qualification or Miscellaneous Supplier Management Process Project \[page 197\]](#)

[Making a Status Decision for a Supplier Management Process \[page 220\]](#)

Supplier Qualification and Disqualification Status Flow

A supplier has an overall qualification status, and each of their individual qualifications has its own status.

A supplier can have multiple qualification statuses for different commodity, region, and department combinations. The **Qualifications** detail area of their profile shows each of these individual statuses along with details of the associated projects.

The supplier's overall qualification status shows in:

- The **Supplier Status** panel, in sites that use the supplier profile summary (NGSM-2959).
- The **Summary** area, in sites that use the classic supplier 360° profile.

The statuses of those individual qualifications and disqualifications determine the supplier's overall qualification status.

The overall qualification status for a supplier is based on the following priorities:

- If the supplier has at least one approved qualification or requalification, **Qualified** is shown.
- If the supplier has no approved qualification or requalification, but has a disqualification, the status of the disqualification is shown.
- If supplier has no approved qualification or requalification and no disqualification in any stage of progress, the highest in-progress qualification or requalification's status is shown.
- Otherwise, the supplier's status is **Qualification Not Started**.

The following table describes the status flow for individual qualifications, which roll up to an overall qualification status for the supplier based on those priorities. Depending on how your organization manages supplier

qualifications, these statuses can be based on either supplier qualification and disqualification projects or qualification process and discontinuation process projects.

Supplier Qualification or Disqualification Project Activity	Qualification Process Project Activity	Standard SAP Ariba Qualification Lifecycle Status
There are no qualifications associated with the supplier.	There are no process qualifications associated with the supplier.	Qualification Not Started
A qualification manager has created a qualification project and sent a qualification questionnaire to the supplier.	A process initiator has started a qualification process project.	Qualification Not Started > Qualification Started
The supplier has started but not yet completed the qualification questionnaire.	Invitations or update requests for the modular questionnaires included in the qualification process project have been sent to questionnaire recipients.	Qualification Started > In Qualification
N/A	Recipients of modular questionnaires included in the qualification process project have filled out and submitted their assigned questionnaires.	In Qualification
The supplier has submitted responses to the qualification questionnaire and they are in the approval process.	Approvers and task owners have completed all tasks in the modular questionnaires included in the qualification process project and all of them are finally approved or denied.	In Qualification > Pending Qualification Approval
An approver has asked the supplier for more information as a condition of approving the qualification.	N/A	Pending Qualification Approval > Pending Qualification Resubmit
The supplier has resubmitted responses to the qualification questionnaire and approval is one again in progress.	N/A	Pending Qualification Resubmit > Pending Qualification Approval
Approvers have rejected the qualification.	A process decision-maker has manually set the qualification process project's status to denied, or automatic rules have assigned the process project a denied status based on the statuses of its included modular questionnaires.	Pending Qualification Approval > Rejected
The supplier's qualification has been finally approved.	A process decision-maker has manually set the qualification process project's status to approved, or automatic rules have assigned the process project an approved status based on the statuses of its included modular questionnaires.	Pending Qualification Approval > Qualified
N/A	The qualification process project includes an expiration schedule and an expiration reminder schedule, and the expiration reminder schedule has started.	Qualified > Expiring

Supplier Qualification or Disqualification Project Activity	Qualification Process Project Activity	Standard SAP Ariba Qualification Lifecycle Status
N/A	The qualification process project includes an expiration schedule and an expiration reminder schedule, and the scheduled expiration date has been reached.	Expiring > Expired
The qualification project includes an expiration date and that date has been reached.	The qualification process project includes an expiration schedule but no expiration reminder schedule, and the scheduled expiration date has been reached.	Qualified > Expired
A disqualification has been started for an existing qualification.	A process initiator has started a discontinuation for a process qualification.	Qualified > In Disqualification
The disqualification form has been submitted and approval is in progress.	Approvers and task owners have completed all tasks in the modular questionnaires included in the discontinuation process project and all of them are finally approved or denied.	In Disqualification > Pending Disqualification Approval
The disqualification has been finally approved and it doesn't use a phase-out period.	A process decision-maker has manually set the discontinuation process project's status to approved, or automatic rules have assigned the process project an approved status based on the statuses of its included modular questionnaires.	Qualified > Disqualified
The disqualification has been finally approved, the project uses a phase-out period, and the specified phase-out date is in the future.	N/A	Qualified > Restricted
The approved disqualification uses a phase-out period and the specified phase-out date has been reached.	N/A	Restricted > Disqualified
A qualification manager has started a re-qualification for a qualification that hasn't expired yet.	A process initiator has started a renewal for a qualification process project that isn't expiring or expired.	Qualified > Qualification Started In this case, the supplier is still eligible for sourcing events that require qualification despite no longer having Qualified status.
N/A	A process initiator has started a renewal for an expiring qualification process project.	Expiring > Qualification Started
A qualification manager has started a re-qualification for an expired qualification.	A process initiator has started a renewal for an expired qualification process project.	Expired > Qualification Started

Supplier Qualification or Disqualification Project Activity	Qualification Process Project Activity	Standard SAP Ariba Qualification Lifecycle Status
The supplier has started but not yet completed the questionnaire for a requalification based on an expired qualification.	Invitations or update requests for the modular questionnaires included in the qualification process renewal have been sent to questionnaire recipients.	Qualification Started > In Qualification If the requalification is for a qualification that hasn't expired yet, the supplier is still eligible for sourcing events that require qualification despite no longer having Qualified status.
	Recipients of modular questionnaires included in the qualification process renewal have filled out and submitted their assigned questionnaires.	In Qualification
The supplier has submitted responses to the requalification questionnaire and approval is in progress, and the requalification is based on an expired qualification rather than a disqualification.	Approvers and task owners have completed all tasks in the modular questionnaires included in the qualification process renewal and all of them are finally approved or denied.	In Qualification > Pending Qualification Approval If the requalification is for a qualification that hasn't yet expired, the supplier is still eligible for sourcing events that require qualification despite no longer having Qualified status.
An approver has asked the supplier for more information as a condition of approving the requalification, and the requalification is based on an expired qualification rather than a disqualification.	N/A	Pending Qualification Approval > Pending Qualification Resubmit If the requalification is for a qualification that hasn't yet expired, the supplier is still eligible for sourcing events that require qualification despite no longer having Qualified status.
The supplier has resubmitted responses to the requalification questionnaire and approval is once more in progress, and the requalification is based on an expired qualification rather than a disqualification.	N/A	Pending Qualification Resubmit > Pending Qualification Approval If the requalification is for a qualification that hasn't expired yet, the supplier is still eligible for sourcing events that require qualification despite no longer having Qualified status.
The supplier's requalification has been finally rejected and the requalification is based on an expired qualification rather than a disqualification.	A process decision-maker has manually set the qualification process renewal's status to denied, or automatic rules have assigned the process a denied status based on the statuses of its included modular questionnaires.	Pending Qualification Approval > Rejected This status change occurs even if the requalification is for a qualification that hasn't expired yet. In this case, any related preferred status is removed and the supplier is also no longer eligible for sourcing events that require qualification.

Supplier Qualification or Disqualification Project Activity	Qualification Process Project Activity	Standard SAP Ariba Qualification Lifecycle Status
The supplier's requalification has been finally approved and the requalification is based on an expired qualification rather than a disqualification.	A process decision-maker has manually set the qualification process renewal's status to approved, or automatic rules have assigned the process an approved status based on the statuses of its included modular questionnaires.	Pending Qualification Approval > Qualified

Transition from Legacy Supplier Qualification Projects to Qualification Process Projects

If your site previously used legacy qualification projects for supplier qualifications, you can switch to using qualification process projects instead. Understanding what happens when you enable the process project feature in your site and the current restrictions for qualification processes is important to managing this transition.

When the Process Project Feature Starts Affecting Qualification Projects

Enabling the process project feature (SM-16798) in your site immediately disables creation of new projects from the legacy supplier qualification project template.

Changes to the Supplier Profile

If a supplier doesn't have a legacy qualification project in any status, the **Qualifications** detail area of their profile only shows qualification process controls and qualification processes. The **Qualifications** detail area is only visible in the profiles of registered suppliers.

If a supplier does have at least one legacy qualification in any status, the **Qualifications** detail area of their profile includes two different tabs:

- **Legacy qualifications**, which show any legacy qualification and disqualification projects.
- **Process qualifications**, which shows qualification process controls and qualification processes.

The following image shows an example of a **Qualifications** detail area with these two tabs:

Qualifications +

Process qualifications
Legacy qualifications

Prequalification

CATEGORY	REGION	BUSINESS UNIT	STATUS	OWNER	EFFECTIVE DATE
Alloys Category ID: 1117	Brazil Region ID: 405	All Business Unit ID: 0	Prequalified	John Smith	.6/2021 ...
Alloys Category ID: 1117	Mexico Region ID: 419	All Business Unit ID: 0	Prequalification in Progress	Jane Wu	...

Transition for Existing Qualifications and Disqualifications

Process qualification doesn't disrupt qualification activity that is in progress in legacy qualification and disqualification projects, but for an entirely new qualification, you can only use a qualification process project. During this transition:

- If a legacy qualification or disqualification is in progress (has a status of **Qualification Started**, **In Qualification**, **Pending Qualification Approval**, **Pending Qualification Resubmit**, **In Disqualification**, or **Pending Disqualification Approval**):
 - If it's based on a project, suppliers and internal users can complete the questionnaires and tasks in the project.
 - A process initiator can't create a qualification process project based on the same combination of commodities, regions, and departments.
- If a legacy qualification, disqualification, or requalification is completed (has a status of **Qualified**, **Disqualified**, **Restricted**, or **Expired**), a process initiator can create a qualification process project for the same combination of commodities, regions, and departments. Once a status decision is made for the process qualification, the legacy qualification is marked as obsolete and:

- The legacy qualification remains in the supplier's profile for information purposes only.
- Search results and API output reflect the process qualification rather than the legacy qualification.
- External questionnaires from a legacy qualification project remain in the supplier's SAP Business Network account but can't be edited.

The completed legacy qualification is also marked obsolete if a customer administrator imports a process status for the same combination of commodities, regions, and departments. Starting or importing a process qualification for a subset of the commodities, regions, and departments in a legacy qualification has no effect on the legacy qualification.

- A qualification manager can still start a disqualification (create a legacy disqualification project) based on a legacy qualification (project-based or imported).
- Starting a requalification based on a legacy qualification or disqualification (project-based or imported) automatically opens the page for creating a new qualification process project.

→ Tip

Once the process project feature is enabled in your site, the legacy **Supplier qualification data** import is disabled for most uses. However, you can still use it to update the statuses of imported legacy qualifications to **Expired**. If a supplier has a legacy qualification that was created from a data import, updating its status to **Expired** enables a process initiator to start a requalification (renewal) and create a process qualification for the same combination of commodities, regions, and departments.

ⓘ Note

Migration of data from legacy qualification projects to process qualification projects isn't supported. When a qualification manager starts a requalification from a legacy qualification project, the resulting new process qualification project starts from scratch.

Transition for Supplier Qualification Status

If a supplier has a legacy qualification for a combination of commodities, regions, and departments, that legacy qualification continues to determine the supplier's qualification status for that combination until there's a qualification process with an approved, conditionally approved, or denied status for the same combination. At that point, the qualification process becomes the source of the qualification status.

Qualification Management Using Supplier Qualification and Disqualification Projects

Your organization can use supplier qualification and disqualification projects to vet suppliers for specific combinations of commodities, regions, and departments.

These topics are applicable if your organization uses supplier qualification and disqualification projects to manage supplier qualifications. If your organization uses qualification process projects, refer to [Supplier Qualification and Lifecycle Management Using Process Projects \[page 187\]](#).

[Supplier Qualification and Requalification Using Supplier Qualification Projects \[page 170\]](#)

[Supplier Disqualifications Using Supplier Disqualification Projects \[page 171\]](#)
[Starting a New Qualification Using a Supplier Qualification Project \[page 173\]](#)
[Reinviting a Supplier to Qualify or Requalify Using a Qualification Project \[page 176\]](#)
[Filling Out an Internal Qualification Questionnaire \[page 177\]](#)
[Disqualifying a Supplier Using a Disqualification Project \[page 179\]](#)
[Requalifying a Supplier Using a Supplier Qualification Project \[page 182\]](#)
[Approving or Denying a Qualification, Disqualification, or Requalification Based on a Supplier Qualification or Disqualification Project \[page 184\]](#)
[Editing or Removing a Qualification Restriction from a Supplier \[page 186\]](#)

Supplier Qualification and Requalification Using Supplier Qualification Projects

After a supplier is registered, a qualification manager can start qualifying the supplier for one or more specific combinations of commodities, regions, and (optionally) departments by starting qualification projects and sending qualification questionnaires. Approvers review the supplier's answers and approve or deny the qualifications.

Note

This topic describes qualification and requalification using supplier qualification projects. If your site uses the process projects to manage supplier qualifications, refer to [Qualification and Miscellaneous Supplier Management Process Projects \[page 188\]](#).

Although a customer administrator can set qualification statuses for suppliers using a data import operation in both SAP Ariba Supplier Management solutions, supplier qualification projects are only available in solutions that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance.

Supplier qualification questionnaires typically ask for detailed information from the supplier that's specific to the qualification's commodities and regions. For example, qualification questionnaires can ask suppliers about their sourcing and sustainability processes; shipping, delivery, and return policies; commodity-specific certifications; compliance with policies; and other matters. New qualifications are always based on commodities and regions that a qualification manager selects. They don't have to be for the commodities and regions for which the supplier is registered. Qualifications and requalifications are also based on departments if they're enabled in your site.

When a supplier has either been disqualified or had a qualification expire, they're eligible for requalification. Qualifications and requalifications use the same workflow; however, a requalification is always based on the same commodities, regions, and departments as the previous disqualification or expired qualification.

The supplier qualification project template determines:

- The questionnaire segments for various commodity, region, and department combinations, and which segments are required.
- The approvers for the qualification or requalification. In sites that use buyer category assignments, approvers are automatically assigned based on the commodities, regions, and departments of the qualification or requalification.
- The content of the questionnaire segments.

- Whether other stakeholders in your organization must also approve the qualification or requalification.
- Whether internal questionnaires or other tasks or documents are part of the qualification or requalification w.
- Whether the qualification expires after a specific date, and if so, whether there's a waiting period before the supplier can be requalified.

The category or supplier managers assigned to the supplier start a new qualification or a requalification, send the questionnaire, review the supplier's answers, request more information, approve or deny the qualification or requalification, and monitor the approval flow and status in the **Qualification** detail area of the supplier's profile on the **Supplier Management** tab of the dashboard. The supplier answers the qualification questionnaire in their Ariba Network for Suppliers profile. The supplier's profile information is automatically shared between SAP Business Network and SAP Ariba Supplier Management solutions.

Notifications let the supplier know that they've been invited to qualify for specific commodities, regions, and departments and provide a link to the questionnaire; let approvers know that they need to approve a supplier qualification or requalification; let supplier or category managers know when one of their qualifications has expired or is eligible for requalification; and let the supplier know that the qualification or requalification has been approved, denied, or requires more information.

At any point after the supplier qualification or requalification has been approved, category or supplier managers can:

- Start new qualifications for additional combinations of commodities, regions, and departments.
- Evaluate the supplier for a preferred category status (if your company uses preferred supplier management projects).
- Disqualify the supplier for commodities, regions, and departments for which it was previously qualified.

In solutions that include SAP Ariba Sourcing, event templates can specify that suppliers must have specific qualification statuses for the event's commodities and regions to either participate in or be awarded events. Departments aren't considered for event eligibility.

Related Information

[Internal Supplier Requests \[page 93\]](#)

[External Supplier Requests \[page 94\]](#)

[New Supplier Registrations \[page 108\]](#)

[Preferred Category Statuses Management Projects \[page 223\]](#)

[Supplier Disqualifications Using Supplier Disqualification Projects \[page 171\]](#)

[Supplier Performance Evaluations Using SPM Projects](#)

Supplier Disqualifications Using Supplier Disqualification Projects

After a supplier is qualified or preferred, a qualification manager can ask to disqualify the supplier for previously qualified commodities, regions, and (optionally) departments by submitting a disqualification form.

Although a customer administrator can set qualification statuses for suppliers using a data import operation in both SAP Ariba Supplier Management solutions, supplier qualification and disqualification projects are only available in solutions that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance.

📘 Note

Disqualification projects work with qualifications based on supplier qualification projects. If your site uses process projects to manage supplier qualifications, you don't use disqualification projects to manage disqualification statuses. For more information, refer to [Qualification and Miscellaneous Supplier Management Process Projects \[page 188\]](#).

Disqualifications are always based on a previous qualification. However, the disqualified commodities and regions don't have to match exactly, and the disqualification always applies to all commodity or region levels below the ones approved for disqualification. For example, a supplier can be qualified for Europe and later disqualified only in France; that disqualification applies to all departments and cities in France. Disqualifications are also based on departments if they're enabled in your site.

The disqualification project template determines:

- What information qualification managers add to the form.
- Whether the disqualification requires approval, and if so, who the approvers are.
- Whether other stakeholders in your organization must also approve the disqualification.
- Whether the disqualification is immediate upon approval, takes effect on a specified date without phase-out, or takes effect automatically after a phase-out period during which the supplier has **Restricted** status.

Category or supplier managers start the disqualification, approve or deny it, and monitor the approval flow and status in the **Qualification** detail area of the supplier's profile on the **Supplier Management** dashboard.

If a disqualification includes an approval flow, notifications let the approver know that the disqualification requires approval, let the requesting user know when the disqualification has been approved or denied, and show the final approver so that requesting users can have further discussions about denied disqualifications.

Once a disqualification is approved, any preferred supplier status for the disqualified commodities, regions, and departments (including any preferred commodities, regions, or departments above or below the disqualified commodities, regions, and departments in the same branch of the hierarchy) is automatically removed. The rationale is that suppliers can't be considered "preferred" if they're disqualified, for whatever reason and through whatever means, at any hierarchical level within the same combination. For example, if a supplier is preferred for shoes and later disqualified for apparel, the preferred status for shoes is automatically removed. Likewise, if a supplier is preferred for apparel and later disqualified for shoes, the preferred status for apparel is automatically removed. In solutions that include SAP Ariba Sourcing, if event templates are restricted to qualified participants, or automatically invite preferred suppliers, disqualified suppliers aren't event participants. However, disqualification is otherwise just a status. There's no mechanism for preventing users from inviting disqualified suppliers to unrestricted sourcing events or conducting other activities with them.

Qualification managers can requalify disqualifications. If a qualification is restricted, a qualification manager can only do so after the restricted period has passed and the supplier is disqualified. If a disqualification has a minimum disqualification period, they can only do so after that date has passed. They can also start new qualifications for categories, regions, and departments other than the ones for which the supplier was disqualified.

📘 Note

- If a supplier is requalified for a process, the supplier can again be marked "preferred" for the same combination of commodity, region, and department.
- If a supplier is qualified for more than one process type for the same commodity, region, and department combination, is preferred for the same combination, and is subsequently disqualified for one of those processes, then the "preferred" status is automatically invalidated.

Related Information

[Internal Supplier Requests \[page 93\]](#)

[External Supplier Requests \[page 94\]](#)

[New Supplier Registrations \[page 108\]](#)

[Supplier Qualification and Requalification Using Supplier Qualification Projects \[page 170\]](#)

[Preferred Category Statuses Management Projects \[page 223\]](#)

[Supplier Performance Evaluations Using SPM Projects](#)

Starting a New Qualification Using a Supplier Qualification Project

Use these steps to start qualifications for different combinations of commodities, regions, and departments if your organization uses supplier qualification projects. Questionnaire content in qualification projects is tailored to specific combinations to measure whether or not a supplier meets your organization's standards and requirements for them.

Prerequisites

To start a new supplier qualification, you must be a member of the **Supplier Qualification Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** group.

Supplier qualifications and disqualifications are only available in sites that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance.

Context

This topic is only applicable if your organization manages qualifications using supplier qualification and disqualification projects. If your organization uses process qualification projects, refer to [Creating a Qualification or Miscellaneous Supplier Management Process Project \[page 197\]](#). If the process project feature is enabled in your site, creation of new supplier qualification projects is disabled, and you can create process qualification projects instead.

Supplier qualifications are always based on a commodity and a region. If your organization's prequalification form includes a question for it, you can also choose a department for the qualification. The commodities, regions, and departments you select determine which external (supplier-facing) questionnaire segments are available for the qualification, which can be required or optional. This targeting allows your organization to evaluate the suitability of a supplier based on specific metrics, which can involve legal requirements, different regulatory jurisdictions, business criticality, and other factors.

The qualification combines all the questionnaire segments that you select into a single questionnaire for the supplier to fill out, and generates a single notification with a link to that combined questionnaire. Your organization's qualification setup can also include one or more internal questionnaires. Internal questionnaires

aren't dependent on the qualification's commodities, regions, and departments and are added automatically when you start a qualification.

Since commodities, regions, and departments are hierarchical, with higher and lower levels, qualifying a supplier for a commodity, region, or department qualifies them for the lower levels of the hierarchy branch. For example, qualifying a supplier for the U.S. qualifies them for all 50 states.

The prequalification form can include questions about expiration date and requalification eligibility date. Whether or not these questions are included, or are required if they're included, depends on your organization's qualification setup. If you specify an expiration date for a qualification, it automatically expires on that date. Otherwise, the supplier remains qualified until a qualification manager starts a disqualification. If you specify a requalification eligibility date, once a supplier is disqualified or a qualification has expired, a qualification manager can't start a requalification until that date is reached.

You can start any number of qualifications for the same supplier to qualify them for different combinations of commodities, regions, and departments. You can't start a new qualification for a combination that is already covered by an existing qualification.

Procedure

1. Locate the supplier you want to qualify on the **Supplier Management** dashboard.
2. Choose the supplier's name to open their profile.
3. Perform one of the following actions:
 - In the supplier's profile summary, choose the **Qualifications** panel.
 - In the classic supplier 360° profile, choose **Qualifications** in the left-hand navigation bar.

The **Qualifications** detail area of the supplier's profile opens.

4. Choose **+** (add).
5. Choose one or more commodities, regions, and (if your organization uses them) departments by performing one of the following actions:
 - Choose **Search** and enter search terms in the field, then select a value from the list of search results.
 - Choose **Browse** and use the arrows (**>**) to navigate through the hierarchy, then select the values you want to qualify the supplier for.
6. (Optional) If the prequalification form includes a question about expiration date and you want the qualification to expire, specify an expiration date.
7. (Optional) If the prequalification form includes a question about requalification eligibility date and you want to ensure that the supplier can't be requalified until a specific date, specify that date.
8. Choose **Next**.
9. Choose the external (supplier-facing) questionnaire segments that you want to include in the qualification. You can't uncheck required questionnaires.

To see the content of a questionnaire, choose **🔍** (view).
10. Choose the supplier contact to whom to send the qualification. If you want to send the questionnaire to a new contact, you can [add them here \[page 54\]](#).
11. (Optional) To change any aspect of the new qualification, such as commodities, regions, or dates, choose **Edit**, make your changes, and choose **Next**.

Your changes can cause the list of available external questionnaires to change. Review the list and choose or uncheck questionnaires as needed.

12. Choose **Send**.

Results

If the supplier has never been qualified before, they now have an overall qualification status of **Qualification Started**. If they had at least one previously approved qualification, their overall qualification status remains **Qualified**. In either case, the status for the current qualification is **Qualification Started**. The supplier contact that you chose receives an email notification with a link that they can use to fill out the combined external questionnaire. If your qualification includes any internal questionnaires, they're now available to fill out as well.

In the supplier's profile, the new qualification shows on the **Qualifications** detail area. To view qualification details, including questionnaires, tasks, and process flow, choose [🔗](#) (view).

Next Steps

External qualification questionnaires close after an amount of time defined in your site's questionnaire setup. After a questionnaire has closed, the supplier contact can no longer edit it to fill it out. If a supplier hasn't responded, or if the invitation has bounced, [reinviting the supplier to qualify \[page 128\]](#) reopens any closed questionnaires and allows you to choose a different recipient if necessary. By default, questionnaires close 30 days after the invitation is sent, but your organization can specify a different amount of time in its questionnaire setup.

Related Information

[Supplier Qualification and Requalification Using Supplier Qualification Projects \[page 170\]](#)

[Supplier Disqualifications Using Supplier Disqualification Projects \[page 171\]](#)

[Supplier Qualification and Disqualification Status Flow \[page 163\]](#)

[About the Qualifications Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 158\]](#)

[Disqualifying a Supplier Using a Disqualification Project \[page 179\]](#)

[Requalifying a Supplier Using a Supplier Qualification Project \[page 182\]](#)

[Filling Out an Internal Qualification Questionnaire \[page 177\]](#)

Reinviting a Supplier to Qualify or Requalify Using a Qualification Project

Use these steps to remind a supplier to respond to an initial qualification or requalification invitation or to change the invited supplier contact.

Prerequisites

To reinvite a supplier to qualify or requalify using a qualification project, you must be a member of the **Supplier Qualification Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** group. If your organization manages qualifications using process projects instead, you can [request updates for included modular questionnaires \[page 240\]](#) instead.

To add or edit a supplier contact on the send questionnaires page, you must be a member of the **Supplier Registration Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** group. Members of the **Supplier Qualification Manager** group can add but not edit supplier contacts on the send questionnaires page.

You can only reinvite a supplier to qualify or requalify if the qualification project is in **Qualification Started** status. Once the supplier has opened and viewed an external questionnaire and the qualification project has moved to **In Qualification** status, you can no longer reinvite them. If the supplier doesn't submit the questionnaire, you must use another method to remind them.

Context

Reinviting a supplier is useful if:

- **The previously invited contact is the right person to complete the qualification or requalification but they need a reminder.** Reinviting the same contact sends them another invitation as a reminder.
- **The previously invited contact isn't the right person to complete the qualification or requalification.** You can choose a different contact when reinviting the supplier.
- **External questionnaires have closed before the invited contact responded.** External questionnaires close after an amount of time defined in your site's questionnaire setup. By default, that amount is 30 days, but your organization can specify a different amount of time in its questionnaire setup. After a questionnaire has closed, the supplier contact can no longer edit it to fill it out. Reinviting the supplier reopens the external questionnaires.

You can't change which external questionnaires are included when you reinvite a supplier to qualify or requalify. The qualification always includes the external questionnaires selected during the original invitation.

Procedure

1. Locate the supplier you want to reinvite on the **Supplier Management** dashboard.
2. Choose the supplier's name to open their profile.

3. Navigate to the **Qualifications** detail area of the profile.
4. Locate the qualification and choose **...** (more options) > **Reinvite** .
5. (Optional) To change the questionnaire recipient, choose a different contact. If the supplier only has one contact, that contact is automatically selected and you can't uncheck it. If you have the appropriate permissions, you can [add or edit a contact now \[page 54\]](#) to make sure you're sending the invitation to the recipient you want at the correct email address.
6. Choose **Send**.

Results

The supplier contact you selected receives one new invitation for the qualification questionnaire. The supplier contact can use the links in the emails to create an account and fill out and submit the questionnaires.

If you added or edited a supplier contact while reinviting the supplier, those changes show in the **Contacts** detail area of the supplier's profile.

Related Information

[About the Qualifications Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 158\]](#)

[Starting a New Qualification Using a Supplier Qualification Project \[page 173\]](#)

[Requalifying a Supplier Using a Supplier Qualification Project \[page 182\]](#)

[Requesting an Update or Changing the Recipient for a Modular Questionnaire \[page 240\]](#)

Filling Out an Internal Qualification Questionnaire

Use these steps if your organization's qualification projects include one or more internal questionnaires and you're a questionnaire editor. Filling out internal questionnaires can be a required or optional step in supplier qualification.

Prerequisites

To edit an internal qualification questionnaire, you must be a member of the **Supplier Qualification Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** group.

If the questionnaire is associated with a To Do task, you must also be a task owner to edit the questionnaire while completing the To Do task.

Context

Internal supplier qualification questionnaires typically collect supplemental information about a qualification that only people in your organization can provide, such as evaluations.

Internal questionnaires can be associated with To Do tasks. If there's no To Do task associated with an internal questionnaire, or if it's associated with an optional To Do task, filling out the questionnaire is optional. If there's a required To Do task associated with an internal questionnaire and you're a task owner, you must submit the internal questionnaire to complete the task.

Internal qualification questionnaires that don't have a To Do task are editable as long as they're not in approval until the qualification project is finally approved or denied. An internal qualification questionnaires with To Do tasks is editable as long as any To Do task on the questionnaire is open, and is no longer editable when all of the To Do tasks on the questionnaire are complete. When the tasks on an internal qualification questionnaire start depends on how the qualification project is set up. If a task doesn't have a predecessor, it starts when the qualification starts. Otherwise, it starts when the predecessor task is completed.

If the owner of a To Do task on an internal questionnaire is a project group, all members of that project group who have the appropriate permissions can edit the internal questionnaire. The first member to submit the questionnaire becomes the owner of the completed task..

Note

Attachments in supplier management questionnaires can't include embedded documents.

The internal qualification questionnaires mentioned in this topic are meant for legacy qualification projects only. If your site previously used legacy qualification projects for supplier qualifications, you can consider switching to qualification process projects instead. See [Filling out an internal questionnaire for a supplier management process](#).

Procedure

1. On the **Supplier Management**, locate the supplier and choose their name to open their profile.
2. Perform one of the following actions:
 - To fill out an internal qualification questionnaire, navigate to the **Qualifications** detail area of the profile, then locate the qualification and choose **...** (more options) > **View** .
 - If the questionnaire is associated with an active To Do task and you're a task owner, choose the link in the email notification.
3. Perform one of the following actions:
 - Locate the questionnaire in the **Questionnaires** table and choose **View**  to open the questionnaire details page. On the questionnaire details page, choose **Edit**.
 - If the questionnaire is associated with an active To Do task and you're a task owner, locate the task in the **Tasks** table and choose  (take action) to open the task details page, where the questionnaire is automatically editable.
4. Fill out the questionnaire as needed.
5. **Optional:** To save your draft edits of the questionnaire, choose **Save**.

You can continue editing the questionnaire later by opening it and choosing **Edit** again.

6. Perform one of the following actions:

- On the questionnaire details page, click **Submit**.
- On the task details page, click **Mark Complete**.

If the questionnaire is associated with a To Do task, either of these actions completes the task.

Results

If the questionnaire has an approval task, that task starts and approvers approve or deny your answers.

If you're the first user to submit the questionnaire, your name is added to the **Owner** field and is always displayed even if other users edit the questionnaire subsequently. If you have access to the **Advanced View**, you can choose **Advanced View** () in the top right corner of the questionnaire and view the questionnaire's activity history in the **History** tab. To view a project's activity history, see [Viewing a Project's Activity History \[page 274\]](#).

Next Steps

You can edit an internal qualification questionnaire that doesn't have a To Do task as long as the qualification project is still active, by clicking  (view).

Related Information

[About the Qualifications Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 158\]](#)

[Starting a New Qualification Using a Supplier Qualification Project \[page 173\]](#)

Disqualifying a Supplier Using a Disqualification Project

Use these steps to disqualify a previously qualified supplier when they no longer meet your organization's standards or requirements.

Prerequisites

To disqualify a supplier, you must be a member of the **Supplier Qualification Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** group.

Supplier qualifications and disqualifications are only available in sites that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance.

If the process project feature (SM-16798) is enabled in your site, you can only start a disqualification project for an existing, legacy qualification project. For process qualifications, a process decision-maker can [change its status to denied \[page 220\]](#) instead.

Context

Supplier disqualifications are always based on an existing qualification, which can be the result of either an approved qualification project or a data import. The qualification is for specific commodities and regions and (if your organization uses them) departments. You can disqualify the supplier for the same combination or commodities, regions, and departments in the original qualification, or for subsets of the qualified commodities, regions, and departments. For example, if a supplier has a qualification for clothing in Europe, you can disqualify them for shoes in Spain. Disqualifications show under the original qualification in the **Qualifications** area of the supplier 360° profile. If a supplier is already disqualified for part of the original qualification, and you can disqualify the supplier for other commodities regions, and departments until all of the original qualification is disqualified.

Since commodities, regions, and departments are hierarchical, with higher and lower levels, disqualifying a supplier for a commodity, region, or department automatically disqualifies them for the lower levels of the hierarchy branch. For example, disqualifying a supplier for the U.S. disqualifies them for all fifty states.

Depending on how the disqualification process is set up in your site, a disqualification can take effect immediately upon approval, on a date that you specify in the disqualification questionnaire, or after a phase-out period that you specify in the questionnaire.

Procedure

1. Locate the supplier that you want to disqualify on the **Supplier Management** dashboard.
2. Choose the supplier's name to open their profile.
3. Perform one of the following actions:
 - In the supplier's profile summary, choose the **Qualifications** panel.
 - In the classic supplier 360° profile, choose **Qualifications** in the left-hand navigation bar.

The **Qualifications** detail area of the supplier's profile opens.

4. Locate the qualification that you want to disqualify either fully or partially and choose **...** (more options) > **Disqualify** .

If your organization now uses process qualifications, existing legacy qualifications for which you can start a disqualification project are located on the **Legacy qualifications** tab.

5. Choose one or more commodities, regions, and (if your organization uses them) departments by performing one of the following actions:
 - Choose **Search** and enter search terms in the field, then select a value from the list of search results.
 - Choose **Browse** and use the arrows () to navigate through the hierarchy, then select values to include in the request. Your choices are limited to the values included in the qualification on which this disqualification is based. You can select the same values or a subset.
6. Enter any other information in the disqualification questionnaire.

7. Choose **Submit**.

Results

If the supplier doesn't have any other qualifications, after a full disqualification is approved, they now have the following overall qualification status:

- **Disqualified**, if the disqualification is immediate.
- **Restricted**, if your disqualification process includes a phase-out period and you specified a date in the questionnaire. This status automatically updates to **Disqualified** after the phase-out period has ended.
- **Qualified**, if you specified a future date for the disqualification in the questionnaire. This status automatically updates to **Disqualified** on that date.

If the supplier has at least one other valid qualification, or the disqualification is only partial, their overall qualification status remains **Qualified** but the associated qualification now shows the appropriate disqualification status.

Once you've disqualified a supplier for a combination of commodities, regions, and departments, they can no longer participate in new sourcing events that require qualification for participation. Disqualification doesn't remove suppliers from existing events. Disqualification also removed any related preferred status level for the disqualified commodity, region, and department combination.

Next Steps

You can [edit or remove a qualification restriction \[page 186\]](#) or [start a requalification \[page 182\]](#). If your organization now uses process qualifications, the requalification [creates a new process qualification \[page 197\]](#) instead.

Related Information

[Supplier Qualification and Requalification Using Supplier Qualification Projects \[page 170\]](#)

[Supplier Disqualifications Using Supplier Disqualification Projects \[page 171\]](#)

[Supplier Qualification and Disqualification Status Flow \[page 163\]](#)

[Starting a New Qualification Using a Supplier Qualification Project \[page 173\]](#)

[Requalifying a Supplier Using a Supplier Qualification Project \[page 182\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a Qualification, Disqualification, or Requalification Based on a Supplier Qualification or Disqualification Project \[page 184\]](#)

[Editing or Removing a Qualification Restriction from a Supplier \[page 186\]](#)

Requalifying a Supplier Using a Supplier Qualification Project

Use these steps to requalify a supplier that has an expired or denied qualification, or has been disqualified, if your organization uses supplier qualification projects to manage supplier qualifications.

Prerequisites

To requalify a supplier, you must be a member of the **Supplier Qualification Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** group.

Supplier qualifications and disqualifications are only available in sites that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance.

Context

Requalifications are always based on one of the following previous qualifications:

- An imported disqualification status. In this case, the requalification creates a new qualification project with the commodities, regions, and departments associated with the status.
- An existing qualification project that was denied or has expired. In this case, the requalification relaunches the original denied or expired qualification project.
- A disqualification project based on the entire set of commodities, regions, and departments of an existing qualification project. In this case, the requalification relaunches the original qualification project.
- A disqualification project based on a subset of the commodities, regions, and departments of an existing qualification project. In this case, the requalification creates a new qualification project with the subset of commodities, regions, and departments from the disqualification.

If the process project feature (SM-16798) is enabled in your site, starting a requalification based on a legacy disqualification or an expired, legacy qualification always [creates a new qualification process project \[page 197\]](#). If the qualification is a process qualification, you [renew it instead \[page 197\]](#).

Procedure

1. Locate the supplier that you want to requalify on the **Supplier Management** dashboard.
2. Choose the supplier's name to open their profile.
3. Perform one of the following actions:
 - In the supplier's profile summary, choose the **Qualifications** panel.
 - In the classic supplier 360° profile, choose **Qualifications** in the left-hand navigation bar.

The **Qualifications** detail area of the supplier's profile opens.

4. Locate the qualification that you want to disqualify either fully or partially and choose **...** (more options) > **Requalify**  .

If your organization now uses process qualifications, existing legacy qualifications and disqualifications are located on the **Legacy qualifications** tab.

5. (Optional) To see the content of the external qualification questionnaire before you send it, choose [🔍](#) (view). If the requalification is based on a previous qualification project, the external qualification questionnaire shows the previous answers from the supplier.
6. If the requalification isn't based on a previous qualification project, check the external (supplier-facing) questionnaire segments that you want to include in the qualification. You can't uncheck required questionnaire segments. If the requalification is based on a previous qualification project, it automatically uses the questionnaire segments selected for that project and you can't edit that selection.

To see the content of a questionnaire segment, choose [🔍](#) (view).

7. Select the supplier contact to whom to send the requalification. The contact you select can be different from the contact who completed the previous qualification questionnaire. If you want to send the questionnaire to a new contact, you can [add them here \[page 54\]](#).
8. Choose **Send**.
9. If the prequalification form in your site includes a question about qualification expiration date, requalification eligibility date, or both, a popup asks you to review the dates specified for the previous qualification, if any. Edit these dates if necessary and choose **Send**.

Results

The qualification is now in **Qualification Started** status. The supplier contact that you chose receives a notification email with a link to the qualification questionnaire. Internal users can now fill out and submit any internal questionnaires and complete assigned tasks for the requalification. If the requalification relaunches an existing qualification project, the previous answers to both external and internal questionnaires are visible to the people who fill them out for the requalification, including a different supplier contact than the one who filled out the questionnaire for the original qualification. They can edit them as required. If the requalification is finally approved, it uses any new expiration or requalification eligibility dates you provided.

The qualification statuses that **suppliers** see during requalifications depend on whether the requalification is based on an original qualification project or a new qualification project and isn't always the same qualification status that shows in your site. If the requalification relaunches an existing qualification project, the supplier sees a status of **Qualified**, although they're in **Qualification Started** qualification status in your site. If the requalification creates a new qualification project, the supplier sees a status of **Qualification Started**, which is the same as their qualification status in your site.

Related Information

[About the Qualifications Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 158\]](#)

[Starting a New Qualification Using a Supplier Qualification Project \[page 173\]](#)

[Disqualifying a Supplier Using a Disqualification Project \[page 179\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a Qualification, Disqualification, or Requalification Based on a Supplier Qualification or Disqualification Project \[page 184\]](#)

[Editing or Removing a Qualification Restriction from a Supplier \[page 186\]](#)

[Filling Out an Internal Qualification Questionnaire \[page 177\]](#)

Approving or Denying a Qualification, Disqualification, or Requalification Based on a Supplier Qualification or Disqualification Project

If you're in the approval flow for a supplier qualification, disqualification, or requalification based on a supplier qualification or disqualification project, you can approve or deny it.

Prerequisites

Supplier qualifications and disqualifications are only available in sites that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance.

Context

This topic is applicable if your organization manages supplier qualifications using supplier qualification and disqualification projects. If your organization manages supplier qualifications using process projects, approvers for modular questionnaire projects included in a process qualification [approve or deny them \[page 209\]](#). Then either [a decision-maker sets the qualification process's status \[page 220\]](#) or the status is automatically set based on the statuses of included modular questionnaires.

Procedure

1. To open the approval task details page with the questionnaire answers, perform one of the following actions:
 - Navigate to the **Qualifications** detail area of the supplier's profile, then locate the qualification and choose  (more options) > **View** . On the qualification details page, locate the approval task and choose  (take action).
 - Choose the link in the approval notification email.
2. Review the questionnaire answers.

→ Tip

If an approver previously requested more information for this questionnaire, or if the questionnaire is for a requalification based on an original qualification project, use the **Latest Version** and **Previous Version** columns to compare answers. These columns show the approval decisions for the versions. To show only the questions with updated answers, choose **Updated**. To show all questions and answers, choose **All**.

3. In the upper right corner of the page, perform one of the following actions:
 - To approve the questionnaire, choose **Approve**, enter an optional comment, and choose **Approve**.
 - To deny the questionnaire, choose **Deny**, enter an explanatory comment, and choose **Deny**.

- To request additional information from the respondent, choose **Request Additional Info**, enter a comment explaining what information you want, and choose **Request Additional Info**.

Results

For qualifications and requalifications, if you're the final approver, the qualification now has **Qualified** or **Qualification Rejected** status and receives an email notification of that status. If not, the qualification remains in **Pending Qualification Approval** status until the final approval or denial.

For disqualifications, if you're the final approver, the qualification is now in **Restricted** or **Disqualified** status, depending on how your organization's disqualification process is set up. If not, the qualification remains in **Qualified** status until the final approval or denial. Suppliers in **Restricted** status are automatically disqualified at the date specified on the disqualification form. If the supplier has preferred status for the commodities, regions, and departments specified in the disqualification, that status is automatically removed.

Any comments that you or other approvers added during questionnaire approval show on both the questionnaire and approval task details pages, which you can see by viewing the questionnaire or task. Questionnaire details pages show all comments for all tasks in the project, and you can filter them to just show the comments for the current questionnaire. Task details pages show only the comments associated with the current task. Depending on how your site's notifications are set up, approval comments can also be included in approval or denial notifications to suppliers.

If you requested additional information during approval of an external questionnaire and entered a comment, the supplier sees the most recent approval comment when they revise their response to the questionnaire.

Next Steps

If you denied the qualification, a qualification manager can [requalify them \[page 182\]](#) at a later date.

If your organization uses preferred supplier management to grant preferred category status to suppliers, after the qualification or requalification for the specified commodities, regions, and departments is finally approved, you can [request a preferred category status \[page 225\]](#) for the supplier for those commodities, regions, and departments.

If you approved a disqualification with a phase-out period, you can [edit or remove the restriction \[page 186\]](#).

Related Information

[About the Qualifications Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 158\]](#)

[Starting a New Qualification Using a Supplier Qualification Project \[page 173\]](#)

[Disqualifying a Supplier Using a Disqualification Project \[page 179\]](#)

[Requalifying a Supplier Using a Supplier Qualification Project \[page 182\]](#)

[Editing or Removing a Qualification Restriction from a Supplier \[page 186\]](#)

[Completing a Standalone To Do Task in a Supplier Management Project \[page 259\]](#)

[Filling Out an Internal Qualification Questionnaire \[page 177\]](#)

Editing or Removing a Qualification Restriction from a Supplier

If your organization's disqualification projects include a phase-out period, a supplier qualification has **Restricted** status until the end of that period. Use these steps to edit or remove the restriction by changing the date on which the supplier moves to **Disqualified** status.

Prerequisites

To edit or remove a qualification restriction, you must be a member of the **Supplier Qualification Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** group.

Supplier qualifications and disqualifications are only available in sites that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance. The supplier disqualification form in your site must be set up to include a phase-out period for the qualification.

Qualification restrictions are only available in supplier disqualification projects. If your organization uses process projects to manage supplier qualifications, a decision-maker can [change a qualification process's status \[page 220\]](#) instead.

Context

When a supplier qualification is restricted, it's not disqualified until the restricted period has ended. During that time, you can't start a requalification for it. You can edit the disqualification date for a restricted qualification to lengthen or shorten the restricted period or to remove the disqualification date entirely so that the qualification moves immediately to **Disqualified** status and you can start a requalification.

Procedure

1. Locate the supplier from which you want to remove the qualification restriction on the **Supplier Management** dashboard.

→ Tip

In supplier search results, you can filter by the qualification status **Restricted**.

2. Choose the supplier name to open their profile.
3. Perform one of the following actions:
 - In the supplier's profile summary, choose the **Qualifications** panel.
 - In the classic supplier 360° profile, choose **Qualifications** in the left-hand navigation bar.

The **Qualifications** detail area of the supplier's profile opens.

4. For the restricted qualification, choose **⋮** (more options) > **Edit** .
5. Edit or delete the disqualification date.

6. Choose **Submit**.

Results

If the disqualification project has an approval flow, once your edit of the restriction is finally approved, the new phase-out date takes effect. If you removed the disqualification date, the qualification moved immediately to **Disqualified** status.

Related Information

[About the Qualifications Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 158\]](#)

[Starting a New Qualification Using a Supplier Qualification Project \[page 173\]](#)

[Disqualifying a Supplier Using a Disqualification Project \[page 179\]](#)

[Requalifying a Supplier Using a Supplier Qualification Project \[page 182\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a Qualification, Disqualification, or Requalification Based on a Supplier Qualification or Disqualification Project \[page 184\]](#)

Supplier Qualification and Lifecycle Management Using Process Projects

Your organization can use qualification process projects to vet suppliers for specific combinations of commodities, regions, and departments, and miscellaneous process projects to manage other supplier lifecycle stages.

These topics are applicable if your organization uses process projects to manage supplier qualifications. If your organization uses supplier qualification and disqualification projects, refer to [Qualification Management Using Supplier Qualification and Disqualification Projects \[page 169\]](#).

[Qualification and Miscellaneous Supplier Management Process Projects \[page 188\]](#)

[Discontinuation Processes \[page 193\]](#)

[Workflow for Creating a Qualification or Other Supplier Management Process Project \[page 195\]](#)

[Creating a Qualification or Miscellaneous Supplier Management Process Project \[page 197\]](#)

[Creating a Qualification or Miscellaneous Supplier Management Process for Multiple Suppliers at One Time \[page 202\]](#)

[Discontinuing a Qualification Process \[page 205\]](#)

[Filling Out an Internal Questionnaire for a Supplier Management Process \[page 207\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a Modular Questionnaire in a Process Project \[page 209\]](#)

[Canceling a Qualification or Other Process in the Supplier's Profile \[page 212\]](#)

[Workflow for Renewing a Qualification or Other Supplier Management Process \[page 214\]](#)

[Renewing a Qualification or Other Supplier Management Process \[page 216\]](#)

Qualification and Miscellaneous Supplier Management Process Projects

Your organization can use supplier management process projects to collect information about and decide status for supplier qualifications, other business processes, or their discontinuation.

A supplier management process project is a framework that includes a collection of modular questionnaires to gather information relevant to the process and a workflow for deciding an outcome. A process project can be for:

- **Qualification:** If your organization uses process projects for supplier qualifications, the modular questionnaires can ask for specific qualification-related information for a particular combination of commodities, regions, and departments. A qualification process can include one or more general modular questionnaires that cover your organization's universal qualification criteria. It can also include specific modular questionnaires related to critical information or certifications for specific commodities, regions, and departments. Qualification processes can include both internal and external questionnaires.
If your company uses a qualification process and you're a process initiator for it, you can create and manage those qualification process projects in the **Qualifications** or **Processes** detail area of the supplier profile.
- **Miscellaneous processes:** If your organization uses process projects for any other types of supplier management process, they can also include external or internal modular questionnaires relevant to that specific process. If your organization uses a miscellaneous process and you're a process initiator for it, you can create and manage those process projects in the **Processes** detail area of the supplier profile.
- **Discontinuation:** If your organization uses qualification process projects, they can be disqualified using a discontinuation process. A discontinuation process can also include internal modular questionnaires to collect information about the reason for discontinuing the qualification process. You can fully or partially discontinue existing qualification processes in the **Qualifications** detail area of the supplier profile.

Data imported in your site determine whether a process is a qualification process, discontinuation process, or other (miscellaneous) process and the names of its statuses. The process project template determines:

- Who can start the process (process initiators) and set its final status (decision-makers).
- The intake form that process initiators fill out when creating or renewing a process. This intake form can include questions about the commodities, regions, and departments to which the process is applicable. A question about at least one of these three elements is required. It can also include questions that set schedules for the process's expiration and for expiration reminder notifications.
- The types of external or internal modular questionnaires used in the process.

Within a process, each modular questionnaire is defined by its own template, which determines:

- The questionnaire's type, which determines the processes it's included in.
- Whether the questionnaire is internal or external.
- Whether or not the questionnaire is required in matching processes.
- The commodities, regions, and departments to which the questionnaire applies.
- The content of the questionnaire.
- The approval flow for the questionnaire.
- Whether there are other tasks in the questionnaire's workflow.
- Whether or not the questionnaire project itself has an expiration date, and if so, which people in your organization receive notifications of pending and elapsed expirations in addition to the questionnaire owner.

- Whether the expiration of a certificate in a questionnaire triggers the questionnaire project's expiration as well.
- Whether or not recipients can update the questionnaire after it's first approved, and if so, whether or not the updates also require approval and the update approval flow.
- Whether the questionnaire automatically generates update requests to recipients each time it's included in a new or renewed process.

Each modular questionnaire contains its own answers. Once a recipient has submitted a modular questionnaire for the first time, those answers are available in the questionnaire in any process that reuses it.

Users with the appropriate permissions create a process for a supplier in the relevant area of their supplier profile. Process creation involves several steps:

1. The process initiator chooses what type of process that they want to create, then specifies the commodities, regions, and departments for the process and answers any other questions in the process intake form. If the intake form includes questions about an expiration schedule, they can also specify when the process expires and its expiration notification schedule. The following image shows an example of this step:

Create or renew qualification process

Supplier
Supplier ABC
Vendor ID
S20963434

Process Type * Full Qualification

Geographical Area: *

Categories Supplied: *

Business Unit: *

Validity from approval date (time): * Years

Validity from approval date (value): *

Expiration reminder (time): * Months

Validity from approval date (value): *

Next **Cancel**

2. The process initiator sees the modular questionnaires that are both included in the process **and** match the process commodities, regions, and departments. These questionnaires can be newly assigned, meaning that they've never been filled out before for this particular supplier. If they've already been filled out and approved for the supplier, the process initiator has the option to request an update, or the update request

can be automatic. Questionnaires can be required or optional. The process initiator can choose which optional questionnaires to include in the process. The following image shows an example of this step:

Supplier

Supplier ABC

Vendor ID S20963434

Process Type

Full Qualification

Process Owner

Alice Jones

Matrix

Category

Alloys

Category ID: 1117

Region

Japan

Region ID: Japan

Business unit

All

Business unit ID: 0

Choose questionnaires

Add new questionnaires

QUESTIONNAIRE NAME

☒

Full Qualification Questionnaire

☐Supplementary Due Diligence for Raw Materials Qualification

Reuse existing questionnaires

QUESTIONNAIRE NAME	STATUS	EXPIRATION DATE	SCORE	REQUEST UPDATES
☒Logistics Questionnaire - APAC	Approved		-	☒
☒Safety Audit - APAC	Expiring	06/15/2022	-	☒

Previous

Next

Cancel

3. The process initiator chooses recipients for both external and internal questionnaires and finishes creating the process project. The following image shows an example of this step:

Create or renew qualification process

Supplier
Supplier ABC
Vendor ID S20963434

Process Type
Full Qualification

Process Owner
Alice Jones

Matrix
Category: Alloys
Category ID: 1117
Region: Japan
Region ID: Japan
Business unit: All
Business Unit ID: 0

Review questionnaire recipients

Questionnaire	Status	Type	Recipient	
Full Qualification Questionnaire	New	External	 Barbara Aiken	Change recipient
Logistics Questionnaire - APAC	Approved	External	 Barbara Aiken	Change recipient
Safety Audit - APAC	Expiring	Internal	 Robert Smith	Change recipient

Add a message

Please fill out your assigned questionnaire by the due date to complete this qualification.

[Previous](#) [Send](#) [Cancel](#)

Notifications let questionnaire recipients know that they need to fill out or update their assigned questionnaires and inform the supplier primary contact that they've been invited to participate in the process.

Suppliers fill out or update external modular questionnaires and view any processes to which they've been invited in their SAP Business Network account. Internal recipients fill out or update the internal modular supplier management questionnaires to which they've been assigned in the **Questionnaires** detail area of the supplier's profile or from the detail page for the process. Task owners and approvers complete To Do tasks and approve or deny individual questionnaires in the **Questionnaires** detail area or from the process details page as well.

While a process is in progress, the process project owner can cancel it if necessary.

After all approvals and other tasks for every questionnaire in the process are completed, a decision-maker for the process decides its final status in the **Qualifications**, or **Processes** detail area of the supplier profile. These final statuses have names that are specific to your organization's business process, but they correspond to an approved, conditionally approved, or denied status.

Once a process is complete, a process initiator can renew it to collect updated information for a new status decision. For qualification processes, a renewal is a requalification.

📌 Note

Before starting a renewal, verify that the correct modular questionnaire is selected. Avoid canceling a renewal unless necessary. If a new renewal is created immediately after cancelation, the intake form may not display or accept values for **Commodity**, **Region**, or **Department**, which can prevent the process from starting. To prevent this from happening, wait briefly between canceling a renewal and creating a new one. Ensure all required fields are visible on the intake form.

Decision-makers can also update the final status for a process at any time without a renewal. For example, if a critical underlying questionnaire expires without an update, a decision-maker can change the final status of the process from approved to denied. Currently, no separate disqualification process is supported, but changing the status of a qualification process to denied produces the same result. The primary supplier contact, process project owner, and all the decision-makers receive notifications when a decision-maker sets or updates the final status of a process.

After a qualification process has been approved, category or supplier managers can evaluate the supplier for a preferred category status level (if your organization uses preferred supplier levels) for the same combination of commodities, regions, and departments or a subset. This option isn't available if the process is only conditionally approved.

The process initiator of an approved or partially approved qualification process can fully or partially discontinue the qualification process.

Administrators can also create processes using data imports. These processes aren't based on projects and don't have associated questionnaires or workflows. However, if the imported process has an eligible status, users with the appropriate permissions can:

- Cancel it using the same data import.
- Cancel or renew it (creating a process project for it) in the supplier's profile.

Canceling a process created using a data import doesn't generate any notifications, since there's no associated project.

Related Information

[Creating a Qualification or Miscellaneous Supplier Management Process Project \[page 197\]](#)

[Filling Out an Internal Questionnaire for a Supplier Management Process \[page 207\]](#)

[Making a Status Decision for a Supplier Management Process \[page 220\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a Modular Questionnaire in a Process Project \[page 209\]](#)

[Canceling a Qualification or Other Process in the Supplier's Profile \[page 212\]](#)

[Renewing a Qualification or Other Supplier Management Process \[page 216\]](#)

[Requesting an Update or Changing the Recipient for a Modular Questionnaire \[page 240\]](#)

[Workflow for Creating a Qualification or Other Supplier Management Process Project \[page 195\]](#)

Discontinuation Processes

Discontinuation is associated with a separate supplier lifecycle stage **Disqualification**. It's a separate process with its own workflow and process statuses. Discontinuing existing qualification processes is to disqualify these processes.

Currently, a site can only have one discontinuation process type and one associated discontinuation process project template. The discontinuation process type maps to all qualification process types in the site.

Currently, discontinuation isn't supported for miscellaneous processes. Only qualification processes can be discontinued.

You can create a full or partial discontinuation process, cancel an ongoing discontinuation process, renew a discontinued supplier management process, or make a decision for a discontinuation process in the supplier 360° profile. The administrator in your organization can also perform all these operations through the data import task.

The qualification process projects imported through the data import task can be partially or completely discontinued in the user interface. The status is updated to show the discontinuation of the qualification process.

Note

After a data import task is successfully executed to create a discontinuation process with status "discontinuation denied" for an existing supplier management process, no discontinuation process is created in the supplier 360° profile.

After a data import task is successfully executed to update an existing discontinuation process to the "discontinuation denied" status, the results are as follows:

- The existing discontinuation process is removed.
- For a full discontinuation, the original supplier management process is reverted, and the status is "qualified" or "conditionally qualified".

The following table describes the differences between full discontinuation and partial discontinuation during the creation, cancellation, renewal, and decision-making performed in the supplier 360° profile.

Scenario	Full discontinuation	Partial discontinuation
Discontinue • You must be a member of the Process Initiator group of the existing supplier management process to be discontinued. • The supplier management process to be discontinued must have a "qualified" or "conditionally qualified" status. For details, refer to Discontinuing a Qualification Process [page 205] .	You discontinue a supplier management process for the commodity, region, and department combination that is exactly the same as those configured for an existing supplier management process. The original supplier management process changes to a discontinuation process and is displayed in red. The status of the discontinuation process is "discontinuation in progress".	You discontinue a supplier management process with a subset combination of commodities, regions, and departments for those configured for an existing supplier management process. A new discontinuation process is created in red and nested under the existing supplier management process. The status of the discontinuation process is "discontinuation in progress".

Scenario	Full discontinuation	Partial discontinuation
Cancel - You must be the discontinuation process owner. - The discontinuation process to be canceled must have an "in progress" or "pending decision" status. For details, refer to Canceling a Qualification or Other Process in the Supplier's Profile [page 212].	After the cancellation, the discontinuation process is removed. The original supplier management process is reverted, and the status is the original "qualified" or "conditionally qualified". If you cancel a discontinuation renewal, the new supplier management process created during the renewal is removed, and the original discontinuation record with a decision is reverted and displayed again.	After the cancellation, the discontinuation process record is removed, and the existing supplier management process isn't affected.
Renew - You must be a member of the Process Initiator group of the discontinued supplier management process to be renewed. - The discontinuation process to be renewed must have an expired or decision status. The renewal is to start a new supplier management process with the same category, region, and department combination as the discontinuation process. For details, refer to Renewing a Qualification or Other Supplier Management Process [page 216].	The discontinuation process is removed. A new supplier management process is created in the supplier 360° profile, and the status is "qualification in progress".	The status of the existing supplier management process remains unchanged. The discontinuation process is removed. A new supplier management process is created in the supplier 360° profile, and the status is "qualification in progress".
Make a decision or update the decision status - You must be a member of the Decision Maker group of the original supplier management process. - To make a decision, the discontinuation process to be decided must be in "pending decision" status. After the decision status is set, you can also update the decision status. For details, refer to Making a Status Decision for a Supplier Management Process [page 220].	The discontinuation process status changes to "discontinued" or "conditionally discontinued" according to the setting made by the decision-maker. However, the "denied" status never shows on the supplier 360° profile regardless of whether you denied the discontinuation process in supplier 360° profile or through the data import task. If the discontinuation decision is set to "denied", the discontinuation process is removed, and you're navigated to the process list page. The original supplier management process is reverted, and the status is the original "qualified" or "conditionally qualified".	If the discontinuation decision is set to "denied", the discontinuation process is removed, and the existing supplier management process isn't affected.

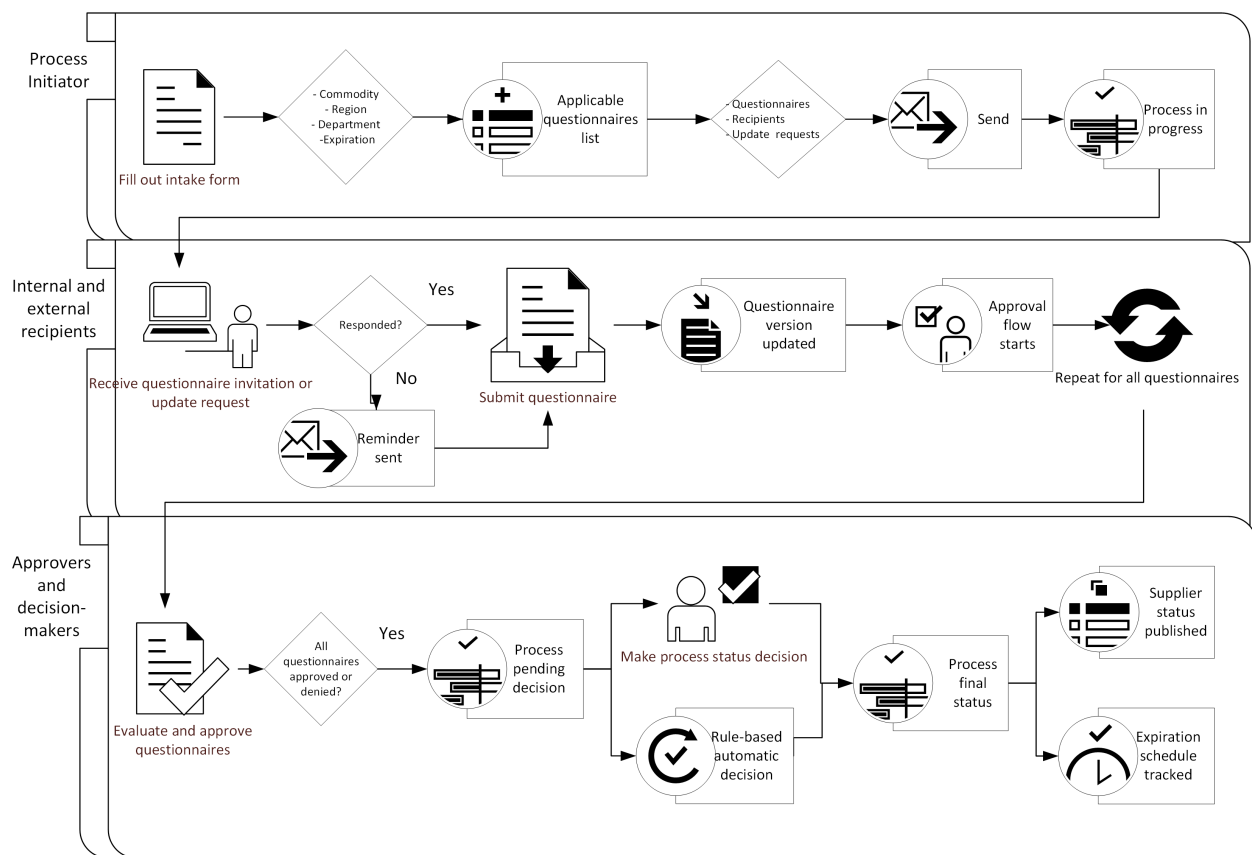
Related Information

[Discontinuing a Qualification Process \[page 205\]](#)

[Qualification and Miscellaneous Supplier Management Process Projects \[page 188\]](#)

Workflow for Creating a Qualification or Other Supplier Management Process Project

Process initiators create a new process by answering questions on an intake form and selecting questionnaires to include and their recipients.



1. In a supplier's profile, a process initiator creates a new process project by selecting a process type and filling out and submitting the process intake form. The form can include questions about:

- The process's commodities, regions, and departments. A question about at least one of these three elements is required.
- The process's expiration schedule and expiration reminder schedule, if the process can expire.
- Other aspects of the process that are part of your organization's business process.

Commodity, region, and department values are prepopulated in intake forms with entries from supplier request or registration. If a supplier has both a request and a registration with this data, the registration data is used to prepopulate the intake form. Therefore, the process initiator doesn't have to manually select these values in intake forms while creating process qualifications. However, if they're creating a process qualification for a different matrix combination, they must use the dropdown menu to select the desired matrix values.

Commodity, region, and department values in intake forms are prepopulated based on the following inbuilt rules:

- If both supplier request and supplier registration contain identical or different matrix values, the intake form is prepopulated with data from supplier registration.

Note

If matrix values from supplier registration are available, they always override values from supplier request. For example, if supplier registration contains only commodity values and supplier request contains commodity, region, and department values, all the matrix values from registration (even empty values) override all the values of supplier request.

- If a supplier request contains matrix values and supplier registration doesn't, the intake form is prepopulated with data from the supplier request.
 - If both supplier request and supplier registration don't contain any matrix values, the intake form is prepopulated with default values provided in the template.
2. The system uses the following criteria to determine the list of modular questionnaires applicable to the process project:
 1. Questionnaire type: modular questionnaires with types referenced by the process project template's external tasks are potentially applicable.
 2. Commodity, region, and department: among the potentially applicable modular questionnaires with matching types, the ones with commodities, regions, and departments that match the selections in the process intake form are applicable to the new process project.
 3. The process initiator selects the questionnaires to include in the process project. Their options in this step are controlled by settings in the modular questionnaire templates, and can include:
 - Adding optional questionnaires. Required questionnaires are automatically included.
 - Requesting updates for any reused questionnaires that require an update for the current process. A setting in the modular questionnaire template determines whether this option is available to the process initiator in this step or whether the questionnaire automatically generates update requests.
 4. The process initiator changes the default recipients of the questionnaires as needed and sends them. The process initiator (project owner) is the default recipient of internal questionnaires. The supplier's primary contact is the default recipient of external questionnaires.
 5. The system:
 - Creates the process project.
 - Creates any new modular questionnaires included in the process and invites their recipients to submit them. New questionnaires can include questionnaires that are entirely new for the supplier or questionnaires that require a new questionnaire project for each process.
 - Sends update requests to recipients of any reused questionnaires for which the update request option is either automatically or manually selected.
 6. Internal recipients receive invitations to new internal questionnaires or requests to update reused internal questionnaires and submit their responses in the supplier's profile.
 7. External recipients receive invitations to new external questionnaires or requests to update reused external questionnaires. They create a new supplier account, create a new supplier user account, or sign into an existing supplier user account as necessary on SAP Business Network and submit their responses.
 8. Approvers for the modular questionnaire projects approve, deny, or request additional information for the questionnaires or questionnaire updates. If they requested additional information, they then approve or deny the edited questionnaires.
 9. Completion of all included questionnaires starts the decision-making phase of the process project, which occurs in one of the following two ways, depending on the project's configuration:

- The system automatically sets a final status for the process following rules based on the statuses of the process's questionnaires. For example, a process can have a rule that automatically sets its final status to approved if all of its questionnaires are approved.
 - A process decision-maker manually sets a final status for the process after evaluating its questionnaires. The decision-maker can optionally edit the intake form while setting the process status.
10. If the process is a qualification process, the system publishes the supplier's status for consumption in other areas such as sourcing events, contract workspaces, or guided buying. If the process has an expiration schedule, that schedule starts.
 11. (Optional) After the status is first set, process decision-makers can change it, and can edit the intake form when changing a status decision. For example, if a process is approved but an important questionnaire in the process has expired without an update, a decision-maker can change the status to conditionally approved or denied and change the expiration schedule.
 12. (Optional) A process initiator [renews the process \[page 214\]](#). Renewal can occur at any time once a process has a final status, but typical reasons include:
 - The process is expiring or has expired.
 - The process itself hasn't expired, but conditions in underlying questionnaires, such as expiration or denial of update to a critical questionnaire, warrant a systematic re-evaluation rather than a simple status change.
 13. (Optional) A process initiator [discontinues the process \[page 205\]](#).
Currently, only qualification processes can be discontinued. The qualification process to be discontinued must be in the approved or conditionally approved status.
The process initiator can cancel an ongoing discontinuation process or renew a discontinued supplier management process in the supplier's profile. The decision-maker can make a decision for a discontinuation process in the supplier's profile. The administrator in the buyer organization can perform all these operations through data import tasks.

Creating a Qualification or Miscellaneous Supplier Management Process Project

Use these steps to create a qualification or miscellaneous process project to evaluate a supplier for a specific combination of commodities, regions, and departments based on information in modular questionnaires.

Prerequisites

The process project feature (SM-16798) must be enabled in your site.

To create a qualification or miscellaneous process project, you must be a member of both the **SM Modular Questionnaire Manager** global user group and a project group with the **Process Initiator** role in the process project template.

If the supplier doesn't have a registration status of **Registered**, you can only create a qualification process for them if an administrator has enabled the self-service configuration parameter **Application.SM.Process.AllowStartOfProcessQualificationForUnRegisteredSuppliers** ► **SM Administration** ► **Configuration Parameters** ► in your site. You can always start a miscellaneous processes for a supplier regardless of their registration status.

You can't request an update for a questionnaire during process project creation if the questionnaire is in **Pending Submission** or **Pending Approval** status.

To add, edit, or delete a supplier contact in a supplier's profile or when inviting a supplier to a questionnaire, you must be a member of one of the following groups:

- **Supplier Registration Manager**
- **SM Ops Administrator**
- **Customer Administrator**
- **Category Manager**
- **Commodity Manager**
- **Event Administrator**
- **Limited Event Administrator**
- **Sourcing Project Administrator**
- **Supplier Project Administrator**
- **Supplier/Customer Manager**
- **Supplier/Customer Agent**

Members of the **Supplier Qualification Manager** group can add, but not edit or delete, supplier contacts in the supplier's profile and when inviting a supplier to a questionnaire.

Context

Depending on how your organization uses process projects, you can create a qualification or miscellaneous lifecycle process:

- Qualification process projects are tied to the SAP Ariba qualification lifecycle stage. You create a qualification process project in either the **Qualifications** or **Processes** detail area of the supplier profile.
- Miscellaneous process projects aren't tied to a specific SAP Ariba lifecycle stage. Your organization can use them to define processes that meet your organization's particular business requirements. You create a miscellaneous process project in the **Processes** detail area of the supplier profile.

A process project is always based on a combination of commodities, regions, and departments. A supplier can only have one process of each process type for each unique combination. Commodities, regions, and departments are hierarchical, with higher and lower levels structured in parent-child relationships. You can create multiple process projects with the same process type for combinations that include parents or children of the commodities, regions, and departments used in an existing process.

For example, if a supplier has an existing qualification process for equipment in the United States for the manufacturing department, you can't create another qualification process project for that exact combination. However, you can create a separate qualification process project for equipment in Florida for the manufacturing department (one level lower in the region hierarchy), or equipment in North America for the manufacturing department (one level higher in the region department), or laboratory equipment in Germany for the manufacturing department (one level lower in the commodity hierarchy and a different branch of the region hierarchy).

The commodities, regions, and departments you specify in the process intake form determine which modular questionnaires the process project uses to gather information from internal or external recipients.

If the type of process project you're creating can expire, the intake form includes questions that set an expiration schedule for the process. If these questions are required, the process always expires at the frequency you set in

the schedule. If they're optional, the process only expires if you set an expiration schedule. If your process intake form includes questions about an expiration schedule, it can also include questions that set an expiration reminder schedule. The expiration reminder schedule determines when the process automatically moves to expiring status and sends notifications to suppliers and internal process stakeholders.

The templates for the modular questionnaires included in a process project determine whether they can be reused in multiple process projects for the same supplier, or whether each new process project requires a separate, new questionnaire for the supplier. If the process includes reusable questionnaires that have already been assigned to suppliers or internal recipients, you have the option of requesting updates to those questionnaires for your new process.

Procedure

1. In the **Qualifications** or **Processes** detail area of the supplier's profile, choose the add icon (+).
2. On the **Process type** menu, choose the type of process you want to create.
3. In the process intake form, enter the following information:
 - Answers to any available questions about the commodities, regions, and departments to which the process applies. This information determines which modular questionnaires the process project uses to gather information from external and internal recipients. If the question is optional and you leave it blank, the answer defaults to "All."

Note

Matrix values (commodities, regions, departments, and material) in modular questionnaires are prepopulated with entries from the intake form when process initiators create a qualification or miscellaneous supplier management process. This behavior also holds true when process initiators create a qualification or miscellaneous process for several suppliers at a time.

- An expiration schedule and an expiration reminder schedule, if available. Both schedules are defined by a set of two questions, one for frequency and one for offset, which combine to create the schedule. For example, an expiration frequency of months and an expiration offset of 6 means that the process expires 6 months after its decision is made. An expiration reminder frequency of months and an expiration reminder offset of 5 means that the process generates expiration reminder notifications and moves to expiring status 5 months after the decision and 1 month before the scheduled expiration.
- Any other questions included in the intake form.

The following image shows an example of a process intake form:

Create or renew qualification process

Supplier

Supplier ABC
Vendor ID
S20963434

Process Type *

Full Qualification

Geographical Area: *

Categories Supplied: *

Business Unit: *

Validity from approval date (time): *

Years

Validity from approval date (value): *

Expiration reminder (time): *

Months

Validity from approval date (value): *

Next Cancel

Note

You can only proceed to the next step if you're a process initiator for the type of process you selected and there's no existing process of the same type for the combination of commodities, regions, and departments you've selected.

If there's an existing process for the same type with the same combination, a popup lets you know you can't create a duplicate. If you left a commodity, region, or department answer blank, it shows as **null** in this popup and **All** (the default value for blank answers) in all other process pages.

4. Choose **Next**.
5. Choose questionnaires to include in the process by performing the following actions:
 - a. In the **Add new questionnaires** area, choose the new questionnaires you want to include in the process. Required questionnaires are automatically checked and you can't uncheck them.
 - b. **Optional:** If the questionnaire has already been assigned and is reusable, perform any of the following actions in the **Reuse existing questionnaires** area:
 - Choose the questionnaires to reuse it in the new process.

- Slide the toggle switch to request an update as part of the new process. If the questionnaire has been set up to always request updates, you can't change this setting.
6. Choose **Next**.
 7. **Optional:** Change the recipient of any external questionnaires from the default primary contact by performing the following steps:
 - a. Choose **Change recipient**.
 - b. **Optional:** If the recipient you want isn't listed as an existing contact and you have permission to create contacts, you can [add them here \[page 54\]](#).
 - c. Choose the recipient that you want to use and choose **Save**.

The default recipient for external questionnaires is the supplier's primary contact.

If the supplier already has a process for the same type with the same combination, a popup lets you know that the process you're creating already exists.
 8. **Optional:** Change the recipient of any internal questionnaires from the default recipient by performing the following steps:
 - a. To the right of the questionnaire, choose **Change recipient**.
 - b. **Optional:** If the recipient you want isn't listed, search for them.
 - c. Choose the recipient that you want to use.

The default recipient for internal questionnaires is the process initiator who creates the process project and becomes its owner.
 9. **Optional:** Enter an optional message to internal and external questionnaire recipients. This message is included in the email notifications that recipients receive asking them to complete the questionnaires.
 10. Choose **Send**.
 11. Choose **OK** to confirm that you want to create the process project.

Results

Choosing **OK** creates the process project itself. It also creates projects for any modular questionnaires that are either newly assigned or that aren't reusable.

The primary contact for the supplier receives a notification that you've started the process with them. The notification includes the names of any included external questionnaires and their recipients.

The recipients of new internal and external questionnaires also receive notifications inviting them to fill them out, and the recipients of existing internal and external questionnaires for which you've requested updates receive notifications with those requests.

The newly created process project shows on the **Processes** detail area of the supplier's profile. If the newly created process is a qualification process, it also shows in the **Qualifications** detail area.

All questionnaires included in the process project show in the **Questionnaires** area, where approvers and task owners can review them and complete their assigned tasks.

Related Information

[Filling Out an Internal Questionnaire for a Supplier Management Process \[page 207\]](#)

[Making a Status Decision for a Supplier Management Process \[page 220\]](#)

[Canceling a Qualification or Other Process in the Supplier's Profile \[page 212\]](#)

[Renewing a Qualification or Other Supplier Management Process \[page 216\]](#)

[Requesting an Update or Changing the Recipient for a Modular Questionnaire \[page 240\]](#)

Creating a Qualification or Miscellaneous Supplier Management Process for Multiple Suppliers at One Time

Use these steps to create qualification and miscellaneous processes for one or more suppliers at a time to evaluate them for a specific combination of commodities, regions, and departments based on information in modular questionnaires.

Prerequisites

The process project feature (SM-16798) must be enabled and configured in your site.

To create or renew a process qualification, you must be a member of both the **SM Modular Questionnaire Manager** global user group and a project group with the **Process Initiator** role in the process project template.

If a supplier doesn't have a registration status of **Registered**, you can only create a qualification process for them if an administrator has enabled the self-service configuration parameter

Application.SM.Process.AllowStartOfProcessQualificationForUnRegisteredSuppliers ► **SM Administration**

► **Configuration Parameters** ► in your site. You can always start a miscellaneous processes for a supplier regardless of their registration status.

Procedure

1. On the dashboard, choose ► **Manage** ► **SM Process Flow** ►.

A page with a list of all the processes that are sent to one or more suppliers is displayed. The table displays the following columns:

Column Header	Description
Process Type/ID	Process Type indicates the type of process, and ID indicates the background job ID that is created for this bulk process creation (for multiple suppliers).

Column Header	Description
Status	The status of the job. The Status field can take values such as Completed, In Progress, Failed, Partially Completed and so on.  Note This status is for the background job, not the process creation status.
Supplier Count	The number of suppliers the process creation was initiated for. Clicking the blue number that appears as a hyperlink in the Supplier Count column opens a popup that displays the process creation status for each supplier. Clicking the view icon () opens the process detail page.  Note The View icon is made available only when the process creation status shows Completed. For other statuses such as In Progress, Failed and so on, the View icon isn't displayed in that row.
Process Owner	The internal user that initiated the process creation for multiple suppliers.
Creation Date	The date on which the process creation job for multiple suppliers was created.

- In the **Processes** area, choose the add icon (+).
- On the **Process type** menu, select the type of process you want to create.
- In the process intake form, enter the following information:
 - Answers to any available questions about the commodities, regions, and departments to which the process applies. This information determines which modular questionnaires the process project uses to gather information from external and internal recipients. If the question is optional and you leave it blank, the answer defaults to "All."

Note

Matrix values (commodities, regions, departments, and material) in modular questionnaires are prepopulated with entries from the intake form when process initiators create a qualification or miscellaneous supplier management process. This behavior also holds true when process initiators create a qualification or miscellaneous process for a single supplier.

- An expiration schedule and an expiration reminder schedule, if available. Both schedules are defined by a set of two questions, one for frequency and one for offset, which combine to create the schedule. For example, an expiration frequency of months and an expiration offset of 6 means that the process expires 6 months after its decision is made. An expiration reminder frequency of months and an expiration reminder offset of 5 means that the process generates expiration reminder notifications and moves to expiring status 5 months after the decision and 1 month before the scheduled expiration.
- Any other questions included in the intake form.

You can only proceed to the next step if you're a process initiator for the type of process you selected.

- Choose **Next**.
- Choose questionnaires to include in the process. In the **Add new questionnaires** area, choose the new questionnaires you want to include in the process. Required questionnaires are automatically checked and you can't uncheck them.

7. Choose **Next**.
8. Select the suppliers that you wish to create the process for.
9. Choose **Next**.
10. **Optional:** Verify if the default supplier contacts are the contacts you want to send the questionnaires to. If not, change the recipient of any internal questionnaires from the default recipient by performing the following steps:
 - a. To the right of the questionnaire, choose **Change contact**.

You can choose only one supplier contact as the recipient. All the external questionnaires for a supplier are sent to the same supplier contact. You can't choose different supplier contacts for the same supplier for different external questionnaires.
 - b. **Optional:** If a supplier has no contact selected, process creation for that supplier is skipped. You must add a contact for all the selected suppliers. If the recipient you want isn't listed, see [Adding a Supplier Contact as a Questionnaire Recipient \[page 54\]](#).
 - c. Choose **Next**.
11. **Optional:** Review your choices. Enter an optional message to internal and external questionnaire recipients. This message is included in the email notifications that recipients receive asking them to complete the questionnaires.

The default recipient for internal questionnaires is the process initiator who creates the process project and becomes its owner.
12. Choose **Send**.
13. Choose **OK** to confirm that you want to create the process project.

If the process you're creating already exists for any of the chosen suppliers, a popup lets you know that suppliers with duplicate processes that are either a partial match or not in final state will be excluded. A match can either be partial or exact:

 - Exact match: If the supplier has an existing process for the same type with the same commodity, region, and (optionally) department combination.
 - Partial match: If the supplier has an existing process for the same type with a partially matching combination.

If any of the chosen suppliers already have a process that is an exact match and in final state, you can choose to either renew the process or exclude those suppliers from the list.
14. Click **Submit**.

Results

The primary contact (or other supplier contact that you selected) receives a notification that you've started the process with them. The notification includes the names of any included external questionnaires and their recipients.

The recipients of new internal and external questionnaires receive notifications inviting them to fill them out. However, if you're sending an existing modular questionnaire that can be reused to the same supplier through a mass process, then:

- If the status of the modular questionnaire is **Approved**, it changes to **Not Responded**.
- If the status of the modular questionnaire is any status other than **Approved**, the status remains as is.

The newly created process project shows on the **Processes** detail area of the supplier's profile. If the newly created process is a qualification process, it also shows in the **Qualifications** detail area.

All questionnaires included in the process project show in the **Questionnaires** detail area, where approvers and task owners can review them and complete their assigned tasks.

Discontinuing a Qualification Process

Use these steps to discontinue an existing qualification process when a supplier no longer meets the standards or requirements of your organization. Discontinuing a qualification process is a disqualification.

Prerequisites

- You must be a member of both the **SM Modular Questionnaire Manager** global user group and the **Process Initiator** group of the existing qualification process to be discontinued.
- The qualification process to be discontinued must be in the approved or conditionally approved status. You can't discontinue a denied or in progress qualification process.

Context

📘 Note

Discontinuation processes are designed to be internal processes that only involve people in your organization. Choosing external modular questionnaires for a discontinuation process notifies the supplier of the discontinuation when they receive invitations or other notifications for included external modular questionnaires.

You can fully or partially discontinue an existing qualification process depending on the commodity, region, and department combination you choose when starting a discontinuation process:

- To fully discontinue a qualification process, don't change the prefilled combination of categories, regions, and departments.
- To partially discontinue a qualification process, you can choose the subset combination of prefilled categories, regions, and departments.

When creating a discontinuation process, keep the following points in mind:

- You can only create one discontinuation process with the same category, region, and department combination.
- After starting a partial discontinuation for an existing qualification process, you can still fully discontinue the existing qualification process. After the full discontinuation, the partial discontinuation isn't affected.
- For two existing qualification processes with the parent-child relationship, if you start a discontinuation process having the child relationship with both two processes, this discontinuation process is nested under its parent, not the grandparent, regardless of under which qualification process you create the discontinuation process.

- After starting a discontinuation process, you can't create a qualification process with the same categories, regions, and departments used in the discontinuation process.

If the intake form asks for an expiration schedule and expiration reminder schedule and you answer these questions, the discontinuation process expires at the time you set. The process then automatically moves to expiring status and sends notifications to contacts before the discontinuation expires. After the discontinuation process expires, the process status changes to expired. Expired discontinuation processes can be renewed. Renewing a discontinuation process creates a new qualification process with the same categories, regions, and departments used in the discontinuation process.

Procedure

1. In the **Qualifications** or **Processes** detail area of the supplier's profile, choose the more option icon (•••) >  **Discontinue**.

The intake form opens. Some questions can be prefilled with answers that are inherited from the existing qualification process.

2. Answer questions in the intake form.

In addition to the partial or full discontinuation, the commodities, regions, and departments you specify in the process intake form also determine which modular questionnaires the discontinuation process uses to gather information from recipients.

In addition to the discontinuation, the commodities, regions, and departments you specify in the process intake form also determine which modular questionnaires the discontinuation process uses to gather information from recipients.

3. Choose questionnaires to include in the discontinuation process by performing the following actions:
 - a. In the **Add new questionnaires** area, choose the new questionnaires you want to include in the process. Required questionnaires are automatically checked and you can't uncheck them.
 - b. **Optional:** If the questionnaire has already been assigned and is reusable, perform any of the following actions in the **Reuse existing questionnaires** area:
 - Choose the questionnaires to reuse in the new process.
 - Slide the toggle switch to request an update as part of the new process. If the questionnaire has been set up to always request updates, you can't change this setting.
4. Change the recipient of any internal questionnaires from the default recipient by performing the following steps:
 - a. To the right of the questionnaire, choose **Change recipient**.
 - b. **Optional:** If the recipient you want isn't listed, search for them.
 - c. Choose the recipient that you want to use.

The default recipient for internal questionnaires is the process initiator who creates the qualification process being discontinued. The default recipient becomes the discontinuation process owner.

5. Enter an optional message to questionnaire recipients. This message is included in the email notifications that recipients receive asking them to complete the questionnaires.
6. Click **Send**.
7. Choose **OK** to confirm that you want to create the discontinuation process.

Results

Discontinuation Characteristic	Result
Partial discontinuation	The existing qualification process remains in the fully approved status. A new discontinuation process is created in red and nested under the existing qualification process. The newly created discontinuation process status is "in progress".
Full discontinuation.	The qualification process changes to a discontinuation process and displays in red. The status changes from "fully approved" to "in progress".

The recipients of new questionnaires also receive notifications inviting them to fill them out, and the recipients of existing questionnaires for which you've requested updates receive notifications with those requests.

All questionnaires included in the process project show in the **Questionnaires** detail area, where approvers and task owners can review them and complete their assigned tasks.

Related Information

[Filling Out an Internal Questionnaire for a Supplier Management Process \[page 207\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a Modular Questionnaire in a Process Project \[page 209\]](#)

Filling Out an Internal Questionnaire for a Supplier Management Process

If you're the recipient of an internal questionnaire in a supplier management process, follow these steps to either fill it out and submit it or specify a different recipient so that the process can be completed.

Prerequisites

To fill out an internal modular questionnaire, you must be its current recipient.

The process project feature (SM-16798) must be enabled in your site.

Context

You can receive a request to fill out an internal questionnaire for a new process, or during the renewal of an existing process. The process can be a qualification process, in which case the renewal is a requalification, or it can be a miscellaneous process.

If you're the first recipient for the questionnaire, you fill it out and submit it for the first time.

If you're the recipient of an existing questionnaire for which there's an update request, either you're the original recipient of the questionnaire or the process owner has reassigned the questionnaire to you for an update. In either case, you edit any existing answers that require an update and resubmit the questionnaire. When updating an existing questionnaire, you can see its version history.

If the feature for internal forms in modular questionnaire projects (SM-30222) is enabled in your site, modular questionnaire projects can also include one or more internal forms. If you're the recipient of an internal questionnaire, you fill out and submit the key questionnaire in the project. To edit internal forms, see [Filling out an Internal Form in a Modular Questionnaire Project \[page 246\]](#).

Procedure

1. Perform one of the following actions:
 - Choose the link in the email notification informing you that you're the questionnaire recipient.
 - Navigate to the **Questionnaires** detail area of the supplier's profile and open the questionnaire.
2. Choose **Edit** and fill out the questionnaire as needed.
3. Choose **Save** to save your responses in draft mode, and return later to complete and submit them. Saved draft versions aren't versioned, and only the most recent changes are included. An upgraded template for an internal questionnaire retains draft responses even after it has been upgraded.

Choosing the **Cancel** option in the **Edit** page opens a dialog box named **Cancel questionnaire**. If you choose **Confirm** in the dialog box, you lose all unsaved changes and be redirected to the previous page. If you choose **Cancel** in the dialog box, you stay on the same page and can continue updating the questionnaire.

By default, only the process owner can edit internal questionnaires and save them as drafts. However, the process owner can request an update from a different recipient and invite them to update the questionnaire. The new recipient can see the responses saved previously and can provide their own responses. The new recipient can also overwrite previous responses if necessary, and save the draft again.

4. Choose **Submit**.

Results

If there's an approval flow for the questionnaire, submitting it generates notifications letting approvers know that they must review your answers and approve or deny the questionnaire.

Related Information

[Qualification and Miscellaneous Supplier Management Process Projects \[page 188\]](#)

[About the Questionnaires Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 232\]](#)

[Comparing Different Versions of a Supplier Management Questionnaire \[page 258\]](#)

[Filling out an Internal Form in a Modular Questionnaire Project \[page 246\]](#)

[Requesting an Update or Changing the Recipient for a Modular Questionnaire \[page 240\]](#)

Approving or Denying a Modular Questionnaire in a Process Project

If you're an approver for a modular questionnaire that is included in a process, use these steps to complete your assigned approval. Qualification and other process projects use modular questionnaires to collect information that's relevant to the process. Your approval decision can affect the final approval, denial, or conditional approval of the process.

Prerequisites

The process project feature (SM-16798) must be enabled in your site.

Context

Process projects can include modular questionnaires submitted by either the supplier or an internal recipient in your organization. A supplier can have multiple processes that include the same questionnaire. The questionnaire's setup determines whether or not it's reused in different processes for the same supplier:

Reused?	Description
Yes	The same modular questionnaire project is reused in every process for which it is included. Once you approve or deny the questionnaire, your current approval decision continues to apply in all of those processes until one of the following situations occurs: • A process initiator requests an update when creating another process that includes the questionnaire. • A process owner requests an update when renewing the current process. • The questionnaire is expiring or has expired. • The recipient decides to independently update the questionnaire.

Reused?	Description
No	A new modular questionnaire project is created for every process in which it's included. You approve or deny each of these independent questionnaires separately.

New modular questionnaire projects have an approval flow defined by your organization. Depending on how a modular questionnaire is set up, updates to the questionnaire can have the same approval flow, a different approval flow, or can be approved automatically.

If you're approving an update to a modular questionnaire, or if you've requested more information from the recipient during approval, the approval task details page shows the answers of both the current version in approval and previous versions so that you can compare them.

If the feature for internal forms in modular questionnaire projects (SM-30222) is enabled in your site, modular questionnaire projects can include one or more internal forms in addition to the main or key questionnaire submitted by the supplier. Approval or denial of the key questionnaire is typically the last step in the workflow for the modular questionnaire project. For information on approving internal forms, refer to [Approving or Denying an Internal Form in a Modular Questionnaire Project \[page 248\]](#).

Note

When a questionnaire only has one approval task on it and that task is active, the process details page shows an action icon () that provides a shortcut to the task's details. You don't have to be an approver to see and use this shortcut. However, only approvers in the currently active approval node see the **Approve**, **Deny**, and **Request Additional Info** buttons on the task details page.

Procedure

1. Perform one of the following actions:
 - Choose the link in the notification email.
 - Navigate to the **Processes** or (for qualification processes) **Qualifications** detail area of the supplier's profile, then locate and view the process. Act on the approval task directly from the process details page if that option is available. Otherwise, view the questionnaire and act on the task from there.

The approval task details page opens.

2. Review the questionnaire answers. If you're approving an update, to display only the questions with updated answers, choose **Updated**. To display all answers, choose **All**.
3. **Optional:** If you're approving an update, to compare the current answers with versions of the questionnaire that the recipient submitted before the previous version, choose the version number in the **Previous Version** column and select the version.

The **Previous Version** column displays answers from the selected version. The **Latest Version** column continues to show answers from the current update.

4. Perform one of the following actions:
 - To approve the questionnaire, choose **Approve**, enter an optional comment, and choose **Approve**.
 - To deny the questionnaire, choose **Deny**, enter an explanatory comment, and choose **Deny**.

- To request additional information from the respondent, click **Request Additional Info**, enter a comment explaining what information you want, and click **Request Additional Info**.

Results

For new questionnaire projects, if you're the final approver, the modular questionnaire project status is now **Approved** or **Denied** and the recipient is notified of that status by email. If not, the modular questionnaire project remains in **Pending Approval** status until the final approval or denial. If you're the final approver and you approve a questionnaire that allows updates, it reopens so that the recipient can update it. Any internal forms not associated with To Do tasks in an update phase also become editable again. If you deny the questionnaire, the project closes permanently. The supplier can't update the external questionnaire and internal forms editors can't update internal forms.

If your approval moved the questionnaire to either **Approved** or **Denied** status, that status can affect the processes in which the questionnaire is included in one of the following ways:

- If process decision-makers in your organization decide the final status of the process manually, they evaluate the statuses of a process's modular questionnaires when setting the process's final status.
- If the process type is set up to generate an automatic status decision, that decision is always based on the statuses of the process's questionnaires.

If you requested additional information during approval of an external questionnaire and entered a comment, the supplier sees the most recent approval comment when they revise their response to the questionnaire.

Any comments that you or other approvers added during approval show on the questionnaire and approval task details pages, which you can see by choosing  (view) next to the questionnaire or task name. The questionnaire details page shows all comments for all tasks in the current phase of the modular questionnaire project, including approval or To Do tasks for both the key questionnaire and any internal forms. Task details pages show only the comments associated with the current task.

Related Information

[Qualification and Miscellaneous Supplier Management Process Projects \[page 188\]](#)

Canceling a Qualification or Other Process in the Supplier's Profile

Use these steps to cancel a qualification or other supplier management process that's in progress so that you can create a new process or process renewal for the same combination of commodities, regions, and departments. Canceling an in-progress process removes or reverts it.

Prerequisites

In the supplier's profile, you can only cancel a new process or process renewal that is in progress. Once a decision has been made for the process or process renewal and it has an approved, conditionally approved, or denied status, you can't cancel it. An administrator in your organization can cancel processes for which decisions have been made using data import.

To cancel a process associated with a project, you must be the project owner. For processes created through data import, you can cancel them if you have the necessary permissions to view the supplier profile.

The process project feature (SM-16798) must be enabled in your site.

Context

A supplier can only have one process of each process type for a specific combination of commodities, regions, and departments. Canceling a new, in-progress process allows you to remove it from the supplier so that a process initiator can create a new process of that type with the same combination. For example, if a template creator in your organization has updated the process project template, you can cancel an in-progress process to create a new one that uses the new version of the template. Or if a process project stalled out or was abandoned while it was in progress, you can cancel it to start fresh with a new one.

Canceling a process renewal that is in progress reverts the process to the state (questionnaire and intake form content, expiration schedule) and status it had before the renewal started, and can be used for the same purposes.

Processes can be based on a process project, or they can be created using a data import. If the process is based on a project and is new, canceling it also cancels any modular questionnaires included in the process that meet cancellation criteria. If the process is based on a project and has a renewal in progress, canceling the renewal also cancels any modular questionnaires added during the current renewal that meet cancellation criteria.

Modular questionnaires are canceled during process cancellation under the following circumstances:

When the modular questionnaire is...	Is it canceled?
- Approved and reusable, whether or not it's currently reused in other processes. - Not yet approved, but is included in more than 1 process project for the supplier. - Only included in the current process or process renewal for the supplier, but has an update that's pending approval.	No

When the modular questionnaire is...	Is it canceled?
- In the new questionnaire phase, hasn't yet been approved, and is only included in the current process or process renewal for the supplier. - Is approved but isn't reusable.	Yes

⚠ Caution

Cancellation of a process or process renewal that includes an approved, single-use questionnaire results in cancellation of and loss of approved data in that questionnaire. Make sure to identify any questionnaires that meet this criteria and decide whether the data loss is acceptable before proceeding with the cancellation.

If a process is based on a data import, there are no modular questionnaires associated with it.

Procedure

1. In the **Qualifications** or **Processes** detail area of the supplier's profile, locate the process you want to cancel.
2. Choose more options (...) **Cancel**.
3. **Required:** Enter an internal comment to let the other people in your organization who are associated with the process project know why you're canceling it. This comment is required, but is only used if the process you're canceling is based on a project.
4. **Optional:** Enter an external comment to let the supplier know why you're canceling the process. This comment is only used if the process you're canceling is based on a project.
5. Choose **Confirm**.

Results

If the canceled process was a new project or was based on a data import, it's removed from the supplier and no longer shows in their profile. You can no longer see the project in search results for project searches on the **Home** dashboard. On the **Supplier Management** dashboard, you can no longer search for the supplier by filtering on their process status for the associated combination of commodities, regions, and departments.

If the canceled process was in renewal, it reverts to its previous state (questionnaire and intake form content, expiration schedule) and status from before the renewal started.

If the process was based on a project:

- Any associated modular questionnaires that meet the criteria for cancellation are also canceled. Canceled modular questionnaires no longer show in the **Questionnaires** detail area of the supplier's profile or in project search results on the **Home** dashboard. If a canceled modular questionnaire is in approval, the approval is withdrawn and approvers receive notifications letting them know that they no longer need to complete the approvals.

- The system generates the following notifications to various people involved in the process project:

Modular Questionnaire State	Process State	Email Notifications	Notification Recipients
Not sent yet	In progress	Not sent	N/A
Sent, but invited contacts haven't responded to any questionnaires	In progress	Process-level notification of cancellation	Invited supplier contacts and process project owner
The supplier has submitted at least one questionnaire, which is in approval	In progress	Process-level notification of cancellation	Invited supplier contacts and process project owner
		Notification of withdrawn approval task for specific questionnaire	Modular questionnaire approvers
The supplier has submitted questionnaires and approval process is completed	Pending decision	Process-level notification of cancellation	Invited supplier contacts, process project owner, members of project groups with the Decision Maker role.

If the process you canceled was the only process qualification currently in progress for the supplier, and the supplier has other qualification processes that are approved, the supplier's overall qualification status reverts from **Qualified for Some** to **Qualified**.

Related Information

[Qualification and Miscellaneous Supplier Management Process Projects \[page 188\]](#)

[Supplier Process Projects Import File Format](#)

[Use of the Supplier Data API with Pagination processCancellationRequest Endpoint](#)

Workflow for Renewing a Qualification or Other Supplier Management Process

Process initiators renew a process by updating questions on its intake form, selecting additional questionnaires to include, and deciding whether to request updates for existing questionnaires. For qualification processes, a renewal is a requalification.

1. In a supplier's profile, a process initiator selects an existing process to renew.
2. The system loads the intake form from the currently published version of the process project template and populates it with existing answers.
3. The process initiator edits the intake form as needed. They can't change the process's commodities, regions, or departments during renewal, but can edit other answers, such as answers that set the expiration schedule and expiration reminder schedule.
4. A renewed process always includes all previously added questionnaires. The system uses the following criteria to determine the list of additional modular questionnaires applicable to the renewed process project:

1. Questionnaire type: modular questionnaires with types references by the process project template are potentially applicable, including questionnaire types added to the process project template since the process was first created.
2. Commodity, region, and department: among the potentially applicable modular questionnaires with matching types, the ones with commodities, regions, and departments that match the selections in the process intake form are applicable to the process project.
5. The process initiator selects any additional questionnaires to include in the process project renewal. Their options in this step are controlled by settings in the modular questionnaire templates, and can include:
 - Adding optional questionnaires. Required questionnaires are automatically included.
 - Requesting updates for any reused questionnaires that require an update for the process renewal. A setting in the modular questionnaire template determines whether this option is available to the process initiator in this step or whether the questionnaire automatically generates update requests.
6. The process initiator changes the recipients of the questionnaires as needed and sends them.
7. The system:
 - Creates any new modular questionnaires included in the process and invites their recipients to submit them. New questionnaires can include questionnaires that are entirely new for the supplier or questionnaires that require a new questionnaire project for each process.
 - Sends update requests to recipients of any reused questionnaires for which that option is either automatically or manually selected.
8. Internal recipients receive invitations to new internal questionnaires or requests to update reused internal questionnaires and submit their responses in the supplier's 360° profile.
9. External recipients receive invitations to new external questionnaires or requests to update reused external questionnaires. They create a new supplier account, create a new supplier user account, or sign into an existing supplier user account as necessary on SAP Business Network and submit their responses.
10. Approvers for the modular questionnaire projects approve, deny, or request additional information for the questionnaires or questionnaire updates. If they requested additional information, they then approve or deny the edited questionnaires.
11. Completion of the final included questionnaire that isn't already completed starts the decision-making phase of the renewal, which occurs in one of the following two ways, depending on the project's configuration:
 - The system automatically sets a final status for the process renewal following rules based on the statuses of the process's questionnaires. For example, a process can have a rule that automatically sets its final status to approved if all of its questionnaires are approved.
 - A process decision-maker manually sets a final status for the process renewal after evaluating its questionnaires. The decision-maker can optionally edit the intake form while setting the status.
12. If the process is a qualification process, the system publishes the supplier's updated status for consumption in other areas such as sourcing events, contract workspaces, or guided buying. If the process has an expiration schedule, that schedule restarts from the beginning.

Renewing a Qualification or Other Supplier Management Process

Follow these steps to renew a qualification or other supplier management process. Renewing a process allows you to gather updated information about it and potentially revise an earlier decision, including restarting an expired or denied process. For qualification processes, renewing means requalifying the supplier.

Prerequisites

To renew a process, you must be a member of both the **SM Modular Questionnaire Manager** global user group and a project group with the **Process Initiator** role in the associated process project template.

You can't renew a process that's in progress. You can only renew a process that has a status corresponding to a decision (approved, conditionally approved, or denied) or that's expiring or has expired.

To request an update while the questionnaire is in **Pending Submission** or **Pending Approval** status, you must enable the parameter **Application.SM.AllowRequestUpdateOnPendingModularQuestionnaireStatuses**. For more information, see [Allow request update on pending modular questionnaire statuses \[page 285\]](#).

The process project feature (SM-16798) must be enabled in your site.

To add, edit, or delete a supplier contact in a supplier's profile or when inviting a supplier to a questionnaire, you must be a member of one of the following groups:

- **Supplier Registration Manager**
- **SM Ops Administrator**
- **Customer Administrator**
- **Category Manager**
- **Commodity Manager**
- **Event Administrator**
- **Limited Event Administrator**
- **Sourcing Project Administrator**
- **Supplier Project Administrator**
- **Supplier/Customer Manager**
- **Supplier/Customer Agent**

Members of the **Supplier Qualification Manager** group can add, but not edit or delete, supplier contacts in the supplier's profile and when inviting a supplier to a questionnaire.

Context

Process renewals always use exactly the same commodities, regions, and departments as the previous process. A process renewal can be based on a previous process achieved through either of the following methods:

- **An imported process status.** In this case, the renewal creates a new process project for the commodities, regions, and departments associated with the imported status. Since imported processes don't have any associated questionnaires, renewing the process means selecting the modular questionnaires to include for

the first time. You can also set expiration and expiration reminder schedules for the first time, if they're available.

- **A previous process project.** In this case, the renewal restarts the previous process project. The project already includes the modular questionnaires selected when the process project was first created, and you can change recipients and request updates as part of the renewal. If there are optional questionnaires available for the process, you can choose whether or not to include them in the renewal. You can also set a new reminder and expiration reminder schedule for the process, if they're available.

Since process renewals allow you to resend questionnaires, you can use them to collect updated information. Decision-makers can use those updates to reassess the previous process decision, or they can leave the previous decision in place.

The renewal always includes any questionnaires previously included in the process. You can also add other questionnaires that either were available but weren't previously included or that have been added since the previous process was completed and match the process's criteria.

Procedure

1. In the **Qualifications** or **Processes** detail area of the supplier's profile, choose *** (more options) >  **Renew**.
2. In the process intake form, update any of the following information:
 - The expiration schedule and an expiration reminder schedule, if available. Both schedules are defined by a set of two questions, one for frequency and 1 month for offset, which combine to create the schedule. For example, an expiration frequency of months and an expiration offset of 6 means that the process expires 6 months after its decision is made. An expiration reminder frequency of months and an expiration reminder offset of 5 means that the process generates expiration reminder notifications and moves to expiring status 5 months after the decision and one before the scheduled expiration.
 - Any other questions included in the intake form.

Note

For renewals, you can't edit the commodity, region, or department questions on the intake form. A renewal is always for the same commodities, regions, and departments as the original process.

3. Choose **Next**.
4. In the **Choose questionnaires** area, perform the following actions:
 - Select any additional questionnaires that you want to include in the renewal.
 - Uncheck any questionnaires that were included in the previous process, but that you don't want to include in the renewal.
 - For reused questionnaires, slide the toggle switch to request an update during the renewal. If the questionnaire has been set up to always request updates, you can't change this setting.

Questionnaires included in the previous process and required questionnaires are selected by default. You can't uncheck required questionnaires.

5. Choose **Next**.
6. **Optional:** Change the recipient of any external questionnaires by performing the following steps:
 - a. Choose **Change recipient**.
 - b. **Optional:** If the recipient you want isn't listed as an existing contact and you have permission to create supplier contacts, you can [add them here \[page 54\]](#).

- c. Select the recipient that you want to use and choose **Save**.
7. **Optional:** Select or change the recipients for any internal questionnaires by performing the following steps:
 - a. To the right of the questionnaire, choose **Change recipient**.
 - b. If the recipient you want isn't listed, search for them.
 - c. Select the recipient that you want to use.
8. **Optional:** Enter a message to internal and external questionnaire recipients. This message is included in the email notifications that recipients receive asking them to complete the questionnaires.
9. Choose **Send**.
10. Choose **OK** to confirm the renewal.

Results

Choosing **OK** returns the process to in progress status and creates projects for any modular questionnaires that you added.

The primary contact for the supplier receives a notification that you've started the process with them. The notification includes the names of any includes external questionnaires and their recipients.

The recipients of new internal and external questionnaires also receive notifications inviting them to fill them out, and the recipients of existing internal and external questionnaires for which you requested updates receive notifications with those requests.

All questionnaires included in the process project show in the **Questionnaires** detail area, where approvers and task owners can review them and complete their assigned tasks.

Since the process is now in progress again, it can be cancelled. Canceling a process renewal returns it to its previous state and status.

At a later point in time, if there are multiple versions of the process intake form in the system, you can export any version to Microsoft Excel. Open the intake form in the supplier's 360° profile, select the desired version in the upper right corner, and choose **Export**.

Supplier qualification renewals (requalifications) have the following impact on the supplier's qualification status:

Previous qualification process status	Renewal state	Process status in the user interface	Qualification status in supplier search, sourcing events, and contract workspaces
Qualified	In progress	Label for in progress process	In progress
			 Note SAP Ariba recommends enabling the configuration parameter Application.SM.Process.EnablePublishQualificationStatusDuringRenewal to ensure that the status of a process is changed to "In Progress" when it's renewed. An administrator can enable this parameter in Manage > SM Administration > Configuration Parameters. See Reference of Configuration Parameters in Supplier Administration [page 318].
Expired or disqualified	In progress	Label for in progress process	In progress
N/A	Decided	Label for new status decision after renewal	New status after renewal

Related Information

[Qualification and Miscellaneous Supplier Management Process Projects \[page 188\]](#)
[Creating a Qualification or Miscellaneous Supplier Management Process Project \[page 197\]](#)
[Filling Out an Internal Questionnaire for a Supplier Management Process \[page 207\]](#)
[Approving or Denying a Modular Questionnaire in a Process Project \[page 209\]](#)
[Making a Status Decision for a Supplier Management Process \[page 220\]](#)
[Requesting an Update or Changing the Recipient for a Modular Questionnaire \[page 240\]](#)

Making a Status Decision for a Supplier Management Process

If you're a decision-maker for a process, use these steps to set or update its status to conditionally approved, approved, or denied based on the most recent information in its questionnaires.

Prerequisites

To make a status decision for a process project, you must be a member of a project group with the **Decision Maker** role.

The process must be in a pending decision, approved, denied, or conditionally approved status.

The process project feature (SM-16798) must be enabled in your site.

Context

A process can be configured so that its final status is set automatically based on the statuses of its included modular questionnaires. Otherwise, a decision-maker reviews the process and its questionnaires and manually sets its status.

This status isn't permanent. A decision-maker can edit it at any time unless the process currently has a renewal in progress or has expired. Changing a status decision is a more lightweight alternative to process renewal, which can require updates to and re-evaluation of process questionnaires.

For example, if an important questionnaire in a qualification process is expiring and the recipient hasn't updated it yet, a decision-maker for that process can update its status from an approved status to a conditionally approved status. If the recipient allows the questionnaire to expire without updating it, the decision-maker can update the process status again to change it from a conditionally approved status to a denied status. Comments allow decision-makers to describe why they made a particular decision, and the decision history table on the process details page shows all the status changes and the reasons behind them.

While you're making a status decision, most of the questions in the process intake form are editable and you can change their answers. Saving your decision also saves any changes you made to the intake form. If the intake form includes questions about the process's expiration schedule or expiration reminder schedule, you can edit those schedules while making or updating a decision. For example, if you decide to conditionally approve the process instead of fully approving it, you can shorten the expiration schedule so that the process comes up for renewal sooner. The only questions that you can't edit on the intake form are the ones about the process's commodities, regions, and departments. Those answers are set when the process is created and can't be changed.

Your organization's process setup determines the names of the statuses in each process.

If the process has been set up to allow decision-making in an external system, the **Make decision** button is locked while that external decision-making is in progress. Once it's completed, you can once again set a status for the process on the process details page.

You can choose **View all decision makers** in the **Process status** area of the details page to see the list of decision-makers along with their email addresses, allowing you to contact the decision-maker when the decision is delayed or pending. As a decision-maker you can use **Make Decision** to make a status decision for the project and use **View all decision makers** to view the list of decision-makers for the process project.

Qualification processes for which you're a decision maker show on the **Qualifications** tile of your **Supplier Management** dashboard. Miscellaneous processes for which you're a decision maker don't show on the dashboard.

Procedure

1. Perform one of the following actions:
 - Choose the link in the email notification informing you that the process is ready for a status decision.
 - Navigate to the **Qualifications** or **Processes** detail area of the supplier's profile, locate the process, and choose the view icon () to open its details page.
2. In the **Process status** area, perform one of the following actions:
 - To set the final status of the process for the first time, choose **Make decision**.
 - To update an existing status, choose **Change**.

If you choose **Change**, the application displays an information message. This message informs you that the preferred status, if any, will be removed for the existing commodity, region, and department combination if you set the process status to **Conditionally Qualified** or **Denied**. However, the application doesn't display the message when you attempt to change a status decision while renewing or discontinuing the process.

3. Choose the status that you want to set.
4. Enter a required comment about your decision.
5. **Optional:** Edit the process intake form to change answers as needed.
6. Choose **Save**.

Results

The process shows the currently set status. The primary contact, the process project owner, and the specific decision-maker for the project receive notifications informing them of the status change.

The **Process status** area shows the decision history for the process, including the name of the decision-maker who set the status and their comments. Currently, decision history doesn't include information about any changes to the intake form made with the decisions.

If the process is a qualification process, changing its status from approved to conditionally approved or denied doesn't affect any preferred category statuses associated with the previous approved status. An approved discontinuation for the process does automatically remove the associated preferred category status.

Whenever you make a status decision, a new version of the process intake form is created. At a later point in time, if there are multiple versions of the process intake forms in the system, you can export any version to Microsoft Excel. To export a version, open the intake form in the supplier's profile, select the desired version in the upper right corner, and click **Export**.

The following image shows an example of a process decision history:

The screenshot displays a 'Process status' section. Under 'Current status', it shows 'Fully Qualified' with a 'Change' link. Below this, it lists 'Status set' as 9/14/2021, 'By' as Greg Brown, and a 'Comment' stating 'Expiring certificate updated before expiration deadline. Meets full qualification criteria again.' The 'Previous decisions' section contains a table with two rows of historical data.

DATE	DECISION	AUTHOR	COMMENT
8/12/2021	Fully Qualified with Conditions	Jack Chen	Expiring certificate hasn't been updated yet.
6/16/2021	Fully Qualified	Mary Smith	Full qualification criteria met.

Related Information

[About the Processes Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 162\]](#)

[Creating a Qualification or Miscellaneous Supplier Management Process Project \[page 197\]](#)

[Qualification and Miscellaneous Supplier Management Process Projects \[page 188\]](#)

Preferred Supplier Management

Preferred supplier management vets suppliers' suitability for a preferred category status for specific commodities for specific regions and (if your organization uses them) departments. Your organization can use up to five different preferred category statuses.

Suppliers must be qualified for a combination of commodities, regions, and departments before they can be preferred.

[Preferred Category Statuses Management Projects \[page 223\]](#)

[About the Preferred Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 224\]](#)

[Requesting a New or Updated Preferred Category Status for a Supplier \[page 225\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a Preferred Supplier Category Status \[page 227\]](#)

[Removing a Preferred Category Status from a Supplier \[page 228\]](#)

Preferred Category Statuses Management Projects

After the supplier is qualified for a specific commodity, region, and (optionally) department combination, a category or supplier manager can designate them as a preferred supplier for that combination.

Although a customer administrator can set preferred statuses for suppliers using a data import operation in both SAP Ariba Supplier Management solutions, preferred supplier management projects are only available in solutions that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance.

Supplier preferred category status is always based on a combination of commodity and region. It can also be based on departments if the department feature for supplier management projects is enabled in your site.

The preferred supplier management project template determines:

- What information users add to the preferred category status request form.
- Whether the preferred category status request requires approval, and if so, who the approvers are.
- Whether other stakeholders in your organization must also approve the status change.

Users request a preferred category status for a new commodity, region, and department combination, or a change to an existing status, in the **Preferred** detail area of the supplier's profile on the **Supplier Management** dashboard. Up to five status levels are supported, including the preferred level. They also remove preferred status levels there.

Note

- You can't combine multiple qualified combinations in the same preferred status request. For example, if a supplier has separate qualifications for **Electronic reference material** and **Printed media** in the Canada region, you must create individual preferred category status requests for each category.
- If your site uses process qualifications, you can request preferred category status for any valid process qualification or a subset.

If the preferred supplier management workflow includes an approval flow, notifications let the approver know that the preferred status change request requires approval; let the requesting user know when the preferred status request has been approved or denied; and show the final approver so that requesting users can have further discussions about denied preferred status requests.

In solutions that include SAP Ariba Sourcing, event templates can be set up to automatically invite the suppliers that are preferred for the event's commodities and regions. Department isn't considered for automatic event invitation.

Related Information

[Preferred Supplier Level Data Import](#)

[Internal Supplier Requests \[page 93\]](#)

[External Supplier Requests \[page 94\]](#)

[New Supplier Registrations \[page 108\]](#)

[Supplier Qualification and Requalification Using Supplier Qualification Projects \[page 170\]](#)

[Supplier Disqualifications Using Supplier Disqualification Projects \[page 171\]](#)

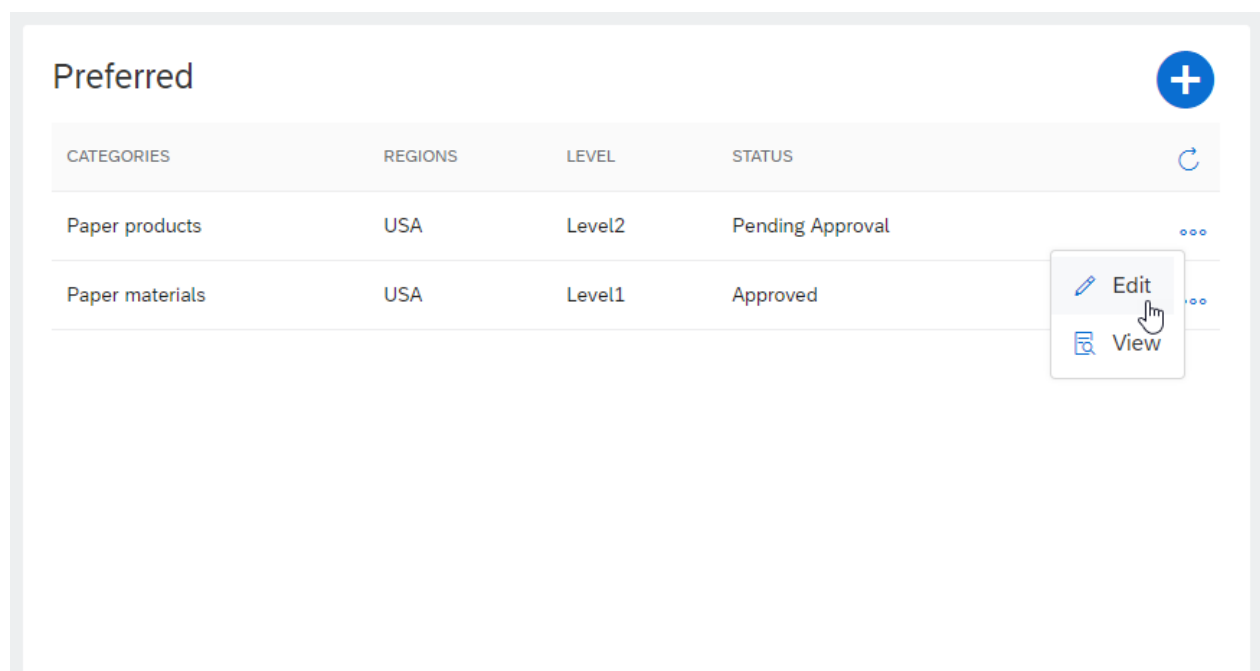
[Supplier Performance Evaluations Using SPM Projects](#)

About the Preferred Detail Area in the Supplier Profile

Preferred category statuses indicate the desirability of using a supplier for specific combinations of commodities, regions, and departments. You view and manage supplier preferred category statuses in the **Preferred** detail area of the supplier profile.

Preferred category statuses are a set of labels that your organization uses to indicate the desirability of using a supplier for a specific combination of commodities, regions, and departments. Whether or not your organization uses preferred supplier management depends on its processes.

Preferred supplier management projects are only available in solutions that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance. The **Preferred** detail area only shows in a supplier's profile after the supplier is qualified for at least one commodity, region, and department.



CATEGORIES	REGIONS	LEVEL	STATUS	
Paper products	USA	Level2	Pending Approval	...
Paper materials	USA	Level1	Approved	...

You can do the following things in the **Preferred** detail area of the supplier profile:

- View a summary list of all of the supplier's preferred category statuses.
- View the preferred category request for a status by choosing  (view).
- Request a [new or updated preferred category status \[page 225\]](#) for a supplier.
- [Remove a preferred category status \[page 228\]](#) from a supplier.

In the preferred category request, you can approve or deny the task by choosing  (take action).

Note

There is no advanced view for preferred supplier management projects.

Related Information

[About the Contacts Detail Area of the Supplier Profile \[page 47\]](#)

[About the Registration Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 114\]](#)

[About the Qualifications Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 158\]](#)

[About the Questionnaires Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 232\]](#)

Requesting a New or Updated Preferred Category Status for a Supplier

You can request a new preferred category status for a supplier to indicate the desirability of doing business with them for a specific combination of commodities, regions, and departments, or request a status change based on changing circumstances.

Prerequisites

To request a new or updated preferred category status for a supplier, you must be a member of the **Preferred Supplier Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** groups.

Preferred supplier management projects are only available in solutions that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance.

You can only request a new preferred category status for a combination of commodities, regions, and departments for which the supplier is already fully qualified. You can't request a preferred category status based on less than full qualification:

- If your organization manages supplier qualifications using supplier qualification and disqualification projects, you can't request a preferred category status based on a partial qualification that has one or more subordinate disqualifications. For example, if a supplier is qualified for clothing in the United States for the marketing department but disqualified for shirts in Florida, their qualification is partial and you can't request a preferred category status based on it.
- If your organization manages supplier qualifications using qualification process projects, you can't request a preferred category status based on an approved qualification process that has 1 or more subordinate qualification processes that are denied. You also can't request a preferred category status based on a qualification process that's conditionally approved.

Context

Preferred category statuses encourage the procurement and sourcing agents in your organization to do business with certain suppliers for specific commodities, regions, and departments. Depending on how your site is set up, suppliers with the highest preferred category status can appear at the top of guided buying search results or be invited automatically to participate in sourcing events.

Procedure

1. On the **Supplier Management** dashboard, locate the supplier for which you want to request a new or updated preferred category status.
2. Choose the supplier's name to open their profile.
3. Perform one of the following actions:
 - In the supplier's profile summary, choose **Preferred** in the **Quick Links** panel.
 - In the classic supplier 360° profile, choose **Preferred** in the left-hand navigation bar.

The **Preferred** detail area of the supplier's profile opens.

4. Perform one of the following actions:
 - To request a new preferred category status, choose **+** (add).
 - To request a change to an existing preferred category status, locate the status and choose **⋮** (more options) > **Edit** .
5. If you're requesting a new preferred category status, select one or more commodities, regions, and (if your organization uses them) departments by performing one of the following actions:
 - Choose **Search** and enter search terms in the field, then select a value from the list of search results.
 - Choose **Browse** and use the arrows (**>** **<**) to navigate through the hierarchy, then select values to include in the request.

Your choices are limited to the values for which the supplier is already fully qualified.

6. Choose the status level to request.
7. Enter any other required information in the form.
8. Choose **Submit**.

Results

The request, with its current status, shows in the **Preferred** detail area. If there's an approval task for it, that task starts now.

Related Information

[About the Preferred Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 224\]](#)
[Removing a Preferred Category Status from a Supplier \[page 228\]](#)
[Approving or Denying a Preferred Supplier Category Status \[page 227\]](#)

Approving or Denying a Preferred Supplier Category Status

If you're an approver for a preferred category status request, you can approve or deny it. Final approval grants the supplier the requested preferred category status.

Prerequisites

Preferred supplier management projects are only available in solutions that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance.

Context

Procedure

1. Navigate to the **Preferred** detail area of the supplier's profile.
2. Locate the preferred category in **Pending Approval** status and choose  (view) to view the details of the preferred status.

The preferred category details page opens.

Preferred Supplier Management for Supplier 123, Inc.

SUPPLIER Supplier 123, Inc.	OWNER Project Owner	MATRIX Category All Commodities>Apparel and Luggage and Personal Care Products>Sewing supplies and accessories Region All>Asia Pacific>Japan Business unit All>Corporate>Finance
--------------------------------	------------------------	--

QUESTIONNAIRE ID
Doc5194520

QUESTIONNAIRE TYPE
External

Process flow

Started → Approval for category status change [Project Owner] → Approved

Questionnaire

QUESTIONNAIRE NAME	TYPE
Category status	External

Tasks

NAME	ACTION BY	STATUS
Approval for category status change	Project Owner	In Approval

3. In the **Tasks** area, choose  (take action) for the approval task.

The approval task detail page opens. It shows the request.

4. Perform one of the following actions:

- To approve the request, choose **Approve**, then click **Approve**.
- To deny the request, choose **Deny**, enter a message to the requester explaining your choice, and choose **Deny**.

Results

The status of the preferred category changes to **Approved** or **Denied** in the **Preferred** detail area of the supplier's profile. Any comments that you or other approvers added during approval show on the approval task details page.

Related Information

[About the Preferred Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 224\]](#)

[Requesting a New or Updated Preferred Category Status for a Supplier \[page 225\]](#)

[Removing a Preferred Category Status from a Supplier \[page 228\]](#)

Removing a Preferred Category Status from a Supplier

If a supplier is no longer preferred for a specific combination of commodities, regions, and departments, you can remove their preferred status by deleting it.

Prerequisites

To remove a supplier preferred category status, you must be a member of the **Preferred Supplier Manager** or **SM Ops Administrator** groups.

Preferred supplier management projects are only available in solutions that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance.

You can't remove a preferred category status if its request is still in approval. You can only remove approved category statuses.

Context

Deleting a preferred category status never requires approval.

If your organization manages supplier qualifications using qualification and disqualification projects, when a supplier is disqualified for a combination of commodities, regions, and departments, any preferred statuses associated with the previous qualification are removed from the supplier automatically.

If your organization manages supplier qualifications using process projects, changing the status of a qualification process from approved to conditionally approved or denied doesn't affect any preferred statuses associated with the previous approved status. A discontinuation of the qualification process does automatically remove any associated preferred category statuses from the supplier.

When a preferred category status is automatically removed from a supplier because of a disqualification, the **Preferred** detail area of their supplier profile shows the disqualification status instead.

Procedure

1. Locate the supplier for which you want to remove a preferred category status on the **Supplier Management** dashboard.
2. Choose the supplier's name to open their profile.
3. Perform one of the following actions:
 - In the supplier's profile summary, choose **Preferred** in the **Quick Links** panel.
 - In the classic supplier 360° profile, choose **Preferred** in the left-hand navigation bar.The **Preferred** detail area of the supplier's profile opens.
4. Locate the status and choose ... (more options) > **Delete** .
5. Choose **Delete**.

Results

After you delete a preferred category status, the supplier is no longer eligible for sourcing events that use preferred status as a criteria. You can request a new preferred category status for the same supplier and combination of commodities, regions, and departments at any time.

Related Information

[About the Preferred Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 224\]](#)

[Requesting a New or Updated Preferred Category Status for a Supplier \[page 225\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a Preferred Supplier Category Status \[page 227\]](#)

How Supplier Performance Management (SPM) Projects Fit into the Supplier Management Workflow

To measure supplier performance, your organization can use classic Supplier Performance Management (SPM) projects.

The features associated with SPM projects include:

- Scorecards for grading suppliers. Scorecards can include data from surveys responses, report data, and data added directly to the scorecard.
- Surveys for periodic evaluation of suppliers by internal and external stakeholders.
- Performance criteria translated into key performance indicators (KPIs) that map between SPM scorecards and surveys. You can store KPIs in the **Sourcing Library** for use across multiple projects.
- Analytical reporting tools.

SPM projects are standalone projects that use the classic project interface. They don't show on the **Supplier Management** dashboard and aren't linked in any way to supplier request, registration, qualification, disqualification, preferred supplier management, or process projects.

For information on running supplier performance management reviews using SPM projects, see [Running Supplier Performance Management Reviews](#).

Modular Questionnaire and Supplier Certificate Management

Modular questionnaires are projects that maintain discrete sets of related information, such as certificates, risk assessments, or policy, compliance, audit, or other information about suppliers or engagement risk. They can function independently or serve as components in a larger process such as a process qualification or an engagement risk assessment.

Modular questionnaires are the recommended way to collect supplier certificates. They include some special features for certificate management, including features for managing expiring and expired certificates.

[About the Questionnaires Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 232\]](#)

[Supplier Certificate Management \[page 234\]](#)

[Inviting Suppliers to Fill Out Standalone Modular Questionnaires \[page 237\]](#)

[Requesting an Update or Changing the Recipient for a Modular Questionnaire \[page 240\]](#)

[Scores for Modular Questionnaires \[page 241\]](#)

[Approving or Denying an External Modular Questionnaire \[page 243\]](#)

[Ratings for Internal Forms and Questionnaires \[page 245\]](#)

[Filling out an Internal Form in a Modular Questionnaire Project \[page 246\]](#)

[Approving or Denying an Internal Form in a Modular Questionnaire Project \[page 248\]](#)

[Viewing Modular Questionnaire Projects Based on Previous Template Versions After Template Upgrade \[page 250\]](#)

[Status Flow for Modular Questionnaire Projects \[page 252\]](#)

About the Questionnaires Detail Area in the Supplier Profile

You view and manage modular questionnaires for a supplier in the **Questionnaires** detail area of the supplier's profile.

Questionnaires				
Questionnaire Task				
Filter				
NAME	STATUS	TYPE	EXPIRY DATE	SCORE
ISO 14000 Certification for Supplier 123, Inc.	Approved	External	Tue Aug 27 2019	-
ISO 9001 Certification for Supplier 123, Inc.	Approved	External	Tue Aug 27 2019	-

The **Questionnaires** area includes a **Questionnaires** tab and a **Tasks** tab.

You can do the following things on the **Questionnaires** tab:

- See all of the modular questionnaire projects associated with the supplier, their statuses, and their expiration dates. If a questionnaire is scored and the recipient has submitted answers, the overall score shows on the **Questionnaires** tab.
- View details about the modular questionnaire project, including workflow progress and any included internal forms.
- [Fill out and submit \[page 207\]](#) internal modular questionnaires included in process projects, if you're the questionnaire's recipient.
- [Fill out and submit \[page 246\]](#) internal forms included in modular questionnaire projects, if you're the project owner or the owner of an associated To Do task.
- [Request an update or change the recipient \[page 240\]](#) of a modular questionnaire.

You can do the following things on the **Tasks** tab:

- Complete any stand-alone To Do tasks for any questionnaires or internal forms in a modular questionnaire project to which you've been assigned.
- [Approve or deny \[page 243\]](#) a questionnaire if you're in its approval flow.
- [Approve or deny \[page 248\]](#) an internal form if you're in its approval flow.
- View completed tasks by choosing the view icon ().

If a modular questionnaire project only includes a questionnaire, viewing it directly opens the questionnaire details page with questions, answers, and version history. If the process project feature (SM-16798) is enabled in your site, questionnaire details for the project or key questionnaire also include a summary of the process projects in which the questionnaire is included.

If a modular questionnaire project also includes internal forms, viewing it opens the questionnaire project details page.

Logistics Questionnaire

Not Responded

SUPPLIER

Supplier ABC

QUESTIONNAIRE TYPE

Modular Questionnaire

LAST UPDATED

Oct 19, 2021

RECIPIENT

Terry Kwan
tkwan@supplierabc.com

OWNER

Alice Jones

MATRIX

Category

All>Logistics>Regional Transportation & Storage>Warehousing

Region

All Regions>North America>USA

Business unit

All>Manufacturing

Process Flow

```

graph LR
    A((Questionnaire started)) --> B((To Do for Due Diligence))
    B --> C((Approval for Due Diligence [Legal]))
    C --> D((To Do for Compliance))
    D --> E((Approval for Compliance [Compliance Team]))
    E --> F((Approval for Logistics Questionnaire [Logistics Team]))
    F --> G((Questionnaire approved))
  
```

Questionnaires

NAME	TYPE	
Logistics questionnaire	External	
Due Diligence	Internal	
Compliance Check	Internal	

Tasks

NAME	ACTION BY	STATUS	
To Do for Due Diligence		Not Started	
Approval for Due Diligence		Not Started	
To Do for Compliance		Not Started	
Approval for Compliance		Not Started	
Approval for Logistics Questionnaire		Not Started	

The questionnaire project details page includes:

- A **Questionnaires** table with the project's key questionnaire and internal forms. View a questionnaire or form to open its questionnaire details page, which shows questions, answers, and version history. In these questionnaire details pages, comment history shows all comments for all tasks associated with both the key questionnaire and all internal forms in the current phase of the project.

The **Questionnaires** table doesn't show scores or score band indicators for questionnaires or forms with scoring. However, scores and score band indicators do show on individual questionnaire details pages.

- A **Tasks** table with the project's tasks. Viewing a task from this table shows the standard task details page with questions, answers, and version history for the questionnaire or form associated with the task. In the task details page, comment history shows only comments for the current task.

→ Tip

If a modular questionnaire project includes internal forms, the internal forms don't show on the **Questionnaires** tab but the project's key questionnaire does. Tasks for internal forms show on the **Tasks** tab. To see an internal form in a modular questionnaire project, view the key questionnaire for the project or a task associated with the form.

Related Information

[About the Registration Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 114\]](#)

[About the Qualifications Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 158\]](#)

[About the Contacts Detail Area of the Supplier Profile \[page 47\]](#)

[About the Preferred Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 224\]](#)

[About the Processes Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 162\]](#)

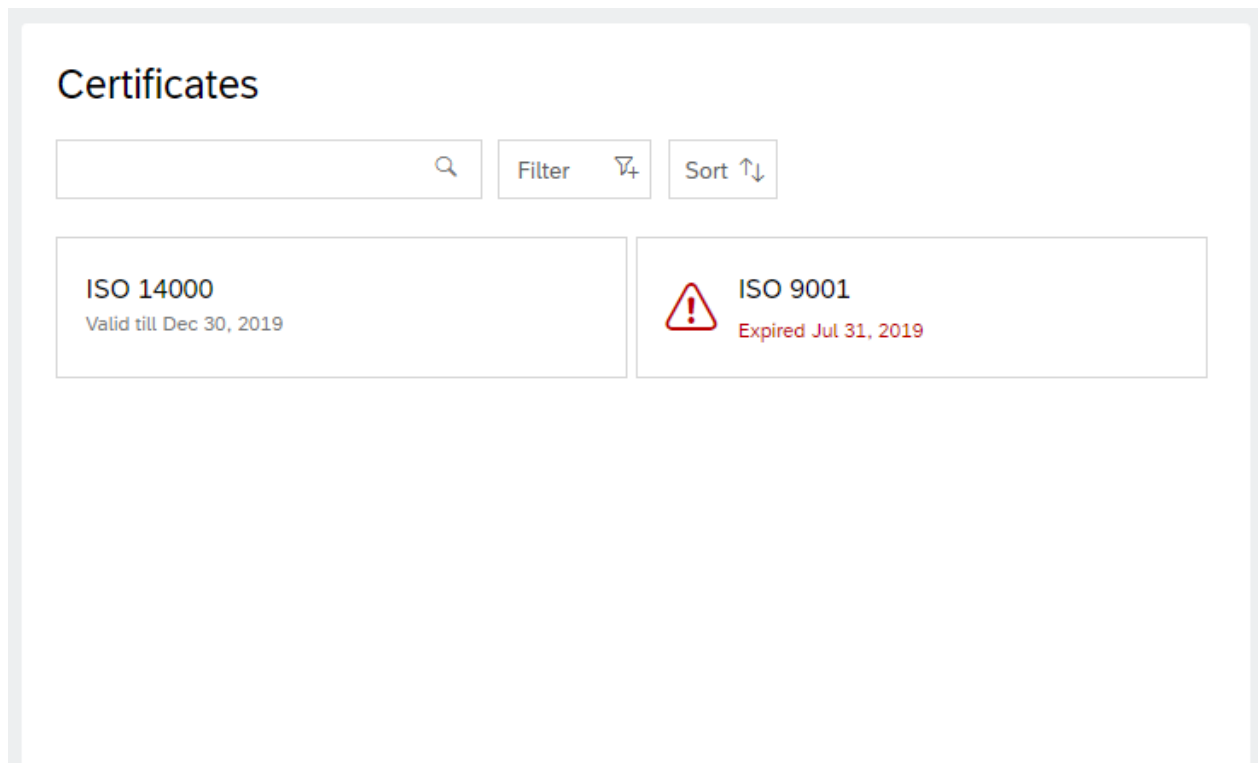
[Supplier Certificate Management \[page 234\]](#)

Supplier Certificate Management

Supplier management questionnaires can collect certificate information from suppliers. You can view a supplier's certificates and their expiration status in the **Certificates** area of the supplier profile.

If your site uses the supplier profile summary (NGSM-2959), it includes a **Certificates** panel that shows the number of **Valid**, **Expiring**, and **Expired** certificates for the supplier that your organization has collected. The **Certificates** area shows more certificate details.

Any internal or external supplier management questionnaire can include certificate questions. The **Certificates** detail area of a supplier's profile shows all certificates associated with a supplier that were collected in approved questionnaires or questionnaire updates. Each certificate has a summary with the certificate name, expiration date, and a status of **Valid**, **Expiring**, or **Expired**.



To be included in the **Certificates** detail area of a supplier's profile, a certificate must be collected using either of the following methods:

- Internal or external questionnaires using **Certificate** questions mapped to the `vendor . certificate` field in the supplier database, including request, registration, and qualification questionnaires.
- Modular questionnaires using **Certificate** questions or certificate sections with mapped certificate questions.

In either case, the questionnaire must be approved. Certificates that were added in denied questionnaires or questionnaire updates aren't included in the **Certificates** area.

If your site uses the supplier profile summary (NGSM-2729) and the supplier is public (has a linked SAP Business Network account), a separate **Business Network Certificates** panel shows the certificates the supplier has added to their SAP Business Network profile. Choosing that panel opens the **Certifications** area of the supplier's SAP Business Network profile. The number of certificates shown in the **Certificates** panel (collected by your organization in approved questionnaires) and in the **Business Network Certificates** panel (self-reported by the supplier on SAP Business Network) can be the same in some cases, or can differ. See [About the Supplier Profile Summary \[page 14\]](#) for details.

In the **Certificates** detail area, you can view certificate details by performing the following actions:

- Search for a certificate by entering the certificate type in the search bar. You can enter all or part of the type to start the search.
- Filter certificates by any combination of type, status, effective date, whether or not the certificate has expired, and the commodities, regions, and departments to which it applies. After selecting one or more filter values in the filter popup, choose **Apply** to apply them to the **Certificates** area. To clear filters, in the filter popup, choose **Clear all**, then choose **Apply**.
- Sort certificates by last updated, recently expired, or oldest expired.
- Choose any certificate summary card to open complete certificate details, including links for downloading the certificate attachment and opening the questionnaire where the certificate was collected. Certificate details

can include associated commodities, regions, and departments. However, that information is only valid for certificates collected in modular questionnaires, which create a direct relationship between the commodity, region, and department of the modular questionnaire project and its associated certificates.

Note

- SAP Ariba doesn't validate the details in certificate answers (effective date, expiration date, and so on) against associated certificate attachments. Approvers are responsible for comparing the certificate attachment to the details in the certificate answer to make sure that they match before approving the associated questionnaire. Approvers can request additional information from the recipient to resolve any discrepancies.
- If a questionnaire recipient submits a certificate with a past expiration date, the certificate's status can show as **Expiration in Progress** for a short time before changing to **Expired**.

Certificates collected in modular questionnaires include some special features. A template creator in your site sets up these certificate-related modular questionnaires, which can include both certificate and other types of questions, usually for a specific subject. Some certificate-related modular questionnaires can ask for multiple related certificates, while other questionnaires can ask for one critical certificate. A modular questionnaire project can be applicable to all commodities, regions, and departments, or only to a specific combination, and the certificates collected in it inherit that commodity, region, and department information from the modular questionnaire. In addition to the expiration dates of individual certificates, the modular questionnaire project where they're collected can also expire.

Managing supplier certificates in modular questionnaires involves the following tasks:

- **Sending suppliers certificate questionnaires:** you can ask suppliers to provide information about their certificates by inviting them to fill out the relevant modular questionnaires. Depending on your site's solution package, these certificate-related modular questionnaires can be standalone questionnaires, engagement risk assessments, or included in a process project.
- **Approving or denying certificate questionnaires:** If you're an approver, you must [review supplier answers and approve or deny their certificate questionnaires \[page 243\]](#) or questionnaire updates.
- **Monitoring certificate status:** In addition to viewing certificates in the **Certificates** detail area of supplier profiles, you can monitor certificates collected in modular questionnaires by:
 - **Receiving email notifications:** depending on how a modular questionnaire is set up, if you're a supplier's primary supplier manager or an owner of the questionnaire project, you can receive email notifications for upcoming and lapsed expirations. These notifications can be for a specific certificate or for the modular questionnaire project as a whole.
 - **Monitoring questionnaire status:** you can view the status of modular questionnaire projects associated with the supplier, as well as the questionnaires themselves, in the **Questionnaires** detail area of the supplier's profile. A modular questionnaire project status of **Expiring** or **Expired** can mean that the questionnaire project itself has an expiration schedule. Certificate questions in modular questionnaires can also be set up so that a certificate expiration changes the questionnaire's status to **Expiring** or **Expired**. Certificate expirations themselves are always based on the certificate expiration date and aren't affected by the status of the modular questionnaire project in which they're collected.

Related Information

[Approving or Denying an External Modular Questionnaire \[page 243\]](#)

[About the Classic Supplier 360° Profile \[page 26\]](#)

Inviting Suppliers to Fill Out Standalone Modular Questionnaires

To invite suppliers to fill out standalone modular questionnaires, you send invitations to the supplier contacts. Modular questionnaires are individual questionnaire projects that ask sets of related questions about specific subjects. For example, different modular questionnaires can ask questions about supplier certificates in different areas or specific risk controls.

Prerequisites

To send standalone modular supplier management questionnaires, you must be a member of the **SM Modular Questionnaire Manager** group.

To add, edit, or delete a supplier contact in a supplier's profile or when inviting a supplier to a questionnaire, you must be a member of one of the following groups:

- **Supplier Registration Manager**
- **SM Ops Administrator**
- **Customer Administrator**
- **Category Manager**
- **Commodity Manager**
- **Event Administrator**
- **Limited Event Administrator**
- **Sourcing Project Administrator**
- **Supplier Project Administrator**
- **Supplier/Customer Manager**
- **Supplier/Customer Agent**

Members of the **Supplier Qualification Manager** group can add, but not edit or delete, supplier contacts in the supplier's profile and when inviting a supplier to a questionnaire.

Context

You can invite multiple suppliers to fill out multiple standalone modular questionnaires in a single operation. This invitation is for standalone questionnaires, meaning that the invitation isn't related to a specific supplier management process. In sites that include SAP Ariba Supplier Risk, control-based engagement risk assessment projects include modular questionnaires for specific risk controls. Invitations to risk assessment questionnaires are part of the engagement project workflow. In sites where the process project feature (SM-16798) is enabled, process projects include modular questionnaires that are applicable to the process's commodities, regions,

and departments, and questionnaire invitations are part of the process project creation or renewal workflow. Standalone modular questionnaires are always external. Modular questionnaires in engagement risk assessment projects or process projects can be either external or internal.

You can only send standalone modular questionnaire invitations to suppliers that have at least one supplier contact with an associated email address. The primary supplier contact is the default recipient. However, the modular questionnaire invitation process allows you to add missing contacts or choose different contacts while sending the invitation. You can create two different supplier contacts with the same email addresses for a supplier because the email addresses aren't case-sensitive. For example: you can create **emailaddress@company.com** and **Emailaddress@company.com**.

If the feature for internal forms in modular questionnaires (SM-30222) is enabled in your site, modular questionnaire projects can also include internal forms. The external questionnaire that you send to the supplier is the key or main questionnaire in the project. You or another person in your organization [fill out and submit \[page 246\]](#) the included internal forms as well.

Procedure

1. On the dashboard, choose **Manage > SM Modular Questionnaires**.
2. On the **Questionnaire** page, choose **Filter**.

The **More options** popup is displayed. This popup contains four types of filters to help you to arrive at your desired set of questionnaires. You can select one or more of the filters **Questionnaire type**, **Category**, **Department**, and **Region** to further narrow down your search using the sub-filters under each main filter type.

→ Tip

By default, the **Questionnaire** page shows 10 modular supplier management questionnaires at a time. You can use the **Show more** control on this page to append 10 more questionnaires. Each time you click **Show more**, 10 more rows are appended to the list.

3. Choose **Apply**.

The Questionnaire page displays all the questionnaires that meet your filter criteria.

4. From the list of questionnaires displayed now, select the questionnaires you want to send to your suppliers. Choose **Next**.
5. Select the suppliers that you want to invite to fill out the questionnaires you selected in the previous step.

→ Tip

- To search for suppliers to invite, enter a name in the search field or filter the supplier list by choosing **Filters**, selecting filters in the navigation pane of the **More Options** popup, choosing filter values, and choosing **Apply**.
- The **Questionnaire Status** filter helps you narrow down suppliers by the current status of the modular questionnaire - for example, whether it hasn't yet been sent, hasn't been responded to, has been approved, is pending submission, and so on. The available statuses to choose from are Not Sent, Not Responded, Pending Submission, Submitted, Pending Resubmit, Pending Approval, Denied, Approved, Expiring, and Expired.
- The filter results display only those suppliers that were **created or invited after** the [enhanced pagination and filtering](#) functionality was enabled in your site.

- Currently, choosing **Select all** selects the first 500 suppliers in the supplier list rather than all suppliers. To invite additional suppliers beyond the first 500, you must select them individually.
- Each supplier you select is saved, even if the current search results don't show them. The filter list above the search results shows the number of suppliers that you've selected. If you want to remove a previously selected supplier and it's not currently visible in search results, search for the supplier, then deselect it.

6. Choose **Next**.

The confirmation page shows the **Supplier good to go** tile with a list of selected suppliers who have contacts and are ready for the invitation. There's also a **Supplier missing contact** tile. If any of the suppliers you selected don't have contacts, you can choose this tile to see them.

7. **Optional:** On the **Supplier good to go** tile, verify that the primary contact for each listed supplier is the person you want to invite to fill out the questionnaires. If not, perform the following actions:
- Choose **Change contact**.
 - Optional:** If the person you want to invite isn't listed as one of the supplier's current contacts and you have the required permissions, choose **Add new contact** and [add a contact \[page 54\]](#).
 - Select the contact that you want to invite and choose **Save**.
8. If you added any suppliers that don't currently have contacts to the invitation and you have the required permissions to add contacts, choose the **Supplier missing contact** tile and [add a contact \[page 54\]](#):
9. Choose **Send**.

Results

Each modular questionnaire that you sent generates an email invitation to the supplier contact you specified. The supplier contact can use the links in the emails to sign in and fill out and submit the questionnaires.

If the modular questionnaire project includes internal forms:

- If you're an owner of the modular questionnaire project, you can now fill out and submit any forms that don't have To Do tasks.
- Owners of To Do tasks for submitting internal forms receive notifications when their tasks become active in the workflow for the modular questionnaire project.

In the **Questionnaires** detail area of the profiles of the suppliers you selected, the **Questionnaires** tab shows the modular questionnaire projects that you invited them to. The **Tasks** tab shows any tasks associated with those questionnaire projects. Each questionnaire project initially has a status of **Not Responded**. To see the details and process flow graphs for a questionnaire project, including any included internal forms, choose **View**.

If the questionnaire project is approved and it has an expiration schedule, you receive a notification when the questionnaire project moves to **Expiring** status and another notification when it moves to **Expired** status.

Related Information

[Supplier Certificate Management \[page 234\]](#)

[About the Questionnaires Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 232\]](#)

[Approving or Denying an External Modular Questionnaire \[page 243\]](#)

[Status Flow for Modular Questionnaire Projects \[page 252\]](#)

[Enable enhanced filtering and pagination for standalone modular questionnaires \[page 300\]](#)

Requesting an Update or Changing the Recipient for a Modular Questionnaire

Use these steps to request an update for a modular questionnaire. Requesting an update allows you to send the current recipient a reminder or select a different recipient and invite them to update the questionnaire.

Prerequisites

To request an update or change a recipient for a modular questionnaire, you must be a member of the **SM Modular Questionnaire Manager**, **Supplier Risk Engagement Expert**, or **Supplier Risk Engagement Governance Analyst** group.

You can't request an update while the questionnaire is in **Pending Submission** or **Pending Approval** status.

Internal modular questionnaires are only available in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance process projects and in SAP Ariba Supplier Risk engagement risk assessment projects, where they're used as risk assessments. Internal modular questionnaires can't be standalone projects.

Context

Modular questionnaires can allow continuous updates or permanently close after the submitted answers are first approved or denied. However, even if a modular questionnaire doesn't normally allow updates, requesting an update reopens the questionnaire so that the recipient can update it once.

For external modular questionnaires, once supplier contact has opened the questionnaire and viewed it, the questionnaire is assigned to them and they're the only user in the SAP Business Network account who can view or respond to it.

If the modular questionnaire project also includes internal forms, you can request an update for or change the recipient of the main or key questionnaire in the project. You can't request updates for or change recipients of internal forms.

In sites where the process project feature is enabled, a process initiator who is also a member of the **SM Modular Questionnaire Manager** group can also request a questionnaire update or change recipients when creating or renewing a process.

Procedure

1. Open the modular questionnaire by performing one of the following actions:
 - Navigate to the **Questionnaires** detail area of the supplier's profile. On the **Questionnaire** tab, view the questionnaire.
 - On the **Home** dashboard, choose **SM Modular Questionnaire** in the search context menu, optionally enter a search term such as the name of the questionnaire, then choose the search icon (Q). On the search page, choose the name of the questionnaire and choose **Open**.
 - If the modular questionnaire is included in a process, on the process details page, view the questionnaire.
2. Choose **Request Update**.
3. Perform one of the following actions:
 - For an internal questionnaire, choose the current recipient or search for and select a different recipient.
 - For an external questionnaire, leave the current recipient selected, search for and select a different supplier contact or (if you have permission to add supplier contacts) [add a new contact \[page 54\]](#) and choose them as the recipient.
4. **Optional:** Enter a comment about the update request or questionnaire reassignment.
5. Perform one of the following actions:
 - For an internal questionnaire, choose **Confirm**.
 - For an external questionnaire, choose **Save**.

Results

The current or updated recipient receives an email notification inviting them to submit the questionnaire.

If the questionnaire is set up to generate reminders, requesting an update restarts the reminder schedule.

Scores for Modular Questionnaires

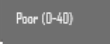
If a modular questionnaire is set up with scoring, it generates a score for each question and section, and an overall score for the entire questionnaire, based on the respondent's answers and the scoring setup. These scores help you decide how to evaluate questionnaire answers.

Questionnaire scores are useful because they apply uniform judgments. No matter who is filling out the questionnaire, the same answers result in the same score. Approvers and other stakeholders don't have to guess how acceptable or unacceptable the answers are because the scoring provides clear guidelines.

The **Questionnaires** detail area of the supplier profile shows overall scores for questionnaires. If your organization uses process projects, process details pages also show overall questionnaire scores. If a modular questionnaire project includes internal forms, both the key or main questionnaire in the project and the internal forms can have scores. However, the key questionnaire score is the project score and shows in the **Questionnaires** detail area and process details page. Scores for any internal forms don't contribute to the overall questionnaire project score.

When you view a questionnaire or form's details page, the questionnaire or form score shows at the top of the page. The questions and answer details include the score for each question and each section:

Supplier questionnaire

Question	Response	Score
1 Section 1		30.14 
1.1 Question 1.1	A	25 
1.2 Question 1.2	B	30.00
1.3 Subsection 1.3		32.86 
1.3.1 Question 1.3.1	B	10.00
1.3.2 Question 1.3.2	A	50.00
2 Section 2		44.55 
2.1 Question 2.1	C	50.00
2.2 Question 2.2	A	40.00

Questions with quantifiable (multiple choice or **Yes/No**) or numeric (number, date, or percentage) answers can be scored, though they're not always. Questions with free text answers can't be scored.

Scoring information include two components:

- A **numerical score** that expresses, as a percentage, how many points the question, section, or overall questionnaire has earned out of the total number of possible points. Questions, sections, and the questionnaire itself have numerical scores.

An **indicator of the scoring band** into which the score falls. A scoring band is a grouping that applies a single label to a range of scores. All scores within the range for a band receive the same judgment and the same label, such as "Good," "Average," or "Poor." The colored dot to the right of the numerical score shows the color code for the band, and you can hover over the colored dot to see the name of the band and the range of numerical scores it covers. Scoring bands only show for section and overall questionnaire scores.

Note

For each scoring band, the scores **equal to or greater than** the lowest number in its score range **up to but not including** the highest number in its score range fall within the band. For example, if a scoring band has a range of 50-75, scores of 50 and 74 both fall within the band, but a score of 75 falls outside it.

In all cases, scores and band indicators are based on the most recently submitted answers.

Questionnaire scoring can involve complicated calculations about not only how desirable an individual answer is relative to others, but how important the question is and how much significance or weight its section has. Some questions, sections, or entire questionnaires involve critical requirements, while some are about more optional or less critical information. Depending on the nature of the content, a numerical score of 30 can be unacceptable in one case, marginal in another, and acceptable in a third. Moreover, the overall questionnaire score isn't a sum

of the score of its sections. Some sections contribute more to the overall score than others. Numerical scores by themselves are difficult to interpret.

A score's band provides important context for the numerical score. Your organization can use different sets of scoring bands for different types of information. For example, one set can include only two bands: "Failed" and "Passed." Another set can include a larger number of graduated bands: "Bad," "Poor," "Average," "Good," and "Excellent." The template creator in your organization who sets up scoring for a modular questionnaire applies a specific set of scoring bands to the questionnaire and defines a score range for each band in the set so that you have the appropriate guidance for interpreting the scores of that particular set of content. The template creator can also apply different sets of scoring bands with different score ranges to different sections within the same questionnaire to provide different guidance for those specific sections.

Example

For example, questionnaire or section A can include questions about regulatory compliance that are critical to your organization. In this case, your organization can apply a strict yes-or-no judgment to the scores in this questionnaire or section by using the set of scoring bands that include only a "Failed" band (score range of 0-70) and a "Passed" band (score range of 70-100). Questionnaire or section B can include questions about less critical regulatory compliance and your organization can apply a looser standard of judgment by using the set of scoring bands that include "Bad" (0-20), "Poor" (20-40), "Average" (40-60), "Good" (60-80), and "Excellent" (80-100) bands. In this example, both A and B can have a numerical score of 65. However, because of the different content involved, a score of 65 means "Failed" in one section and "Good" in the other.

Related Information

[About the Questionnaires Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 232\]](#)

Approving or Denying an External Modular Questionnaire

Approve or deny external modular questionnaires based on organization-defined approval flows. Request additional information from supplier if needed. Final approval or denial closes project permanently. Review and manage comments and notifications.

Context

New modular questionnaire projects have an approval flow defined by your organization. Depending on how a modular questionnaire is set up, updates to the questionnaire can have the same approval flow, a different approval flow, or can be approved automatically.

If modular questionnaire updates have approval flows, or if you've requested more information from the supplier, the questionnaire details page shows the answers in both the [latest version and previous versions so that you can compare them \[page 258\]](#).

If the feature for internal forms in modular questionnaire projects (SM-30222) is enabled in your site, modular questionnaire projects can include one or more internal forms in addition to the main or key questionnaire submitted by the supplier. Approval or denial of the key questionnaire is typically the last step in the workflow for the modular questionnaire project. For information on approving internal forms, refer to [Approving or Denying an Internal Form in a Modular Questionnaire Project \[page 248\]](#).

Note

Once an approver denies the key questionnaire in either a new external modular questionnaire project or an update, the questionnaire project closes permanently. It remains permanently closed unless a user with permission to work in the advanced view manually monitors the key external questionnaire and reopens it. This action does reopen the project but doesn't automatically notify the supplier or form editors that they can now update the external questionnaire and internal forms again. You can use the **Request additional info** option to ask the supplier to provide more acceptable answers using automatic email notifications instead of explicitly denying the modular questionnaire project and requiring a manual intervention to reopen it.

In sites that include SAP Ariba Supplier Risk, external modular questionnaires are associated with risk controls in control-based engagement risk assessment projects. A control decision-maker can't review a control for effectiveness until all of its associated questionnaire projects are approved.

Procedure

1. Perform one of the following actions:
 - Click the link in the notification email.
 - Navigate to **Questionnaires** detail area of the supplier's profile. On the **Tasks** tab, choose  (take action) for the approval task.

The approval task details page opens.

2. Review the supplier's answers. If you're approving a questionnaire update, to display only the questions with updated answers, choose **Updated**. To display all answers, choose **All**.
3. **Optional:** If you're approving a questionnaire update, to compare the current answers with versions of the questionnaire that the supplier submitted before the previous version, choose the version number in the **Previous Version** column and select the version.

The **Previous Version** column shows answers from the selected version. The **Latest Version** column continues to show answers from the current update.

4. Perform one of the following actions:
 - To approve the questionnaire, choose **Approve**, enter an optional comment, and choose **Approve**.
 - To deny the questionnaire, choose **Deny**, enter an explanatory comment, and choose **Deny**.
 - To request additional information from the respondent, choose **Request Additional Info**, enter a comment explaining what information you want, and choose **Request Additional Info**.

Results

For new questionnaires, if you're the final approver, the status of the modular questionnaire project is now **Approved** or **Denied** and the supplier is notified of that status by email. If not, the questionnaire project remains in **Pending Approval** status until the final approval or denial. If you're the final approver and you approve the questionnaire, and the questionnaire project is set up to allow updates, the questionnaire reopens so that the supplier can update it. Any internal forms not associated with To Do tasks in an update phase also become editable again. If you deny the questionnaire, the project closes permanently. The supplier can't update the external questionnaire and internal forms editors can't update internal forms.

Any comments that you or other approvers added during questionnaire approval show on both the questionnaire and approval task details pages, which you can see by viewing the questionnaire or task. Questionnaire details pages show all comments for all tasks in the project, and you can filter them to just show the comments for the current questionnaire. Task details pages show only the comments associated with the current task. Depending on how your site's notifications are set up, approval comments can also be included in approval or denial notifications to suppliers.

If your organization uses different phases to manage tasks for new questionnaires and questionnaire updates, the questionnaire details page only shows comments for tasks in the current phase. When the questionnaire is new, comments for tasks in the new questionnaire phase show. After a recipient submits the first questionnaire update, only comments for tasks in the update phase show, and the comment history shows comments for all updates. If the advanced view for the project is enabled and you have permission to view it, you can see comments for tasks in the new phase by viewing task details on the **Tasks** tab of the advanced project view.

If you requested additional information during approval of an external questionnaire and entered a comment, the supplier sees the most recent approval comment when they revise their response to the questionnaire.

Related Information

[About the Questionnaires Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 232\]](#)

[Comparing Different Versions of a Supplier Management Questionnaire \[page 258\]](#)

[Requesting an Update or Changing the Recipient for a Modular Questionnaire \[page 240\]](#)

[Approving or Denying an Internal Form in a Modular Questionnaire Project \[page 248\]](#)

Ratings for Internal Forms and Questionnaires

Ratings can be useful in evaluating responses in internal forms or questionnaires.

Internal stakeholders of your organization can enter ratings in one or more internal forms or internal questionnaires of a project. Ratings enable your organization to create a formal methodology by which you evaluate responses. You use ratings to evaluate or "rate" the responses (on various parameters such as delivery, quality, service, price, compliance, and so on). The final rating is a simple aggregation of all the individual ratings entered by internal users in their respective internal forms or questionnaires.

These ratings are configured as questions in internal forms or internal questionnaires and can be included as part of a modular questionnaire project. The project can include external or internal survey questionnaires of type **Questionnaire** in addition to one or more internal forms of type **Form**.

For example, you may want to gather information on certain aspects related to mandatory environmental compliance, and this project may have several different components. Different internal users can complete forms in the same internal modular questionnaire project. Or you can have an external questionnaire asking a supplier to provide information, and include several internal forms in the project so that internal users can provide a rating of that information. The **Total Rating** field, if configured in the final form, displays the aggregate of all the ratings entered by previous task owners in their respective forms.

This functionality is available for both internal and external modular questionnaire projects. To edit an internal form in a modular questionnaire project, you must be either the project owner or the owner of an active To Do task on that form.

Filling out an Internal Form in a Modular Questionnaire Project

Internal forms in a modular questionnaire project typically provide information or analysis to supplement the project's key questionnaire. If you're the modular questionnaire project owner a To Do task owner for the form, you can fill it out and submit it.

Prerequisites

The internal forms in modular questionnaire projects feature (SM-30222) must be enabled in your site.

To fill out an internal form in a modular questionnaire project, you must be either the owner of a To Do task associated with the form or the project owner. To Do task owners can only edit the form while the task is active.

Context

A modular questionnaire project can include one or more internal forms in addition to its key questionnaire. The key questionnaire is the "main" questionnaire in the project. The recipient of the key questionnaire shows as the recipient for the entire questionnaire project, and can be a supplier contact (for an external modular questionnaire) or someone in your organization (for an internal modular questionnaire).

Internal forms can have To Do tasks and approval tasks. If there's no To Do or approval task associated with an internal form, filling it out is optional. If there's a To Do task associated with an internal form and you're a task owner, you must submit the form to complete the task. If there's an approval task associated with an internal form, you or someone else with edit permission must submit the form so that it can be approved and the project can be completed.

An internal form is editable in the following circumstances as long as the project doesn't have a **Denied** status:

Questionnaire project stage	Editability
New	From the time the questionnaire project is created until it's finally approved, internal forms are always editable. To Do task owners who aren't also the project owner can only edit the questionnaire while the task is active.
Update	After the questionnaire project has been finally approved, internal forms that don't have To Do tasks are always editable, even if the key questionnaire doesn't allow updates. Internal forms that have To Do tasks only become editable when the modular questionnaire recipient submits an update to the key questionnaire and the project returns to Pending Approval status, which is only possible if the key questionnaire allows updates. The forms remain editable until the update workflow that includes the key questionnaire is finally approved and the project returns to Approved status. This behavior applies whether or not the associated To Do task becomes active again. If the project's key questionnaire doesn't allow updates, internal forms with To Do tasks can't be edited again either once the project reaches Approved status.

If an approver denies any form or questionnaire in the modular questionnaire project, the project moves to **Denied** status and all of its forms and questionnaires close to further updates.

If the owner of a To Do task on an internal form in a modular questionnaire project is a project group, all members of that project group can potentially edit the form. The first project group member to submit the form and complete the task then becomes the owner of the completed task.

Procedure

1. Locate the supplier on the **Supplier Management** dashboard.
2. Choose their name to open their profile.
3. Perform one of the following actions:
 - In the supplier profile summary, choose the **Questionnaires** panel.
 - In the classic supplier 360° profile, choose **Questionnaires** in the left-hand navigation bar.
4. Perform one of the following actions:
 - **If the form isn't associated with an active To Do task, or if it's but you aren't the task owner:** On the **Questionnaires** tab, click the name of the questionnaire project where the form is included to open its details page. In the **Questionnaires** table, view the form, then choose **Edit**.
 - **If the form is associated with an active To Do task and you're a task owner:** On the **Tasks** tab, locate the task and act on it to open the task details page, where the form is automatically editable.

→ Tip

If the modular questionnaire project is included in a process project, you can also view the questionnaire project by clicking its name on the process details page. From there, you can either view the form and choose **Edit** from the **Questionnaires** table or act on an assigned To Do task from the **Tasks** table.

5. Fill out the form as needed.
6. Choose **Save** to save your responses in draft mode, and return later to complete and submit them. Saved draft versions aren't versioned, and only the most recent changes are included. An upgraded template for an internal form retains draft responses even after it has been upgraded.

Choosing the **Cancel** option in the **Edit** page opens a dialog box. If you choose **Confirm** in the dialog box, you lose all unsaved changes and are redirected to the previous page. If you choose **Cancel** in the dialog box, you stay on the same page and can continue updating the form.

By default, only the process owner can edit internal forms and save them as drafts. However, the process owner can request an update from a different recipient and invite them to update the form. The new recipient can see the responses saved previously and can provide their own responses. The new recipient can also overwrite previous responses if necessary, and save the draft again.

7. Perform one of the following actions:
 - On the details page for the form, choose **Submit**.
 - On the task details page for the form To Do task, choose **Mark Complete**.

Results

If the internal form has an approval task, that task starts and approvers approve or deny your answers.

Approving or Denying an Internal Form in a Modular Questionnaire Project

Internal forms in a modular questionnaire project typically provide information or analysis to supplement the project's key questionnaire. If you're in the approval flow of an internal form in a modular questionnaire project, you can approve or deny it.

Prerequisites

The internal forms in modular questionnaire projects feature (SM-30222) must be enabled in your site.

Context

Internal forms in a modular questionnaire project can have an approval flow defined by your organization. Depending on how a modular questionnaire project is set up, updates to the form can have the same approval flow, a different approval flow, or be approved automatically.

Note

Approval of the internal form doesn't directly affect the modular questionnaire project's status but is required to complete the project workflow. Denial of the internal form moves the entire modular questionnaire project to **Denied** status and closes it permanently. To reopen it, a user with permission to work in the advanced view must manually monitor the project's key questionnaire and reopen it. You can use the **Request additional info** option to ask the person who submitted the internal form to provide more acceptable answers instead of denying the form and closing the project.

Procedure

1. Locate the supplier on the **Supplier Management** dashboard.
2. Choose their name to open their profile.
3. Perform one of the following actions:
 - In the supplier profile summary, choose the **Questionnaires** panel.
 - In the classic supplier 360° profile, choose **Questionnaires** in the left-hand navigation bar.

The **Questionnaires** detail area opens.

4. Choose the **Tasks** tab.

The **Tasks** tab only shows tasks to which you've been assigned.

5. Act on the approval task.

The task details page opens.

6. Review the form answers.

→ Tip

If you're approving a form update, to display only the questions with updated answers, choose **Updated**. To display all answers, choose **All**. If the form has been updated multiple times, you can also [compare current answers with previous versions of the form \[page 258\]](#).

7. Perform one of the following actions:
 - To approve the form, choose **Approve**, enter an optional comment, and choose **Approve**.
 - To deny the form, choose **Deny**, enter a required explanatory comment, and choose **Deny**.
 - To request additional information from the respondent, choose **Request Additional Info**, enter a comment explaining what information or changes you want, and choose **Request Additional Info**.

Results

Any comments that you or other approvers added during form approval show on both the questionnaire details page for the form and on the approval task details page, which you can see by viewing the form or task. Questionnaire details pages show all comments for all tasks in the current phase for the project, and you can filter them to show us the comments for the current form. Task details pages show only the comments associated with the current task in the current phase.

If you're the final approver for the form, your approval completes the approval task and starts the next tasks in the modular questionnaire project workflow. The project remains in **Pending Submission** or **Pending Approval** status, depending on whether the recipient of the project's key questionnaire has viewed or submitted it.

If you denied the form, the modular questionnaire project moves to **Denied** status and all forms and questionnaires in the project close to further edits.

Viewing Modular Questionnaire Projects Based on Previous Template Versions After Template Upgrade

If a customer administrator in your organization has upgraded a modular questionnaire project to a newer version of the template, you can see project information across template upgrades, including changes to questionnaires, internal forms, tasks, and project and message history.

Prerequisites

To access the advanced view of a project, you must be either a member of the **SM Advanced View Access** group or the project owner or a member of the **SM Ops Administrator** group, depending on your site's configuration.

Context

When template creators in your site changes one of your organization's modular questionnaire processes by updating its project template, an administrator can upgrade the existing modular questionnaire projects that were created from it to the newer template version. Each template upgrade creates a new modular questionnaire project with the current project information and automatically archives the previous project based on the previous template version. The template version menu on the shows all of the template versions that have been applied to the modular questionnaire project, including the version number and the date on which the version was published. This template version menu is available in the following places:

- On the questionnaire details page, if the modular questionnaire project includes just a questionnaire.
- On the questionnaire project details page, if the modular questionnaire includes one or more internal forms in addition to the key questionnaire.

When you select a previous template version, the questionnaire details or project details page updates to show you the previous, archived project based on that version. Differences in template version can include:

- **Different process flow diagrams:** The process flow diagram shows the process flow for the modular questionnaire project based on the template version that you select, including tasks and task owners or approvers in that version.
- **Status of the modular questionnaire project:** An administrator in your organization can upgrade a modular questionnaire project to the latest template version when it has a status of **Not Responded**, **Denied**, **Expiring**, or **Expired**, or when it has **Approved** status and an update isn't in approval. The summary reflects the modular questionnaire project status at the time of upgrade to the selected template version. For example, a modular questionnaire project can have a current status of **Approved** for the current template version 3, but can be in **Expiring** status for template version 2 and **Not Responded** status for template version 1.
- **Different internal forms:** If the feature for allowing internal forms in modular questionnaire projects (SM-30222) is enabled in your site, modular questionnaire projects can include one or more internal forms in addition to the key or main questionnaire sent to the recipient. Whether internal forms are included in a modular questionnaire project, and which forms are included, can change with different template versions.
- **Questionnaire and form contents:** If the recipient hasn't submitted the questionnaire, or an internal form editor or To Do task owner hasn't submitted a form, viewing it shows the contents for the selected template version. Otherwise, questionnaire or form version history reflects changes to content across template upgrades as well as changes to answers.

If you have permission to access the advanced view of a modular questionnaire project, you can use the template version dropdown menu to access the advanced view of the selected template version. The advanced view also includes the following information for the selected template version:

- Questionnaire-specific notifications sent to recipients on the **Event Messages** tab.
- Questionnaire response activity history in the bid history for individual questionnaires.
- Project history.
- Project documents and tasks, which are always read-only in previous projects. For modular questionnaire projects, the only way to see previous project tasks based on previous template versions is in the advanced view.

Procedure

1. In the **Questionnaires** detail area of the supplier's profile, on the **Questionnaires** tab, view the questionnaire project for which you want to see previous versions.
2. On questionnaire details page or questionnaire project details page, choose a template version from the template version dropdown menu.

The questionnaire or project details page updates to show you the previous, archived modular questionnaire project based on that version.

3. (Optional) To access the advanced view of the previous project associated with the selected template version, click  (advanced view).

Next Steps

If you're in the advanced view of a project that has a previous, archived project from a previous template upgrade, the **Previous Project** field on the **Overview** tab shows its ID, and you can choose the ID to see that previous project.

Related Information

[About the Questionnaires Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 232\]](#)

[Comparing Different Versions of a Supplier Management Questionnaire \[page 258\]](#)

Status Flow for Modular Questionnaire Projects

During the lifecycle of a modular questionnaire project, its status moves from **Not Responded** to **Approved** or **Denied**. If the project is set up with an expiration schedule, or contains certificate questions that expire, the questionnaire can also have **Expiring** or **Expired** status.

Action	Status
The recipient has been invited to fill out the modular questionnaire and sent a link where they can do so. If the modular questionnaire project includes internal forms, this action refers to the key questionnaire.	Not Responded
The recipient has opened but not submitted the modular questionnaire. If the modular questionnaire project includes internal forms, this action refers to the key questionnaire. Opening internal forms doesn't change the project's status.	Not Responded > Pending Submission
The recipient has submitted responses to the modular questionnaire. If the modular questionnaire project includes internal forms, this action refers to the key questionnaire. Submission of internal forms doesn't change the project's status.	Pending Submission > Submitted
The approval process for the modular supplier management questionnaire has started. If the modular questionnaire project includes internal forms, this action refers to the key questionnaire. The starting of approval tasks for internal forms doesn't change the project's status.	Submitted > Pending Approval
An approver has asked the recipient for more information as a condition of approving the modular supplier management questionnaire. If the modular questionnaire project includes internal forms, this action refers to the key questionnaire.	Pending Approval

Action	Status
The recipient has resubmitted more information for the modular supplier management questionnaire and it's back in the approval process. If the modular questionnaire project includes internal forms, this action refers to the key questionnaire.	Pending Approval
All of the approval tasks on all questionnaires and forms in the modular questionnaire project have been finally approved. If the modular questionnaire project includes internal forms, this action refers to approval tasks on both internal forms and the key questionnaire.	Pending Approval > Approved
An approval task in the modular questionnaire has been denied project has been denied. If the modular questionnaire project includes internal forms, this action refers to any approval task on either an internal form or the key questionnaire.	Pending Approval > Denied
The recipient has submitted an update to a modular questionnaire. If the modular questionnaire project includes internal forms, this action refers to the key questionnaire. Submitting updates to internal forms doesn't change the project's status.	Approved, Expiring, or Expired > Submitted
The approval process for the modular supplier management questionnaire update has started. If the modular questionnaire project includes internal forms, this action refers to approval tasks on the key questionnaire. The starting of approval tasks on internal forms doesn't change the project's status.	Submitted > Pending Approval
An approver has asked the supplier for more information as a condition of approving the modular questionnaire update. If the modular questionnaire project includes internal forms, this action refers to the key questionnaire.	Pending Approval
The recipient has resubmitted more information for the modular supplier management questionnaire update and it back in the approval process. If the modular questionnaire project includes internal forms, this action refers to the key questionnaire.	Pending Approval

Action	Status
All approval tasks in the modular questionnaire project related to the current update have been finally approved. If the modular questionnaire project includes internal forms, this action refers to approval tasks on both internal forms and the key questionnaire.	Approved
An approval task related to the current update has been denied. If the modular questionnaire project includes internal forms, this action refers to approval tasks on both internal forms and the key questionnaire.	Denied
For a new or updated questionnaire, reminder notifications for an upcoming expiration have been sent in one of the following circumstances: • The modular questionnaire project itself has an expiration schedule. • The questionnaire contains a certificate question that is configured to update the questionnaire status based on the certificate's expiration. If both of these circumstances occur in the same questionnaire, and the certificate's reminders are sent before the questionnaire's reminders, the certificate's reminders trigger the status change for the questionnaire. If the modular questionnaire project includes internal forms, this action refers to the key questionnaire. Certificate management features, including expiration of the questionnaire project, aren't supported in internal forms.	Approved > Expiring

Action	Status
One of the following expiration dates has passed in a new or updated questionnaire: • The expiration date of the modular questionnaire project itself if it has been set up with an expiration schedule. • The expiration date of a certificate question in the key questionnaire that is configured to update the questionnaire status based on the certificate's expiration. If both of these circumstances occur in the same questionnaire and the certificate expires before the questionnaire, the certificate's expiration triggers the status change for the questionnaire. If the modular questionnaire project includes internal forms, this action refers to the key questionnaire. Certificate management features, including expiration of the questionnaire project, aren't supported in internal forms.	Expiring > Expired

Note

Modular questionnaire projects contain separate **Questionnaire Status** and **Questionnaire Update Status** fields. For new questionnaires, these status changes occur in the **Questionnaire Status** field. Once the recipient has updated the key questionnaire at least once, they occur in the **Questionnaire Update Status** field.

Common Activities in Supplier Management Projects

There are some common activities that you can perform in most or all types of supplier management projects. They include exporting questionnaires, comparing questionnaire versions, completing stand-alone To Do tasks, and viewing project activity history.

[Exporting a Supplier Management Questionnaire to Microsoft Excel \[page 256\]](#)

[Comparing Different Versions of a Supplier Management Questionnaire \[page 258\]](#)

[Completing a Standalone To Do Task in a Supplier Management Project \[page 259\]](#)

[Adding a Missing Approver to a Supplier Management Project \[page 261\]](#)

Exporting a Supplier Management Questionnaire to Microsoft Excel

Use these steps to export the content of a supplier management questionnaire to a Microsoft Excel workbook. Exporting questionnaire content makes it available offline or in another application.

Prerequisites

To export the content of a supplier management questionnaire, you must have permission to search for and view suppliers on the **Supplier Management** dashboard.

You can export questionnaires in supplier registration, qualification, disqualification, preferred supplier management, and modular questionnaire projects. You can't export supplier requests to Microsoft Excel.

Context

You can export the content of both internal and external questionnaires to Microsoft Excel from the following places:

- The questionnaire details page. To see the details page for a questionnaire, navigate to the applicable area of the supplier's profile and choose  (**View**) for the questionnaire. If the questionnaire has an approval flow, the questionnaire details page always shows the most recent approved answers for the questionnaire.
- The task details page, if the task is associated with a questionnaire. To see the details page for a task, navigate to the applicable area of the supplier's profile. If the task is a pending To Do or approval task and you're a task owner or approver, choose  (take action). If the task is completed, choose  (**View**). You can only see the

task details page for a pending task if you're a task owner or approver. In this case, it always shows the current answers to the questionnaire, even if it's not approved at that time. You can always see the task details for a completed task. In this case, if the questionnaire has an approval flow, the task details page always shows the most recent approved answers.

The questionnaire export always includes the recent questions and answers that show in the current view. If a questionnaire has been updated and has multiple versions, you can export all versions. The export generates a Microsoft Excel workbook with the following two sheets:

- **Project Details**, which include the ID of the questionnaire and its associated project.
- **Questionnaire Content**, which includes all content and responses in the questionnaire, including their numbers. This numbering reflects the numbering of content in the questionnaire layout (for example, section 3.1 and question 3.1.1) rather than content IDs.

Procedure

1. Navigate to the questionnaire or task details page for the questionnaire that you want to export.
2. If the questionnaire has multiple versions, choose the version you want to export from the version dropdown menu.
3. Choose **Export**.

Related Information

[Filling Out an Internal Registration Questionnaire \[page 128\]](#)

[Completing a Standalone To Do Task in a Supplier Management Project \[page 259\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a Qualification, Disqualification, or Requalification Based on a Supplier Qualification or Disqualification Project \[page 184\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a Preferred Supplier Category Status \[page 227\]](#)

[Approving or Denying an External Modular Questionnaire \[page 243\]](#)

Comparing Different Versions of a Supplier Management Questionnaire

Use these steps to see previous answers to a questionnaire alongside current answers in questionnaires with updates.

Prerequisites

To view the details of tasks that are in progress, including associated questionnaire versions, you must be an approver (for approval task) or a task owner (for To Do tasks).

To view the details pages for questionnaires and for completed tasks, you must have permission to view supplier profiles on the **Supplier Management** dashboard.

Context

Questionnaires that allow updates use versions to track previous answers. Questionnaires that allow updates include both internal and external registration questionnaires, internal qualification questionnaires (while the qualification is in progress), and modular questionnaires. Every new submission of a questionnaire generates a new version regardless of whether or not the respondent changed any answers before submitting.

Suppliers submit questionnaires when submitting initial questionnaires or questionnaire updates and responding to requests for additional information during approval. Internal respondents submit internal questionnaires by editing and submitting the questionnaires, responding to requests for additional information during approval, or marking To Do tasks associated with internal questionnaires complete.

The initial version of an external questionnaire is always version 1. For external questionnaires, the initial version 1 is the version that the supplier first submits. After approval, if the supplier submits an update, that update becomes version 2.

The versioning of internal questionnaires with prepopulated answers is controlled by the self-service configuration parameter [Create initial version of internal questionnaires on submission \[page 287\]](#), which an administrator sets in **Intelligent Configuration Manager**. By default, if at least one question in an internal questionnaire has an existing answer, the initial version 1 of the questionnaire is only created after an internal questionnaire editor submits it for the first time. The next update becomes version 2. When this parameter is disabled, if at least one question in an internal questionnaire has an existing answer, creating the project (for example, by inviting a supplier to register) also creates the initial version 1 of the questionnaire and records its approval decision as **Approved**. After an internal questionnaire editor submits it for the first time, the version updates to 2. The next update becomes version 3.

If a questionnaire has more than one version, the task or questionnaire details page includes **Previous Version** and **Latest Version** columns with version numbers for the current and previous updates. These columns also show the approval decisions associated with the versions, such as **Approved**, **Denied**, or **Additional Information Requested**, if any.

If the questionnaire includes a repeatable section, the version comparison highlights sections that have changed answers and shows the number of section instances in each answer in parentheses. If the repeatable section

includes a complex, multi-field question such as a bank account or tax question, the version comparison highlights the entire answer, not just individual fields in the answer where the values have changed.

If a customer administrator in your organization upgrades a project to the latest template version, the questionnaire version history includes previous versions from previous, upgraded projects.

Procedure

1. Open the questionnaire or task details page in the supplier's profile.
2. Perform any of the following actions:
 - To compare the current answers with older versions of the questionnaire, choose the version number in the **Previous Version** column, then select a version. The **Latest Version** column always shows answers from the current update.
 - To display only the questions in the currently selected versions that have updated answers, choose **Updated**.
 - To display all questions in the currently selected versions regardless of whether or not they've updated answers, choose **All**.
3. **Optional:** For repeatable sections in the questionnaire:
 - Choose a section link to see the answers in an individual repeatable section.
 - Choose **Compare** to compare repeatable section answers between questionnaire versions.

Supplier registration questionnaire

All Updated

Version V3

Question	Previous Version V2 (Approved)	Latest Version V3
Question	Answer	Answer
Tax Details		
Tax IDs	Tax IDs (1)	Tax IDs (2) Compare

Completing a Standalone To Do Task in a Supplier Management Project

If you're a task owner, use these steps to indicate that you've completed a project activity that's not related to editing an internal questionnaire by marking your assigned To Do task complete.

Prerequisites

To mark a To Do task in a supplier management project complete, you must be a task owner.

Context

To Do tasks can be associated with editing an internal registration or qualification questionnaires or they can be standalone, meaning not associated with an internal questionnaire. You complete a To Do task associated with an internal registration or qualification questionnaire by [filling out and submitting the questionnaire \[page 128\]](#). Completing a standalone To Do task can involve verifying or signing off on information in the project or completing an activity outside the project, after which you mark the To Do task complete.

Depending on how a supplier management project is set up, a To Do task can be required or optional. If it's required, a task owner must mark the task complete before other project owners can complete other parts of the workflow. Unlike To Do tasks in other types SAP Ariba projects such as sourcing or contract projects, To Do tasks in supplier management projects start automatically as follows:

Table 13: Triggers for Starting a Standalone To Do Task

Task Condition	Trigger for Task Start
Doesn't have a predecessor task and isn't on an external questionnaire in the project	The project is created
Has a predecessor task	The predecessor task is completed
Is on an external questionnaire in the project	The external questionnaire is submitted

If the owner of a To Do task is a project group, all members of that project group can mark it complete. The first project group member to do so becomes the owner of the completed task. In registration projects, if the To Do task has restarted because of a registration update, task ownership reverts to the entire project group so that all members can again mark it complete.

Restriction

Working with tasks in supplier management projects isn't supported in SAP Ariba mobile app.

Procedure

1. Navigate to the project details page.
2. In the **Tasks** table or **Tasks** tab, locate the To Do task to which you're assigned and click  (mark complete).
3. Enter a required comment.
4. Click **Mark Complete**.

Results

Any other project tasks for which your To Do task was a predecessor now start. The comment you added is visible on the To Do task details page, which you can see by viewing the task.

Related Information

[Filling Out an Internal Registration Questionnaire \[page 128\]](#)

[About the Qualifications Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 158\]](#)

[About the Registration Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 114\]](#)

[About the Questionnaires Detail Area in the Supplier Profile \[page 232\]](#)

Adding a Missing Approver to a Supplier Management Project

If a node in the approval flow for a supplier management questionnaire doesn't include any approvers, use these steps to add approvers manually so that the approval can be completed.

Prerequisites

The add missing approvers feature must be enabled in your site.

To see the missing approvers message and manually add a missing approver to an approval task on a supplier management questionnaire, you must be either the project owner or a member of the **SM Ops Administrator** or **SM ERP Administrator** group. You're the project owner if you created the project by creating a supplier request, inviting a supplier to register or fill out a modular questionnaire, or started a qualification.

Adding missing approvers is supported for tasks in the following types of projects:

- External and internal supplier request
- Supplier registration
- Supplier qualification
- Modular questionnaire

Context

Approval tasks can have approval flows with multiple nodes in a specific order. Each node can have different approvers. If a node in an approval flow can't be approved or denied because there's no approver, the approval becomes stuck.

When you create a supplier management project that includes an approval task with at least one missing approver, you receive an email notification. A message at the top of the questionnaire details page also alerts you that there are approvers missing from the approval flow. It includes details about which nodes in each approval task is missing an approver, along with links for adding missing approvers to each node.

You can only add one individual user in your site as an approver, and they must be a person in your organization who has a user account in your site. You can't add a project or global user group.

→ Tip

The list of available users that you can add as approvers has a maximum length of 1000. If you don't see the user that you want to add in the list, search for them instead.

Procedure

1. Click **Add missing approvers** in the missing approvers message.

The list of tasks and nodes that are missing approvers expands.

2. Perform the following steps for each approval node with a missing approver:
 - a. Click **Add missing approver for the node**.
 - b. Click ☐ (choose) for the approver you want to add.
 - c. Repeat these steps as necessary to add other missing approvers to other approval nodes for the current questionnaire.

Results

Each approver you added receives a notification letting them know that they need to approve the questionnaire, with a link that they can click to approve or deny it.

Next Steps

Depending on your site configuration, an approver requesting additional information from a questionnaire respondent either restarts just their approval node or restarts the entire approval process. If your site is configured to restart just the approval node, when an approver you added requests additional information, they remain the approver for that node. However, if your site is configured to restart the entire approval process, the approvers you added aren't retained and you must add them again.

Related Information

[Approving or Denying a Supplier Registration Questionnaire \[page 131\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a Qualification, Disqualification, or Requalification Based on a Supplier Qualification or Disqualification Project \[page 184\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a Preferred Supplier Category Status \[page 227\]](#)

[Approving or Denying an External Modular Questionnaire \[page 243\]](#)

Tasks in Supplier Management Projects

Approval Tasks in Supplier Management Projects

Approval of forms or questionnaires is an important part of the workflow for most supplier management project. Approval tasks in supplier management projects have some specific behaviors.

In some cases, approval tasks in supplier management projects have some important differences in behavior from To Do tasks in other types of SAP Ariba projects.

Approval tasks in supplier management projects are always on forms or questionnaires. The approval task always starts when its associated form or questionnaire is submitted. Completion of the final approval task in the project's workflow approves the project. In most cases, denying a questionnaire in the project denies the project. In supplier registration projects, whether or not an internal questionnaire approval affects the project's status depends on its configuration.

Registration projects are the only type of supplier management project to support creating a new round of an approval task after a denial. However, most approval tasks in most projects include a **Request Additional Information** option. This option allows approvers to ask questionnaire recipients to update unsatisfactory answers rather than denying the questionnaire. The option isn't available in approval tasks for registration questionnaire updates, since denial of updates doesn't affect the supplier's registration status, and a supplier can continue to submit updates to a registration questionnaire after denial.

If your site uses qualification and other process projects, they don't include approval tasks. Modular questionnaires included in process projects have approval tasks. However, the process's final status is determined by a process decision-maker or automatic decision assignment rather than by approval tasks.

Related Information

[Approving or Denying a Supplier Request \[page 102\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a Supplier Registration Questionnaire \[page 131\]](#)

[Starting a New Approval Round for a Denied Supplier Registration Questionnaire \[page 135\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a Qualification, Disqualification, or Requalification Based on a Supplier Qualification or Disqualification Project \[page 184\]](#)

[Approving or Denying a Preferred Supplier Category Status \[page 227\]](#)

[Approving or Denying an External Modular Questionnaire \[page 243\]](#)

[Approving or Denying an Internal Form in a Modular Questionnaire Project \[page 248\]](#)

To Do Tasks in Supplier Management Projects

Supplier management projects can include To Do tasks. These To Do tasks behave in specific ways to help supplier management workflows.

In some cases, To Do tasks in supplier management projects have some important differences in behavior from To Do tasks in other types of SAP Ariba projects.

Automatic Start

To Do tasks in supplier management projects automatically start when the project meets specific circumstances. In other types of SAP Ariba projects, task owners typically must manually start To Do tasks.

The To Do task's setup in the project determines when it automatically starts:

Table 14: When To Do Tasks Start

Task Setup	Circumstance for Automatic Start
Standalone (not on a questionnaire) and with no predecessors	Project creation
On an internal questionnaire, with no predecessors, and not set to auto-complete	Project creation
On an internal questionnaire, with no predecessors, and set to auto-complete	A user submits the internal questionnaire.
On an external questionnaire and with no predecessors	The supplier submits the external questionnaire.
Either standalone or on a questionnaire, with a predecessor task, and configured to start when dependencies complete. The questionnaire can be internal or external.	The predecessor task is complete.

Project Group Ownership

Since To Do tasks in supplier management projects start automatically, if a task owner is a project group, any member of the group can complete the task. In other types of SAP Ariba projects, the project group member who manually starts the task must also complete it.

Once a project group member completes the task, they show as the owner of the completed task.

If the To Do task restarts, ownership reverts to the project group assigned as the task owner and any member of the group can complete the task again.

Visibility in My Tasks

To Do task owners can see their assigned tasks by choosing **Manage > My Tasks** on the dashboard. By default, the **My Tasks** area shows all incomplete tasks, both active and inactive. Since To Do tasks in supplier management projects start automatically, they can show in the **My Tasks** list even if the part of the project workflow in which they're located hasn't started yet.

For example, if a registration project includes a standalone To Do task in the registration update phase, the task starts when the registration starts (project creation). At that point, task owners see it in their **My Tasks** lists. However, they can't complete it until the new registration is completed and the registration update phase starts, activating the To Do task.

Internal Questionnaire or Form Assignment

To Do tasks on internal questionnaires or forms in certain supplier management projects assign those questionnaires or forms to the task owners. Task owners act on their assigned To Do tasks to edit the questionnaire or form, and mark the task complete to submit it.

Related Information

[Completing a Standalone To Do Task in a Supplier Management Project \[page 259\]](#)

[Filling Out an Internal Registration Questionnaire \[page 128\]](#)

[Filling out an Internal Form in a Modular Questionnaire Project \[page 246\]](#)

Advanced View of Supplier Management Projects

Project Advanced View

The advanced view of a supplier management project provides access to some advanced actions, such as reopening closed questionnaires and editing certain project components.

To see the advanced view of a supplier management project:

- Access to advanced view for the project type must be enabled in your site.
- Depending on your site's configuration, you must be either:
 - The project owner or a member of the **SM Ops Administrator** or **SM ERP Administrator** group, if your site doesn't control access by the **SM Advanced View Access** group.
 - A member of the **SM Advanced View Access** group, if your site does control access by that group.

To edit project components, you must also be a member of the project's **Project Owner** project group.

Advanced view isn't available for supplier request projects in **Pending Resubmission** status.

Since advanced view provides access to, and ability to edit, some project components, it's important to understand best practices for using it.

- **Overview Tab** [\[page 266\]](#)
- **Documents Tab** [\[page 266\]](#)
- **Tasks Tab** [\[page 270\]](#)
- **Team Tab** [\[page 270\]](#)
- **Event Messages Tab** [\[page 271\]](#)
- **History Tab** [\[page 272\]](#)

Overview Tab

You can do the following things on the **Overview** tab in the advanced view of a supplier management project:

Table 15: Best Practices and Supported Actions on the **Overview** Tab

Action	Details	Additional Required Permissions
Edit the project owner.	Explicit project owners generally have broad permissions in their projects. By default, the explicit project owner is the person who created the project. To edit the project owner, choose ► Actions ► Edit Overview ► Note If you change the project owner to a user who isn't currently a member of the Project Owner project group, they're automatically added. The previous project owner remains a member of the Project Owner group unless you remove them manually.	Membership in the Project Owner project group.
Manually synchronize all questionnaire or task data or questionnaire answers for the project.	If a synchronization error has occurred, manual synchronization can correct it. Synchronization on the Overview tab applies to the entire project. For more information, refer to Correcting Questionnaire, Task, and Registration Status Synchronization Errors.	Membership in the Customer Administrator or SM ERP Administrator global user group.

The project's **Commodity**, **Region**, and **Department** attributes are always set by the template and can only be edited by SAP Ariba Support as part of an approved data fix.

Documents Tab

On the **Documents** tab in the advanced view of a supplier management project, you can:

Table 16: Best Practices and Supported Actions on the **Documents** Tab

Action	Details	Additional Required Permissions
Reopen a closed external questionnaire.	Refer to Reopening a Closed External Supplier Management Questionnaire [page 276].	Membership in the Project Owner project group.

Action	Details	Additional Required Permissions
Edit a questionnaire.	Select the questionnaire. For internal questionnaires: 1. Choose Prepare Response. 2. Choose Revise Response, then edit and submit the response.	Membership in the Project Owner project group.
Download questionnaire content in a Microsoft Excel file.	Select the questionnaire and choose Monitor. On the Content tab, choose  Document  Excel Export , then download the file to the location of your choice. This Excel export contains details about the questionnaire configuration that aren't included in the export from the questionnaire details page. Importing updated answers here isn't supported. To update the questionnaire, you can edit it in advanced view. An administrator can also import updates to external registration questionnaires in SM Administration. For more information, refer to Importing Supplier Registration Questionnaires.	None
View information about the supplier contact invited to an external questionnaire or remove or restore their access to the questionnaire.	Select the external questionnaire and choose Monitor, then choose the Participants tab. Locking the invited supplier contact removes their access to the questionnaire, and unlocking them restores it. To lock or unlock the contact, select them and choose Lock/Unlock. There's no visual indication that the contact is locked, but both locking and unlocking activities are listed on the questionnaire's Log tab. Both activities also generate notifications to the contact.	None

Action	Details	Additional Required Permissions
View the number of invitations and responses for a questionnaire.	Select the questionnaire and choose Monitor, then choose the Report tab. On this tab, Number Invited shows the number of different recipients that have been invited to an external questionnaire. This number can include internal recipients invited to an external questionnaire in an internal registration as well as supplier contacts invited or reinvited to the questionnaire. For internal questionnaires, which don't have invitations, this number is always 1. Total Responses shows the number of times a recipient or internal questionnaire editor has submitted the questionnaire.	None

Action	Details	Additional Required Permissions
View a detailed log of activity associated with a specific questionnaire.	Select the questionnaire and choose Monitor, then choose the Log tab. Since the system treats supplier management questionnaires as a form of event, the terminology on this tab is event-related. For example, questionnaires are called events, questionnaire responses are called bids, and questionnaire closing is called bidding ending. → Tip - For user-initiated actions, this tab lists the effective internal supplier contact user, and doesn't indicate whether or not someone is acting as that user. Members of the Customer Administrator can use the Site Manager > Audit Log task in Ariba Administrator to see when a user is acting as another user in your site, and compare those timestamps with user actions on the questionnaire Log tab. - For internal questionnaires, the Owner field on the questionnaire details page always shows the name of the first person who submitted the questionnaire. If the questionnaire allows updates, you can use entries on the Log tab to see who made subsequent edits, including the last submitted edit.	Membership in the Project Owner project group.
Synchronize questionnaire data, task data, or answers for a specific questionnaire.	If a synchronization error for a specific questionnaire or related task has occurred, manual synchronization can correct it. For more information, refer to Correcting Questionnaire, Task, and Registration Status Synchronization Errors .	Membership in the Customer Administrator or SM ERP Administrator global user group.

Note

While it's possible to upload and store documents that weren't created from the template on the **Documents** tab, this action isn't supported. Documents uploaded to individual projects in advanced view can exhibit unexpected behavior, and they're not transferred to the new project version during template upgrade.

Tasks Tab

On the **Tasks** tab in the advanced view of supplier management projects, you can:

Table 17: Best Practices and Supported Actions on the **Tasks** Tab

Action	Details	Additional Required Permissions
View task details	Select the task and choose View Task Details .	None
Update the name or description of an active task.	Select the task and choose Edit Task .  Note Don't edit other task settings. Changing task owners, approvers, or other settings after the project has been created can cause unpredictable behavior and block project workflows.	Membership in the Project Owner project group.
Complete a task.	Select the task and choose Approve , Reject , or Mark Complete .	Task owner or approver.

Team Tab

On the **Team** tab in the advanced view of supplier management projects, you can:

Table 18: Best Practices and Supported Actions on the **Team** Tab

Action	Details	Additional Required Permissions
Add or remove members of existing project groups, or add or remove project groups.	Choose ► Actions ► Team Members ► Edit and: - To add a project group, choose Add Group. - To delete a project group, select the group and choose Delete. You can't delete the Project Owner group. - To add a member to a project group, expand its Members field for the group, or choose the Add more link if it's present. Choose a name from the checklist, or search for additional users. - To remove a member from a project group, expand the Members field and select the group member to clear their checkmark. Note Project team membership in supplier management projects is defined by the template and your site's buyer category assignments (user matrix). If you edit the project team of an individual registration or modular questionnaire project in advanced view, and the project is then upgraded to the latest template version, your edits are overwritten by the template settings during upgrade.	Membership in the Project Owner project group.

Event Messages Tab

On the **Event Messages** tab in the advanced view of supplier management projects, you can:

Table 19: Best Practices and Supported Actions on the **Event Messages** Tab

Action	Details	Additional Required Permissions
View questionnaire-specific notifications (event messages) generated by the project, such as questionnaire invitations.	This tab only shows event messages. It doesn't show project or task notifications. In general, each questionnaire invitation has two versions: one for supplier contacts with known SAP Business Network accounts and one for supplier contacts with no known SAP Business Network account. The Event Messages tab shows both versions, but only one version is sent to the supplier contact.	Membership in the Project Owner project group. In some cases, the Project Owner project group must have the Event Access All Messages role to see the full list of messages. Members of other project groups with this role who can access the advanced view can also see the full list of messages.

History Tab

On the **History** tab in the advanced view of supplier management projects, you can:

Table 20: Best Practices and Supported Actions on the **History** Tab

Action	Details	Additional Required Permissions
View the project's activity history.	Project activity history includes questionnaire submissions, task completion, and automatic system activities. For more information, refer to Viewing a Project's Activity History [page 274].	None

Action	Details	Additional Required Permissions
View comments associated with tasks in a previous phase of a registration or modular questionnaire project (such a task in a new phase, after the project is in an update phase)	Registration and modular questionnaire projects support new and update phases for tasks. However, task and questionnaire details pages only show comments for tasks in the current phase. For example, while a new modular questionnaire is pending approval, the Comments area of the questionnaire detail page shows comments for tasks in the new questionnaire phase. Once the new questionnaire is approved and an update has been requested or submitted, and tasks in an update phase start, the Comments area no longer shows comments for tasks the new questionnaire phase. Instead, it shows comments for tasks in the current update phase. To see comments for a task in a previous phase, locate the entry for the task's completion in the project history. Searching by Type of Task and by timestamp or title can help narrow down the list of entries. Once you've located the task entry, choose the task name to open the task details page. It shows the comments associated with the task when it was completed.	None

Related Information

[Reopening a Closed External Supplier Management Questionnaire \[page 276\]](#)

[Disable participant view for supplier management questionnaires \[page 289\]](#)

[Viewing a Project's Activity History \[page 274\]](#)

[Importing Supplier Registration Questionnaires](#)

[Correcting Questionnaire, Task, and Registration Status Synchronization Errors](#)

[Managing Access to the Advanced View of Supplier Management Projects](#)

Viewing a Project's Activity History

Use these steps to view an audit trail of project activities and changes on the project's **History** tab.

Prerequisites

For supplier request, registration, qualification, disqualification, modular questionnaire, and process projects:

- The advanced view for the project type must be enabled.
- Your site's configuration determines who can access the advanced view for a type of project if it's enabled. If access to the **Advanced View** link is controlled by membership in the **SM Advanced View Access** group, members of that group can access the advanced view of a project. Otherwise, the project owner and members of the **SM Ops Administrator** and **SM ERP Administrator** group can access the advanced view of a project.
- You must navigate to the project's **Advanced View** before you can view the **History** tab.

For SAP Ariba Sourcing and SAP Ariba Contracts project types, you must be the project owner or a team member with permission to manage the project to view the **History** tab.

Context

The **History** tab displays an audit trail of changes to projects and activity in projects. The entries are created from database log and user sign in activities and actions to show who edited header fields, who opened documents and when, who completed tasks and when, and so forth.

Each entry contains the following fields:

- **Time Stamp:** Date and time the event occurred.
- **User:** Name of the user whose action is recorded.
- **Type:** Type of object for the action, such as **Workspace**, **Task**, or **Document**.
- **Title:** Name of the object for the action, such as My Workspace.
- **Details:** The action, such as **Edited** or **Created**.

Procedure

1. Navigate to the project's **Overview** area and choose ► **Actions** ► **Display** ► **Full View** ►.
2. To filter entries:
 - a. Navigate to the **Search Filter** area under the **History** tab. Select or specify values for the filter fields as appropriate:
 - **User**
 - **Timestamp**
 - **Type.** Select the type of entry. To select audit entries for activities performed on the project, choose **Workspace**. To select all entry types, choose **No Choice**.

- **Title.** Specify words in the title of the audit entry.
- **Overview Field Name.** The choices are dependent on the value of the **Type** field. To use this field, choose a value for **Type** other than **No Choice**.
- **Contract Attributes.** SAP Ariba displays meaningful choices only if the project is a contract workspace and the value for **Type** is **Workspace**.

b. Click **Search**.

Choose **Type** > **Workspace** and **Overview Field Name** > **Commodity** and click **Search** to display all audit entries for events related to the Commodity field.

3. If an entry has blue hyperlink text in the **Details** column, you can click the hyperlink value in the **Details** column.

For example, an entry for a contract workspace contains the value **Edited** in the Details column. Clicking **Edited** displays the following details about the edit to the workspace:

Food Beverage and Tobacco Products was added to Contract Workspace (Procurement)
Commodity

4. **Optional:** To export the entries to a Microsoft Excel file, click the table icon and choose **Export to Excel** > **Export All Rows** or **Export to Excel** > **Export Current Page**.

Related Information

[About the Activity log Detail Area of the Supplier Profile \[page 45\]](#)

[Project Advanced View \[page 265\]](#)

Viewing Audit Logs When Users "Act As" Another User

Important information is displayed in audit logs when an internal user modifies questionnaires or other project data on behalf of another internal user.

Context

Important information is displayed in audit logs when an internal user modifies questionnaires or other project data on behalf of another internal user by utilizing the "Act as" feature inside your organization. To view the audit logs:

Procedure

1. Open the supplier management project in [Advanced View](#).
2. Go to the **Documents** tab.

3. From the list of documents, click the document for which you want to view the audit log.
4. Choose **Monitor** from the menu.
5. Go to the **Participants** tab.
6. Click **Organization Name > Bid History**.

The Response History page opens. A few important details that are logged in this page:

- **Submitted For:** shows the user on behalf of whom the questionnaire was updated
- **Submitted By:** shows the user who actually updated the questionnaire
- **Submission Time:** shows when an update or request was submitted
- **Time Updated:** shows when data was updated

Reopening a Closed External Supplier Management Questionnaire

Use these steps to reopen a closed external questionnaire in project advanced view so that the invited recipient can once again edit and submit it.

Prerequisites

To see the advanced view of a supplier management project:

- Access to advanced view for the project type must be enabled in your site.
- Depending on your site's configuration, you must be either:
 - The project owner or a member of the **SM Ops Administrator** or **SM ERP Administrator** group, if your site doesn't control access by the **SM Advanced View Access** group.
 - A member of the **SM Advanced View Access** group, if your site does control access by that group.

To edit project components, you must also be a member of the project's **Project Owner** project group.

Context

In external questionnaires, the due date defines how much time a supplier has to fill out and submit a new questionnaire before it closes. The countdown to the due date starts when the supplier is invited to fill out the questionnaire. The questionnaire closes either when the supplier has submitted the questionnaire or when the due date is reached, whichever comes first. When the questionnaire is closed, the supplier can no longer edit it. The questionnaire reopens automatically when:

Questionnaire Type	Condition for Reopening
All external questionnaires	An approver requests additional information during the approval process.

Questionnaire Type	Condition for Reopening
External qualification questionnaires and external registration questionnaires in new registrations	A registration or qualification manager reinvites a supplier to fill out the questionnaire because the supplier didn't respond to the previous invitation by the due date.
External registration questionnaires in completed registrations	A questionnaire update is approved or denied.
External modular questionnaires	- A category or supplier manager reinvites the supplier to fill out the questionnaire because the supplier didn't respond to the previous invitation by the due date. - If the questionnaire allows updates, either the new questionnaire or a questionnaire update is approved.

Once a registration questionnaire or a modular questionnaire that allows updates has reopened, the supplier can edit and resubmit it until it closes again. The questionnaire's configuration determines whether it remains reopened indefinitely or closes again after a specific amount of time.

After a questionnaire has closed, it can only be reopened in one of the following ways:

- If the questionnaire is new and it has closed before the supplier responded to it for the first time, reinviting the supplier to the registration or modular questionnaire reopens it.
- If the questionnaire has closed after reopening for updates, a project owner who also has permission to work in the project advanced view must manually monitor and reopen the questionnaire.

Modular questionnaires can expire, but questionnaire expiration is a status change that indicates the current validity of the questionnaire content. It's not related to whether or not the questionnaire is open or the questionnaire due date. An expiring or expired questionnaire that is set to always open only closes if the supplier doesn't update it before its due date. Otherwise, it remains open until the supplier submits an update.

Only external questionnaires close based on due date settings. Internal questionnaires and forms don't have due dates, and their editability is determined by their project's specific lifecycle. For example, internal registration questionnaires are typically editable whenever they're not in approval.

Procedure

- On the **Supplier Management** dashboard, locate the supplier and choose their name.
- In the supplier's profile, navigate to the area that includes the project with the questionnaire you want to reopen:
 - For a registration questionnaire, navigate to the **Registration** area.
 - For a qualification questionnaire, navigate to the **Qualifications** area, then view the qualification project from the summary list.
 - For a modular questionnaire, navigate to the **Questionnaires** area, then view the questionnaire project from the summary list on the **Questionnaire** tab.
- Choose **Advanced View** .

The project advanced view opens.
- Choose the **Documents** tab.
- Choose the questionnaire, then choose  **Action**  **Monitor** .

The advanced view of the questionnaire survey document opens. Indications that the questionnaire has closed include a status of **Closed** on the **Overview** tab, which also shows the planned due date.

6. Choose the **Content** tab.
7. Choose ► **Actions** ► **Timing** ► **Reopen Event** ►.
8. Specify the amount of time to keep the questionnaire reopened. You can specify a relative duration, such as 90 days, or a fixed date.
9. Choose **OK**.

Results

The questionnaire reopens and the invited recipient can now edit and submit it.

📌 Note

Reopening a closed questionnaire doesn't resend any invitation notifications. If you need to ask the supplier to respond to the questionnaire once it's reopened, you must do so separately. Once a questionnaire has reopened, you can reinvite the supplier to it and generate a new invitation notification.

The advanced view of the questionnaire survey document now shows a countdown to the new due date you set. If the recipient hasn't responded by that due date, the questionnaire closes again.

Related Information

[Project Advanced View \[page 265\]](#)

[Reinviting a Supplier to Register \[page 120\]](#)

[Requesting an Update or Changing the Recipient for a Modular Questionnaire \[page 240\]](#)

[Managing Access to the Advanced View of Supplier Management Projects](#)

Site Configuration Parameters for Supplier Management

A number of supplier management features and functions are optional. Their availability in your site is controlled by site configuration parameters.

The parameters that control behavior of certain features and functions in your site can be either support-enabled or self-service:

- **Support-enabled parameters** can only be set by SAP Ariba Support.
- **Self-service parameters** can be set by an administrator in your organization. Depending on what they control, self-service configuration parameters are available in one of the following locations:
 - **Intelligent Configuration Manager**
 - **► SM Administration ► Configuration Parameters ►**

Some behavior in your site is controlled by feature toggles, which an administrator can also set, rather than by parameters. For more information, see [Supplier Management and Risk Self-Service Feature Toggles](#).

[Support-Enabled Site Configuration Parameters for Supplier Management \[page 279\]](#)

[Self-Service Site Configuration Parameters for Supplier Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager \[page 283\]](#)

[Self-Service Site Configuration Parameters in Supplier Administration \[page 318\]](#)

Support-Enabled Site Configuration Parameters for Supplier Management

Some of the functionality for supplier management is controlled by configuration options that SAP Ariba Support sets for you. These parameters apply to supplier management in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance and SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture).

Application.Password.NewPasswordTokenLifeSpan (set by SAP Ariba Support)

The `Application.Password.NewPasswordTokenLifeSpan` parameter is an integer value that specifies the amount of time, in hours, that a temporary password token remains valid after an administrator generates a password.

This parameter also controls the date displayed by the supplier registration deadline (`SUPPLIER_REG_DEADLINE`) token in notifications sent to suppliers.

The default value is 48.

Application.AQS.FileUploadMaxSize

Specifies the maximum size of files that suppliers can upload in events, surveys, and supplier management questionnaires in bytes. The default value is 104857600, or approximately 100MB. For supplier management questionnaires such as registration,

qualification, and modular questionnaires, this maximum only applies to supplier responses to external questionnaires.

Application.SM.DeleteHiddenItemsInRepeatableSectionsEnabled (set by SAP Ariba Support)

Enables the same automatic deletion and cleanup of item values for conditionally hidden questions in repeatable sections that occurs by default outside of repeatable sections. The default value is **No**. Set this parameter to **Yes** if any questionnaires in your site include repeatable sections in which one piece of content triggers visibility conditions on other content in the section, and recipient responses to requests for additional information during questionnaire approval that involve deleting existing instances of the repeatable section and then adding other instances of the same section result in submitted questionnaires that include both deleted and re-added instances.

Application.SM.DisableRepeatableSectionAutoPopulationValidation (set by SAP Ariba Support)

Specifies whether or not the a questionnaire automatically validates auto-populated items in repeatable sections when opened for editing. The default setting is **No**. Setting this parameter to **Yes** disables the automatic validation, which is necessary in rare cases where it causes an external questionnaire to generate additional instances of a repeatable section that suppliers are unable to delete, and that can prevent suppliers from submitting those questionnaires. This situation occurs for some external questionnaires that include 100 or more instances of repeatable sections.

Application.SM.DisableRepeatableSectionDeleteOnceRegistered (set by SAP Ariba Support)

Specifies whether or not suppliers updating external registration questionnaires after a supplier is registered can delete repeatable section answers such as bank accounts and tax IDs that were added during the initial registration. Setting this parameter to **Yes** means that once a supplier has achieved **Registered** registration status, suppliers do not see the **Delete** option for repeatable section answers when updating external questionnaires. It is useful if an integrated system separately deactivates or otherwise flags obsolete answers but does not expect them to be removed entirely. The default setting, **No**, means that suppliers can remove repeatable section answers from external registration questionnaires both during the initial registration and when updating questionnaires after registration.

Application.SM.IsStateCodePopulatedInS4 (set by SAP Ariba Support)

Specifies whether, in solutions where you have migrated from supplier organizations and supplier users to the unified vendor model, and plan to use an existing SAP Ariba integration toolkit or SOAP web service integration to continue to update suppliers in the unified vendor model after migration, the vendor push task enabled by `Application.SM.VendorPushTaskEnabled` pushes data in the supplier organization `CorporateAddress.PostalAddress.State` field to the `vendor.address.state` field (which has a maximum size of 2 characters) or the `vendor.address.stateName` field (which has a maximum size of 6 characters) in the unified vendor model.

The default setting, **No**, means that supplier organization state data is pushed to `vendor.address.stateName`. If you migrated your supplier organizations without the **Consider state as stateName** option enabled, supplier organization address state data was migrated to the `vendor.address.state` field. Disabling this parameter means that the vendor push task pushes updates to the same field.

Application.SM.ITKImportProfileInSM (set by SAP Ariba Support)

Specifies whether or not, in solutions where a customer has migrated from using the supplier profile questionnaire to supplier registrations in the unified vendor model, and has configured mappings between supplier profile questionnaire content and supplier registration questionnaire content, extended profile data imported using SAP Ariba integration toolkit or SOAP web service integration is synchronized from the now-inactive supplier profile questionnaire to the supplier registration questionnaires. The default value, **No**, means that there is no synchronization from supplier profile questionnaire to supplier registration questionnaires.

Application.SM.PopulateDefaultValuesOfRepeatableSectionInInternalQues (set by SAP Ariba Support)

Automatically populates text questions in internal questionnaires in repeatable sections with initial values from the template. If this parameter is disabled, these questions don't include any initial values from the template. Contact SAP Ariba Support to enable this parameter.

Application.SM.SyncEmptyRepeatableSectionToSM (set by SAP Ariba Support)

Specifies whether empty repeatable sections in the supplier view of external questionnaires on SAP Business Network are synchronized to the supplier management application. The default setting is **No**, meaning that when a supplier deletes the only remaining instance of a repeatable section in a questionnaire, the supplier management application retains that final instance and its answers.

This default behavior is designed to preserve one bank account or tax ID per supplier so that their removal does not cause integration errors with ERP systems that require bank account or tax data. It only occurs for the deletion of the final instance of a repeatable section. Deletion of all other instances up to the final instance are synchronized to the supplier management application and then to the integrated ERP system. The bank account or tax details in the final deleted instance remain visible in the **ERP data** detail area of the supplier's profile and continue to be included in integration messages sent to the ERP system, and there is a mismatch between the data in the supplier management application and the supplier view of the questionnaire.

Setting this parameter to **Yes** also removes the deleted repeatable section instance from the supplier's profile and synchronizes the deletion to the integrated ERP system.

Application.SM.VendorContactPushTaskEnabled (set by SAP Ariba Support)

Specifies whether or not supplier user data is synchronized from the classic supplier organization model or SAP Ariba Procurement solutions common suppliers to supplier contacts in the new unified vendor data model used by SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance and SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture) solutions. The synchronization occurs for a limited number of fields and is performed by the `SMVendorContactPushScheduledTask`. The default value, **No**, means that supplier user data is not synchronized.

The `SMVendorContactPushScheduledTask` is designed to synchronize a limited number of records. It is not designed to replace manual or automatic migration. If you enable this task as part of migrating supplier users to supplier contacts in the unified vendor model, only do so after data import or automatic migration tools have migrated your site's current data so that it can push post-migration updates.

Keep this task enabled if:

- Your site includes SAP Ariba Supplier Risk but does **not** include either SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance or SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture), and you maintain supplier user data in supplier organization profiles.
- Your solution includes SAP Ariba Procurement solutions and your configuration expects updates to common supplier users in SAP Ariba Procurement solutions to be pushed to SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance or SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture).
- You have completed supplier user migration to the unified vendor model, and you plan to continue using either the SAP Ariba integration toolkit or SOAP web service integration to send updates from an integrated ERP system to supplier organization profile fields after supplier user migration is completed.

If you have enabled this task to support a migration cut-over period after the initial automatic or manual data migration but do not meet one of the above circumstances, SAP Ariba recommends disabling it after migration is finally complete.

Application.SM.VendorPushTaskEnabled (set by SAP Ariba Support)

Specifies whether or not supplier data is synchronized from the classic supplier organization model or SAP Ariba Procurement solutions common suppliers to the new unified vendor data model used by SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance and SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture) solutions. The synchronization occurs for a limited number of fields and is performed by the **SMVendorSyncScheduledTasks** scheduled task. The default value, No, means that supplier data is not synchronized.

The SMVendorSyncScheduledTasks task is designed to synchronize a limited number of records. It is not designed to replace manual or automatic migration. If you enable this task as part of migrating supplier organizations to suppliers in the unified vendor model, only do so after data import or automatic migration tools have migrated your site's current data so that it can push post-migration updates

Keep this task enabled if:

- Your site includes SAP Ariba Supplier Risk but does **not** include either SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance or SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture), and you maintain supplier organizations.
- Your solution includes SAP Ariba Procurement solutions and your configuration expects updates to common suppliers in SAP Ariba Procurement solutions to be pushed to SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance or SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture).
- You have completed supplier organization migration to the unified vendor model, and you plan to continue using either the SAP Ariba integration toolkit or SOAP web service integration to send updates from an integrated ERP system to supplier organization profile fields after supplier migration is completed. In this case, the parameters **Application.SM.ITKImportProfileInSM** and **Application.SM.IsStateCodePopulatedInS4** might also be applicable.

If you have enabled this task to support a migration cut-over period after the initial automatic or manual data migration but do not meet one of the above circumstances, SAP Ariba recommends disabling it after migration is finally complete.

Application.SM.MQ.KeepMQStatusIfExpiredViaCertificate

Retains **Expired** or **Expiring** statuses of modular questionnaire projects that are achieved through certificate expirations after template upgrades. This parameter is disabled by default, meaning that modular questionnaire projects that have achieved **Expired** or **Expiring** status through a certificate expiration move to **Approved** status after template upgrade .

The following configuration option can only be set by SAP Ariba engineering. Contact SAP Ariba Support if you want this option enabled in your site.

skipBlankAnswersDuringMassInvite

By default, if a buyer mass invites a supplier to register, creating a registration project, if there are any optional questions in the external questionnaires that have vendor database field mappings where the database field is a blank value, and then the buyer adds answers to the questions through a method such as questionnaire import and again mass invites the supplier to the registration, those existing answers are overwritten by blank values from the mapped vendor database fields. Required questions and questions with no vendor database field mappings retain prepopulated answers. Setting this parameter to `true` skips resetting answers to optional questions that are mapped to vendor database fields with blank values to those blank values so that they also retain prepopulated answers when the supplier is reinvited.

Self-Service Site Configuration Parameters for Supplier Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager

Some of the functionality for supplier management is controlled by self-service configuration parameters in **Intelligent Configuration Manager**, which members of the **Customer Administrator** group can set.

These parameters apply to supplier management in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance and SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture).

For information about how to manage parameters, refer to the [Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#) topics.

[Allow request update on pending modular questionnaire statuses \[page 285\]](#)

[Automatically start supplier registrations \[page 285\]](#)

[Automatically synchronize supplier users from SAP Business Network \[page 286\]](#)

[Create initial version of internal questionnaires on submission \[page 287\]](#)

[Define the length of supplier bank IDs \[page 287\]](#)

[Disable field restrictions for field mappings in supplier management questionnaires \[page 288\]](#)

[Disable participant view for supplier management questionnaires \[page 289\]](#)

[Enable additional street lines in supplier addresses \[page 290\]](#)

[Enable API updates for external modular questionnaires with any status \[page 291\]](#)

[Enable certificate sections in supplier management questionnaires \[page 291\]](#)

[Enable country/region-specific visibility and optionality configurations for Bank Account fields \[page 292\]](#)
[Enable custom sender name options \[page 293\]](#)
[Enable Extended Address editing in supplier requests using Dun & Bradstreet lookup \[page 294\]](#)
[Enable improved user experience for internal questionnaires with visibility conditions \[page 294\]](#)
[Enable internal forms in modular questionnaires \[page 295\]](#)
[Enable internal supplier registrations \[page 296\]](#)
[Enable modular process framework \[page 296\]](#)
[Enable modular questionnaire template creation in sites with a basic supplier management entitlement \[page 298\]](#)
[Enable questionnaire recipients in internal registrations to see and edit otherwise masked answers \[page 298\]](#)
[Enable repeatable sections in internal questionnaires \[page 299\]](#)
[Enable enhanced filtering and pagination for standalone modular questionnaires \[page 300\]](#)
[Enable ratings and total ratings in internal forms or questionnaires \[page 300\]](#)
[Enable external validation of registration questionnaires using web services \[page 301\]](#)
[Enable external validation of modular questionnaires using web services \[page 301\]](#)
[Exclude vendor.vendorInfo.name3 from Dun & Bradstreet lookup in supplier requests \[page 302\]](#)
[Hide bank master data fields in Bank Account questions \[page 303\]](#)
[Hide timestamps in external supplier request names in project search \[page 304\]](#)
[Increase maximum size for name fields to 40 characters each in applied field restrictions \[page 305\]](#)
[Include previous approved answers in external validation of registration questionnaires using web services \[page 306\]](#)
[Include previous approved answers in external validation of modular questionnaires using web services \[page 306\]](#)
[List Extended Address fields for which blank updates from SAP Business Network clear data \[page 307\]](#)
[Make account holder name required in Bank Account questions \[page 308\]](#)
[Make Extended Address State/Province/Region Required Where Available \[page 308\]](#)
[Override existing source system with SAP domain values during vendor push \[page 309\]](#)
[Prepopulate process qualifications with request or registration commodities, regions, and departments \[page 310\]](#)
[Remove blank DUNS IDs in supplier data synchronization from supplier management to sourcing \[page 310\]](#)
[Reopen period for supplier questionnaires \[page 311\]](#)
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[Send Email Notification On Adding Supplier Contacts \[page 312\]](#)
[Set maximum length for Room ID in Extended Address \[page 313\]](#)
[Set minimum registration status for event participation \[page 314\]](#)
[Specify the Web Assistant JavaScript template URL for supplier management \[page 315\]](#)
[Start automatically-generated supplier bank IDs with 0001 \[page 315\]](#)

- [Use custom logo and footer for emails sent to suppliers \[page 316\]](#)
- [Validate required questions in repeatable sections in external questionnaires \[page 317\]](#)
- [Web Assistant in-context help for supplier management \[page 317\]](#)

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)

Allow request update on pending modular questionnaire statuses

Enables you to request updates for modular questionnaires with pending statuses.

ID	Application.SM.AllowRequestUpdateOnPendingModularQuestionnaireStatuses
Name	Allow request update on pending modular questionnaire statuses
Default value	No

Setting this parameter to "Yes" enables internal stakeholders of your organization to request updates for modular questionnaires that are in **Pending Submission** or **Pending Approval** statuses. After the request for update is sent, the modular questionnaire reverts to **Not Responded** status.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Automatically start supplier registrations

Specifies whether to start supplier registrations automatically (automatically create supplier registration projects) on approval of supplier requests.

ID	Application.SM.AutoStartRegistration
Name	Automatically start supplier registrations
Default value	No

The default value, **No**, means that a category or supplier manager must manually invite the supplier to register, either individually or in a mass invitation wave, after the supplier request is approved. Setting this parameter to **Yes** automatically sends the registration invitation email to a supplier as soon as the supplier request is approved without requiring a manual invitation.

This parameter is only applicable in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance and SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management(new architecture) solutions, which include supplier registration projects.

Note

If the feature for validating supplier requests in SAP Master Data Governance (MDG) is enabled, MDG validation is the final step in the supplier request workflow. In such a case, or when primary supplier contacts are added or imported for the very first time, you can ensure that supplier registrations are started automatically by enabling the configuration parameter **Application.SM.AutoStartRegistrationWhenPrimaryContactAdded** in

► **Manage** ► **SM Administration** ► **Configuration Parameters** ►.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager administration](#)

[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

[Reference of Configuration Parameters in Supplier Administration \[page 318\]](#)

Automatically synchronize supplier users from SAP Business Network

Specifies if new supplier users in SAP Business Network profiles are automatically synchronized with existing supplier organizations in your site.

ID	Application.A0D.EnableAdditionalSupplierUserDataSync
Name	Automatically synchronize supplier users from SAP Business Network
Default value	Yes

This parameter specifies whether or not new supplier users in supplier SAP Business Network accounts are automatically synchronized with existing suppliers in your site. If this parameter is set to **Yes**, the new users are added to your site as new supplier contacts.

A separate support-enabled parameter, **Application.A0D.EnableAutoApproveSupplierUserOnDataSync**, specifies whether or not the supplier contacts are automatically approved when they are synchronized, or whether they require manual approval.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)

[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Create initial version of internal questionnaires on submission

Creates the initial version of internal supplier management questionnaires that include prepopulated answers when the internal recipient submits the questionnaire for the first time rather than when the project is created.

ID	<code>Application.SM.CreateInitialVersionOfInternalQuestionnaireOnSubmission</code>
Name	Create initial version of internal questionnaires on submission
Default value	Yes

The default value of **Yes** means that version 1 is created when an internal questionnaire editor first submits an internal supplier management questionnaire that includes prepopulated answers, rather than when the project is created. For example, if a registration project includes one internal questionnaire, that questionnaire is created when the registration starts and the registration project is created. When this parameter is set to **Yes** and the questionnaire includes prepopulated answers, it's not assigned an initial version of 1 until an internal questionnaire editor submits it. Then, when an internal questionnaire editor next updates the questionnaire, its version updates to 2.

Setting this parameter to **No** means that when the project is first created, internal questionnaires with prepopulated answers are assigned an initial version of 1 immediately. When an internal questionnaire editor submits the questionnaire for the first time, its version updates to 2. Then, when an internal questionnaire editor next updates the questionnaire, its version updates to 3.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Define the length of supplier bank IDs

Specifies the length, in characters, of automatically-generated supplier bank IDs. An automatically-generated bank ID combines a country or region-specific prefix, defined by master data, and an automatically generated number. The maximum length is 4 characters.

ID	<code>Application.SM.BankIdSize</code>
Name	Define the length of supplier bank IDs

Default value 4

SAP Ariba automatically generates supplier bank IDs as sequential numerical values and, optionally, a country or region-specific prefix, with a maximum combined length defined by this parameter. For example, if you set this parameter to 4 and you do not define country or region-specific prefixes, SAP Ariba generates sequential, numerical bank IDs starting at 0000 up to a maximum of 9999 per supplier. If you set this parameter to 4 and define 3-character country or region-specific prefixes such as EUR and USD, SAP Ariba generates sequential bank IDs such as EUR0 through EUR9 and USD0 through USD9.

The related parameter **Start automatically-generated supplier bank IDs with 0001** (`Application.SM.InitializeBankIDFromOne`) specifies whether the automatically-generated IDs start with 0000 (the default) or 0001.

If you use country or region-specific prefixes for bank IDs, make sure that the value you set for this parameter is at least one character longer than those prefixes so that automatically-generated bank IDs include at least one number.

This parameter is only applicable in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance and SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management(new architecture) solutions.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Bank Account Questions for Collecting Supplier Bank Information](#)
[Country/Region-Specific Bank ID Prefix Data Import](#)
[Start automatically-generated supplier bank IDs with 0001 \[page 315\]](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Disable field restrictions for field mappings in supplier management questionnaires

Disables or enables the option for applying field restrictions to field mappings in supplier management questionnaires. These field restrictions suggest validation patterns and maximum lengths based on default SAP business partner configurations.

ID	<code>Application.SM.EnableSupplierFieldMappingRestrictions</code>
Name	Disable field restrictions for field mappings in supplier management questionnaires
Default value	Yes

Setting this parameter to **Yes** enables feature SM-12250, which adds the **Apply field restrictions** tool to pages for adding and editing questions in supplier management project templates. Template creators adding questions with answer types of **Text (single line limited)** or **Text (single line)** can add a field mapping to the **Supplier Field Mapping** field and then choose the **Apply field restrictions** button. The tool provides system-

generated suggestions for validation patterns and maximum field lengths based on default SAP business partner configuration for the mapped field. Setting this parameter to **No** disables this feature by removing the **Apply Field Restrictions** button from the page for adding or editing questions. If your integrated ERP system uses business partner configurations that differ from the defaults, setting this parameter to **No** prevents template creators from using suggested validation patterns and maximum field lengths that aren't necessarily valid for your integration.

By default, the **Apply field restrictions** tool sets a maximum field length of 35 characters for individual name fields (`vendor.vendorInfo.name1` through `vendor.vendorInfo.name4`) and, in sites with the supplier full name feature (SM-14213) enabled, 140 characters for the `vendor.vendorInfo.fullName` field.

If your site has enabled both the full name feature and the feature for increasing maximum length of individual name fields to 40 characters and the full name field to 160 characters (SM-36076), you can make suggestions generated by the **Apply field restrictions** tool match these increased lengths by also enabling [Increase maximum size for name fields to 40 characters each in applied field restrictions \[page 305\]](#).

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)

[Automatic Field Restrictions for Questions in Supplier Management Questionnaires](#)

[Adding a Question to a Supplier Form or Questionnaire](#)

[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

[Increase maximum size for name fields to 40 characters each in applied field restrictions \[page 305\]](#)

Disable participant view for supplier management questionnaires

Disables or enables the **View as Participant** option for supplier management questionnaires in project advanced view user interface. Since the associated functionality is not supported, the user interface option is disabled by default.

ID	<code>Application.SM.HideSMPProjectViewAsParticipantAfterEventPublish</code>
Name	Disable participant view for supplier management questionnaires
Default value	No

The default value for this parameter is **No**, meaning that the **View as Participant** option is visible by default. However, the associated functionality is **not** supported. Therefore, we recommend that you change the value of this parameter to **Yes**. This action hides the **View as Participant** option.

Note

Setting this parameter to **Yes** hides the **View as Participant** option from all users in your site, including customer administrators.

In SAP Ariba Supplier Risk, this setting is only applicable to modular questionnaires.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Enable additional street lines in supplier addresses

Enables additional street lines in supplier address questions in the supplier view of supplier management questionnaires and in project advanced view so that those views match the buyer view.

ID	Application.SM.EnableAdditionalStreetLines
Name	Enable additional street lines in supplier addresses
Default value	No

In supplier management questionnaires, default configurations of the **Address** and **Extended Address** questions include not only a main field for street address (line 1), but two additional street address lines (**Street 2** and **Street 3**). **Street 2** and **Street 3** automatically show in internal questionnaires such as the internal supplier request and internal registration questionnaires. By default, they do not show in the supplier view of external questionnaires in supplier SAP Business Network accounts or in project advanced view. Suppliers can only add or update address information for the main street address field.

If your configuration of **Address** or **Extended Address** questions includes **Street 2** and **Street 3**, setting this parameter to **Yes** shows those fields in supplier view so that suppliers can add or update that information in external questionnaires as well. It also enables those fields in project advanced view.

Note

The fields included in **Address** and **Extended Address** and questions can be customized. By default, both questions include **Street 2** and **Street 3** fields, but your site's configuration can vary.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Default Fields and Field Mappings in Address Question Answer Types](#)
[Address or Extended Address Questions for Collecting Supplier Address Information](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Enable API updates for external modular questionnaires with any status

Enables API updates to external modular questionnaires with any status, including questionnaires that are currently editable by the supplier. By default, API client applications can only update external modular questionnaires with specific statuses.

ID	Application.SM.MQ.AllowUpdateResponseOnAllStatusFromAPI
Name	Enable API updates for external modular questionnaires with any status
Default value	No

The default setting for this parameter, **No**, means that client applications can't use the `/answers` endpoint of the Supplier Data API with Pagination to update external modular questionnaires with **Not Responded**, **Pending Submission**, or **Pending Resubmission** status. Questionnaires with these statuses are editable in the supplier view on SAP Business Network. Setting this parameter to **Yes** removes this restriction and allows client applications to use the `/answers` endpoint to update external modular questionnaires with any status.

For example, when this parameter is enabled, a client application can prepopulate a modular questionnaire with data from an external system such as an ERP system immediately after a modular questionnaire manager or process initiator has invited the supplier to fill it out, while it's still in **Not Responded** status. The invited supplier contact sees the prepopulated answers and can verify them and update them as needed when submitting the questionnaire for the first time.

The Supplier Data API with Pagination `/answers` endpoint always allows updates to **internal** modular questionnaires with any status regardless of the setting of this parameter.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Use of the Supplier Data API with Pagination answers Endpoint](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Enable certificate sections in supplier management questionnaires

This parameter enables you to configure certificate sections in supplier management questionnaires.

ID	Application.SM.CustomizableCertificateSectionSupport
Name	Enable certificate sections in supplier management questionnaires
Default value	False

The default value of **False** means that certificate section can't be added in the internal and external modular supplier management questionnaire template. Setting this parameter to **True** provides option to add a certificate section in the modular supplier management questionnaire template.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Enable country/region-specific visibility and optionality configurations for Bank Account fields

Enables configuration of the visibility and optionality based on bank country/region of some fields in **Bank Account** questions, such as bank key, account number, and IBAN number.

ID	Application.SM.EnableBankComponentVisibility
Name	Enable country/region-specific visibility and optionality configurations for Bank Account fields
Default value	No

Bank Account questions, which collect supplier bank information, include a set of predefined fields. By default, all of those fields are visible. Either **IBAN Number** or a combination of **Bank Key/ABA Routing Number** and **Account Number** is required for all countries/regions.

When this parameter is set to **No**, this default behavior always applies. Any values in the the **Visible** and **Mandatory** fields for **IBAN Number**, **Bank Key/ABA Routing Number**, and **Account Number** in bank syntax validation data files are ignored during data imports.

Setting this parameter to **Yes** does the following things:

- Adds default data to the **Visible** and **Mandatory** fields for **IBAN Number**, **Bank Key/ABA Routing Number**, and **Account Number** in bank syntax validation data files and reads any values present in those columns during data imports.
For **Bank Key/ABA Routing Number** and **Account Number**, these columns are in the **BankValidationMetaData.csv** file that [defines country/region-specific syntax validation for account numbers and bank key or ABA routing numbers.](#)
For **IBAN Number**, these columns are in the **BankIBANMetaData.csv** file that [defines country/region-specific syntax validation for IBAN numbers.](#)
- Bases visibility and requirements for these three fields on this bank syntax validation data.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)

[Country/Region-Specific Validation Syntax, Visibility, and Optionality for Supplier Bank Account IBAN Number Data Import](#)

[Country/Region-Specific Syntax Validation, Visibility, and Optionality for Supplier Bank Account Holder Name, Account Number, and Bank Key or ABA Routing Number Data Import](#)

[Bank Account Questions for Collecting Supplier Bank Information](#)

[Syntax Validation, Visibility, and Optionality for Supplier Bank Account Information](#)

[Predefined Fields and Field Mappings in Bank Account Questions](#)

[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Enable custom sender name options

Enables a setting in template external registration questionnaires where template creators can specify a default sender for registration invitations. This sender shows in the “From” fields of registration invitation emails unless overridden by requester selection during manual registration invitations.

Full name	<code>Application.SM.EnableCustomSenderName</code>
Name	Enable custom sender name options
Default value	No

When this parameter is set to **Yes**, the **Message Board** area of the **Rules** step in survey documents in the supplier registration project template includes a setting, **Sender name used in the 'From' field in emails to participants**, that template creators can use to specify a custom sender name such as a supplier onboarding group for email notifications to suppliers related to registration invitations.

If this parameter is set to **No**, or if it is set to **Yes** but a template creator has not configured a custom sender name for an external registration questionnaire, the associated registration invitations use a generic system alias or the registration project owner name instead, depending on questionnaire configuration.

This parameter is only applicable in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance and SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management(new architecture) solutions.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)

[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Enable Extended Address editing in supplier requests using Dun & Bradstreet lookup

Makes **Extended Address** questions editable in supplier requests using Dun & Bradstreet lookup during both initial request submission and approval. **Extended Address** answers are populated automatically by D&B lookup and are read-only when this parameter is disabled.

ID	Application.SM.IsExtendedAddressSectionEditableForDNBLookup
Name	Enable Extended Address editing in supplier requests using Dun & Bradstreet lookup
Default value	No

In the supplier request with Dun & Bradstreet lookup, the lookup prepopulates fields in the **Extended Address** question with address data from D&B, which isn't always complete. By default, when this parameter is disabled, all of the fields in the supplier request that are populated by the D&B lookup are read-only, including all **Extended Address** fields except for **Region**.

When this parameter is enabled, the requester and the users who have permission to edit a supplier request during approval can edit all fields in **Extended Address** questions to add missing information in required fields or to make corrections. Edited address information isn't overwritten by subsequent D&B data pulls, and it's synchronized to integrated ERP systems and to supplier registration questionnaires that include corresponding mapped address questions.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)

[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

[Dun & Bradstreet Integration with SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance](#)

Enable improved user experience for internal questionnaires with visibility conditions

Enables or disables the improved user experience for internal questionnaires with visibility conditions, which processes conditions in the background so that recipients can continue to edit the questionnaire during that processing. Enable or disable this parameter depending on the performance of your internal questionnaires.

ID	Application.SM.SMUIConditionEvaluation
Name	Enable improved user experience for internal questionnaires with visibility conditions
Default value	No

This parameter is one of two settings required for improved user experience for internal questionnaires with visibility conditions. You can set it in **Intelligent Configuration Manager**. The other required setting is the

Application.SM.SMUIConditionEvaluation configuration parameter in ► **SM Administration** ► **Configuration Parameters** ►. Always enable or disable both parameters together.

The setting of **Yes** means that the recipients can continue to edit the questionnaire during processing. You can enable or disable this parameter depending on the performance of your internal questionnaires.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)

[Reference of Configuration Parameters in Supplier Administration \[page 318\]](#)

[Managing Configuration Parameters in Supplier Administration \[page 353\]](#)

Enable internal forms in modular questionnaires

Enables or disables support for additional internal forms with To Do and approval tasks in modular questionnaire projects. Important: enabling or disabling this parameter requires a corresponding change to the **Application.SM.MQEnableInternalFormsinModularQuestionnaires** parameter in ► **SM Administration** ► **Configuration Parameters** ►.

ID	Application.SM.MQ.EnableInternalFormsinModularQuestionnaires
Name	Enable internal forms in modular questionnaires
Default value	No

This parameter is one of two required settings that enable or disable support for internal forms with associated To Do and approval tasks in modular questionnaire projects (SM-30222). You set it in **Intelligent Configuration Manager**. The other required setting is the **Application.SM.MQEnableInternalFormsinModularQuestionnaires** parameter in ► **SM Administration** ► **Configuration Parameters** ►. Always enable or disable both parameters together.

Internal forms are a way of collecting information in modular questionnaire projects that is additional to or supplements the information provided by the questionnaire project recipient in the key or main questionnaire. You can use these internal forms and associated To Do and approval tasks to provide supplementary information or analysis, or affirm actions performed in other systems.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)

Enable internal supplier registrations

Enables or disables internal registrations, where buyers complete registration projects on behalf of suppliers.

Important: enabling or disabling internal registration also requires a corresponding change in ► **SM**

Administration ► **Configuration Parameters** ►

ID	Application.SM.InternalRegistrationEnabled
Name	Enable internal supplier registrations
Default value	Yes

This parameter is one of two settings that control the availability of the internal registration feature, where buyers can complete registration projects on behalf of suppliers, in your site. You set it in **Intelligent Configuration Manager**. The other required setting is the **Application.SM.InternalRegistrationEnabled** parameter in ► **SM Administration** ► **Configuration Parameters** ►. **Always enable or disable both parameters together.**

The default value of **Enable internal supplier registrations** is **Yes**, meaning that the internal registration feature is enabled by default. Setting this parameter to **No** and making a corresponding change to **Application.SM.InternalRegistrationEnabled** in ► **SM Administration** ► **SM Administration** ► disables internal registration in your site, meaning that buyers can't complete registration on behalf of suppliers.

⚠ Caution

If you want to disable internal registrations, SAP Ariba recommends doing so before any internal registrations are created in your site. Disabling this feature prevents completion of any internal registration projects that are in progress and removes the mechanism for inviting suppliers to participate in completed internal registrations.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Reference of Configuration Parameters in Supplier Administration \[page 318\]](#)
[Managing Configuration Parameters in Supplier Administration \[page 353\]](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Enable modular process framework

Enables or disables the modular process framework for qualification and other lifecycle processes, which includes process projects and associated functionality. Important: enabling or disabling this parameter requires

a corresponding change to the **Application.SM.Process.EnableModularProcessFramework** parameter in **SM Administration > Configuration Parameters**.

ID	Application.SM.Process.EnableModularProcessFramework
Name	Enable modular process framework
Default value	No

This parameter is one of two required settings to enable the modular process framework feature (SM-16798) in your site and is set in **Intelligent Configuration Manager**. The other required setting is the **Application.SM.Process.EnableModularProcessFramework** parameter in **SM Administration > Configuration Parameters**. **Always enable or disable both parameters together.**

Process projects provide a flexible, repeatable framework that allows process initiators to create different supplier management processes for different types of suppliers using different combinations of modular supplier management questionnaires. They allow you to tailor questionnaire content to specific suppliers, to leverage and reuse modular questionnaires across different processes, and to create custom processes for your specific supplier lifecycle activities. The feature includes:

- Process project templates.
- Specialized settings in modular questionnaire project templates for questionnaires used in process projects.
- Data imports for setting up process projects and for importing supplier processes.
- Workflow pages for creating and managing processes.
- Additional elements in the supplier profile for viewing and managing processes.
- A filter for process statuses in supplier searches.

Caution

Enabling the flexible process framework feature (SM-16798) in your site immediately disables creation of new projects from the legacy supplier qualification project template and introduces other restrictions to legacy supplier qualifications and disqualifications. If you manage supplier qualifications using supplier qualification and disqualification projects, only enable this feature when you're prepared to transition to process qualifications. For details, refer to [Transition from Legacy Supplier Qualification Projects to Qualification Process Projects \[page 167\]](#).

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Workflow for Setting Up Qualification and Miscellaneous Process Projects](#)
[Qualification and Miscellaneous Supplier Management Process Projects \[page 188\]](#)
[Managing Configuration Parameters in Supplier Administration \[page 353\]](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Enable modular questionnaire template creation in sites with a basic supplier management entitlement

Enables creation of modular questionnaire project templates in sites that have the basic supplier management entitlement and a solution package where modular questionnaires are a supported feature.

ID	Application.SM.MQ.EnableMQCreationWithSMBasicConfig
Name	Enable modular questionnaire template creation in sites with a basic supplier management entitlement
Default value	No

This feature enables the **SM Modular Questionnaire** project type in the **Templates** area in sites that have a basic supplier management entitlement for core supplier management features. You must be a member of both the **Template Creator** and **SM Modular Questionnaire Manager** group to create modular questionnaire templates.

Enabling this parameter isn't necessary if your site includes either SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance or SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture). Sites that include either of these solutions automatically include modular questionnaire project templates and other core supplier management features. However, if your site includes SAP Ariba Supplier Risk without one of these solutions, you must enable this parameter to create project templates for engagement risk assessments.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)

[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

[Features and Functions for Managing Suppliers and Supplier Lifecycles \[page 8\]](#)

Enable questionnaire recipients in internal registrations to see and edit otherwise masked answers

Enables questionnaire recipients in internal registrations to see and edit otherwise masked answers in their assigned questionnaires. This setting only applies to external questionnaires in internal registrations on behalf of the supplier.

ID	Application.SM.EnableOB0UserCanViewOrEditMaskData
Name	Enable questionnaire recipients in internal registrations to see and edit otherwise masked answers
Default value	No

By default, internal recipients of external questionnaires in internal registrations also required membership in the **Sensitive Data Access** group to view and edit masked answers in those questionnaires. Membership in the **Sensitive Data Access** group allows a user to see masked data in any questionnaire they can view.

Enabling this parameter allows the internal recipients of external questionnaires in registrations on behalf of suppliers to see and edit answers that are otherwise masked, even if they're not members of the **Sensitive Data Access** group. Masked answers can be prepopulated data from other sources such as an ERP system, or they can be answers that the recipient previously provided and for which an approver has requested more information. Enabling this parameter allows internal recipients to complete internal registrations on behalf of suppliers by updating those answers in their assigned questionnaires without granting them access to sensitive data in all questionnaires.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)

[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

[Sensitive Data Masking in Supplier Forms and Questionnaires](#)

[Filling Out an External Registration Questionnaire on Behalf of a Supplier in an Internal Registration \[page 130\]](#)

Enable repeatable sections in internal questionnaires

Enables creation and editing of repeatable sections in internal questionnaires, including external registration questionnaires in internal registrations. Important: enabling or disabling this parameter requires a corresponding change to the **Application.SM.RepeatableSectionsInInternalQuestionnaires** parameter in ► **SM Administration** ► **Configuration Parameters** ►.

ID	Application.SM.RepeatableSectionsInInternalQuestionnaires
Name	Enable repeatable sections in internal questionnaires
Default value	No

This parameter is one of two required settings for enabling or disabling the ability to create and edit repeatable sections in internal questionnaires, including external supplier registration questionnaires in internal registrations. You set it in **Intelligent Configuration Manager**. The other required setting is the **Application.SM.RepeatableSectionsInInternalQuestionnaires** parameter in ► **SM Administration** ► **Configuration Parameters** ►. **Always enable or disable both parameters together.**

Suppliers can always add or edit repeatable sections in external questionnaires on SAP Business Network. However, by default buyer users can only view repeatable sections added or edited by suppliers. Enabling these parameters allows internal questionnaire editors, including the recipients of external questionnaires in internal registration questionnaires, to add or edit repeatable sections as well.

If you allow internal registrations and at least one of your external registration questionnaires includes a repeatable section, make sure to enable these parameters so that internal recipients can answer those questions.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Enable enhanced filtering and pagination for standalone modular questionnaires

Enables enhanced filtering and pagination in the workflow for sending standalone modular questionnaires.

ID	Application.SM.MQ.EnableStandaloneMQEnhancement
Name	Enable enhanced filtering and pagination for standalone modular questionnaires
Default value	No

This parameter is one of two required settings to enable enhanced filtering and pagination in the workflow for sending standalone modular questionnaires, and is set in **Intelligent Configuration Manager**. The other required setting is the **Application.SM.MQ.EnableStandaloneMQEnhancement** parameter in **SM Administration > Configuration Parameters**. **Always enable or disable both parameters together.**

Setting this parameter to **Yes** allows for content in the standalone external modular questionnaire list to:

- load much faster.
- be filtered based on **Questionnaire Type**, **Category**, **Department**, and **Region**.
- include additional search filters such as **Questionnaire Status** of suppliers, and **Expiry Date** of questionnaires.
- select 500 suppliers instead of 100 suppliers.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Enable ratings and total ratings in internal forms or questionnaires

Enables internal stakeholders to enter ratings and total ratings in internal forms or questionnaires.

ID	Application.SM.MQ.EnableRatingandAggregationInInternalForms
Name	Enable rating and aggregation in internal forms

Default value **No**

Setting this parameter to "Yes" enables internal stakeholders of your organization to enter ratings in one or more internal forms or internal questionnaires of a project. It also enables them to view the final ratings. A final rating is a simple aggregation of all the individual ratings.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Enable external validation of registration questionnaires using web services

Indicates whether suppliers questionnaire responses require external validation

ID	<code>Application.SM.ExternalValidationEnabled</code>
Name	Enable external validation of registration questionnaires using web services
Default value	No

By default this parameter is disabled. After enabling this parameter you will be able to mark questions for external validation. **Marks Responses for External Validation** checkbox should be checked in the template configuration. This will send the supplier responses for validation to the external system.

Note

It is recommended that you should mark only required questionnaires for external validation. For validation of Registration questionnaire, the attachment type cannot be validated.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Enable external validation of modular questionnaires using web services

Indicates whether suppliers questionnaire responses require external validation for modular questionnaires

ID	<code>Application.SM.ExternalValidationEnabledForMQ</code>
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Name	Enable external validation of modular questionnaires using web services
Default value	No

By default this parameter is disabled. After enabling this parameter you will be able to mark modular questionnaire for external validation. **Marks Responses for External Validation** checkbox should be checked in the template configuration. This will send the supplier responses for validation to the external system.

Note

It is recommended that you should mark only required questionnaires for external validation. For validation of Modular questionnaire, the attachment type and the certificate in the attachment type cannot be validated.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Exclude vendor.vendorInfo.name3 from Dun & Bradstreet lookup in supplier requests

When enabled, excludes the `vendor . vendorInfo . name3` field from Dun & Bradstreet lookup and makes inclusion of a question mapped to the field in the supplier request with D&B lookup optional. If the request configuration does include a question mapped to the field, it's editable. By default, the supplier request with D&B lookup must include a question mapped to `vendor . vendorInfo . name3`, it's automatically prepopulated with D&B data if available, and it's read-only.

ID	<code>Application.SM.ExcludeName3FieldFromDnB</code>
Name	Exclude vendor.vendorInfo.name3 from Dun & Bradstreet lookup in supplier requests
Default value	No

By default, the supplier request with D&B lookup must include a question mapped to `vendor . vendorInfo . name3`, it's automatically prepopulated with D&B data if available, and it's read-only. The request automatically concatenates the values in `vendor . vendorInfo . name1` and `vendor . vendorInfo . name3` fields to show in the user interface and synchronize to an integrated ERP system. However, if the `vendor . vendorInfo . name3` value populated by the D&B lookup is identical to the `vendor . vendorInfo . name1` value selected or added by the requester, the resulting concatenated name can be confusing to users and can synchronize inaccurate name data to the ERP system.

If this parameter is enabled:

- The `vendor . vendorInfo . name3` field isn't included in the D&B lookup, and therefore isn't populated with D&B data.

- The `vendor.vendorInfo.name3` question is optional in the supplier request. If it's included, the requester can edit the question to add a value.
- Only the `vendor.vendorInfo.name1` field is shown in the user interface and synchronized to an integrated ERP system. Since this field has a maximum length of 35 characters, any remaining characters are truncated.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)

[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

[Dun & Bradstreet Integration with SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance](#)

Hide bank master data fields in Bank Account questions

Hides bank master data fields such as bank name, branch, state, street, postal code, and city in **Bank Account** questions.

ID	<code>Application.SM.HideBankMasterFields</code>
Name	Hide bank master data fields in Bank Account questions
Default value	No

Bank Account questions, which collect supplier bank information, include a set of predefined fields that are visible by default. This parameter controls whether some of those fields are hidden, and therefore uneditable, in questionnaires in your site. When set to **Yes**, it hides the following fields:

- **Name**
- **Bank Branch**
- **Street**
- **City**
- **State/Province/Region**
- **Postal Code**

These fields are considered bank master data and are typically maintained with bank master records in an integrated ERP system. Hiding these fields avoids confusion for questionnaire recipients who don't know these details and prevents them from entering answers that conflict with the ERP bank master records. This parameter's default setting, **No**, means that the predefined bank master data fields in **Bank Account** questions are visible and questionnaire recipients can edit them.

These fields are visible in the **ERP data** detail area of the supplier profile even when hidden in questionnaires.

If you have existing suppliers with **Bank Account** data, when you enable this parameter, questionnaire recipients can no longer see bank master data they previously added.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)

[Enable country/region-specific visibility and optionality configurations for Bank Account fields \[page 292\]](#)

[Bank Account Questions for Collecting Supplier Bank Information](#)

[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Hide timestamps in external supplier request names in project search

Hides the timestamps in the names of external supplier requests in project search results. These timestamps reflect the server time zone rather than the time zone where the request was submitted.

ID	Application.SM.ExcludeDateInSupplierRequestTitle
Name	Hide timestamps in external supplier request names in project search
Default value	No

By default, when you search for external supplier request projects using project search on the **Home** dashboard, search results include a "submitted on" timestamp in the supplier request project name. Other types of supplier management projects, such as registrations and modular questionnaires, don't include this timestamp in project search results. The timestamp in search results reflects the time the external supplier request was submitted in the server time zone, while the project history for the external supplier request shows the timestamp in the time zone of the submitting supplier. If you don't find the timestamps in project search results useful, or if they confuse users in your site, you can hide them by setting this parameter to **Yes**.

Note

Setting this parameter to **Yes** hides timestamps in the names of external supplier requests created after the parameter is enabled. It doesn't hide timestamps in the names of external supplier requests created before the parameter was enabled.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)

[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Increase maximum size for name fields to 40 characters each in applied field restrictions

Increases the maximum field size settings for questions mapped to `vendor . vendor . Info . name1` through `vendor . vendorInfo . name4` from 35 to 40 characters each, and the setting for `vendor . vendorInfo . fullName` to from 140 to 160 characters, in question configurations that use the **Apply Field Restrictions** validation tool. Keep this parameter enabled if name fields in an integrated ERP system also have 40 character maximum lengths (160 total), or disable it if the ERP system's name fields have a 35 character maximum length (140 total).

ID	<code>Application.SM.Enable160CharacterSupportForFullName</code>
Name	Increase maximum size for name fields to 40 characters each in applied field restrictions
Default value	No

The **Apply Field Restrictions** validation tool on pages for adding or editing questions in supplier management project templates validates field mappings and suggests values for ERP-related settings such as maximum length. By default, it sets a maximum length of 35 characters for individual name fields and 140 characters for the full name field. These default settings are appropriate in sites integrated with SAP ECC, where name fields have the same maximum lengths.

Enable this parameter to increase maximum length settings to 40 for individual name fields and 160 for the full name field if your site meets the following conditions:

- The supplier full name feature (SM-14213) is enabled. It's disabled by default.
- Name fields in an integrated ERP system such as SAP S/4HANA or SAP Master Data Governance (MDG) have a maximum length of 40 characters.
- The support for supplier names of up to 160 characters feature (SM-36076) is enabled. It's disabled by default and its availability is controlled by the self-service configuration parameter **Application.SM.Enable160CharacterSupportForFullName** in ► **SM Administration** ► **Configuration Parameters** ►.
- The **Apply Field Restrictions** tool for question configuration (SM-12250) is enabled. It's enabled by default and its availability is controlled by the self-service configuration parameter **Disable field restrictions for field mappings in supplier management questionnaires** in **Intelligent Configuration Manager**.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)

[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

[Support for Supplier Display Names Longer Than 35 Characters in SAP Ariba Solutions](#)

[Disable field restrictions for field mappings in supplier management questionnaires \[page 288\]](#)

[SM-14213: Enable supplier full name](#)

Include previous approved answers in external validation of registration questionnaires using web services

Include previously approved supplier submissions in external questionnaire validation

ID	<code>Application.SM.IncludePreviousVersionForExternalValidation</code>
Name	Include previous approved answers in external validation of registration questionnaires using web services
Default value	No

By default this parameter is disabled. To enable **Application.SM.IncludePreviousVersionForExternalValidation**, the **Application.SM.ExternalValidationEnabled** must be enabled. Once this parameter is enabled, the previous approved version of the registration questionnaire is sent to the external system for validation. This helps the buyer to compare the supplier's responses of previous version with the latest version and identify which fields have changed and route the request to the respective business line for approval.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Include previous approved answers in external validation of modular questionnaires using web services

Allows users to choose if externally validated questionnaire responses should also include previously approved supplier submissions for modular questionnaires

ID	<code>Application.SM.IncludePreviousVersionForExternalValidationForMQ</code>
Name	Include previous approved answers in external validation of modular questionnaires using web services
Default value	No

By default this parameter is disabled. To enable **Application.SM.IncludePreviousVersionForExternalValidationForMQ**, the **Application.SM.ExternalValidationEnabledForMQ** must be enabled. Once this parameter is enabled, the previous approved version of the modular questionnaire is sent to the external system for validation. This helps the buyer to compare the supplier's responses of previous version with the latest version and identify which fields have changed and route the request to the respective business line for approval.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

List Extended Address fields for which blank updates from SAP Business Network clear data

Specifies a list of **Extended Address** fields for which data will be removed if a supplier updates their SAP Business Network profile address and an **Extended Address** question in an external registration questionnaire is mapped to 'vendor.addressExt.postalAddress,network.legal.addressExt.postalAddress'. Data is removed from the specified field if either the supplier specifically removes the value in the corresponding SAP Business Network profile field, or if there is no corresponding profile field but the supplier updates their profile address. By default, in this situation, the answer is removed from the questionnaire with the mapped question, but remains in the database field and is synchronized to the ERP system unless the field is specified in this parameter. The setting for this parameter is a comma-separated list that can include one or more of the following values: CountryCode, RegionCode, CityName, AdditionalCityName, DistrictName, StreetPostalCode, POBoxPostalCode, CompanyPostalCode, StreetPrefixName, AdditionalStreetPrefixName, StreetName, StreetSuffixName, AdditionalStreetSuffixName, HouseID, AdditionalHouseID, BuildingID, RoomID, FloorID, CareOfName, StreetAddressMailNonDeliveryReasonCode, POBoxDeviatingCountryCode, POBoxDeviatingRegionCode, POBoxDeviatingCityName, POBoxLobbyName, POBoxID, POBoxAddressMailNonDeliveryReasonCode, POBoxIDVisibleIndicator, POBoxDeliveryServiceID, POBoxDeliveryServiceTypeCode, TaxJurisdictionCode, TimeZoneCode, TransportationZoneID, RegionalStructureElementGroupCode, RegionalStructureAddressConsistencyStatusCode, RegionalStructureCityCode, AdditionalRegionalStructureCityCode, POBoxDeviatingRegionalStructureCityCode, RegionalStructureDistrictCode, RegionalStructureStreetCode.

ID	Application.SM.ConfigureAddressExtFieldsAllowedForNullUpdates
Name	List Extended Address fields for which blank updates from SAP Business Network clear data
Default value	CountryCode, RegionCode, POBoxDeviatingCountryCode, POBoxDeviatingRegionCode

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)
[Address or Extended Address Questions for Collecting Supplier Address Information](#)

Make account holder name required in Bank Account questions

Makes the **Account Holder Name** field required in **Bank Account** questions.

ID	Application.SM.AccountHolderNameMandatory
Name	Make account holder name required in Bank Account questions
Default value	No

Bank Account questions, which collect supplier bank information, include a set of predefined fields. By default, the **Account Holder Name** field is optional. Enabling this parameter makes the **Account Holder Name** required for bank accounts in all countries/regions.

If you have existing suppliers with **Bank Account** data when you enable this parameter, questionnaire recipients must add any missing account holder names when updating the questionnaire.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Bank Account Questions for Collecting Supplier Bank Information](#)
[Predefined Fields and Field Mappings in Bank Account Questions](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Make Extended Address State/Province/Region Required Where Available

Makes the **State/Province/Region** field in **Extended Address** questions required when there is state/province/region data available for the selected country/region. When there isn't any state/province/region data available for the selected country/region, the field remains optional. This parameter is only applicable in sites that don't have a field customization to make the State/Province/Region field required.

ID	Application.SM.AddressExtRegionCodeMandatory
Name	Make Extended Address State/Province/Region Required Where Available
Default value	No

In **Extended Address** questions, the **State/Province/Region** field is a dropdown menu populated by your site's region master data. Enabling this parameter makes the **State/Province/Region** field required if there's region master data available for the selected country/region, and optional if there isn't data available. This setting requires questionnaire recipients to provide a state/province/region answer where possible, but doesn't block them from submitting the questionnaire with an empty answer if there's no value to select.

This parameter isn't applicable in sites that have a field customization to make the **State/Province/Region** field required. The field customization makes the field required in all circumstances. If you want to use this parameter to control the required behavior of the **State/Province/Region** field instead, request SAP Ariba Support to remove the customization.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)

[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

[Address or Extended Address Questions for Collecting Supplier Address Information](#)

Override existing source system with SAP domain values during vendor push

Specifies whether the vendor push task that pushes supplier organizations to the supplier management database overrides existing supplier source systems of SM with SAP for any suppliers with organization IDs in the SAP domain. By default, the vendor push task doesn't update source systems once set. Disable this parameter if your supplier data load process involves adding SAP organization IDs during the initial load instead of during update.

ID	<code>Application.SM.OverridesourceSystemDuringVendorPush</code>
Name	Override existing source system with SAP domain values during vendor push
Default value	Yes

This parameter is applicable in sites that use data import, SOAP web service integration, or SAP Ariba integration toolkit file transfer to add suppliers to their site and then use the vendor push task enabled by the site configuration parameter `Application.SM.VendorContactPushTaskEnabled` (set by SAP Ariba Support) to push that data to the supplier management database. If your supplier data load process adds suppliers first and adds organization IDs for suppliers later, depending on timing, the vendor push task can add the new suppliers to the supplier management database before their organization IDs are added. In this situation, the suppliers are added with an SM source system. The default setting for **Override existing source system with SAP domain values during vendor push** means that when you update those suppliers to add organization IDs in the SAP domain, the vendor push task updates their source systems from SM to SAP in the supplier management database.

This parameter is only applicable in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance and SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management(new architecture) solutions.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Prepopulate process qualifications with request or registration commodities, regions, and departments

Automatically prepopulates intake forms for a supplier's process qualifications with the commodities, regions, and departments from their supplier request or registration.

ID	Application.SM.PropagateMatrixDimensionToProcessQualification
Name	Prepopulate process qualifications with request or registration commodities, regions, and departments
Default value	No

This parameter automatically prepopulates intake forms for a supplier's process qualifications with the commodities, regions, and departments from their supplier request or registration. If the supplier has both a request and registration with this data, the registration data is used.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Remove blank DUNS IDs in supplier data synchronization from supplier management to sourcing

Removes blank or empty DUNS IDs from sourcing supplier organization records during supplier data synchronization if the field is blank or empty in the corresponding supplier management record. By default, synchronization doesn't remove DUNS IDs from supplier organizations even if the corresponding supplier management field is blank or empty.

ID	Application.SM.ResetDunsInVendorPullTaskIfValueIsEmpty
Name	Remove blank DUNS IDs in supplier data synchronization from supplier management to sourcing
Default value	No

Enable this parameter to ensure that when a D-U-N-S number is removed from the supplier record through removal of an answer to a supplier management questionnaire, ERP data synchronization, or a data import in **SM Administration**, the new blank value is synchronized to the supplier organization and common supplier. Otherwise, the supplier organization and common supplier records retain the previous value.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Reopen period for supplier questionnaires

Specifies the number of days external (supplier-facing) questionnaires remain open if they are closed and reopened.

ID	<code>Application.AQS.RFX.ReopenIfClosedInterval</code>
Name	Reopen period for supplier questionnaires
Default value	365 (days)

If the value for this parameter is 0, the amount of time that a reopened questionnaire remains open is determined by the template survey document **Due date** setting instead. If the document **Keep questionnaire reopened indefinitely** option is set to **Yes**, the questionnaire ignores the **Reopen period for supplier questionnaires** parameter and remains reopened indefinitely.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)
[Setting Up Periodic Reminders for Registration Questionnaire Updates](#)
[Supplier Form or Questionnaire Closing, Reopening, and Due Dates](#)

Require only attachment and expiration date for supplier certificates

Specifies that **Attachment** and **Expiration Date** are the only two required fields for answers to certificate questions in external supplier management questionnaires. Otherwise, all certificate fields are required.

ID	<code>Application.SM.RequireCertificateAttachmentAndExpirationOnly</code>
----	---

Name	Require only attachment and expiration date for supplier certificates
Default value	False

The default value of **False** means that all the certificate fields are mandatory and the supplier must enter values in all the fields. The certificate detail fields are required if a supplier answers **Yes** to a certificate question. The certificate detail fields are not required if a supplier answers **No** to a certificate question.

Setting this parameter to **True** makes only the **Expiration Date** and **Attachment** fields mandatory, which means that the supplier only needs to enter an expiration date and attach a document to proceed.

Note

This parameter applies to external supplier management questionnaires.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Send Email Notification On Adding Supplier Contacts

The system automatically sends an email notification when a supplier contact is added to the relevant SAP Ariba solutions.

ID	<code>Application.SM.SendEmailNotificationOnAddingSupplierContacts</code>
Name	SendEmailNotificationOnAddingSupplierContacts
Default value	No

When this parameter is enabled, an email notification is automatically sent to newly added supplier contacts informing them that their contact details have been added to the system. However, the system doesn't verify if the communication was successfully delivered.

An email template is created for sending such external email communication. The template contains a default message stating that the supplier contact's details such as first and last names, email addresses, and other information can now be processed by your organisation. You can customize this template to include your company logo or to include your own content. Only newly created supplier contacts receive email notifications. The email template is located at **Manage > Administration > Project Manager > Project Email Template > Project type: All Applicable Types**.

Supplier contacts also receive an email notification when they're added:

- through the supplier request form

- via a mass upload of suppliers or supplier contacts in ► **Manage** ► **SM Administration** ► **Data import or export** ► and
- while creating a sourcing event

📘 Note

Supplier contacts added through ► **Manage** ► **Administration** ► **Supplier and Customer Manager** ► **Users** ► don't receive email notifications when they're added.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Set maximum length for Room ID in Extended Address

Specifies the maximum length for the **Room** ID field in **Extended Address** questions. The default setting, 10, is the required setting for answers in mapped questions in supplier management questionnaires, although the base field supports up to 20 characters.

ID	<code>Application.SM.RoomIDFieldMaxLength</code>
Name	Set maximum length for Room ID in Extended Address
Default value	10

Extended Address questions include a set of predefined answer fields, including a **Room** field. The corresponding mapped `vendor.addressExt.postalAddress.roomID` field in the supplier database has a maximum field length of 10 characters. However, the question field allows answers of up to 20 characters. The default setting of this parameter, 10, ensures that **Room** answers in mapped **Extended Address** questions synchronize to the database without causing errors. Since those errors can prevent successful submission of questionnaires such as the supplier request, SAP Ariba recommends against changing this default setting.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)
[Address or Extended Address Questions for Collecting Supplier Address Information](#)

Set minimum registration status for event participation

Specifies the minimum registration status that a supplier must have to participate in sourcing events. Valid values are 0 for **Not Invited**, 1 for **Invited**, 2 for **Pending Approval**, and 3 for **Registered**.

ID	Application.SM.MinimumRegistrationStatusForEventAccess
Name	Set minimum registration status for event participation
Default value	0

Suppliers who are below the minimum status can be invited to events, but can't access them until they've achieved the minimum status. The restriction applies to suppliers who have been qualified for the event commodities, regions, and departments using qualification data import but who haven't yet achieved the required registration status.

The default value is 0. The valid values are:

Value	Description	Associated Registration Invitations
0 or Not Invited	Suppliers who haven't yet been invited to register can participate in sourcing events.	There are no automatic registration invitations.
1 or Invited	Suppliers must have already been invited to register to participate in sourcing events. However, they don't need to submit registration questionnaires to participate in events.	If the person who invites a Not Invited supplier to participate in an event is a member of both the Event Administrator and Supplier Registration Manager groups, the supplier is invited to register at the same time automatically, and their registration status changes to Invited . Otherwise, the supplier must be invited to register separately.
2 or Pending Approval	Suppliers whose registration is pending approval or who are already registered can participate in sourcing events. They must submit registration questionnaires to participate in events, but their registration doesn't need to be approved.	
3 or Registered	Only suppliers with approved registrations can participate in sourcing events. They must submit registration questionnaires and their registrations must be approved before they can participate in events.	

Note

- Event templates have a supplier eligibility rule based on registration status. That rule governs whether or not suppliers can be **invited** to an event. This parameter governs their ability to **participate** after invitation.
- Changes to this parameter's setting apply only to participants invited to events after they're made.

This parameter is only applicable in sites that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance and SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture), which use supplier registration projects.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Specify the Web Assistant JavaScript template URL for supplier management

Enables the use of the Web Assistant for supplier management features.

ID	Application.SM.WebAssistantJSTemplate
Name	Specify the Web Assistant JavaScript template URL for supplier management
Default value	https://webassistant.enable-now.cloud.sap/wa_cfg/ariba_slp/WebAssistant.js

If you have a valid SAP Enable Now license, the template you specify with this parameter defines the behavior as well as the look and feel of the SAP Companion in-application help in supported supplier management user interface pages in your site. You can modify the configuration for your site in Enable Now Manager and then update this parameter with the configuration template.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Start automatically-generated supplier bank IDs with 0001

Specifies that the bank IDs automatically generated for suppliers start with 0001 rather than 0000.

ID	Application.SM.InitializeBankIDFromOne
Name	Start automatically-generated supplier bank IDs with 0001
Default value	No

For supplier bank accounts collected in **Bank Account** questions, SAP Ariba automatically generates unique, sequential IDs. Automatically generated bank IDs consist of sequential numerical values and, optionally, a country/region-specific prefix. By default, these automatically generated bank IDs start with 0000. If you set this parameter to **Yes**, they start with 0001 instead.

The related parameter **Define the length of supplier bank IDs** (`Application.SM.BankIdSize`) controls the length of the automatically-generated IDs. You can also define country/region-specific bank ID prefixes using a data import.

This parameter is only applicable in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance and SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management(new architecture) solutions.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)

[Define the length of supplier bank IDs \[page 287\]](#)

[Bank Account Questions for Collecting Supplier Bank Information](#)

[Country/Region-Specific Bank ID Prefix Data Import](#)

[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Use custom logo and footer for emails sent to suppliers

Allows you to specify a custom logo and footer for emails sent to suppliers.

When this parameter is set to **Yes**, the **Custom Email** tab appears in Ariba Administrator under **Customization Manager** **Branding Settings**. In addition to the SAP Ariba logo and footer, the custom logo and footer that you set in this tab appear in emails. When this parameter is set to **No**, only the SAP Ariba logo and footer appear in emails.

ID	<code>Application.EnableCustomEmailLogoAndFooter</code>
Name	Use custom logo and footer for emails sent to suppliers
Default value	No

You must be a member of the **Customer Administrator** or **Event Administrator** group to customize the invitations sent to suppliers.

To include your company's logo in registration questionnaire invitations, the parameter `Application.EnableCustomEmailLogoAndFooter` must be enabled in your site. In addition, one of your company's customer administrators must upload the logo on the **Custom Email** tab. See [Common Data Import and Administration Guide for SAP Ariba Strategic Sourcing Solutions and SAP Ariba Supplier Management Solutions](#) for details.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[How to customize messages to buyers and suppliers](#)

[Intelligent Configuration Manager administration](#)

[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

Validate required questions in repeatable sections in external questionnaires

Validates required questions in repeatable sections in external questionnaires so that if there's no prepopulated answer in the initial questionnaire draft, suppliers must provide answers before submitting.

ID	<code>Application.SM.ValidationOfRequiredQuesInRSEnabled</code>
Name	Validate required questions in repeatable sections in external questionnaires
Default value	No

By default, when a repeatable section in an external questionnaire contains an individual required question, there's no validation check to ensure that the recipient has provided the required answer before submitting the questionnaire. Enabling this parameter applies a validation check to ensure that individual required questions within repeatable sections in external questionnaires are also validated so that recipients must provide answers before submitting the questionnaire.

This setting only applies to individual required questions in external questionnaires edited by suppliers on SAP Business Network. It doesn't apply to internal questionnaires, or to external questionnaires edited by buyer users on behalf of suppliers.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)

[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)

[Adding a Repeatable Section to a Supplier Form or Questionnaire](#)

Web Assistant in-context help for supplier management

Enable the use of the Web Assistant (SAP Companion) for supplier management features.

ID	<code>Application.SM.EnableWebAssistantForSupplierManagement</code>
Name	Web Assistant in-context help for supplier management

Default value **Yes**

When you set this parameter to **Yes**, SAP Companion, which is used to provide in-application help, is enabled for supplier management. Setting the parameter to **No** disables this in-application help.

A member of the **Customer Administrator** group sets this parameter in the **Intelligent Configuration Manager** workspace.

Related Information

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)
[Parameter Management in Intelligent Configuration Manager](#)
[SAP Companion In-Application Help for Supplier Management](#)

Self-Service Site Configuration Parameters in Supplier Administration

Some of the functionality for supplier management is controlled by self-service configuration parameters which members of the **Customer Administrator** and **SM Ops Administrator** groups can set.

These parameters apply to supplier management in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance and SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture).

The parameters are located in ► **SM Administration** ► **Configuration Parameters** ►.

Reference of Configuration Parameters in Supplier Administration

Some of the functionality for supplier management is controlled by configuration parameters.

The configuration parameters are found in ► **SM Administration** ► **Configuration Parameters** ►.

In guided buying sites, the navigation path is ► **Manage** ► **SM Admin** ► **Configuration Parameters** ►.

For more information on how to modify the settings of these parameters, see [Managing Configuration Parameters in Supplier Administration \[page 353\]](#).

Table 21:

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Integration	Application.SM.BusinessPartner.EnableChangeOrdinal	False	This parameter ensures that the changeOrdinalNumberValue in integration messages sent an integrated MDG-S system includes automatically generated, sequential values for each supplier. It's disabled by default. If your SAP MDG-S system configuration requires these values to generate change requests, enable this parameter in your site.
Integration	Application.SM.BusinessPartner.EnableDUNSIdnSync	False	By default, the vendor.vendorInfo.dunsId field stores D-U-N-S numbers in the vendor.vendorInfo.dunsId field, and it isn't mapped to any elements in integration messages sent to an integrated ERP system. Enabling this parameter synchronizes vendor.vendorInfo.dunsId values to business partner identification segments in integration messages and sets a party identification type code of BUP001 for them.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Integration	Application.SM.BusinessPartner.EnableBup007Sync	False	Includes the vendor . vendorInfo . an Id value in integration messages to the ERP system and automatically sets the PartyIdentifierTypeCode to BUP007. If the partitioned supplier feature (SM-30017) is enabled in your site, enabling this parameter is recommended. It ensures that SAP Business Network IDs (ANIDs) added to suppliers through supplier management activities such as supplier registrations are correctly synchronized to the associated procurement common suppliers, and that those common suppliers are searchable by ANID.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Integration	Application.SM.Vendor.SyncAcmlIdToERP	False	Automatically includes the ACM ID for a supplier created through ERP synchronization or data import with the next update to the ERP system after the ACM ID is set. Since ACM ID generation occurs after the new supplier is created, the initial outbound message to the ERP system typically doesn't include this ID, and it's not otherwise included in updates.

Note

To set the ACM ID for suppliers, your site must use custom fields to store ACM IDs through an [imported default properties configuration](#) where a generic custom field such as `vendor.supplierGenericCustomField.ZS4ID` is set to `$(vendor.vendorInfo.s4OrgSystemId)`. The integrated ERP system must have a custom implementation for the corresponding custom field. This parameter only sends the ACM ID to the integrated ERP system if these configurations are in place.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Questionnaires Tax	Application.SM.Vendor.EnhancedTaxInfo	True	By default, answers in the country/region field of Address or Extended Address questions in supplier requests or registration questionnaires don't affect the extended tax country/region codes associated with supplier tax IDs. This behavior is designed for sites that collect supplier tax information using Tax questions. Tax questions include a required country/region field that sets the extended tax country/region code for the tax ID specified in the answer. The default setting of this parameter ensures that this extended tax country/region code isn't overwritten by the country/region in an Address or Extended Address answer. In sites that collect supplier tax information using individual tax ID questions mapped to tax ID fields such as vendor.taxInfo.taxNumber1 rather than Tax questions, SAP Ariba recommends disabling this parameter so that the extended tax country/region code for tax IDs collected in individual questions is automatically set by the country/region field in Address or Extended Address questions in the supplier request or a registration questionnaire.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Integration	Application.SM.Vendor.PollingClientMtlsEnabled	False	Enables mutual TLS authentication for adapter-based cloud integrations of supplier data using the polling client. For information on how to configure mutual TLS authentication, refer to Setting Up Mutual TLS Authentication for Adapter-Based Cloud Integrations of Supplier Data That Use the Polling Client.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Feature enablement	Application.SM.InternalRegistrationEnabled	True	Specifies whether internal supplier registrations, where buyers complete registrations on behalf of suppliers without supplier involvement, are available in a site. By default, this parameter is set to True and internal registrations are available. You can set this parameter to enable or disable this functionality in your site.

Note

Along with the configuration parameter, you must also enable the **Enable internal supplier registrations** parameter in **Integration Configuration Manager** to ensure the functionality is available in your site.

Caution

If you want to disable internal registrations, SAP Ariba recommends doing so before any internal registrations are created in your site. Disabling the feature prevents completion of any internal registration projects that are in progress and removes the mechanism for inviting suppliers to participate in completed internal registrations.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Feature enablement	Application.SM.AutoStartRegistrationWhenPrimaryContactAdded	False	Allows you to start supplier registrations automatically when primary supplier contacts are added or imported into SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance for the very first time, and when supplier requests are externally approved in an integrated MDG-S system Note Along with this configuration parameter, you must also enable the existing Automatically start supplier registrations parameter in Intelligent Configuration Manager to ensure the functionality is available in your site.
User or administrator interface	Application.SM.Registration.DisplaySetRegisteredOption	False	Enabling this feature allows you to manually set a supplier's status to Registered using the Set Registered option in the Registration details area of the supplier's profile. The system immediately sets the status of the supplier to Registered. In addition, the system synchronizes supplier data with your ERP systems automatically or with manual intervention depending on how your site is configured. This data then becomes available for supplier qualifications or for use in other SAP Ariba procurement applications.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Search	Application.SM.Vendor.PsoftVariantIds		This parameter specifies a comma-separated list of realm IDs for any procurement sites in your SAP Ariba configuration that use PeopleSoft variant. This setting enables procurement sites with the PeopleSoft variant to use supplier data such as addresses and qualified or preferred statuses, and is required for those sites.
Questionnaires	Application.SM.SupplierRequest.RestrictRequestEdit	True	Restricts the ability to edit supplier requests that are in approval to the project owner (the person who created the supplier request) and currently active approvers who are also members of the Supplier Request Manager group. If disabled, all members of the Supplier Request Manager group can edit supplier requests that are in approval.
Questionnaires	Application.SM.PropagateMatrixDimensionToProcessQualification	False	Automatically prepopulates intake forms for a supplier's process qualifications with the commodities, regions, and departments from their supplier request or registration. If the supplier has both a request and registration with this data, the registration data is used.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Feature enablement Questionnaires	Application.SM.MQ.EnableStandaloneMQEnhancement	False	This parameter enables enhanced filtering and pagination in the workflow for sending standalone modular questionnaires. Note Enabling or disabling this parameter requires a corresponding change to the Enable enhanced filtering and pagination for standalone modular questionnaires [page 300] parameter in Intelligent Configuration Manager. Always enable or disable both parameters together.
Search	Application.SM.Vendor.DefaultRealmLocale	en	The default locale for querying master data in your site. If the locale isn't provided, the default value is used.
Questionnaires Tax	Application.SM.Vendor.EnableDefaultTaxMasking	True	Enables or disables the masking of some information collected in Tax questions in portions of the user interface on the Supplier Management dashboard, such as supplier profiles. Country/region and tax ID fields in Tax questions are encrypted in the database, and when this parameter is enabled, data in encrypted tax fields is also masked in those areas of the user interface. It's never masked in other areas, such as project advanced view, internal and external questionnaires, and the supplier view on SAP Business Network. You can make tax data display consistent in all areas of the user interface by disabling this parameter.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Feature enablement	Application.SM.Process.EnableModularProcessFramework	False	Enables or disables the modular process framework for qualification and other lifecycle processes, which includes process projects and associated functionality. Note Enabling or disabling this parameter requires a corresponding change to the Enable modular process framework [page 296] parameter in Intelligent Configuration Manager. Always enable or disable both parameters together.
Feature enablement	Application.SM.MQ.EnableInternalFormsInModularQuestionnaires	False	Enables or disables support for additional internal forms with To Do and approval tasks in modular questionnaire projects. Note Enabling or disabling this parameter requires a corresponding change to the Enable internal forms in modular questionnaires [page 295] parameter in Intelligent Configuration Manager. Always enable or disable both parameters together.
Integration	Application.SM.ERP.PreferredTelephoneUsage	N/A	Specifies a default preferred usage code to set for any telephone number that doesn't have a usage code or, if the supplier doesn't have a telephone number, for the first mobile number if available. The default preferred usage code in SAP MDG systems is AD_DEFAULT.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Integration	Application.SM.ERP.TelephoneUsageDefault	N/A	Specifies a default usage code to set for any telephone number that doesn't have a usage code. The default telephone number usage code in SAP MDG systems is AD_NMBDEFA.
Integration	Application.SM.ERP.MobileUsageDefault	N/A	Specifies a default usage code to set for any mobile number that doesn't have a usage code. The default mobile number usage code in SAP MDG systems is AD_MBDEFAU.
Integration	Application.SM.ERP.AddressUsageDefault	XXDEFAULT	Specifies a default usage code to set for the first address if no addresses have a usage code.
Integration	Application.SM.ERP.ErpldMismatchEnabled	False	If enabled, identifies mismatches between the sender business system ID in inbound integration messages and the ERP business system ID configured in integration settings.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Integration	Application.SM.ERP.Business PartnerIdConversionEnabled	True	Adds leading zeros to partner function bpid in outbound integration messages. Disable this parameter if your integrated ERP system sends partner function bpid without leading zeros to prevent a mismatch. ⚠ Caution - Only disable this parameter together with the Use Internal Format for ERP Vendor Id feature, which also adds leading zeros to outbound ERP vendor IDs. This feature must be disabled by SAP Ariba Support. - If you plan to use the partitioned supplier feature (SM-30017), make sure that you have the desired configuration for both the Use Internal Format for ERP Vendor Id feature and the Application.SM.ERP.BusinessPartnerIdConversionEnabled parameter before enabling the partitioned supplier feature in your site. Changing either configuration after enabling the partitioned supplier feature can result in unexpected effects on partitioned supplier data.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
			For more information, see Management of Leading Zeros in ERP Vendor IDs .
Integration	Application.SM.MasterData.MmSysId	N/A	Specifies an ERP business system ID to replace the ERP Business system ID configured in SM Administration integration settings in ERP search calls for material master data. If left blank, the ERP Business system ID in integration settings is also used for material master data search.
Integration	Application.SM.MDI.MdiEnabled	False	Enables supplier data integrating with SAP S/4HANA Cloud Public Edition using SAP Master Data Integration (MDI). This parameter is only available when the support for supplier data integration with SAP S/4HANA Cloud Public Edition feature (SM-30016) is enabled in your site. For details on this feature, including prerequisites and restrictions, see About Supplier Data Integration with SAP S/4HANA Cloud Public Edition Using SAP Master Data Integration.
Integration	Application.SM.MDI.MdiPrimaryBpld		Specifies the business system ID of the integrated SAP S/4HANA Cloud Public Edition system. This parameter is only available when the support for supplier data integration with SAP S/4HANA Cloud Public Edition feature (SM-30016) is enabled in your site.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Business partner key mapping	Application.SM.BPKM.KeyMappingEnabled	False	Enables automatic creation of partitioned suppliers for each of the child sites defined in the child site mapping rules data import when your site receives a business partner key mapping request. Enabling this parameter shows other key mapping parameters. If your site uses the partitioned supplier feature (SM-30017), only enable this parameter if SAP Ariba Procurement solutions site has a multi-ERP configuration with a child site.
Business partner key mapping	Application.SM.BPKM.KeyMappingTypeCodeForBP	147	Specifies the type code for business partners in your site. This type code is used during business partner key mapping synchronization from an integrated ERP system. This parameter is only visible when Application.SM.BPKM.KeyMappingEnabled is enabled.
Business partner key mapping	Application.SM.BPKM.KeyMappingObjectSchemaCodeForBP	888	Specifies the object schema code for business partners in your site. This schema code is used during business partner key mapping synchronization from an integrated ERP system. This parameter is only visible when Application.SM.BPKM.KeyMappingEnabled is enabled.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Business partner key mapping	Application.SM.BPKM.KeyMappingObjectSchemaCodeForBPUuid	889	Specifies the UUID object schema code for business partners in your site. This code is used during business partner key mapping synchronization from an integrated ERP system. This parameter is only visible when Application.SM.BPKM.KeyMappingEnabled is enabled.
Business partner key mapping	Application.SM.BPKM.KeyMappingTypeCodeForSup	266	Specifies the type code for suppliers in your site. This type code is used during business partner key mapping synchronization from an integrated ERP system. This parameter is only visible when Application.SM.BPKM.KeyMappingEnabled is enabled.
Business partner key mapping	Application.SM.BPKM.KeyMappingObjectSchemaCodeForSup	892	Specifies the object schema code for suppliers in your site. This schema code is used during business partner key mapping synchronization from an integrated ERP system. This parameter is only visible when Application.SM.BPKM.KeyMappingEnabled is enabled.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Partitioned suppliers	Application.SM.P2P.VendorDifferentiationType	All	Specifies the vendor differentiation type for suppliers, which determines whether inbound suppliers replicated from an SAP S/4HANA Cloud Public Edition system are created as common suppliers (main vendors), remittance locations, or supplier locations (ordering addresses) in SAP Ariba Procurement solutions. Valid values are: • PartnerFunction, to set a supplier's vendor type based on partner function. Use Application.SM.BPKM.MainVendorPartnerFunctionCodes, Application.SM.BPKM.OrderingPartnerFunctionCodes, and Application.SM.BPKM.RemittancePartnerFunctionCodes to specify the partner function codes that determine each vendor type. • All, to specify that all suppliers are considered main vendors (common suppliers).

Note

All is the default setting for this parameter. To convert inbound vendor objects to remittance locations or supplier locations where appropriate instead of creating common suppliers for all of them, use the **PartnerFunction** setting and related parameters.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
			This parameter is only available when the partitioned supplier feature (SM-30017) is enabled in your site.
Partitioned suppliers	Application.SM.P2P.RemittancePartnerFunctionCodes	RS	Specifies a comma-separated list of partner function codes that determine whether a business partner is a remittance address (remittance location). These codes are only used if Application.SM.P2P.VendorDifferentiationType is set to PartnerFunction. This parameter is only available when the partitioned supplier feature (SM-30017) is enabled in your site.
Partitioned suppliers	Application.SM.P2P.OrderingPartnerFunctionCodes	BA	Specifies a comma-separated list of partner function codes that determine whether a business partner is an ordering address (supplier location). These codes are only used if Application.SM.P2P.VendorDifferentiationType is set to PartnerFunction. This parameter is only available when the partitioned supplier feature (SM-30017) is enabled in your site.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Partitioned suppliers	Application.SM.P2P.MainVendorPartnerFunctionCodes	LF	Specifies a comma-separated list of partner function codes that determine whether that a supplier is a main vendor (common supplier). These codes are only used if Application.SM.P2P.VendorDifferentiationType is set to PartnerFunction. This parameter is only available when the partitioned supplier feature (SM-30017) is enabled in your site.
Partitioned suppliers	Application.SM.P2P.VendorLevelAccountingGroups	0001, KRED	Not currently used. This parameter is only available when the partitioned supplier feature (SM-30017) is enabled in your site.
Partitioned suppliers	Application.SM.P2P.GoodsSupplierPartnerFunctionCodes	WL	Not currently used. This parameter is only available when the partitioned supplier feature (SM-30017) is enabled in your site.
Partitioned suppliers	Application.SM.P2P.FactoryPartnerFunctionCodes	ZF	Not currently used. This parameter is only available when the partitioned supplier feature (SM-30017) is enabled in your site.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Integration Tax	Application.SM.Vendor.Long PartyTaxIDSupported	False	By default, the tax identification type code is included in the PartyTaxID element of integration messages received from and sent to an integrated ERP system. If enabled, this parameter ensures that the tax identification type code 5 or greater than 5 is included as the LONG_PartyTaxID element in the BusinessPartner segment of integration messages. The LONG_PartyTaxID element supports a maximum length of 60 characters.
Feature enablement	Application.SM.Department Dimension	False	You can enable this parameter to enable business unit or department as third dimension along with commodity and region in supplier management projects such qualifications, disqualification, and preferred projects that are based in commodity/region/department combinations. When the parameter is disabled, the department data no longer shows in the user interface.
Feature enablement	Application.SM.RiskLevelSearchFilter	False	This parameter enables or disables the Risk level search filter on the supplier search page, allowing you to search for suppliers based on their risk levels. This filter is only available in solutions that also include SAP Ariba Supplier Risk. The default value of the parameter is False. You must enable this parameter to use the Risk level filter in the supplier search page.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Search	Application.SM.GB.SearchPreferredAndQualifiedByACMI	False	Uses ACM IDs rather than ERP vendor IDs in guided buying searches for preferred and qualified suppliers. Enable this parameter if your SAP Ariba Procurement solutions site uses a multi-ERP configuration so that search results return the qualification and preferred status for each supplier across all child sites, where the associated partitioned suppliers can have different ERP vendor IDs. Use the default setting, search by ERP vendor ID, if your SAP Ariba Procurement solutions site is a single site with no multi-ERP configuration.

Note

This setting isn't applicable in sites that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance and SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture) where the support for partitioned suppliers feature (SM-30017) is enabled. SM-30017 doesn't currently support multi-ERP configurations. It's only applicable in SAP Ariba solution landscapes where the supplier master data used in guided buying is created and maintained directly in SAP Ariba Procurement solutions.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Feature enablement	Application.SM.SMUIConditionEvaluation	False	Enabling this parameter enables or disables the changed user experience for internal questionnaires with visibility conditions, which processes conditions in the background so that recipients can continue to edit the questionnaire during that processing. This parameter also improves the way visibility conditions are processed in internal questionnaires. Enable or disable this parameter depending on the performance of your internal questionnaires. You must be a member of the SM Ops Administrator group to set this parameter. Note Along with the configuration parameter, you must also enable the Enable improved user experience for internal questionnaires with visibility conditions [page 294] parameter in Integration Configuration Manager to ensure the functionality is available in your site.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Feature enablement Questionnaires	Application.SM.RepeatableSectionsInInternalQuestionnaires	False	Enables or disables repeatable sections in internal questionnaires, including external registration questionnaires in internal registrations. Note Enabling or disabling this parameter requires a corresponding change to the Enable repeatable sections in internal questionnaires [page 299] parameter in Intelligent Configuration Manager. Always enable or disable both parameters together.
Feature enablement Questionnaires	Application.SM.MQ.EnableRatingandAggregationInInternalForms	False	Enables or disables internal stakeholders of your organization to enter ratings in one or more internal forms or internal questionnaires of a project. It also enables them to view the final ratings. A final rating is a simple aggregation of all the individual ratings.
Questionnaires	Application.SM.UI.EnableERPRegionDisplayInSimpleAddress	False	Shows country/region-specific ERP region codes, which are mapped to the state codes (ANStateCode) used on SAP Business Network, in the State/Province/Region field of Address questions in buyer-facing questionnaires. By default, these codes are only available in Extended Address questions.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
User or administrator interface	Application.SM.UI.SourcingSummary	False	This parameter enables the Sourcing Events panel in the Summary area and the Business activity detail area in the supplier profile. You must enable this parameter to show the supplier's sourcing events in the Summary area and view the sourcing events list in the Business activity area in the supplier profile. Note The Business Activity and Summary areas are only available in the classic supplier 360° profile. They aren't available in the supplier profile summary (NGSM-2959).
User or administrator interface	Application.SM.UI.Contracts Summary	False	This parameter enables the Contracts panel in the Summary area and the Business activity area in the supplier profile. You must enable this parameter to show the supplier's contracts in the Summary area and view the contracts list in the Business activity area in the supplier profile. Note The Business Activity and Summary areas are only available in the classic supplier 360° profile. They aren't available in the supplier profile summary (NGSM-2959).

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Feature enablement	Application.SM.Process.AllowStartOfProcessQualificationForUnRegisteredSuppliers	True	This parameter adds an option for restricting the ability to create process qualifications for a supplier until the supplier has a completed registration. You can enable or disable creation of process qualifications for unregistered suppliers. However, this restriction does not apply to miscellaneous processes. • If the option is set to True, the system allows you to start process qualifications for unregistered suppliers. • If the option is set to False, the system doesn't allow you to start process qualifications for unregistered suppliers.
Integration	Application.SM.SkipSettingIndustrySector	False	By default, when supplier request Dun & Bradstreet lookup doesn't return any industry classification code data, the associated fields are automatically populated with a value of NA. When this parameter is enabled, the system doesn't add any industry sector data from D&B. Therefore, industry sector data added by the D&B lookup to <code><sm:GenericCustomField></code> or <code><IndustrySector></code> segments isn't included in outbound integration messages and doesn't show in ERP data in the supplier profile. This exclusion prevents integration errors when data in required fields is missing. This parameter is only applicable in sites integrated with D&B.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Miscellaneous	Application.SM.Purge.JobDelayMinutes	1	Specifies the number of minutes between when a data purge is initiated and the scheduled task to carry out purge actions for supplier and supplier-related data starts, with a minimum of 1 minute and a maximum of 10 minutes. In some cases, increasing the delay can address stalled or failed purges.
Feature enablement	Application.SM.SendEmailNotificationOnAddingSupplierContacts	No	When this parameter is enabled, an email notification is automatically sent to newly added supplier contacts informing them that their contact details have been added to the system. A member of the Customer Administrator group sets this parameter in the Intelligent Configuration Manager workspace.
Feature enablement	Application.SM.Process.EnablePublishQualificationStatusDuringRenewal	False	Enabling this parameter ensures that the status of a process is changed to "In Progress" when you renew the process.
Feature enablement	Application.SM.MQ.PrepopulateIntakeFormMatrixValuesToMQ	False	Enabling this parameter prepopulates matrix values from the intake form into the modular questionnaires used in a process.
Integration User or administrator interface Feature enablement	Application.SM.UI.SourcingBPSyncUI	False	Enables display of status information about the synchronization of inbound ERP business partners to sourcing, including the resulting supplier ACM ID, on the integration status page in SM Administration .

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Integration User or administrator interface Feature enablement Partitioned suppliers	Application.SM.UI.BuyingBP SyncUI	False	Enables display of information about the status of inbound ERP business partners to buying, including the supplier type and synchronization status, on the integration status page in SM Administration . Note This parameter is only applicable in sites where the partitioned supplier data feature (SM-30017) is enabled.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Integration Feature enablement	Application.SM.ApplicationSupportForFullName	False	Increases maximum size of the <code>vendor.vendorInfo.fullName</code> field from 140 to 160 characters, with corresponding increase in maximum size of <code>vendor.vendorInfo.name1</code> through <code>vendor.vendorInfo.name4</code> fields from 35 to 40 characters each, in sites where the supplier full name feature is enabled. ⚠ Caution Make sure that your configuration here matches the length of name fields in the integrated ERP system. Mismatch between maximum length of name fields in SAP Ariba and the integrated ERP system can result in inconsistencies or loss of data. If the Apply Field Restrictions validation tool is enabled on pages for adding or editing questions in project templates in your site, that tool sets a maximum length of 35 characters for individual name fields and 140 for the full name field by default. To increase these settings to 40 and 160 characters, also enable the parameter Increase maximum size for name fields to 40 characters each in applied field restrictions [page 305] (<code>Application.SM.Enable160CharacterSupportForFullName</code>) in Intelligent Configuration Manager.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Integration	Application.SM.UserMatrixServiceBasicAuthenticationEnabled	False	Enables basic authentication using user name and password for integration messages related to user matrix data in integrations that use the polling client. By default, the authentication configured for integrations that use SAP Integration Suite, managed gateway for spend management and SAP Business Network, which is certificate-based, is used.
User or administrator interface Feature enablement	Application.SM.UI.NewSupplier360Profile	False	Enables the feature for the new supplier profile summary (NGSM-2959). Enabling this parameter is only one step in the workflow for configuring this feature. For the complete workflow, see Enabling the Supplier Profile Summary in Your Site .

Note

The supplier profile summary is only supported in sites that include SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance or SAP Ariba Supplier Risk. It isn't supported in sites that include SAP Ariba Supplier Information and Performance Management (new architecture) without one of those other solutions.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Questionnaires	Application.SM.UseDnBDirectPlusAPI	False	Enables use of Dun & Bradstreet Direct + in place of D&B Worldbase marketing Plus with Linkage for data lookups in sites integrated with Dun & Bradstreet. For more information, see Dun & Bradstreet Integration with SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance.
Feature enablement Integration	Application.SM.SupplierRequest.EnableExternalValidationofSupplierCreation	False	Enables a final validation of supplier requests in an integrated SAP Master Data Governance system before supplier creation. Note Enabling or disabling this feature requires corresponding changes to the settings of both this feature parameter and the feature toggle SM-5694: Enable external validation of supplier creation in Intelligent Configuration Manager. Partially enabling or disabling the feature by changing the setting for one but not the other can cause unpredictable behavior or errors. After enabling both the feature toggle and the parameter, you configure the integration settings in your site to use MDG validation. For more information, see Requiring SAP MDG-S Validation and Approval of Supplier Creation in SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Feature enablement Questionnaires	Application.SM.SupplierRequest. EnableBusinessUnitSpecific NotificationsForExternalSupplierRequests	False	Enables display of business unit (department) name rather than the buyer organization's name in the external supplier request and in related notifications to suppliers and approvers. Note Enabling or disabling this feature requires corresponding changes to the settings of both this feature parameter and the feature toggle SM-6380: Enable business unit-specific notifications for external supplier requests in Intelligent Configuration Manager. Partially enabling or disabling the feature by changing the setting for one but not the other can cause unpredictable behavior or errors. After enabling both the feature toggle and the parameter, you set up the external supplier request. For more information, see External Supplier Requests by Business Unit.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Feature enablement User or administrator interface	Application.SM.Contact.EnableSupplierContactNameDisplayWithFamilyNameFirst	False	Shows supplier contact names in reverse order, with family name first, then middle name (if any), then first name, in the user interface and email notifications.

Note

Enabling or disabling this feature requires corresponding changes to the settings of both this parameter and the feature toggle **SM-15622: Enable supplier contact name display with family name first in Intelligent Configuration Manager**. Partially enabling or disabling the feature by changing the setting for one but not the other can cause unpredictable behavior or errors.

After enabling both the feature toggle and the parameter, there are additional steps for ensuring the correct display of existing contact data. For more information, see [Setting Up Your Site to Show Contact Names with Family Name First](#).

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Feature enablement	Application.SM.Bank.HideSWIFTCodeinBankAccountQuestions	False	Hides the Swift Code field in Bank Account questions. Note Enabling or disabling this feature requires corresponding changes to the settings of both this parameter and the feature toggle SM-28926: Enable hiding of Swift Code in Bank Account questions in Intelligent Configuration Manager. Partially enabling or disabling the feature by changing the setting for one but not the other can cause unpredictable behavior or errors.
Feature enablement	Application.SM.Vendor.EnableSupplierFullName	False	Adds a supplier full name field with a default length of 140 characters. The value in this field shows in the user interface of SAP Ariba applications and is split into the four individual name fields for integration. → Remember Enabling or disabling this parameter requires a corresponding change to SM-14213: Enable supplier full name in Intelligent Configuration Manager. Always enable or disable both together.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Feature enablement	Application.SM.Registration.EnableCustomSendersforSupplierRegistrationInvitations	False	Enables registration managers to choose requesters for supplier registrations and shows the requester as the sender in registration invitations. → Remember Enabling or disabling this parameter requires a corresponding change to SM-20904 : Enable custom senders for supplier registration invitations in Intelligent Configuration Manager. Always enable or disable both together.
Feature enablement	Application.SM.SupplierRequest.EnableExternalValidationofSupplierCreation	False	Enables a final validation of supplier requests in an integrated SAP MDG(S) system before supplier creation. → Remember Enabling or disabling this parameter requires a corresponding change to SM-5694: Enable external validation of supplier creation in Intelligent Configuration Manager. Always enable or disable both together.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Feature enablement	Application.SM.SupplierRequest.EnableBusinessUnitSpecificNotificationsForExternalSupplierRequests	False	Enables display of business unit (department) name rather than the buyer organization's name in the external supplier request and in related notifications to suppliers and approvers. → Remember Enabling or disabling this parameter requires a corresponding change to SM-6380: Enable business unit-specific notifications for external supplier requests in Intelligent Configuration Manager. Always enable or disable both together.
Feature enablement	Application.SM.Registration.EnableStatusTrackerForRegistrationInvitations	False	Enables a status tracker for email invitations for supplier registration, which shows when invitations are sent, opened, or bounced. → Remember Enabling or disabling this parameter requires a corresponding change to SM-5116: Enable status tracker for registration invitations in Intelligent Configuration Manager. Always enable or disable both together.

Parameter category	Parameter name	Default setting	Description
Questionnaires Integration	Application.SM.QuestionnaireVersionOnERPSync	False	When enabled, this parameter specifies that ERP synchronization only creates a new questionnaire version if the sync includes an update to at least one mapped question in the currently active version of the questionnaire. Otherwise, ERP synchronizations can create new questionnaire versions even when no data in the currently active version of the questionnaire is updated.
Feature enablement Integration	Application.SM.EnableBPSMProcessOutMessage	False	When enabled, this parameter sends the supplier qualification status information from SAP Ariba Supplier Lifecycle and Performance to Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) systems using custom generic fields in outbound Business Partner (BP) messages.
Feature enablement	Application.SM.EnableERCreationInSupplierRequest		

Related Information

[Enable internal supplier registrations \[page 296\]](#)

[Managing Configuration Parameters in Supplier Administration \[page 353\]](#)

[Managing Feature Toggles for the Site](#)

[Intelligent Configuration Manager Administration](#)

Managing Configuration Parameters in Supplier Administration

The configuration parameters in Supplier Administration control some specific supplier management functionality. Administrators can modify the values for these configuration parameters without having to raise a case with SAP Ariba Support. Use this procedure to manage configuration parameters.

Prerequisites

To manage parameters in **SM Administration**, you must be a member of the **SM Ops Administrator** group.

Context

You modify parameter values to enable or disable functionality controlled by the configuration parameters. For more information about specific parameters, refer to [Reference of Configuration Parameters in Supplier Administration \[page 318\]](#).

Procedure

1. On the dashboard, choose  **Manage**  **SM Administration** .
2. Choose **Configuration Parameters**.
3. Choose the options icon () to expand the list of options.
4. Do one of the following:
 - To see the parameter's description or modify its current value, choose **Edit**. If you're modifying a value, choose or enter the new value and choose **Save**.
 - To restore the parameter's default value, choose **Reset**.

Related Information

[Reference of Configuration Parameters in Supplier Administration \[page 318\]](#)

[Enable internal supplier registrations \[page 296\]](#)

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